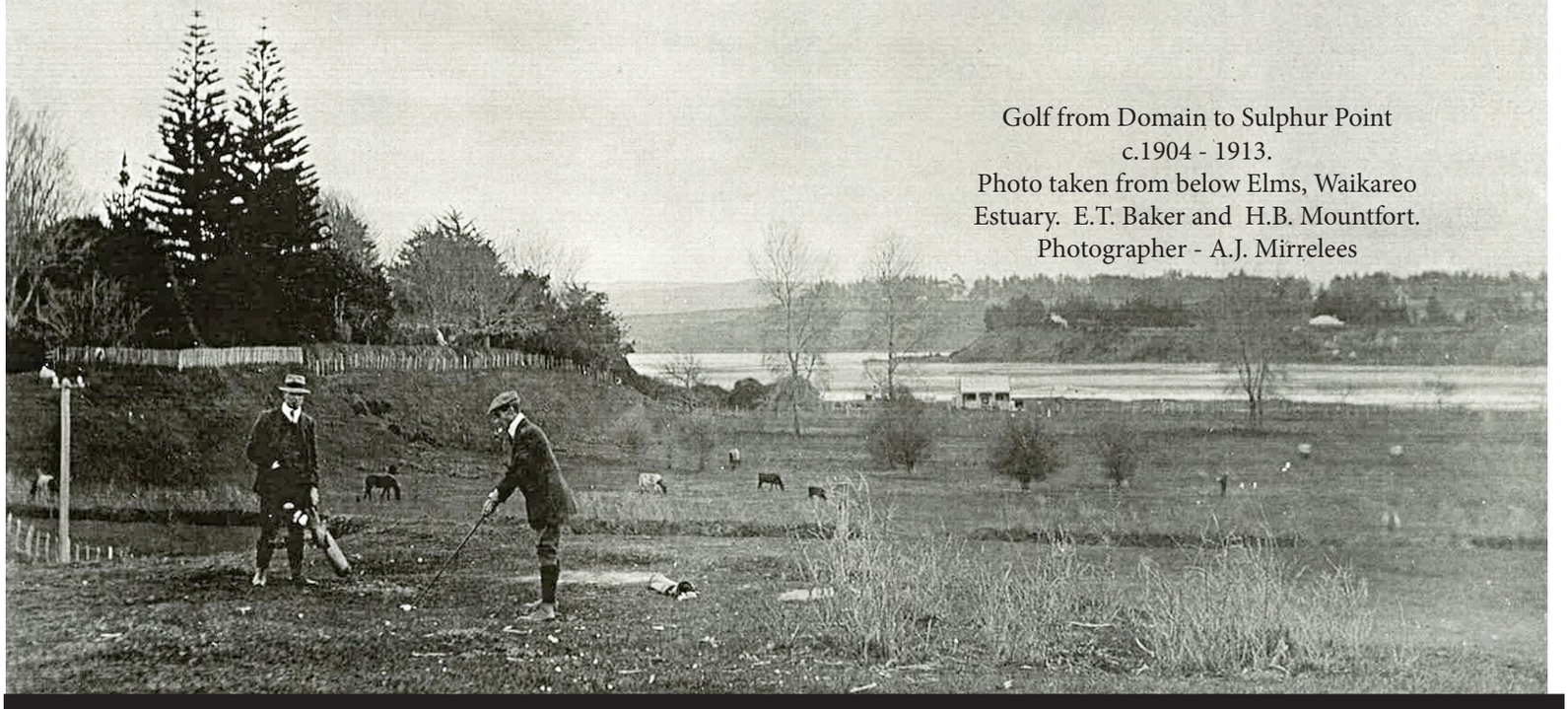
PARS FROM THE PAST



Golf from Domain to Sulphur Point
c.1904 - 1913.
Photo taken from below Elms, Waikareo
Estuary. E.T. Baker and H.B. Mountfort.
Photographer - A.J. Mirrelees

A HISTORY OF THE TAURANGA GOLF CLUB INCORPORATING A CELEBRATION OF ONE HUNDRED YEARS OF GOLF ON THE GATE PA LINKS FROM 1914 TO 2014

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“Golf in New Zealand - A Centennial History” by G.M. Kelly.

FOREWORD

I take great pleasure in writing this foreword to “Pars from the Past”, a comprehensive History of Golf in Tauranga over the past 110 years.

In terms of European settlement Tauranga is a very young city in a young country. Early British settlers brought much of their heritage to New Zealand, and the game of golf was established in Dunedin as early as 1871. This was almost 20 years earlier than the first American Golf Club was established. Golf in Tauranga owed it’s early beginnings to the arrival of Dr Brown from Dunedin who was instrumental in developing our first course on the Domain /Sulphur Point area of the town in 1904. That course proved to be less than ideal and, in 1913, the first overtures were made to the Trustees of the Racecourse Reserve to see if it was feasible to establish a course on the reserve at Greerton. To those people who had the vision to realise that an ideal golf course could be established on what may not at first sight have appeared the best available site, we owe an enormous debt of gratitude.
The course established so early in the twentieth century has been continually developed and improved over the succeeding 100 years so as to provide an enjoyable, yet challenging, course for hundreds of players through the past, the present and, we can be confident, many years into the future.

Miss Joan Mirrielees, a daughter of one of the true pioneers of golf in Tauranga, AJ Mirrielees, was the early historian to the club and her work was continued by Mrs Deidre Hartley and finally completed by long time member David Mowat. This history contains a record of the development of the original course in central Tauranga, the first course on the Racecourse Reserve that extended into the Racecourse oval, and the course as it is played today. While that record is important, this history is most notably a history of the people who have made the club what it is today. The stories of their selfless work over the course of the century, the personal anecdotes that show the human side of their personalities, these are the features of this work that will stand out for many readers.

While club members have contributed richly to our History, so too have the many visitors who have graced our course over the years. In this context the memorable visits of Professional players from around the world who featured in the Spalding Masters and the PGA Championships staged on the course in earlier years added much to the rich tapestry of our History.

David Mowat has captured the spirit of the people who make up our Club’s History in a manner that only a person with a true love of the game and its participants could have done. A member for over sixty years David was an ideal choice to take on the task of compiling this comprehensive, entertaining, and invaluable history of our Club.

On behalf of the Board of Management and of all past, present and future members, I thank David for this contribution to us all.

Graham Cathie – Board Chairman

INTRODUCTION

The gestation period of this Centennial history has been a long one. The early history of the Club was first compiled by the late Miss Joan Mirrielees in preparation for the Golden Jubilee of the club in 1961 but was not published owing to a lack of funding. Miss Mirrielees was a long time Club member, a teacher and an historian. Following that earlier compilation Miss Mirrielees wrote to the 1974 committee offering to prepare a 'complete history of the club'. This offer was accepted with enthusiasm, especially in view of the fact that the club was believed to be approaching its Diamond Jubilee year. The celebration of that milestone in 1986 seemed to cement the year 1911 as the foundation year of the club though there was evidence of a Golf Club in the town somewhat earlier. The move to the present course did not take place until 1914 when the existing club decided to take up an available lease on a portion of the Racecourse Reserve. 1911 appears to have been chosen from a perusal of the original championship honours boards, as this was the first year in which a club champion was officially recognised. Perhaps this represented a sensible compromise although it has now become clear that the club does indeed date back to 1904. Incidentally the honour of winning that first championship belonged to Mr A Matheson who repeated the feat the following year, and again in 1921 and 1927.

The major difficulty facing Miss Mirrielees and subsequent researchers has been a serious lack of documented and minuted history. At some time in the decade of the Forties the club secretary also acted as secretary to a local authority and rumour has it that there was a problem related to the funds of that authority and the said gentleman left town in undue haste, though not before taking the time to destroy significant records of both organisations. As it is impossible to substantiate these rumours so long after the event it may be best to leave the suspect unnamed. Whatever the truth of the matter no minute books recording the first thirty years or so of our history have been discovered. Fortunately Miss Mirrielees was able to contact a number of older residents and members who were able to recall some of the earlier history. Reference material gleaned from copies of the BOP Times held by the Tauranga City Library yielded further vital information.

As an indication of the difficulties faced in researching relevant material it was not until 1985 that the President was able to report to committee that Miss Mirrielees had made significant progress on the task. This enabled the President, Dr Eric Hutcheson, to give an interesting after dinner address on the early history of the club during the Diamond Jubilee celebrations held in 1986.

Miss Mirrielees died in 1989 without the satisfaction of seeing her work go to print .She did however leave a considerable amount of valuable material she had collected from a variety of sources. In time this material was passed on to Mrs Deidre Hartley who, in 1992, expressed the desire to produce a booklet in time for the 90th anniversary planned for June 2001. Over a period Deidre added both to the research and to the developing written text. In this endeavour members of the Ladies' committee assisted Deidre by preparing and distributing questionnaires to members, and by checking through old documents. A notable addition to the historical record was achieved when Deidre was able to interview Jack Bateman, one of the truly outstanding players of earlier years and a senior championship

winner as early as 1934. Jack was able to recall precise details of the original course laid out on the Racecourse Reserve as he had himself played it on many occasions. Much of the detail of that layout has been included in this publication as the result of the information obtained from those interviews. Sadly Deidre's health began to deteriorate before she was able to achieve as much as she would have wished in furthering the evolution of this history. Subsequently I was presented with the material that had been assembled to that date in the hope that I could use it to put together a coherent record of the first one hundred years of golf in Tauranga.

I soon realised that a great deal remained to be done. For example nothing had been done to document the deeds of the many outstanding visiting golfers who had competed in tournaments, professional and amateur, male and female, on our course. World-class performers, including winners of 'Majors' such as the British and US Opens, had graced our links and deserved their place in our history. The supposed Centennial in 2011 was rapidly approaching and a great deal of material still had to be collected, analysed, and organised into coherent form. Fortunately the deadline was extended forward by three years when further research proved the Club dated back to 1904.

A great many people have contributed richly to the development of the Tauranga Golf Club and I have endeavoured to give them credit for that. Unfortunately this could only be done from memory and from the meagre documentation that does exist. There will be many unsung heroes whom I have not been able to acknowledge and to them I apologise. They will have had the deep satisfaction of knowing that they helped develop and improve a vital asset to pass on to future generations. To those stalwarts of the past that would have been reward enough. My grateful thanks go to all those who have made a contribution to this history by way of oral or written material, by donating photographs, or by collecting information. Without them it would have been impossible to produce more than a basic outline of our colourful history.

Finally, though I have endeavoured to report facts in an impartial manner, it has been impossible to refrain from allowing some personal opinion to creep into this narrative. For that I make no apology. The relationship between the Mowat family and the Tauranga Golf Club since my father took up the role of Professional in 1936 dictates that it could never be otherwise.

CHAPTER ONE

SETTING THE SCENE

The earliest written record of Tauranga is attributed to Judge Wilson who served as Commissioner of Lands for the Tauranga District in the latter years of the 19th Century. In his 'Sketches of Ancient Maori Life and History' he records that when the canoe Takitimu, part of the first group of canoes to arrive from Hawaiki, called at Tauranga the newcomers found the district to be occupied by two tribes of aboriginal people known as the Purukapenga and the Ngamaramas. Purukapenga may be translated as 'Full Net' and so is in accord with James Cook's observation that this was a place of abundant resources. Despite the obvious attractions of the area the immigrants aboard Takitimu decided it would be wise to sail further south in search of less populated land. Nearly 600 years then passed prior to the arrival of the first European missionaries during which time numerous tribal battles were waged in attempts, both successful and unsuccessful, to lay claim to this most desirable of locations. Those early missionary newcomers were very soon supported by a strong contingent of British military forces and the stage was set for the commencement of the wide range of activities that these people from the other side of the world brought with them.

Construction of 'The Elms' Mission House began in 1838 and was completed in 1847. This was the home of Archdeacon Alfred Nesbit Brown who lived there until his death in 1884. In 1878 he wrote to a friend in London suggesting to him that he would barely recognise the town since he visited some years earlier. "We now have two large wharves, four weekly steamers, a large public office building, two well-built Banks, three churches, and three hotels. Land values have risen to prices that would astonish you. A quarter acre on the beach recently sold for £1670, he wrote."

Living today in this modern, rapidly growing city of Tauranga it is difficult to imagine what the district was like at the beginning of the 20th century. Because of the poorly formed un-metalled roads the town was isolated. Access was mainly by steamer from Auckland. Even so there was considerable development as described by the Archdeacon above. The Strand and Devonport Road were thriving shopping and business centres, though life remained sufficiently relaxed that it was not unusual to find 'gone fishing' notices posted on shop and office doors. If business was urgent the proprietors were only too happy to be summoned from the waterfront.

The importance of horse-drawn transport was highlighted by the presence of Lane's livery stables on the corner of Spring Street and Grey Street, where the National Bank now stands, and by the Grey Street Smithy where Arthur Rolfe plied his trade. That same Blacksmith's shop was still operating in the 1950s with Charlie Haua at the forge.
The now demolished Town Hall was built in 1913 where the City Council offices now stand and no less than four hotels, complete with water troughs and hitching rails, competed for custom in the down town area. The Fire Brigade Headquarters, Mechanics Institute, Hammond's Bakery, and the Bay of Plenty Times Office were prominent buildings in the centre of the township. Cameron Road was a narrow strip, dusty in summer, muddy in winter, flanked by grassy verges where cows grazed.

The earliest European settlers must have included many far-sighted people for they dedicated areas for sport and recreation well before the turn of the century. By that time the Domain boasted six grass

tennis courts and two croquet greens while the bowling club was established on the Domain in 1906. The rugby football ground alongside was also in active use while a cricket club had been established as early as 1873. The Tauranga Boating Club, involving both Rowing and Yachting, followed soon after in 1878. By 1880 prosperity and stability were beginning to develop and Tauranga was becoming much more than 'an old soldiers settlement'. In 1882 Tauranga gained status as a Borough under the Municipalities Act. This allowed it to raise loans to finance the provision of public infrastructure such as roads and water supply, each being desperately needed. The first Mayor was George Vesey Stewart, an immigration agent from Ireland who had been largely responsible for arranging settlement of immigrants from Britain into the Western Bay of Plenty. He is especially honoured as the founder of Katikati while Te Puke also owes its origins to him. His faithfully restored home, Athenree House, has become an important historic landmark on the road to Waihi Beach.

Wise forethought by the early settlers ensured that an area of 200 acres comprising sections 22-25 of the Parish of Te Papa was reserved from sale in order to preserve it for future use as a racecourse and recreation reserve. This was gazetted on 10th of October 1878 and the area became known as the Racecourse Reserve. Thus the stage was set for people further ahead in time to develop the Reserve as a permanent asset to the developing township.

While the origins of the game of Golf are widely debated credit for the establishment of officially organised golf must lie with the 'Honourable Company of Edinburgh Golfers' founded in 1744. The first British 'Open' was held at Prestwick in 1860 and was 'open' only to professionals. The amateur championship of Great Britain followed in 1885. With these dates in mind it must be said that golf in this part of the World got off to an early start as Royal Adelaide, the first Australian Golf Club was founded in 1870. The Dunedin Golf Club followed just one year later. Surprisingly the first Club in the USA, Oakhurst in Virginia, was not established until 1885. John Reid, who founded the Saint Andrews Club at Yonkers in New York in 1888, is regarded as the father of golf in the USA as it was he who provided the initial stimulus that popularised the game there. Though the first United States Open was not held until as late as 1895, the growth of the game throughout America was such that by 1900 over 1000 courses had been established there. In that same year the A G Spalding and Brothers Sporting Goods Company contracted the immortal English Professional Harry Vardon to participate in a barnstorming exhibition tour of the USA to promote their new Gutta Percha ball, the Vardon Flyer. The exhibitions during this ten-month tour attracted thousands of spectators, including many who had had no previous exposure to the great game. The spark that John Reid had struck was fanned into raging flames by the Vardon tour. By the time it was over more than one hundred new courses were planned or under construction and the development of American Golf was in overdrive. In view of these facts it is significant that Golf had such an early start in the small, isolated settlement of Tauranga.

Charles Richie Howden was the New Zealand equivalent of America's John Reid. He arrived in Dunedin from Edinburgh in 1861 at the age of 23. He became the first Captain of the Dunedin Golf Club in 1871 where the subscription is recorded as having been set at one guinea. A guinea was 21 shillings designed to include the commission payable in the pound on livestock sales. Racehorse sales in New Zealand were still being quoted in guineas almost up to the time of decimal currency. Besides being

recognised as the father of New Zealand Golf Charles Howden founded The New Zealand Distilling Company to produce whisky in Dunedin. Howden left New Zealand in 1881 and, with his departure, the Dunedin Golf Club appears to have expired after its short ten-year life. Eight years later Howden returned to Dunedin and, in 1889, was instrumental in setting up the Otago Golf Club at Balmacewan. That club continues as a major club today. Notable in the list of inaugural members of the original Dunedin Golf Club was a Dr W. M. Brown who later served on the committee of the club that succeeded it, the Otago Golf Club.

Development of the game in New Zealand was very rapid and by the outbreak of World War Two Tauranga was just one of some eighty clubs affiliated to the New Zealand Golf Association that had been established in 1910. Even more rapid expansion followed the cessation of war in 1918 and by 1929 the number of clubs had swelled to 159. Today it is claimed we boast more clubs per head of population than any other country with the possible exception of Scotland where it all began. Certainly the game here is available and affordable to almost all who wish to play, something not true in most parts of the World. On the subject of costs a 1928 edition of New Zealand Golf Illustrated published an average annual golfing budget for the guidance of those contemplating taking up the game. The total cost per year was estimated at £16/2/6 made up of club fees (£6/10/0), balls (£5), repairs (£1), and refreshments (£3/12/6). This annual cost would perhaps be less than some would now spend on a single afternoon at the club. While no comment was made on the cost of equipment to get you started we can be confident that £10 would have done you proud. Based on these figures refreshments represented about 22% of a player's annual expenditure. I wonder what proportion of the average member's annual expenditure is now represented by the cost of refreshments.

Over the years there have been many holes in one, some more unusual than others. Perhaps Harry Jeffreys began it all in the early days when the fifth tee was located inside the Racecourse oval. The green was where the grandstand now stands. Harry made a mighty heave at the ball only succeeding in topping it so that it never became truly airborne. In spite of this it scrambled across the racetrack, hit a tree trunk, straightened up after striking a fence post, trickled up the hill onto the green, and finally dribbled exhausted into the cup. The perfect shot!

Perhaps a more notable hole in one was that scored by Miss Rachell Baker in October 1940 when she holed her tee shot at the notorious Knoll. Apart from the personal thrill associated with the perfect stroke Miss Baker had the distinction of being the first woman to achieve the feat on the course. To commemorate her achievement the Ladies of the Club presented Miss Baker with an engraved silver goblet. I wonder where that goblet is today

CHAPTER TWO

THE FIRST TEE

Dr. W M Brown when he arrived from Dunedin in 1903, most probably by Coastal Steamer, carried with him the seed from which the Tauranga Golf Club grew. While it is uncertain if this Dr Brown and the Dr. William M Brown mentioned above as an inaugural member of the Dunedin Golf Club were one and the same it does seem extremely likely. Both were surgeons hailing from Dunedin, each man had an abiding interest in the game of golf, and the timing fits such a scenario. The earliest written evidence of golf in Tauranga can be found in the Archives of The Bay of Plenty Times dated 20th April 1904 where it is recorded that a Golf Club had been, or was being, formed in Tauranga. On June 20th that same year the Times reported: 'an interesting golf match was played here yesterday afternoon between members of the club for a clique (Sic) presented by Dr. Brown'. Mr. J Bull won this valuable trophy.[1]

Although the year 1911 has long been recognised as the foundation year of the Tauranga Golf Club it is clear the Club can trace its existence back to 1904. This is evidenced by a report in the BOP Times of 17th May 1905 in which it was observed:

'The Tauranga Golf Club has started operations for the present season, and several of the members can be seen on the links at all hours of the day energetically practising. At the annual meeting held on Saturday evening Dr Brown and Mr J Bull were re-elected Captain and Secretary respectively'.

Clearly the club had been in existence prior to that meeting. That Dr. Brown was the inspiration behind the birth of the fledgling club is confirmed by the recollections of early residents who credited Dr. Brown with being instrumental in forming the club and in laying out nine holes based on the present Domain area in central Tauranga.[2]

Foundation in 1904 is further supported by documentary evidence to be found in archived material from the Bay of Plenty Times dated 18th of June 1906. In that edition there is a report of 'a merry gathering at the Masonic Hotel when the past Mayor of Tauranga, Dr. W Brown, was entertained at dinner by the members of the Tauranga Golf and kindred clubs. Mr W Commons, Mayor, occupied the chair and, in proposing a toast to the guest of honour, he said all would regret that they were about to say farewell to Dr. Brown. It was not often that a town of this size had the services of one of such a high profession

1 Editor's note: The correct name for the club presented by Dr. Brown is a cleek, a steep faced driving iron, though the BOP Times reporter of the day could be forgiven his lack of knowledge of the game and its implements.

2 [Editor's Note. The year 1911, upon which the 50th and 75th jubilee celebrations of 1961 and 1986 were based, appears to have been recognised as the Club's foundation year based on evidence sourced from old Honours Boards. These commenced with the championship victory of Mr. A Matheson in that year of 1911. It is now clear that the club was founded in 1904 and moved to the present course at the Racecourse Reserve in 1914. The Board of Management in 2009 decided not to proceed with Centennial celebrations in 2011 but instead to celebrate 100 years of golf at the Gate Pa links in 2014. Thereafter it is expected that the Club will recognise 1904 as the foundation year upon which to base significant milestones in the future.

of skill as Dr. Brown. He, the mayor, had expected Dr. Brown to be here for many years and he had no right to give up the mayoralty and throw it upon him (the speaker). Dr. Brown had been a member of the Racecourse Domain Board and had given that role great and successful attention. On the School Committee he had proved himself a tower of strength and had helped them along in a way that no one else could have done. He had taken great interest in Golf and this had been the salvation of many of them. He hoped interest would be kept up. The Mayor then presented the Doctor with a small token of their esteem in the form of a case of pipes, cigar and cigarette holders.

In reply Dr. Brown said it took his breath away to hear the nice things that had been said of him. In presenting him with pipes they were simply pandering to his weakness. They must have noticed his pipes were very shabby. He expressed regret at leaving Tauranga. He and his wife both liked the town and he had hoped to spend the rest of his days here but stress of circumstances was too much for them. He commented on the grand climate of Tauranga and the beautiful scenery and stressed the need for municipal enterprise. Tauranga needed a water supply and other facilities and Mr. Commons, after viewing some municipalities at home in Britain, had come back full of enterprise and go. With an enterprising Mayor and a live Council Tauranga was bound to go ahead. He said Tauranga was a town without peer in New Zealand. It had a splendid harbour that should be the Port for the Bay and for the Waikato. When he returned he hoped to find a railway station, the town lighted with gas or electricity, and a library built. On the medical side he was leaving in his place Dr. Gault, an excellent man of high professional attainments, high character, and a good fellow. He hoped they would extend the same right-handed fellowship to him as they had done to the speaker during the two or three years he had been here. Mr Semadini then read a farewell ode written by a ‘Bunkered Poet’.

The poem, while perhaps not of any great literary merit, bears reprinting here as a graphic commentary on those times and the influence Dr. Brown had on the developing community during his short residence in Tauranga. From the poem it becomes apparent that the game of Bridge, as with Golf, owes its origins in the town to the initiative and enthusiasm of Dr Brown.

FAREWELL ODE

By a “Bunkered Poet”

We are gathered here this evening,
For a farewell Korero,
With our guest the good old Doctor Brown,
But ‘white’ as we all know.

Since he came into our midst,
About two years ago,
He’s taught us Bridge, He’s taught us Golf,
And Things we didn’t know.
He showed to us the strokes of Golf,

With the patience of a Job,
But the adjectives came naturally
When we failed to hit the ‘Globe’.

He taught us how to tee a ball,
And from a bunker get;
But he did not teach us stymie,
As it just is not etiquette.

And when we thought the game was done,
And finished for the day,
We had his innovation-
The nineteenth hole to play.

Now the nineteenth hole is not a hole,
We never called out ‘Fore!’
But we always liked a halved one,
And sometimes played ‘one more’.

We’ll think of him when he is gone,
And is miles and miles away.
We’ll drink his health and happiness,
When the nineteenth hole we play.

He taught us how to Double Hearts,
Hold four aces, get a slam,
And if we happened to revoke,
Why, he never used a damn.

There’ll be no such thing as Doubled Spades,
And Golf will ne’er be seen,
And the little bird will build a nest,
In the hole on the putting green.

We will keep the Golf Balls snowy white,
And the Golf Clubs clean we’ll scrub,
In honour of the father of,
The Tauranga Golfing Club.

We wish to him and Mrs. Brown,
Long life where’re they roam,
But the best of wishes we can wish,
Is good health and safely home.

As no other claimants have come forward, or are ever likely to do so, we are happy to recognise Dr. Brown as the founder of golf in Tauranga and to give to him the honour of opening proceedings by driving the first ball to commence the first one hundred years of golf in the region.

A report of the AGM of 1910 was printed in the BOP Times of 27th April of that year. The meeting was held in the office of Mr. Phillips who was elected Captain, while Messrs. Sharp, Bull, and McKenzie were elected to the committee. The position of Secretary-Treasurer was not filled and it was left to the committee to fill the vacancy. Misses E and M Wrigley were welcomed as new members along with Messrs. D Selby, A Tudhope, J A McLeod, and G L Cook.

The name Wrigley was well known in the Town in earlier years as 16th Avenue was known as Wrigley Street until some 'progressive' council decided to destroy so much of Tauranga's history by dropping many original Street names and replacing them with rather uninspired numbered Avenues. The Avenues originally did not go beyond 11th Avenue. The intersection of that street with Cameron Road was known as Faulkner's Corner in recognition of the General Store run by the pioneer Faulkner family. Mr Wrigley himself was a well-known local merchant who owned cutters that ran a regular service between Auckland and Tauranga. He also served a term as Mayor of the township. The names Sharp and Tudhope remained prominent in the City more than a century later in the Legal Partnership of that name.

In addition to the names mentioned above the original list of members who played at the Domain course included W H Clemson, R Stubbing, F Cramer-Roberts, W M Darley, J A McKenzie, H B Mountfort and ET Baker. The subscription for men rose to one pound and for women just five shillings. Dr Brown arrived at golf in a two-wheel gig driven by Arthur Faulkner whose family were to have a significant influence on trading and transport in the district for many years into the future. The good doctor's bag contained just four hickory-shafted clubs: a driver/brassie, a cleek, a lofter and a putter. His driving club was somewhat between a 1 and a 2 wood, the cleek was akin to a 2 or 3 iron while the lofter would be a little like a modern sand iron. The responsibility of transporting this burden around the course was delegated to his caddie, one Ossie Daines, who received a shiny sixpence for his trouble. Other players may well have had a more extensive range of equipment including the mid-iron, mashie, mashie niblick, and niblick, corresponding more or less to the 3, 5, 7, and 9 irons of today. The fairway woods called Brassie and Spoon (3 wood) would hardly be required given the length of the holes they played.
The 1911 balance sheet of the club showed just one asset, a hand mower valued at thirty shillings. There were no employees to be paid and probably no shortage of volunteers when and as required.

The course laid out by Dr Brown and based at the Domain was bounded to the North by Brown Street, to the East by Cameron Road, to the South by McLean Street, and to the West by the sea. It started from the South West corner of the Wharepai Domain, the first green being located where the Band Rotunda used to stand at the top of the rise near the entrance to the Tennis Courts and behind the Bowling Green The second hole then ran through the present Rugby ground into the Domain extension which was first designated as High School reserve land. The course then ran through swampy ground below The Elms Mission House before moving down on to Sulphur Point. There must have been some

unusual hazards including that of having to play around, or perhaps through, rugby games in progress. Narrow trenches crossed the fairway on the High School Reserve. These were the aftermath of the European camp constructed during the Maori Wars. These trenches and some other fortifications, made beautiful by masses of white and blue flag lilies, made an unusual form of bunker. One tee was by Waimarie Guest House on McLean Street and the 'fairway' was an unformed road to a green by the gates of the Mission Chapel. The next hole was played from a high tee on the Northeast corner of the Domain extension down to an Island green surrounded by water at high tide - shades of modern USA course design perhaps. This green was located where Odlin's Timber Mill was later located. The land is now the site of the Trinity Hotel. Access to the green was by way of a few tussocky stepping-stones, particularly challenging to ladies wearing long skirts, as was the regulation golf attire of the day. The men were more appropriately turned out in knickerbockers. It was somewhat later that fashion conscious men turned to plus fours for added comfort and style.

The next hole extended eastwards along the flat towards the Military Cemetery. There were no roads, houses or railway, to impede progress, only a large frog pond in the middle of the fairway. The longest hole, 'The Camp', was some 420 yards and rated a bogey 6, bogey having the meaning that par has today. There were some unusual bogey ratings, the sixth and seventh holes being rated 3.5 and 4.5 respectively. Other than these two and the bogey-six second hole there was one bogey 5, four bogey 4s, and a single bogey 3, the final hole of only 105 yards. The bogey 5 eighth was only 210 yards so we have to presume it had to be negotiated in a double dog-leg pattern. The course of only 1860 yards (1690m) in length was rated bogey 38, a very generous rating by the standards of today. In spite of its lack of length the course must have represented a true challenge to the best of players considering the equipment available and the hazards encountered. After completing the first five holes the course returned along almost the same route it followed on the way out - reminiscent of the 'R and A' but perhaps not quite in the same class. The final hole finished where it began at the 'Clubhouse', a tin shed shared by rugby players beneath huge pines on the Southern boundary of Wharepai Domain.

A card from that original Club was discovered in the archives held by the City Library and the names of holes recall some of the early history of the town. In order those names were Bowler, The Camp, End of the World, Dynamite, Railway, The Straight, The Cliff, Anzac, and Home. The origin of many of these names is obvious. Bowler confirms the bowling club was already in existence while Dynamite no doubt refers to the dangerous goods store that was on Sulphur Point. Anzac however is a mystery as this acronym supposedly originated from the Gallipoli campaign of World War 1. That surely came later than the date this card was printed.

In very early times Dominic Corrigan claimed he could drive a ball off his gold watch. When challenged he demonstrated this talent before a large and interested gallery on the first tee. The spectators were witness only to the total destruction of a very good watch.

The local rules recorded on the card give some insight into the conditions faced by our pioneer players. They include:

1. Out of Bounds - Mr Rowe's Property. Through the fence to the right of the course from the eighth tee.
2. In driving from the third tee should a ball fall into and remain in the water or sand adjoining the hole it may be lifted and dropped further away from the hole without penalty.
3. If a ball lands in the sea from the drive off at hole 3 the player may lift and drop the same an equal distance from the hole without penalty.
4. A ball lying in hoof marks or cattle tracks may be lifted and dropped behind without penalty. This does not apply to a ball in a hazard.
5. All ditches on the course are hazards.
6. A ball lying on an intermediate putting green must be lifted and dropped off the green from a height of six inches without penalty at any point not more than two club lengths from the edge of the green, but not nearer to the hole to which it is being played.
7. A ball lying on or touching horse or cow dung may be lifted and dropped not more than a club length behind without penalty. If in a hazard the ball shall be dropped in the hazard.
8. Parties playing odd holes have no standing on the green.
9. On medal and match days parties not playing in the medal or match competition must give way to those who are playing.
10. On Saturday afternoons gentlemen may pass ladies on any part of the course.
11. On Saturdays players shall not be permitted to play odd holes on Findlay's paddock unless they have completed two rounds.

Another point of interest gleaned from this card is that the recognised competitions of the day were Medal, Match, and Bogey (Par). The ubiquitous Stableford system had yet to be invented by Dr Frank Stableford, an English gentleman searching for a way to overcome the problem of one bad hole ruining his round. It was at Wallasley Golf Club near Liverpool in 1931 that this plus handicapper first suggested the system be adopted and it spread rapidly around the golfing world, perhaps to the detriment of the more demanding formats. It is also interesting to note that the longest hole on the old Domain course was the number one/two stroke hole while the shortest was stroke seventeen/eighteen.

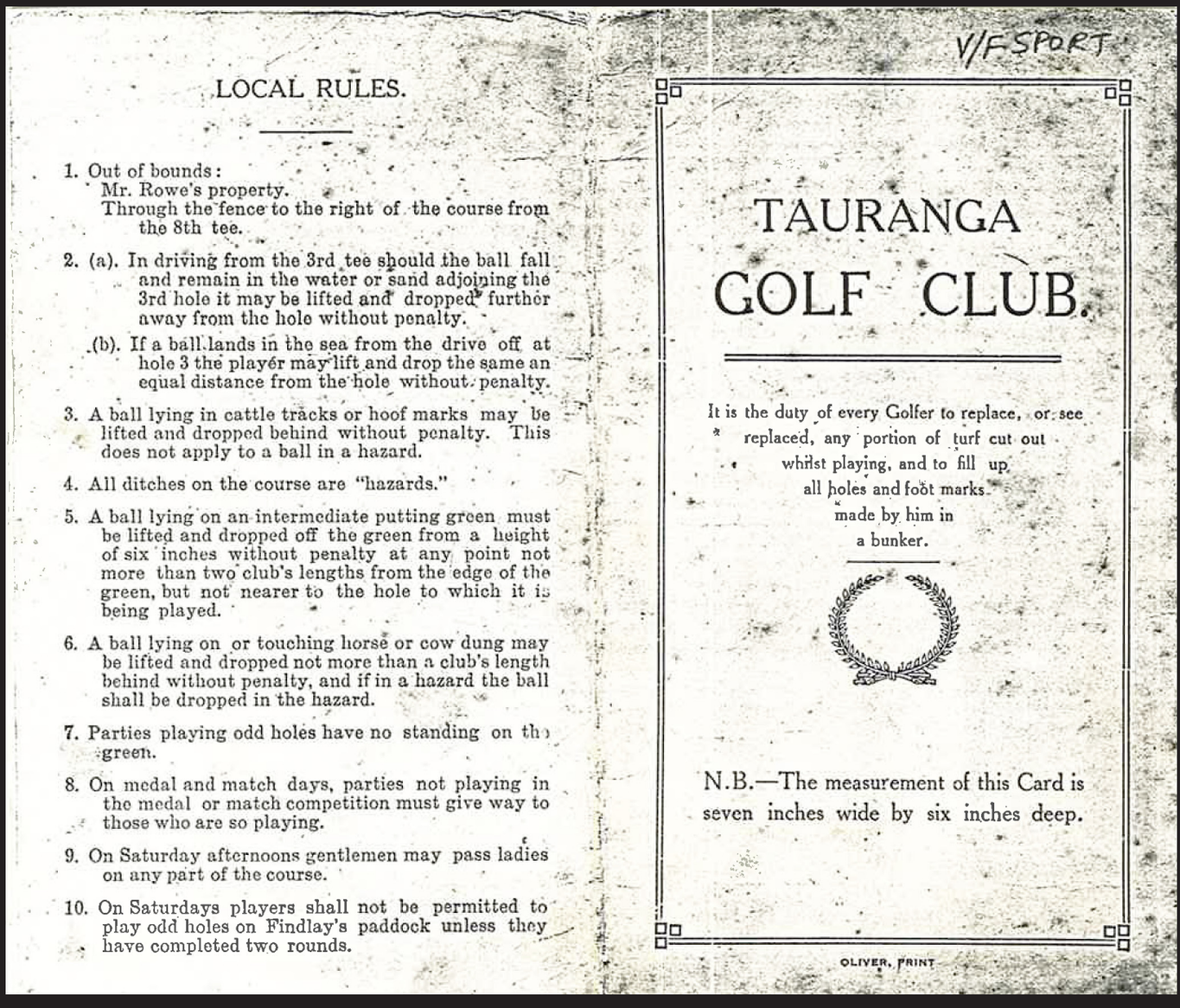
Jack Rowe, who lived in 'Waimarie' on the corner of Cameron Road and Brown Street, recalled that his father, Bert Rowe, somewhat reluctantly took up the game after much urging from his golfing friends. After just six weeks of play he entered and won the championship and promptly gave the game away to return to bowls after declaring that golf was 'just a kid's game'. It would seem few others found the game, or perhaps the course and its unusual hazards, quite so easy. A report on the results of a mixed foursomes competition in 1904 record the winning pair of Mr. Sharp and Miss Bull as finishing five down on bogey (now par). Dr. Brown and Mrs. Corbett were eight down, while the remaining eight pairs finished either ten down or twelve down.

Initially no golf was played on Sundays in deference to the puritanical views of the Landlady of 'The Elms'. When she sold all her sections Sunday golf became standard practice.

Following the 1905 report of an Annual General Meeting in the BOP Times the Club does not appear to have again been mentioned in that journal until June 10th 1908 when a report was carried of the AGM. This was held in the Orderly Room of Tauranga Mounted Rifles, with Mr Bull being elected Captain and Mr Ward Honorary Secretary/Treasurer. Reporting on the finances of the Club Mr Bull stated that the "annual expenses of maintenance had averaged about five pounds". Some dozen new members were elected including four ladies. It was resolved to hold a 16-hole singles tournament under medal play format, an entrance fee of one shilling being made to cover prizes. Players were to be handicapped and a handicapping committee of Messrs Bull, McKenzie, and Shackleford was appointed. Two rounds of the then eight hole course would need to be completed during the one afternoon and proper cards were to be kept with the card showing 'each stroke played for each hole, and the total for the same'. Perhaps one hole had been lost to the sea at the time so reducing the course to 8 holes.

The BOP Times issue of 17th May 1909 reported the election of Mr. J Bull as Captain, Mr. G A Ward as Secretary-Treasurer, and Messrs. H A Sharp, A Matheson, and H Phillips, as committee members. Mr. J A McKenzie presided over the meeting at which it was reported the Balance Sheet was in credit to the tune of 2/6d. Subscriptions were set at 10s for gentlemen, 5s for ladies, and 2/6d for juniors under 18. As Mr. Matheson, soon to be recognised as the first club champion, was welcomed as a new member to this meeting it is apparent that there was no great competition for positions on the committee. The Secretary reported that an order for £2.10.6d worth of balls had been placed but they had not yet been received.

Bill Darley, Secretary to the Club in 1951-53, used to enjoy relating a story from play on the old Domain course. A certain gentleman had the bad habit of playing up on the group ahead. There was a short hole played from the northern end of the Domain, across a small harbour inlet, to Sulphur Point. While Bill was putting out a ball landed on the edge of the green. The offender was at it again! Bill took out his Brassie and smote the ball a couple of hundred yards into the estuary. Bill was on the next green when the said gentleman arrived and asked if anyone had seen his ball. Like the man he was Bill promptly owned up. "Yes, you played onto us and I hope your ball is now well on its way to the open sea somewhere near the Mount."



LOCAL RULES.

1. Out of bounds:
   Mr. Rowe's property.
   Through the fence to the right of the course from the 8th tee.
2. (a). In driving from the 3rd tee should the ball fall and remain in the water or sand adjoining the 3rd hole it may be lifted and dropped further away from the hole without penalty.
   (b). If a ball lands in the sea from the drive off at hole 3 the player may lift and drop the same an equal distance from the hole without penalty.
3. A ball lying in cattle tracks or hoof marks may be lifted and dropped behind without penalty. This does not apply to a ball in a hazard.
4. All ditches on the course are "hazards."
5. A ball lying on an intermediate putting green must be lifted and dropped off the green from a height of six inches without penalty at any point not more than two club's lengths from the edge of the green, but not nearer to the hole to which it is being played.
6. A ball lying on or touching horse or cow dung may be lifted and dropped not more than a club's length behind without penalty, and if in a hazard the ball shall be dropped in the hazard.
7. Parties playing odd holes have no standing on the green.
8. On medal and match days, parties not playing in the medal or match competition must give way to those who are so playing.
9. On Saturday afternoons gentlemen may pass ladies on any part of the course.
10. On Saturdays players shall not be permitted to play odd holes on Findlay's paddock unless they have completed two rounds.

V/F SPORT

TAURANGA
GOLF CLUB.

It is the duty of every Golfer to replace, or see replaced, any portion of turf cut out whilst playing, and to fill up all holes and foot marks made by him in a bunker.

N.B.—The measurement of this Card is seven inches wide by six inches deep.

OLIVER, PRINT

Card of original course
based on the Domain area.
Supplied by Miss Joan Mirrielees
the first club historian.

N.B.—This Card is SIX inches DEEP.

HANDICAP. Stroke | Bogey

Holes.	OUT.	Strokes—where taken	YARDS.	BOGEY.	Ladies' Bogey.	Competitor's Score.	Won + Lost — Halved O	Marker's Score.	Won + Lost — Halved O
1	Bowler	11	180	4					
2	The Camp	1	420	6					
3	End of theWorld	9	184	4					
4	Dynamite	7	217	4					
5	Railway	13	145	4					
6	The Straight	15	168	3½					
7	The Cliff	3	231	4½					
8	Anzac	5	210	5					
9	Home	17	105	3					
			1860	38					

Holes.	IN.	Strokes—where taken	YARDS.	BOGEY.	Ladies' Bogey.	Competitor's Score.	Won × Lost — Halved O	Marker's Score.	Won × Lost — Halved O
10	Bowler	12	180	4					
11	The Camp	2	420	6					
12	End of theWorld	10	184	4					
13	Dynamite	8	217	4					
14	Railway	14	145	4					
15	The Straight	16	168	3½					
16	The Cliff	4	231	4½					
17	Anzac	6	210	5					
18	Home	18	105	3					
	IN		1860	38					
	OUT		1860	38					
	TOTAL 18 HOLES		3720	76					
	HANDICAP								
	NET SCORES								
	BOGEY SCORE								

Competitor.....

Marked by.....

Date.....

If a hole is won from or halved with Bogey, the actual strokes taken MUST be inserted.

PLEASE PASS THROUGH PLAYERS WHO HAVE LOST THEIR PLACE ON THE GREEN.

Miss Joan Mirrielees
the first club historian.

Golfing Party at Mrs Ashworths, Tauranga

CHAPTER THREE

MORE DISTANT FAIRWAYS

The obvious deficiencies of the Domain course and the increasing pressure of Rugby and other sports on the grounds would have encouraged members to seek an alternative location and in 1914 the decision was made to take up an available lease at the Racecourse Reserve. This was done in spite of the fact that the early portents for the land were far from encouraging. The area was described as bleak, treeless, and open to all the winds of heaven, especially the Westerlies that appear to have been more prevalent in those days. The President of the time termed it “the coldest place within 20 miles of Tauranga.”

The history of the Racecourse Reserve dates back to 1878 when it was Gazetted that the Governor of the then Colony of New Zealand had reserved from sale that parcel of land containing 200 acres known as the Racecourse Reserve, the land to be designated for ‘a recreation ground and racecourse’. An addition to The Act of 1880 provided that all sums of money received in respect of the lands were to be applied, after deducting costs and expenses, in improving the lands in respect of which the money was received. This provision has continued to apply throughout the history of the Reserve with the lessee clubs being the beneficiaries of the rentals they pay. Initially Trustees appointed by, and responsible to, the Minister of Crown Lands administered the Reserve. These trustees were elected by the public every seven years and it was not unusual for a degree of lobbying to be undertaken prior to the election in order to ensure particular interests were catered to. In this regard the members of the Golf Club appear to have been somewhat slow to protect their interests. As a result the Racing Club had the right to park vehicles on the 8th, 9th, and 10th fairways each Race Day, and to allow traffic coming from the south to enter via the gate behind the 14th green and to then travel across the golf course to reach those parking areas. This even happened on wet winter days with the expected damage to fairways. In those earlier times attendance at race meetings was much greater than is generally the case now and it was not unusual for all three fairways to be covered in cars. By the end of a race day the Golf Club fairways were usually littered with discarded tickets, lunch wrappings, chicken bones and the like, while on wet days they suffered badly as the soft ground became cut up by vehicles driving across them. Consequently relationships between the two neighbouring Clubs were often severely strained.

The situation improved during the Fifties when some effective lobbying by Golf Club representatives resulted in the election of Domain Board Trustees more sympathetic to the interests of golfers. Several years of negotiations eventually led to an amicable agreement being reached in 1961. Life Member and Honorary Solicitor J C (John) Hare was chiefly instrumental in achieving this agreement which covered a number of contentious issues. None the less, just one year later Secretary Noel Hockin wrote to the Racing Club expressing dismay that the Racing Club proposed breaking the agreement on parking and traffic movement for the scheduled Race Meeting to be held on the 14th of April 1962. In spite of his objection 250 cars entered via the 13th fairway. On this occasion the steward in charge of parking cut the chain locking the gate behind the 14th green with bolt cutters. Even as late as June 1965, the Golf Club committee minutes record that it was still deemed necessary to secure that gate with chain and padlock should weather conditions be adverse. This was in spite of the fact that the right to park on the fairways had supposedly been rescinded in 1960.

Relationships between the two Clubs appeared to improve dramatically from the early Seventies. A

number of factors probably contributed to this. For some time there had been agitation from some elements of the Greerton Community who claimed they were not able to derive much benefit from the 'Park in their backyard'. This was in spite of the fact that many local residents did use the Reserve to jog, to walk, or to attend activities. A meeting of the combined committees of Golf and Racing, meeting under the auspices of the Domain Board, negotiated an agreement whereby the Golf Club would transfer the lease they had long held over McKinlay's paddock and one quarter of the inner oval to the Racing Club. These areas, though in the Golf Club lease, had not been utilised by them since the days when the Golf course extended into the oval. In return the Racing Club undertook to make facilities available to the public so far as was possible without interfering with their own activities. Consequently the Greerton Soccer (Football) Club was granted use of land within the oval where they developed two fields. These fields remained in use until the Club moved elsewhere in 2008. Picnic facilities were developed in McKinlay's Paddock where specimen trees were planted to provide shade and generally beautify the area. In addition the Racing Club sub-leased an area within the oval to Equestrian Interests. These measures were successful to the extent that the interests of many appeared to be satisfied, and local agitation was no longer heard. Fortunately the interests of Golf and Racing had prevailed and eventually the future of the Racecourse Reserve, and tenure in perpetuity of the Tauranga Golf Club upon it, were enshrined in legislation. Generations of the future could look forward to enjoying the game of golf on a course that had offered great playing conditions and a more than adequate challenge to players of all levels of ability since early in the twentieth century.

The original lease term granted to the Golf Club had been for a period of just seven years. This did not confer upon the fledgling club a great measure of security of tenure. This all changed for the better in 1944 when the Crown appointed a Racecourse Domain Board to administer the area on behalf of the Crown. This Board was given the authority to lease any part of the Reserve 'at reasonable rental and under reasonable conditions for a term not exceeding 33 years at any one time.' This 33 year lease term was a big step towards permanence for the Club as the original lease term of just seven years did not allow the members to outlay capital in the confidence that they would always be able to lease the area and thus continue to derive benefit from the investment they had made in developing the land and associated buildings.

In 1956 an additional area of a little more than two hectares to the side of the third fairway was purchased by the Crown and incorporated into the area leased to the Golf Club. As a result the Reserve now contains a fraction over 83 hectares of which 34 hectares is leased to Racing Tauranga, 45 hectares to the Golf Club, the remainder being Reserve land adjoining the Golf Club boundaries. A further area adjacent to the third fairway was incorporated into the Club's lease in 2010 and the land developed as a turf nursery. In the present era 45 hectares would not be considered sufficient by some margin for the establishment of an 18-hole golf course.

The Domain Board remained our Landlord until 1989 when the Local Government Commission proposed that the function, duties and powers of the Domain Board as an administrative body be transferred to the Tauranga District Council. The Board unsuccessfully objected but did manage to get lease terms amended to provide that the rental shall, in the event of dispute, be assessed on the current market

value of the land upon which the Lessee's buildings are located. This replaced the earlier provision where assessment was based on the value of all the land held under the lease.

Administrators of both the Golf and Racing Clubs immediately recognised the danger that the new legislation represented. Having local Councillors replace the Minister of Crown Lands as their Landlord caused trepidation in the minds of those who could see the possibility of wider civic interests coming into play at some future date. Credit for the harmonious administrative niche that now exists is owed most particularly to Life Member E A (Ernie) Craig. Initially a subcommittee of the District Council was set up to assist Council to administer the Reserve. When this was found to be ineffective Mr. Craig lobbied for the establishment of what became known as the Racecourse Reserve Operation and Management Committee. The new committee's terms of reference were to deal with the operation of the Domain, and to liaise with the tenants. It was empowered to ascertain the level of rentals necessary to maintain the domain and to apply these to that maintenance. Hence all rentals charged were ultimately expended in the interests of the tenants in accordance with the terms of the 1880 Act.

The new committee came into being on the first day of January 1994 and included:

- Four representatives of the City Council
- one representative of the Golf Club
- one representative of the Racing Club
- one representative of the Equestrian group
- one representative of the Greerton Soccer Club. (Now discontinued).

The four members appointed by the Council included one Councillor, the other three being members of the Public. Mr. Craig, having been elected to the Domain Board during the period when the Golf Club lobbied to increase their influence, continued to serve that Body, and its successor, for more than 50 years during which time he served equally both Golf and Racing interests. In recognition of this he was elected to Life Membership of both Clubs, a unique and fitting reward for a man who gave so much to both Clubs over such a long period. Prior to his retirement from the Reserve Committee in 2004 Ernie served as its Chairman and was responsible for much of the drive that ensured the Reserve was continually developed and improved for the benefit of the Clubs and for the Community. Ernie, in the latter years of his service, was one of the four Council appointees and upon retirement was accorded a Civic farewell to allow the Council and public to formally recognise his outstanding contribution.

For the record the current lease from the Reserve Committee to the Golf Club was renewed in August 2006 and will expire in 2039. The work of Ernie Craig and those who served with him will surely have ensured that the Racecourse Reserve will continue to accommodate Racing, Golf, Equestrian Sport, and various public activities for the foreseeable future. It is a priceless asset to the City of Tauranga.

In spite of those early uncertainties of tenure on the Reserve land the original Golf Club members gave their labour enthusiastically at regular working bees where they slashed gorse, erected fences to protect greens, built stiles, planted trees, and cut and rolled greens from the existing pasture. Stock belonging to a local farmer kept the fairways under some level of control. The farmer, Mr McKinlay, is

remembered in the name McKinlay's paddock while the eighth hole was named McKinlay's from the earliest years. As soon as the initial work involved in developing the rudiments of a golf course was underway Mr Fred Rutter, an Auckland Professional, was engaged to lay out 18 holes utilising much of the present land together with some land lying within the racecourse oval. A description of that first course will be given in a later chapter.

Golf in New Zealand was essentially a winter game and in summer the fairways at Tauranga were devoted to the production of hay crops. In March the greens would be mown down in preparation for the new season and a single-reel, horse drawn mower would occasionally be run over the fairways to complement the work of the grazing stock.

Secretary/Treasurer Mr H B Mountfort would go around town in January/February to ask the members to pay their subscriptions, £4 at that time, so that he could engage Mr McKinlay to mow the greens in early March and have the funds to pay him.

The first 'clubhouse' was a corrugated iron shed located where the eleventh tee now sits. It served as the jockey's room on race days and must have been a miserable location on wet winter race days.[3] Forms for seating and a long table took up almost all the available space in the 'Tin Shed' while a smaller table accommodated the primuses and kettles. Someone donated a tatty looking basket style armchair that was squeezed into the corner and the first player in for lunch would stake his claim and sit in isolated splendour while the rest sat around the table eating their paper-wrapped sandwiches and sipping their tea. Sometime later a cookhouse was built at the end of the building and an Orion stove installed. Members would collect firewood off the course and fire up the new stove so the days of the primus ended and a new age of convenience began!

At first few members owned cars and many cycled to the course with their clubs on their backs. This was quite a trip as the course was some distance from their downtown residences. A lucky few sometimes succeeded in scrounging a ride in a car or gig. Until as late as 1957 the entry road from Cameron Road was a metal surface prone to severe potholing. The first improvement was made in 1958 when sealing was laid to 1.5 car widths over the first 20 chains of road (about 400m). The final 250m was not done until 1960. The Domain Board, as it was then known, financed this roadwork from the rental received from the two tenants. Such expenditures had to be well planned and budgeted in advance. The Club owes a very real debt of gratitude to the members of the Racecourse Domain Board and its successor, the Racecourse Reserve Committee, for their insight and astute financial management over the history of our time on the Gate Pa course.

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3 There was no clash between racegoers and golfers for no one would have dreamed of playing golf on a race day. For one thing the races were a major social occasion when the men wore their finest suits and no self-respecting lady would attend without having first visited Amy Hogg's establishment in Devonport Road to acquire a fashionable ensemble. In any event the Racing Club had the right to park cars on the golf course and it was not until the Sixties that this ceased to be the situation.

Relationships were established early with neighbouring clubs and tournaments and Interclub days attracted visiting players from Rotorua, Whakatane and Matamata. A Ladies' Committee was established and they worked hard under difficult conditions to cater for such occasions. They cleaned the 'tin shed', peeled buckets of potatoes, cooked meats at home, cut up baths of green salads, and baked mountains of cakes and scones. We can be confident no visitor left the course hungry. Inspired by the competition met on the occasion of these visits members were keen to improve their games and to this end Mr Hood and Mr McCormack, professionals based in Rotorua, were encouraged to visit Tauranga on some weekends in order to conduct lessons. These lessons had to be held on weekends for few members could afford to take time off during the week to play golf and the grazing stock were seldom disturbed by players during week days.

The new course was for many years known as the Gate Pa course just as the Racing Club was said to race at Gate Pa even though the Reserve is more accurately located in Greerton, a mile or so South of the site of the 1864 battle of Gate Pa and the commemorative Church that now stands on that site. Greerton was named in honour of Colonel Greer who was a prominent British military leader during the battle of Gate Pa. The suburb of Greerton had its origins when it was divided into allotments that were granted to soldiers who wished to remain in the area after the cessation of hostilities.

At some time in the thirties Dr. John Mark was playing the 10th hole when 'over the road' was not out of bounds. Somehow his ball lodged in the roof of a small shed that was sited there. John's companions insisted he play the lie so they assisted him onto the roof from whence he was able to knock the ball down the corrugations onto the fairway.

The Bay of Plenty Beacon was a Newspaper of the time that was published in Whakatane. The issue for July 7th 1939 carried an item naming the Tauranga team to represent the Club versus Whakatane Golf Club at Whakatane on the following Sunday. Many of those names are notable in the Club's history and/or in the history of the town. They were: Green, Bateman, Renshaw, Randell, Lusk, Page, Bradmore, Bullock, Douglas, Roach, Hay, Sisson, Kennedy, Jordan, Morpeth, Snodgrass, Harley, Phelan, Matheson, Kirkby, Steele, Verry, Strang.
No first names or initials were given. Many of these men feature elsewhere in this publication. Older readers will remember many above such as Bob Hay, who owned a Chemist Shop in the town.

No. 1 Hole (now 11th) "The Avenue"

GOLF

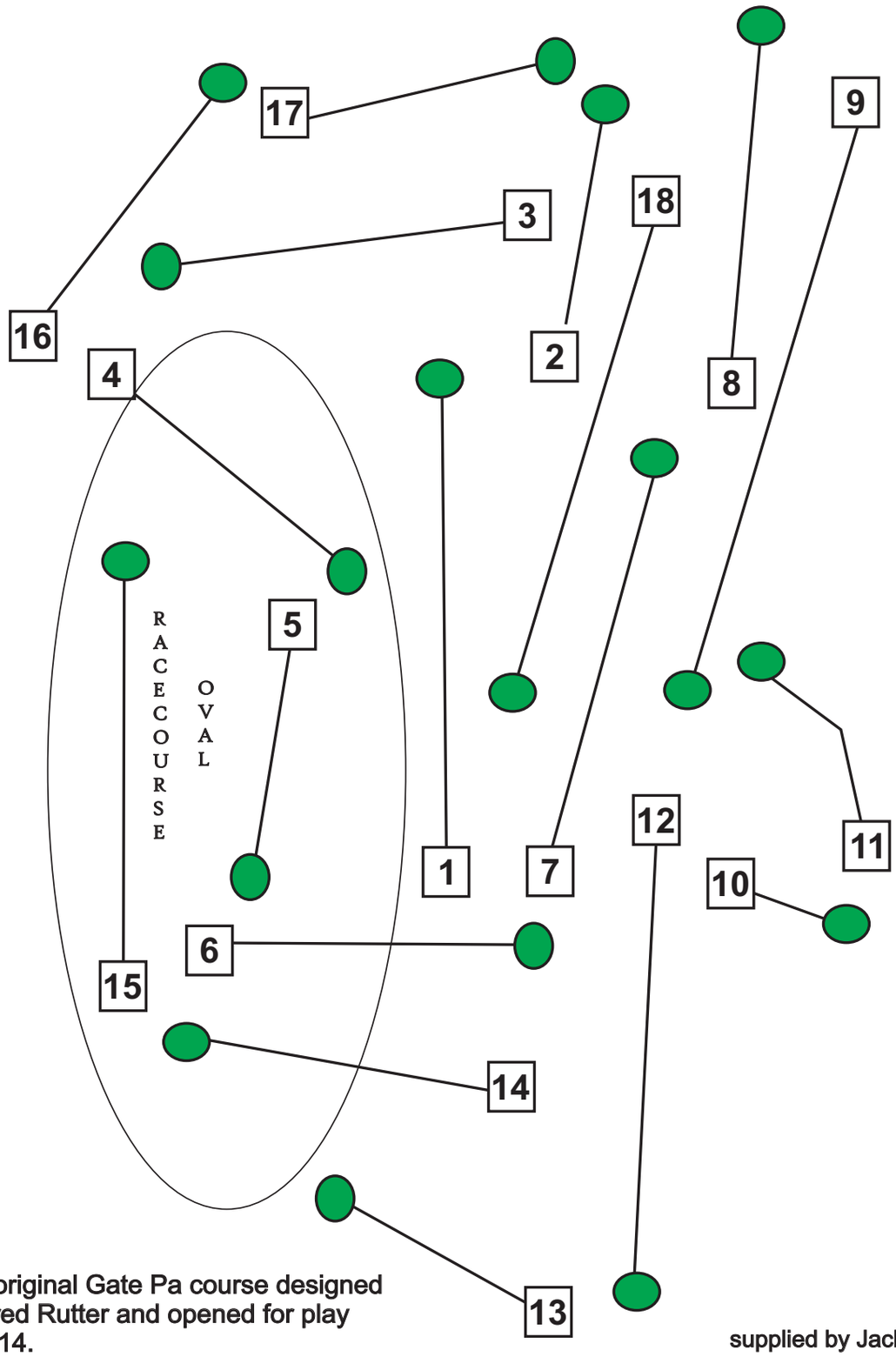
In Future CARS will leave the corner of Wharf Street and the Strand for the links between 1 and 3 pm on Saturdays. To secure seats players must notify the Secretary on or before Friday night.

W. M. DARLEY
Hon. Secretary

B.O.P. Times.
Saturday June 20th 1914

TAURANGA GOLF COURSE

Pre 1934 Changes

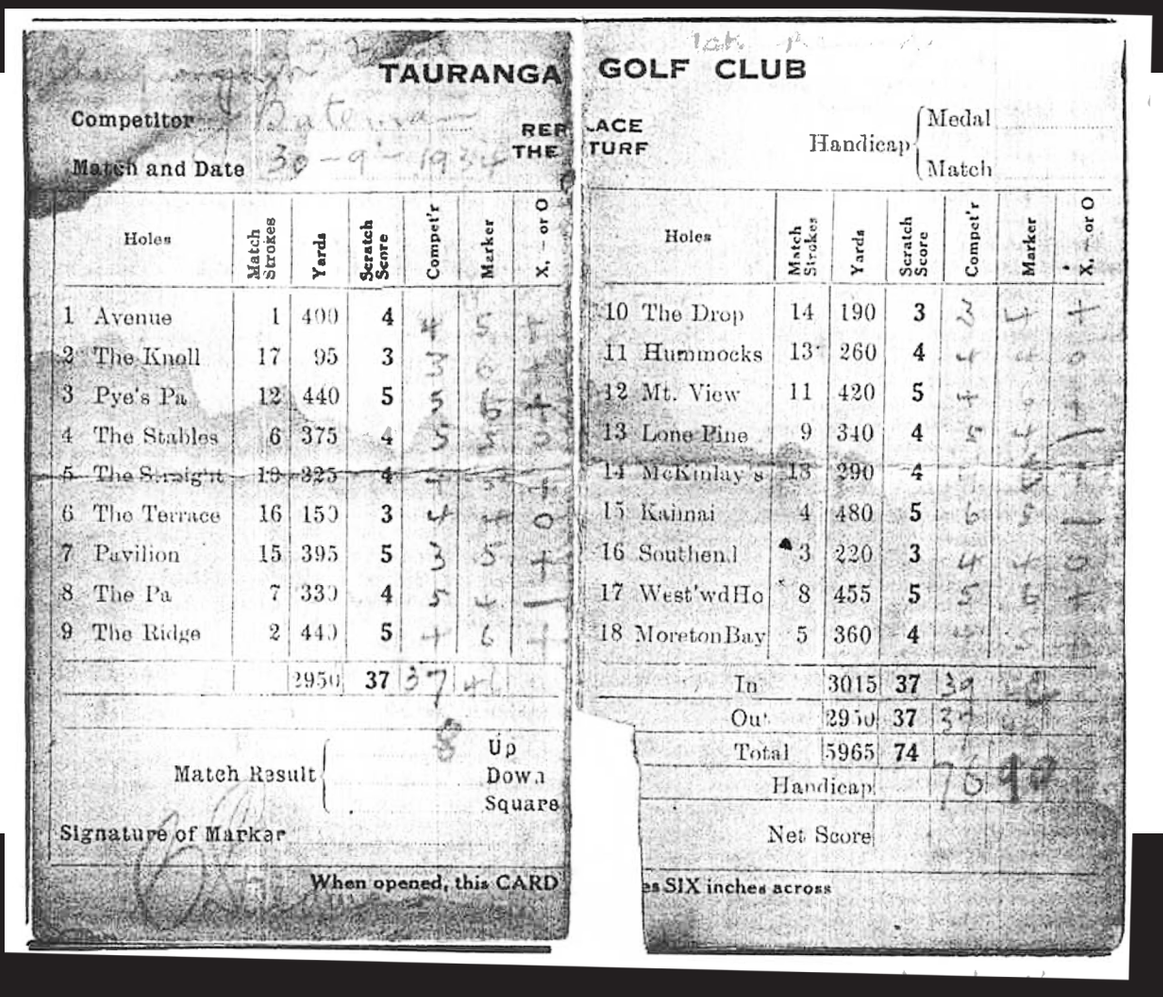


The original Gate Pa course designed by Fred Rutter and opened for play in 1914.

supplied by Jack Bateman

Scorecard of the course prior to the move out of the oval in 1934.

(supplied by Phyl and Jack Bateman)



TAURANGA GOLF CLUB

Competitor ..... RACE COURSE / THE TURF

Match and Date 30-9-1934

Handicap { Medal ..... Match .....

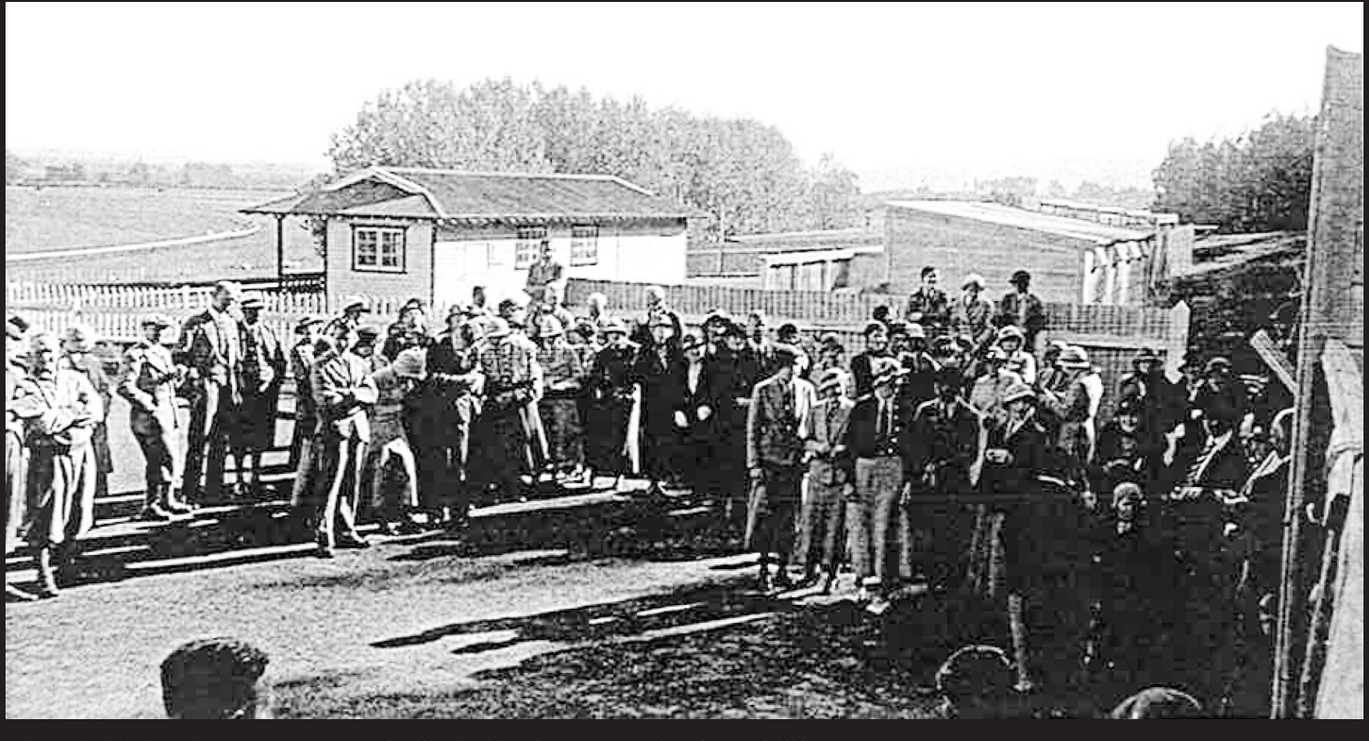
Holes	Match Strokes	Yards	Scratch Score	Compet'r	Marker	X, – or O
1 Avenue	1	400	4	4	5	+
2 The Knoll	17	95	3	3	6	+
3 Pye's Pa	12	440	5	5	6	+
4 The Stables	6	375	4	5	5	0
5 The Straight	18	325	4	5	5	+
6 The Terrace	16	150	3	4	4	0
7 Pavilion	15	395	5	3	5	+
8 The Pa	7	330	4	5	4	–
9 The Ridge	2	440	5	4	6	+
		2950	37	37		

Match Result { Up / Down / Square

Signature of Marker .....

When opened, this CARD ... es SIX inches across

Holes	Match Strokes	Yards	Scratch Score	Compet'r	Marker	X, – or O
10 The Drop	14	190	3	3	4	+
11 Hummocks	13	260	4	4	4	0
12 Mt. View	11	420	5	4	5	+
13 Lone Pine	9	340	4	5	4	–
14 McKinlay's	13	290	4	4	5	+
15 Kainai	4	480	5	6	5	–
16 Southend	3	220	3	4	4	0
17 West'wdHo	8	455	5	5	5	+
18 MoretonBay	5	360	4	4	5	+
In		3015	37	39		
Out		2950	37	37		
Total		5965	74			
Handicap				76		
Net Score						

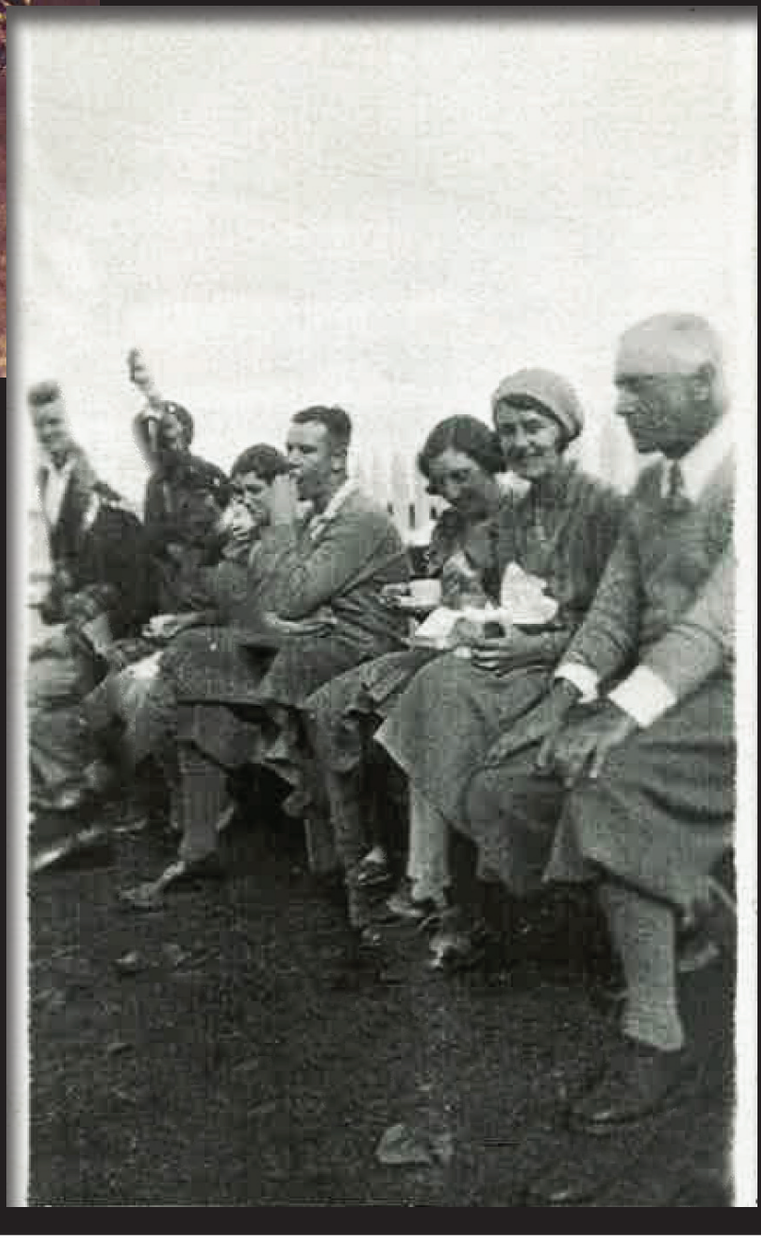


CLOSING DAY - 1931 Outside the Jockey's room - the first clubhouse

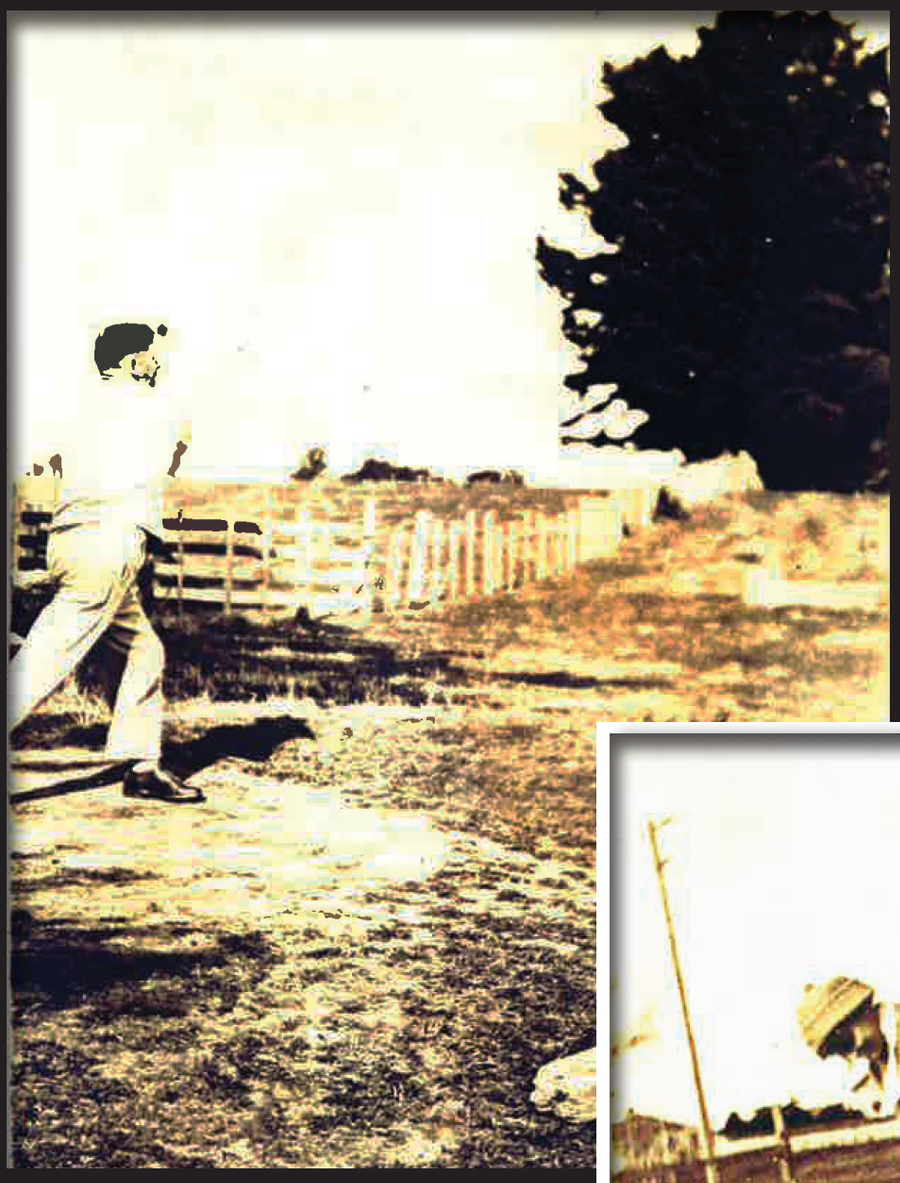
Early years at the new Gate Pa Links.

Note the light bag carried by Connie. No one carried 14 clubs in those times.

Above: Connie Humphreys - 1927



Right: Lunchtime - 1932
From left - Derek Tovey, Eleanor Broad, Phyll Bateman, Cecil Rhodes , Charmaine Renshaw, Marjorie Whitworth, Mr Corrigan



Ground conditions were a little raw in those early years.

Right: Connie Humphreys

CHAPTER FOUR

THE ORIGINAL GATE PA LINKS

The layout of the course has been changed several times and no doubt there will be further changes in the future though these are likely to be minor in comparison to what has gone before. The first course designed by Fred Rutter utilised land within the circumference of the racetrack as well as much of the present leased area. We have been fortunate to obtain a description of the course as it was prior to 1934 from Mr Jack Bateman, a fine player who followed his 1934 Championship win with another three victories in the years from 1946 to 1949. In 1948 and 1949 Jack added the BOP Champion of Champions title to his club victories, an honour not previously achieved by one of our own and not matched until the Michael Nicholson era began in 1970. The following is a description of those original 18 holes as Jack recalled them.

NUMBER 1 - THE AVENUE - PAR 4

This is now the 11th hole and essentially the same as it was then. The tee was conveniently placed adjacent to the 'Jockey's Room' clubhouse and the large gum trees that now form the avenue were then in their infancy.

NUMBER 2- THE KNOLL - PAR 3

This has now become the 12th and is known as Tauranga's signature hole. According to Jack it is now considerably less formidable than when he played it. The tee shot was played through an avenue of gorse to a sloping green perched on a pinnacle. This was somewhat higher than the present cone, the green having been lowered and thus enlarged at some time in the forties. There were shallow bunkers at the sides and back and the entire green was surrounded by long grass and stumpy gorse. While there was no bunker at the front a high premium was still placed on accuracy and correct club selection. When asked his opinion of this hole in 1967 commander Harris glanced briefly at it, said: "it might have been all right in 1900. Take five feet off the top and dish it." With that he walked to the 13th tee.

NUMBER 3 - PYES PA - PAR 5

This is now the 13th and renamed the Crescent. Apart from the new greenside bunker the hole was essentially the same as it is now and followed the racecourse fence around the top turn.

NUMBER 4 - THE STABLES - PAR 4

The tee was close to where the 14th tee is now located and the stroke was played across the oval towards the now 11th fairway to a green near the straight entrance.

NUMBER 5 - THE STRAIGHT - PAR 4

This hole was played as a slight dogleg more or less following the inside running rail to a green near the winning post.

NUMBER 6 - THE TERRACE - PAR 3

Here the tee stroke was played from inside the oval to a green located south of the grandstand and behind the then first tee. This would be where overflow parking can now be found.

NUMBER 7 - THE PAVILION - PAR 4

This was played from a tee near the present tenth green to where the practice putting green now lies.

NUMBER 8 - THE PA - PAR 4

'The Pa' was not unlike the present first hole except that the tee was further west towards the second green. The trundler shed now covers that old tee.

NUMBER 9 - THE RIDGE - PAR 4

The ninth was the present second hole now called The Summit though these names, with exceptions such as The Knoll and The Gully, are now seldom used. The only significant changes to the hole have been to the tee, once just a narrow shelf cut into the bank, and the establishment of the alternative green to the right of the original. The ladies played from a forward tee between the first and second fairways.

NUMBER 10 - THE DROP - PAR 3

To get to this tee the players walked around the top of the slope to a tee situated west of the present seventh tee. They were then faced with a shot across a field of turnips to the present third green. It was very difficult finding a ball falling short amongst the turnips as all turnips look very much alike at close quarters and your carefully noted reference point was easily lost. Eventually one season, when the stock had eaten this fodder crop, the hole was eliminated and pine trees planted on the slope.

NUMBER 11 - THE HUMMOCKS - PAR 4

This was a tricky dogleg that was essentially the present third in reverse. The second shot was to a small green tucked into the slope below the third tee. The shape of that green can still be discerned today. It is just as well present day players do not have to drag their trundlers up the hill while playing that hole!

NUMBER 12 - MOUNT VIEW - PAR 5

The present seventh hole played to the right hand green. As the name suggests the hole played straight towards The Mount. This landmark could be seen much more clearly before the growth of trees eliminated much of the view.

NUMBER 13 - LONE PINE - PAR 4

This hole ran towards the access road and was essentially the present eighth hole. A line of power poles was about 20 metres in from the fence line on the boundary and frequently came into play to the consternation of many a player. On one occasion after this became the eighth hole following course re-organisation a tee shot hit the first of these poles only to fly back over the player's head and settle in the bunker beside the seventh green. The player faced a daunting second shot as no local rule allowed a replay in such situations. No one seems to recall what happened to the 'lone pine' after which the hole was named.

NUMBER 14 - McKINLAYS - PAR 3

This took play back into the oval from a tee over the road behind the present ninth tee to a green not far from Cameron Road.

NUMBER 15 - KAIMAI - PAR 5

This was a long and difficult hole played as it was into the cold southerlies that seemed to blow most days of the winter. The fairway followed the back straight to a green located in the oval not far from that of 'The Crescent'. Water troughs, fences cattle and cowpats were unusual hazards encountered on what was a most unpopular hole. To add to all the other problems Out of Bounds was never far away.

NUMBER 16 – SOUTH END - PAR 3

This hole still bears the same name but is now played as the fourteenth. As with most holes there was less bunkering than is now the case, bunkers having been added from time to time throughout the course.

NUMBER 17 - WESTWARD HO - PAR 5

This hole, together with the eighteenth, are the only holes that are essentially unchanged and are still played as the same numbered holes as they were in the original layout.

NUMBER 18 - MORETON BAY - PAR 4

That fine specimen tree has stood in its commanding position on the ridge almost from the beginning. The hole has changed little and the first real clubhouse was built behind this green to give an excellent view down the length of the hole.

CHAPTER FIVE

OUT OF THE OVAL

In 1934, with the confidence of the new 33-year lease behind them, the Club administration was encouraged to explore new possibilities in course design and facilities. Having determined that the oval was not conducive to the development of quality golf holes the committee commissioned well-known Auckland Professional Alex Murray to advise on the layout of new holes. As part of his commission he was requested to see if it would be feasible to eliminate 'The Drop' and 'The Hummocks' holes that, quite understandably, were most unpopular with members who did not enjoy the climb back up the hill from the present third green. Anyone foolish enough not to play a provisional ball following a doubtful drive at the third hole today will readily appreciate the point. As a result of Alex Murray's review the five holes that utilised the oval were discontinued along with the old 7th, 10th, and 11th holes. To replace them the present 3rd, 4th, 6th, 9th, 10th, 15th, and 16th were developed and they remain in much the same form today. The remaining ten original holes were retained but renumbered to accommodate the very different sequence of holes necessitated by the changes. Below is an outline of the holes as they are now played with a brief summary of their individual history.

NUMBER 1 - THE PA - PAR 4

This was first played as the 8th hole and featured a slight dogleg to the right from a tee west of the present position. A large gum on the ridge some 50m from the green was a prominent feature. Those driving past the gum were inordinately proud of the achievement. As has been the case with other prominent gum trees this one was lost to high winds. Gums are not especially long lived in our conditions.

NUMBER 2 - THE SUMMIT - PAR 4

This was the ninth hole and originally named 'The Ridge'. The men's tee consisted of two shallow terraces cut into the hillock forming the present tee. The women played from a tee near the gum tree on the ridge. The right hand green was developed in the sixties in order to enable the main green to be rested. It continues to be used on a regular basis, perhaps over-used.

NUMBER 3 - JUDEA - PAR 4

This was developed preparatory to the move out of the oval. Recent developments in equipment now allow quite ordinary players to 'take on the corner'. Few, if any amongst club members, were able to achieve this feat when using the old wound ball.

NUMBER 4 - THE GULLY - PAR 3

Another hole developed to replace those in the oval. This is a classical short par three where the green and surrounds have remained in their original form. Extended tees are considered by some to add to the challenge offered while others see them as defeating the intention of the original design. The causeway was built up in the Fifties to provide a much easier passage across the gully. The pond is our one water feature though hardly considered a hazard to most players. It has served its intended purpose of draining the area at the bottom of the driving range.

NUMBER 5 - THE SPUR - PAR 3

The fifth hole proved to be a problem from the start and has perhaps remained so up to the present time. The hole has undergone significant changes, most recently in 2003 when the green was extensively remodelled. The original hole designed by Mr Murray was named 'The Spur' and was played from a raised tee, still discernible in the trees to the left of the fourth green, to a small green located where the new 7th green now lies. There was a difficult bunker with quite a steep face immediately in front of this green. This was a rather weak par three. Perhaps its only redeeming feature was that it minimised the amount of walking required to go from the 4th green to the 6th tee. Some time later the green was relocated to its present position with no change in tee placement so that the hole remained a short par three with the tee shot being played over trees just short of the green. Generally you could not see the base of the pin from the tee.

In the days of the Invitation Tournament it was suggested that a more challenging hole could be provided for the professionals and top amateurs by building a tee in the area where it is now located so that the hole could be played parallel to the 7th fairway. This did prove to be more challenging and so the hole was retained for club play despite the extra walk required moving to the tee.

NUMBER 6 - MIRRIELEES - PAR 5

This was another hole developed when the club moved out of the oval. The excellent background provided to this hole by the positioning of the clubhouse on its present site was a welcome advantage of that siting. The hole is an excellent par five, if a shade short for the best players. It is notable for the Albatross twos scored by Norm Ducker, Ken Carter and Peg Copestake.

NUMBER 7 - MOUNT VIEW - PAR 5

This was the 12th hole and boasted a commanding view of Mount Maunganui before tree growth screened that out. Tree removal in the new Century restored the view. Several changes have been made to both tee and green and some would doubt the present design is the best that could be developed. It has long been a goal to establish a more equitable landing zone for the second shot or to find some other way to solve the problem of balls running off the side of the hill but this goal has proved elusive.

NUMBER 8 - McKINLAY'S - PAR 4

This was originally played as the 13th hole and known as 'Lone Pine'. No one now seems to remember the tree for which it was named. McKinlay's Paddock has long been the name of that part of the reserve North of the Racecourse so it was felt appropriate to retain the name for a hole in that area when the original 'McKinlay's', a hole played into the racecourse, was discontinued.

NUMBER 9 - THE DIP - PAR 3

This new hole was named for the shallow dip that originally featured between tee and green when the tee was across the road at the top of the ridge overlooking McKinlay's paddock. On race days players had a good view of the action should a race be taking place at the time they were on the tee. This was possible only after parking was discontinued on our fairways.

The increasing regularity of Race Days, Show Days, Orange Festival Parades and similar activities led to players becoming increasingly frustrated as streams of traffic flowed in front of them as they awaited a break so they could tee off. Consequently a new tee was constructed across the road, trees planted behind it to lessen the distraction of passing traffic, and the green extended toward the tenth fairway. One result is the hole no longer has the 'dipping' profile that gave it its name but the hole has lost little of its challenge.

NUMBER 10 - K D PAGE - PAR 4

Keith Page no doubt earned the right to have his name perpetuated as a result of the selfless efforts he made to produce the green at this hole. While a green did exist previously in this area it was not suitable for the newly designed tenth hole and was abandoned when play moved from the oval.

NUMBER 11 - THE AVENUE - PAR 4

This was the original opening hole. The stables have now been replaced further from the action, the three bunkers near the beginning of the practise area are no more, and bunkers have been created and removed beside the green. None-the-less the hole remains essentially the same today as when the course was established in 1914.

NUMBER 12 - THE KNOLL - PAR 3

This was originally the second hole and is as memorable now as it was when first played in 1914 in spite of the reduction in height and consequent increase in green size.

NUMBER 13 – THE CRESCENT - PAR 5

This was originally the third hole and named Pyes Pa. It was considered the most testing hole on the course and well deserved its number one stroke rating. When the new 15th and 16th holes were developed to replace those in the oval it was considered more appropriate to name one of these Pyes Pa and the thirteenth hole was renamed to fit its physical shape.

NUMBER 14 – SOUTH END - PAR 3

This was originally played as the sixteenth hole. It remains essentially the same as it then was although the massive pines behind the green that once provided welcome shelter from the strong Southerly winds that exert such an influence on the playing length of this particular hole are no longer there. There is an old adage that he who wins the fourteenth hole wins the match. This does seem to be the case quite frequently.

NUMBER 15 - KAHAROA - PAR 4

Of all the holes on the course this one appears to play the longest for its carded length. Some translate the name Kaharoa as 'long strength', others as 'long net'. The former is especially appropriate. The hole requires strength and stamina in order for it to be negotiated successfully. The 'long net' might also refer to the ability of this hole to trap the unwary. Michael Nicholson used to say that the final four holes on the course were those that separated the men from the boys. We realise how appropriate

that comment is when we reflect upon the number of matches, and stroke play events, that have been decided over those very holes. Kaharoa begins that sequence.

NUMBER 16 - PYES PA - PAR 3

Like the fifteenth this hole was developed to replace those made obsolete following the move from the oval. It has stood the test of time and remains challenge enough for club players of all levels of ability. That test is precisely what we should look for when considering hole design on a course such as our own.

NUMBER 17 - WESTWARD HO - PAR 5

As stated earlier this hole, and the eighteenth, are essentially unchanged and are still played as the same numbered holes as they were in the original layout. The seventeenth has undergone a number of remakes over the years and I do not doubt that some future committee will make another some day. Committees over the years have not been able to agree on whether it warrants the label par 4 or par 5 for men. In its earlier years, given the equipment of the day, even quality players found difficulty reaching the green in two strokes. Now they achieve this with ease. It remains below the length normally defined as being the upper limit for par fours.

NUMBER 18 - MORETON BAY - PAR 4

The tree from which the hole derives its name has created controversy from time to time because of the difficulties it does create for clubhouse maintenance. In this case the pluses appear to exceed the minuses and the tree will likely be there for many a year to come. The hole has changed little over the years and the first real clubhouse was built behind this green to give an excellent view down the length of the hole.

The old stables that once stood to the left of the eleventh hole often came into play and something was lost from the character of the hole when they were demolished. The new stables are set a little further back from our boundary and do not have the same physical or psychological presence as did their predecessors. Many were the tee shots that found their way back to the fairway as a result of striking the roof or walls of the original buildings. One windy day a player was expecting just such a result as his ‘duck hook’ streaked towards a stable door. Just as the ball was about to strike the door a gust of wind blew the door open and the ball disappeared inside. To add insult to injury the door then blew shut as if to ensure the ball remained securely swallowed. Such are the vicissitudes of this game of golf.

The move from the oval was a dramatic development in the history of the club. It signalled a growing maturity whereby players would no longer be satisfied with makeshift fairways and greens. The time had come to develop the property into a course that all could be proud of. The year 1936 was seen as being especially significant in foreshadowing a new era in the Club's development. Quoting from the BOP Times of March 30th that year:

"A disability which the Club has suffered from in the past has been that its ground staff have not had experience in golf green keeping and have been at a disadvantage in not knowing just what they should work for to afford the best conditions for play. The committee has accordingly engaged an experienced greenkeeper, Mr. W H Coles, formerly greenkeeper to the Napier Golf Club and a foundation member and member of the executive of the New Zealand Greenkeepers' Association. Mr. Coles takes over his duties today and, with the benefit of his experience, should do much to produce and keep good greens and fairways on the course.

The Club is also fortunate in that it has been able to obtain the services of Mr. Jas. Mowat to serve as its Professional. Mr. Mowat has for some years been Professional to the Poverty Bay Golf Club and is a member of the Executive Committee of the New Zealand Professional Golfers' Association. He has had experience both in Scotland and in the United States of America, and comes to the Club with first class recommendations, both as a player and as a teacher. For young players and learners there is a tremendous advantage in being kept to the right style until the game is consolidated. For the more experienced golfer there is much to be gained from having an expert on hand to locate and cure the inevitable faults that creep into the swing. Under Mr. Mowat's guidance it is to be hoped that there will be an all round improvement in the standard of the game in Tauranga. Mr. Mowat has already arrived and takes up his duties forthwith".

The next significant development in the evolution of the course came in 1967 when noted British Golf Architect, Commander John Harris, was invited to visit the course and advise on possible improvements that could be made. Commander Harris was in New Zealand under contract to the Government owned Tourist Corporation of New Zealand that was at the time developing the Wairakei Resort Course near Taupo. He was free to make himself available to clubs such as ours who sought his assistance. His charge to visit Tauranga for a day and make a detailed report covering ten pages was £75, a truly bargain price for world-class advice. Commander Harris, Greens Chairman Alan Davidson, and Greens Superintendent Grant Silvester walked the course with Alan and Grant hanging on every word spoken by the designer. Grant later commented: "That man seems to have a built in spirit level and chain measure as, when I carried out his recommendations, I found the levels and distances to be exactly as he described them. I found his plans for alterations so clear and precise that any contractor or green keeper could carry them through with utmost expediency." Alan made comprehensive notes from which, together with the Harris report, he was able to construct Pleistocene models depicting each of the holes as Commander Harris had envisaged them. These models were used by Grant and his staff, greatly assisted by the earth moving and contracting skills of Garth Renner, to faithfully complete the process of converting the Harris report from paper, through Pleistocene model, to completed golf holes, over the next few years. This entire process was continually supervised and monitored by Mr Davidson

who spent an enormous number of hours on this voluntary work. Knowing Alan it can be certain that his reward came from the satisfaction of knowing that the course was so much the better upon the completion of the program.
The changes made under the Harris plan were not major, nor particularly dramatic. Commander Harris recognised the course for what it is, an ideal club course offering variety and challenge to the vast majority of those who play it. He did not see it as a championship course as it lacked both the length, and the potential to extend that length, to achieve championship status. Consequently his suggested changes involved defining preferred lines of play for optimum results and to assist players to 'navigate' their way around the course. This was achieved by incorporating subtle bunkering and mounding on many of the existing holes. These changes were nowhere major, nor unduly expensive, yet there is no doubt that adoption of the Harris plan had a major, and lasting, influence on the level of enjoyment experienced by members and visitors alike when playing the course.

Commander Harris, in association with Michael Wolveridge and Peter Thomson, developed Wairakei to be arguably the best course in the country at that time and today it remains in the very top echelon of New Zealand courses. Commander Harris was involved in the development of some thirty courses worldwide and Tauranga was most fortunate to obtain his expert advice. It is perhaps regrettable that subsequent administrations have, for a variety of reasons, seen fit to nullify some of the improvements made as a result of his visit. Fortunately this tendency has been relatively limited and the course continues to enjoy many of the Harris subtleties incorporated in those years. As shown by many an International course sound design survives the test of time even in the face of technological advances. While the super stars may require greater length and difficulty in the face of these advances golf offers challenge enough to the vast majority of players on the courses they play on a regular basis. Improvement in the quality of playing conditions offered on courses such as our own will do more to enhance the golfing experience for the average club member than will continued fine tuning of design. Improvement in playing conditions has been made possible through the development of machinery specifically designed for golf course maintenance, through research into the soil environment, disease control, turf species, water application, and many other aspects of turf management. In particular the comprehensive training of staff has enabled them to make the best use of these advances. Tauranga has been fortunate to have all these factors adopted with skill and enthusiasm by our staff over many years.

Public interest in golf surged in New Zealand in the Sixties and Seventies driven by such television series as Big Three Golf and Challenge Golf featuring Arnold Palmer, Gary Player, Jack Nicklaus, and other greats. This was before the days of Sky TV and the public had long been able only to read of the exploits of such giants of the game. Now they were able to see them in action and people from all walks of life were keen to see if they could emulate some of the inspiring golf they were able to watch in their living rooms each week. As a result clubs around the country welcomed a surge in membership and the pattern of play changed so that courses had to stand up to more concentrated play and to an extended season that soon stretched to a full twelve months as new members became full time golfers rather than going off to bowls, cricket, boating, or other activities in summer. Tauranga was not left out in this surge of interest and membership had to be closed for a time to those seeking full seven day a

week membership. There were simply not the tee times available to accommodate all who wished to play. While this was unpopular with those placed on waiting lists it was the only practical solution to a problem that could not have been envisaged by earlier administrators. Since the club's inception those administrators had been intent on building membership, not restricting it.

Surveys of course usage at the peak of demand over this period found that weekly play often exceeded 1000 rounds and few flat periods were seen through the week or through the year. This made it very difficult for the Greens Staff, still only two full time men, to maintain the quality of the greens. In response to this pressure the committee introduced a policy of trying to provide an alternate green, or at least an enlarged green, at each hole where it was practical to do so.

Under this policy the 1st, 2nd, and 15th greens were enlarged while alternate greens were formed at the 3rd, 4th, 11th, and 17th holes. Only that at the 4th hole survives, the others proving both unpopular and difficult to maintain. Later developments saw enlargements to the 5th, 8th, 9th, 10th, and 17th greens while the fortuitous retention of the old 7th green proved to be a wise decision prior to its later abandonment.

While this policy did not achieve as much as had been hoped it did relieve the pressure for a time. The advent of a vastly improved irrigation system allied to continued improvements in green keeping techniques, especially the introduction of sanding following coring, led to very much improved surfaces that are better able to withstand the constant pressure of players and machinery. These advances reduced the need for alternate greens. It is sobering to contemplate that wherever one goes in sport, as in other human activities, there are always 'experts' eager to give the benefit of their advice to the professionals employed to do the job. At one stage, there was a tremendous campaign launched by a group of members outside committee to have coring discontinued on the grounds that so much material was being removed, and so little replaced, that the greens were rapidly becoming sunken saucers. Usually all that such critics achieve is to prove themselves blind to the facts. In the case of coring and sanding the advantages are obvious to anyone who has played the course continually through recent years. This is because good drainage, soil aeration, and the soil environment developed under coring provide conditions that suit the growth of fine leaved grasses. In our case Browntop and Chewings Fescue are the species used to produce quality greens. As for saucer shaped greens resulting from our coring program some may wish it had happened as the hole could then be cut in the centre of the green and all putts would find their way there!

Following the establishment of a Board of Management to administer the financial and amenity functions of club management a course improvement group was empowered to consider possible changes to the course and to establish priorities for this work. As a consequence of their deliberations quite radical changes were made to the 5th, 7th, and 17th holes, together with minor changes to the 10th, 11th and 13th holes. It would be fair to say that the most radical of these changes have not been met with universal approval by members. While the intention has clearly been to challenge the more able players the result may have been to make these holes too difficult for those members, both men and

women, who appreciate the more user friendly nature of traditional golf at Tauranga.

While physical changes to the design of the links have had a significant influence on both the challenge and the enjoyment of playing the course they have been overshadowed by aspects of course management that have evolved over the years. In those first years after the Club moved to the Racecourse Reserve there were no defined fairways and grazing animals made up most of the 'greens staff'. Fences surrounded the greens. The greens were the only areas mown regularly, and that perhaps just once each week. The Bay of Plenty Times of March 30th 1936 reported that the course was open for play, that the fairways would be mown from April 1st in accordance with the club's arrangement with the tenant, and that the fences surrounding the greens would be removed. Clearly the stock would also be removed. As can be imagined playing conditions would have been very much inferior to those enjoyed by members today. The greens, following a summer of uncontrolled growth, would suddenly be cut back thus producing slow stubbly surfaces that would gradually improve with regular mowing. The rest of the course would get an occasional mowing with Mr McKinlay's horse drawn hay mower.

Soon after the above item appeared in the 'Times' four groups of members representing Bankers, Commercial Travellers, Loan and Mercantile, and Insurance Brokers undertook to enlarge and remake certain greens and an intense competition was soon underway as to who would prove to have the best techniques and achieve the best results. This was perhaps not the way to get a set of greens that played consistently throughout the course but was a big step forward in the evolution of the course.

Keith Page heard that Tom Bloor had purchased a 5hp rotary hoe, the first to be demonstrated in Tauranga, so he pressured Tom into rotary hoeing his green, the 10th. This hole was subsequently named 'K D Page' in Keith's honour. It was claimed that Keith practically slept beside his green to ensure everything went to plan.

The other teams were initially disadvantaged in that they had to dig over their greens with spades. Loan and Mercantile, represented by Cyril Jordan and Ron Mirrielees were claimed to have an unfair advantage because of their superior agricultural knowledge and access to fertiliser and other requirements for their green, the 16th. Perhaps the claim was true for the 16th remains an excellent green and has suffered no serious problem from disease or burnout in spite of being at the most distant corner of the course and amongst the last to receive a reliable water supply. The K D Page green on the other hand became something of a mystery as, for many years it was a 'green of two halves', the front being almost pure paspalum which was very green and provided quite a good playing surface in summer, while the rear half was the standard browntop/fescue mix. Perhaps only Keith knew how this came to be. It was interesting to see how the paspalum gradually disappeared to be replaced by the finer grasses under the influence of modern cultural techniques without the need to kill it off with herbicides. Such experiences vividly demonstrate the way the soil environment influences the species that grow in it.

During the Second World War the course was reduced to nine holes with the eighth, ninth, and tenth fairways being put to the plough and crops of potatoes planted as part of the war effort. On other parts

of the course the grass was allowed to grow freely and hay crops were harvested. Until recently the ninth fairway still showed evidence of the plough's passage down the centre. Disposal of corings from the greens over a couple of seasons has now eradicated that reminder of days gone by. During those war years nine holes were retained and kept in remarkably good order by the sole green keeper, Mr Reeves, an outstanding man who worked under very difficult conditions with limited equipment.

The racecourse and its buildings were headquarters for the National Reserve and many members underwent training there. Some found the training exhausting but not so Ted Bartlett, the oldest man in camp, or Bob Gray, each of whom would run around the race track before Reveille each morning. Years later I enjoyed playing some rounds with Ted when he was quite an elderly gentleman and I can testify that he was still very fit and a real pleasure to play with. He had genuine zest and enthusiasm for the game. I especially appreciated the manner in which Ted accepted myself and other juniors as fellow players on an equal footing with himself in the days when junior members were considered by many others to be an unnecessary evil on the course. Ted loved to hit the ball hard and appeared not to change his approach as age caught up with him.

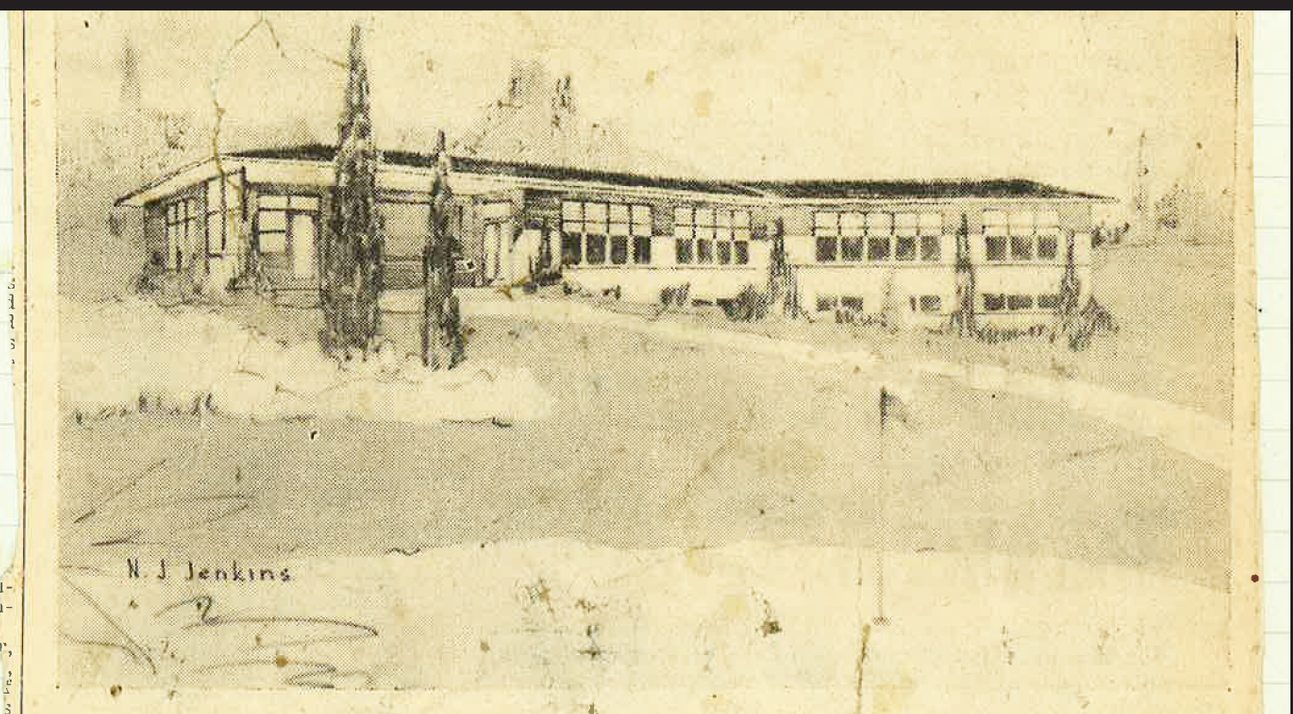
Des Roberts some 50 years back played from the third tee only to see a lad come out of the trees, pick up his ball, and head towards the stream from which we now get our irrigation water. Giving chase Des ran the lad down then marched him back to the green where he made him drop the ball. Des then two putted for a hard earned 'Birdie three'. Full marks for energy and enterprise if not for strict adherence to the rules.

His golfing friends fondly knew Frank Willoughby as the 'Sand Shoe Champion'. One day Frank used a similarly free rule interpretation after hooking his ball from the 14th tee onto the lawn in front of the County Council Building. Armed with his trusty wedge Frank scaled the fence, crossed the road, played a lovely shot across the traffic to the heart of the green, holed the putt, and claimed a par. He definitely deserved one.

OPENING OF THE ORIGINAL CLUBHOUSE - 1938

Right: Miss Eva Goodyear

First Clubhouse built in 1938, where the carpark now is.



A sketch of the new clubhouse on which a start has been made at the Tauranga Golf Club's links at Gate Pa.

Tauranga Golf Club Looks To The Future

Start Made On Modern Clubhouse

For many years the Tauranga golf course, undoubtedly one of the most picturesque in New Zealand, received little recognition from outside golfers. It was appreciated in full by those in the Bay of Plenty and in nearby districts but from the national point of view was "just another golf course."

Today the course is known to most, if not all, of the Dominion's leading amateur and professional players as one of the best in New Zealand. Its remarkable turf places it in the forefront, particularly for winter play.

All that the club needed to provide for big tournaments was an adequate clubhouse. Work on extending and modernising this, is now under way.

When completed the new clubhouse will have a floor space of 4560 square feet. It will contain a men's and general lounge, office and kitchen on the ground floor; men's and women's dressing rooms and provision for a professional's shop in the basement.

Of concrete and brick construction with a brick veneer finish, the new clubhouse will be situated near the first tee and will command good views over most of the course, the front lounge overlooking the 18th green.

Even local golfers have found the present clubhouse inadequate for members' needs and quite beyond catering for additional visitors at open tournaments. The new building is regarded as an essential improvement to bring the course to a standard fit for major tournaments.

First-Class Fairways

The interprovincial women's and men's invitation tournament is to be held at Tauranga in June and it is hoped that the new clubrooms will be ready for that important event.

Over recent years the committee has concentrated on improving playing conditions on the course. With greens and fairways in first-class order and with a greatly increased membership—150 more than five years ago—the committee has now taken a long-term view with the clubhouse in providing a building sufficient in size and facilities to cater for a full membership.

The development of the Tauranga Golf Club links to their present high standard has been remarkable. During the Second World War the club played on only nine holes. A major step was taken in 1950 when a watering scheme was installed by voluntary labour, enabling the condition of the greens to be brought to a standard comparable with any in the country.

Praise for the standard of the links from visiting golfers has been as generous as it has been merited, for after 20 years' work the course is certainly picturesque. There is a background of trees and a variety of colour to every one of the 18 holes.

Some criticism has been made from time to time of the fact that the course is on the short side—under 6000 yards. While this cannot be denied, the several short holes have proved disastrous to experienced golfers. Even when the best amateurs and professionals in the province took part in the last invitation tournament, the course scratch score of 72 was bettered only twice——and then by one stroke only.

Many times it has been said that one day someone will "burn up the course". Perhaps that will happen, but in the meantime many have tried and found it harder than expected.

Tauranga can be proud of its golf course. It is a credit to those who have worked through the years for little reward other than enjoyment from their chosen sport. The addition of the new clubhouse should prove the last major step necessary to bring the links to a standard able to cater for even a New Zealand championship.

Bay of Plenty Times
27.02.54

TAURANGA GOLF CLUB

(Incorporated)

GATE PA COURSE

●

LOCAL RULES

●

1. OUT OF BOUNDS.
The Boundary of the Domain, the Racecourse enclosure and the fence to the left of the 9th fairway.

At the option of the player the following MAY be treated as out of bounds:—

The gully to the left of the 2nd and 7th fairway, the plantation to the right of the 3rd fairway and the lawsoniana hedge to the left of the 15th fairway.

Penalty—Distance only.

2. ONE STROKE PENALTY.
Unless otherwise provided, a ball within 2 club lengths of any fence or stable may be lifted and dropped, a further 2 club lengths, but not nearer to the hole.

3. LIFTING WITHOUT PENALTY.
From any hoof mark, water tap, rabbit scrape, wheel track or electricity pole, or embedded in the fairway or green (the gully at the fourth hole is NOT fairway)—to be dropped within two club lengths but not nearer to the hole.

A ball lying on the teeing ground or green of another hole MUST be lifted and dropped within two club lengths of the edge of the tee or green, but not nearer to the hole.

A ball on the green may be lifted, cleaned ONCE only and replaced.

Match Py. Allow.	Singles	Foursomes
0	1	1
1	2	2
2	3	3
3	4	4
4	5	5
5	6	6
6	7	7
7	8	8
8	9	9
9	10	10
10	11	11
11	12	12
12	13	13
13	14	14
14	15	15
15	16	16
16	17	17
17	18	18
18		

Difference in Hdcp.

Strokes

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
13	13																	
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1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	

MATCH PLAY ODDS

In Singles—¾ of difference between stroke handicaps.
In Foursomes—⅜ of difference between partners' combined stroke handicaps.

Strokes owed to Bogey																		
1	15																	
2	15	17																
3	7	15	17															

REPLACE
THE TURF

Times—23092

Local rules and strokes owed were very different until they changed in the fifties.

The stymie was dropped at that time also.

March 1995

There were once two large pines at the corner of the dog leg on the third hole.

The inner one is prepared prior to felling.

John Rountree showing fine form at the Knoll when the bunker was more user-friendly than it is today.

CHAPTER SIX

POST WAR REVITALISATION

After the war the returning service men and women were very enthusiastic in their desire to return to the pleasures of peacetime life as rapidly as possible and golf rated highly amongst those pleasures. As a result there was a concerted desire to restore the course to its full eighteen holes and, aided by a healthy increase in membership, this was soon achieved. By 1951, only six years after the cessation of hostilities, membership had grown to the unprecedented figure of 416. The old clubhouse soon proved woefully inadequate to cater for such a large and active membership and plans were made to finance a new brick building to be sited adjacent to the first tee. Four hundred debentures at £10 each were sold and a building committee of Alan Davidson, Dave Cambie, and Lionel Smith was empowered to supervise construction that was to be achieved at a cost not to exceed £5,700. The contract was let to a club member, Mr Beck, at what was considered the bargain price of £1/8/6 ($2.85) per square foot. This would be $20.54 per square metre in today's units. This price allowed the project to be completed under budget to the great satisfaction, and no doubt relief, of the building committee. The old wooden building was advertised for sale at a price of £500 but when it was found it could not be moved in one piece the buyer negotiated a reduction and the building was moved to Pyes Pa where it again became a domestic home. The new clubhouse was opened in 1954. While the final outcome was widely admired the project, like most projects run for the benefit of a large group of members, had not been free of controversy. Chief amongst these was the siting of the building. There was a strong move to utilise the area to the west of the putting green on the rise where the right-hand third tee is now located. This would have provided a more panoramic view of the course and left the Moreton Bay to command the area behind the first tee. Apart from the problems this tree now causes by dropping litter on the clubhouse and surrounds it is probably true that the right location was chosen. The latest incarnation of the clubhouse, built upon the foundations of the 1954 building, provides a much better view of the course and surrounding landscape than was ever previously evident.

The new clubhouse was but one factor in the continued growth of membership and club usage. The exposure of the game on television, the advent of a healthy professional tournament circuit in New Zealand, and the rapid improvement in golf course maintenance led by the Turf Research Institute of New Zealand all contributed to the development of the game nation-wide. For the Tauranga Golf Club this renewed interest reached its peak in the sixties and seventies when player pressure became so great that membership had to be restricted. Full men's membership was capped at 335 with just five discretionary places available for players arriving from out of town with national handicaps of 4 or less. The Club's Bank manager or the CEO of our neighbour, the Racing Club, would also gain membership under these discretionary places.

While this restricted membership was a necessity, if play was not to become so congested as to be unpleasant for all, it was very unpopular with keen players transferring to Tauranga from other parts of New Zealand, a trend that was occurring at an ever-accelerating rate and continues into the 21st Century. In an attempt to create opportunities for prospective members to obtain some form of membership new categories of male membership were introduced. Older, less active members were encouraged to move to the new B category that allowed play on six days a week excluding Saturdays. A significant number of existing members took up this option and the reduced subscription that went

with it. This enabled the committee to accept new A category members up to the 335 limit. B category was restricted to 100 members and a further category C was introduced providing for midweek golf only. This category came to be seen as a waiting room for A category and at one stage that waiting time stretched to as much as five years. Sometimes a player would move from C to B as a stepping-stone to the A membership he really wanted. Ultimately priority was given to such B members to move up to full membership. Pressure for membership within the women's section at no time reached the stage where a waiting list had to be instituted. This sometimes caused problems when a wife would gain membership while her husband languished in frustration on the sidelines.

In December 1969 the membership committee reported the following figures:
Men's A - 337 (limit 335 + 5), Men's B - 58 (limit 100), Men's C - 50 (no limit), Ladies' A - 282 (limit 300), Ladies' B - 27 (limit 50). In addition there were 69 non-playing members, while 31 men and 21 women were listed as awaiting membership and 11 men sought a change of category. The reason 21 women were waiting upon membership was because they would accept membership only if and when their husbands gained admittance. At this time the priority for acceptance was to those seeking an upgrade followed by those holding National handicaps of four or better.

The limitation on membership continued through until 1985 when the committee were concerned over a down turn in membership figures following subscription renewals for the new season. As a result there were now vacancies for 23 male members. In response to this trend that was still apparent the following year the committee moved to increase the number of places available and to endeavour to attract new members. Category limits were consequently increased to allow up to 375 men in A category plus 25 discretionary places, up to 125 B category men, and up to 350 women in total over categories A and B, no more than 50 of those to be B category. Shortly thereafter it was realised that category limits were no longer necessary and they have not been found to be necessary since. Quite the reverse has applied. Subsequent committees have actively campaigned to attract new members in order to ensure the financial viability of the Club. Two factors have had a strongly positive influence on maintaining membership levels. These have been the growth of Nine Hole Golf amongst women players, and the attraction of the game to the growing population of Asian Immigrants arriving in Tauranga.

Reg Ellis was about to tee off at the first when a rabbit shot across the tee with a weasel on its back. Reg made a swipe with his club, a much quicker swing than his trademark slow rhythmic golf swing, and killed them both. He then teed off and scored a three. Can anyone else claim to have scored a rabbit, a weasel, and a birdie at the same hole? Well perhaps not but Des Shiel can lay claim to the weasel. As Judge Ian Thomas was about to play his tee stroke on the first tee a few years ago another weasel ran across the tee. Ian had no idea what was going on as people shouted for someone to 'get it'. Several swung clubs at the weasel but, after chasing it out from a hole under the Moreton Bay tree, it was Des who proved himself the successful hunter.

The new Clubhouse built in 1954

The clubhouse was extended
in 1966 to almost double its
original size.
The cost was almost three times
that of the 1954 contract

The clubhouse was completely rebuilt in the new century to open in April 2001

CHAPTER SEVEN

MENS GOLF

From the earliest days, when the Club based itself at the Domain, Saturday afternoon was competition time for those men who wished to exercise their competitive instincts. So it has remained although the growth in membership in the second half of the Twentieth Century resulted in competition play soon occupying Saturday mornings as well as afternoons throughout the playing season. The season has gradually been extended from an original eight or nine months until competition golf is now held almost throughout the year.

At first competition was rather informal with the Secretary or Captain deciding on the day what form the competition would take. The choice lay between Medal, Par, and Match Play, with some variation by way of playing singly or in pairs. Foursomes, including mixed foursomes, were popular. From the beginning match play, including the ubiquitous haggle, was the most popular form of competition. The Stableford scoring system had not then been invented. It was not until 1931 that Dr Frank Stableford of the Wallasley Golf Club near Liverpool developed the system, perhaps in response to his habit of destroying a good Stroke Play round with one or two bad holes. In doing so he gave new hope to generations of players afflicted with the same unfortunate habit.

As the Club membership grew a variety of trophies were donated. This was often to introduce a new competition or to encourage its adoption. Consequently the Club program grew larger as the years went by and it became increasingly difficult to fit everything in. At one time in the 1960s and 70s some competitions were designated as Sunday competitions to alleviate that problem. While this proved popular with some there were many who found it difficult, or impossible, to play both days of the weekend because of family or work commitments and the change was eventually reversed.

While competition within the Club flourished Tauranga men made little impact at Provincial or National level. Perhaps N P (Norman) Green who won the Tauranga Open Championship against all comers in 1938, 39, and 40 was the first Club member to achieve significant victories against outside opposition.

For those who find the Knoll difficult, bear in mind that Joan Mirrielees and Maurice Bradmore each aced the hole on two separate occasions. Some claim Brownie Carnachan did even better by scoring three ones on that hole in the one day. During the Labour Weekend Tournament one year he holed in one at the Knoll in the morning round then amassed an 11 in the afternoon!

On occasion even the very best can make a real mess of The Knoll. In one Spalding Masters Tournament Kel Nagle moved from winning contention after scoring no less than seven at the hole. I believe a sand fly got into his eye at the precise moment when he was attempting to recover from down the side of the green though Kel was never one to seek an excuse for such a lapse.

Norman and his wife Nancy came to the Club in 1936 after experiencing golfing success at Dannevirke, Napier and Stratford before moving to Tauranga. Norman's lowest handicap was 2 yet he played with a rudimentary set of five clubs: a brassie (2 wood), a 3 iron, a niblick (5 iron), a mashie (8/9 iron), and a putter. Norman never managed to win the Tauranga Club Championship to add to his successes at previous Clubs indicating that the standard of local play was showing marked improvement. The two outstanding players of the period were H J (Jack) Bateman and F W (Fred) Ward. These two won the Tauranga Open Championship in six of the seven years from 1946 to 1953. Fred won again in 1958.

Jack Bateman, in addition to his Open successes, won the Club Championship in 1934, and then three more times in the four years from 1946 to 1949. To highlight his career he won the inaugural Bay of Plenty Champion of Champions title held at Whakatane in 1948, successfully defending it at Tauranga the following year.
Further success came the way of Tauranga with victory in the Bay of Plenty District Golf Association (BOPDGA) Senior Inter Club Shield in 1951. Jack and Fred were vital members of the winning team. This shield was the forerunner of the BOP Championship Pennant Series. It was to be another 23 years before Tauranga were again able to hold the shield aloft, winning it three years in a row from 1974.

Fred Ward's many golfing exploits have been included in a later chapter. His influence, both as competitor and as administrator, projected far into the future of the Club.

Prior to 1948 five men were honoured with Life Membership of the Club. They were **E T Baker, Denis Ivory, R T (Bert) Goulding, A J Mirrielees, and P H Roach.** While we know that Denis Ivory (1936-39) served as Club President little is known of the service these men gave to the Club other than in the case of Mr Mirrielees whose contribution is recorded elsewhere. Mr Roach won the Senior Championship in 1919 and Bert Goulding won the same championship in 1933. We can be sure that each of these men together with Mr Baker made outstanding contributions to the growth and development of the Club and to the course at Gate Pa. Life Membership would not have been granted lightly, especially in those times when members were more intimately involved in Club and Course management than they are today.

In the final year or two of the Forties **C Steedman, H B Lusk,** and **Arthur Towsey** were next to be honoured with Life Membership. Arthur's long service as a member of the committee and as voluntary Keeper of the Bar has been well documented. He was a superb 'Mine Host' over a lengthy period during which he ruled his domain with a somewhat flexible 'Rod of Iron'. Mr Lusk was intimately involved in the early design of the course when the Club first made the move to the Racecourse Reserve while memories of "Steedy" appear to have faded with the passing of his contemporaries.

S G (George) Wilcock will be remembered each year when the Intermediate men compete for the Wilcock Cup, a handicap Match Play event. George, who served as President from 1950-52 following his years as a member of the committee, was elected to Life membership in 1949. One year later George was elected Vice President of the BOPDGA

A W (Warwick) Nicol was the Accountant of the BNZ in Tauranga. He was a committee member and Vice President before being elected President in 1958-59. From 1954-56 he was Vice President of the BOPDGA and President in 1957-58. For many of those years he held the post of Men's handicapper at Tauranga. He was made a Life Member of the Tauranga Golf Club in 1958 before retiring to Tirau.

H J W (Harry) Bradmore who was honoured with Life Membership in 1958 was not one to seek the limelight. He, along with his son Maurice, was very active behind the scenes. They followed on from the work of Mr Mirrielees in planting trees and nurturing their early growth. By doing so they made a valuable contribution to the development of the excellent conditions we now enjoy. Mr Bradmore presented the Alan Bradmore Memorial Trophy in remembrance of another son, Alan, who was killed in the Second World War. That trophy is contested annually over two Stableford rounds as part of the regular Saturday programme.

R J (Dick) Phelan was elected to Life Membership in 1963. Details of Dick's contribution to Veterans' Golf and of his long competitive career have been documented elsewhere in this publication. That he was able to feature in the final of the Junior Championship 47 years after his Senior Championship victory in 1930 bears testimony to his unprecedented longevity in the game he so obviously loved. It is unfortunate that complete records of committee personnel prior to 1953 have not been uncovered so it is not possible to document the service records of men of that era. We can be confident that Dick Phelan did more than his share to see that the Club advanced in the right direction.

A L (Alan) Davidson was elected to Life Membership in 1964. There could be no more worthy recipient than 'Zuke' as he became known for reasons lost in time. Much of Alan's contribution to the Club he loved has been well documented elsewhere in this History. For the record Alan was Vice President in 1953 when our full records began and he progressed to the Presidency in 1956-58. There is no doubt his committee work began earlier than that. He returned again to the committee in 1966 serving a second term of Presidency from 1968-70. During this phase Alan did much of his most significant work particularly in relation to course development and the incorporation of the 'Harris Plan' into the design of specific holes.

Many a match committee member of today would be amazed at the amount of work that was once done to achieve the same result that now happens automatically as computer data are projected onto the clubhouse screen to show individual scores. For example prior to the Tauranga Open 28 hole event all competitor names would have been meticulously hand printed on cardboard strips that were then slotted into metal runners on wooden score boards. In the course of the day all the tournament details would be appended by hand following manual checking of all cards. For years Alan, Des Wilson, Jim Reid, Keith Frith and others would forgo the opportunity to participate in the day in order to ensure that all this documentation was completed quickly and efficiently so that prize giving could be held as soon as possible following play. For some years the first two mentioned above sponsored that particular tournament.

As a player Alan won the Junior Championship in 1946 and went on to play to single figures, his best round being a 69.

Alan served in the Second World War as crew in Bomber raids over Germany. On one occasion his plane having been hit by Anti Aircraft fire Alan, believing the plane to be doomed, prepared to bail out. On his way to the escape hatch he touched the Rear Gunners shoulder saying: “the plane is going down. We have to get out”. A few seconds after they cleared the plane it exploded with the loss of the rest of the crew. Alan made it to ground but was captured by German troops and became a prisoner of war. The Tauranga Golf Club was indeed fortunate that Alan survived to tell the tale.
For many years Alan owned and managed the Business known as Davidson’s in Spring Street where many a fashion conscious lady member of the Golf Club bought her ensembles.

Keith Nattrass was first elected to the committee in 1957 joining an especially strong group made up of A L Davidson, A W Nicol, D Coutts, A Towsey, J Mowat, N H E Hockin, F Cassin, and S Randell. Colin Evitt was then the Honorary Secretary. Keith’s administrative abilities were immediately recognised and he was elected Vice President a year later and served as President from 1960-63. At District level Keith served as President of the BOPDGA in 1961-62. The high point of Keith’s golf administration came in 1969 when he assumed the position of North Island Vice President of the NZGA, a position bringing credit both to Keith and to the Tauranga Club. In 1973 Keith was awarded the highest honour available to Golf Club members, that of Life Membership.

J C (John) Hare has been mentioned elsewhere in connection with his work in reconciling differences between the Racing Club and the Golf Club in relation to various privileges each might exercise in their use of the Reserve. He became a member of the Racecourse Domain Board, as it then was, in 1952. He later became its Chairman. John refrained from taking office in either of the tenant clubs in order to avoid any possible conflict of interest though he did serve the Golf Club in the role of honorary solicitor. For many years he acted as timekeeper for the Racing Club. His ‘apprentice’ in that capacity was Keith Frith who carried on the role following John’s death. John was a partner in the law firm of Maltby, Hare and Willoughby with offices in Wharf Street. The firm later merged with Holland, Beckett and Partners to form Hobec, one of the leading Law Partnerships in the city.
John was an enthusiastic golfer whose invaluable contribution to establishing and protecting the Club’s rights on the Reserve were recognised by the award of Life Membership in 1980.

Keith Frith will be remembered as ‘Captain Extraordinaire’. Keith joined the committee in 1971 as Vice Captain before assuming the role of Captain in 1973. Where it had been the custom for men to serve in this demanding role for two years Keith broke the mould by continuing in the post for seven years before accepting the position of Vice President for a further three years. Never one to relish the limelight Keith was reluctantly persuaded to accept the Presidency in 1983, an honour he richly deserved. Never really comfortable in the role of President Keith handed over the reins after just one year but it was not long before he returned to the committee. In 1985 D Cotterall was elected Captain but did not take up the role. Keith stepped into the breach to help the Club out and served another two

years. In recognition of his dedicated service over so many years the Club were delighted to honour him with Life Membership in 1985.

Keith had his moments as a golfer as well as an administrator. In 1979 Keith contested the final of the Junior Championship and, to the delight of all, he was successful against Kevin Moynahan who was generally well ahead of Keith on the drive. Kevin was almost as pleased as everyone else to have Keith enjoy this success on the course where his Match Committee work had enabled so many others to enjoy their competitions over the years.
In 1968 Keith won the Nicoll Cup. On the first Saturday of this 36-hole par competition Keith shot 84-21-63 to be 7 up on par. On the second Saturday Keith's daughter was to be married and Keith had not intended playing golf. His friend and wedding guest Vince O'Connor persuaded him they should play at dawn on the Saturday and still have ample time to prepare for the wedding. And so they did with Keith this time scoring an 86 to be 5 up on par. Is there anyone else who has bettered 12 up against par over 36 holes?
When the horror of Parkinson's disease caught up with him Keith had to give up playing the game he so enjoyed but it did not end his association with the Club. For many years he continued to arrive prior to midday on Saturday to start the afternoon field. His extensive knowledge of the organisation of Saturday competition play was frequently called upon, and greatly appreciated, by successive match committees. Keith's unobtrusive manner, his wisdom and experience, and his unfailing loyalty to his Club and to his colleagues made him an exceptional member.

Alex Gallagher joined the Club in 1938 and remained a member for more than 60 years. In 1972 he was elected Vice President, progressing to the Chair in 1974, filling that position for three years. In the days of manual score boards Alex' special skills were much in demand. A surveyor by profession, Alex produced scoreboards that were works of art. His calligraphic skills became legend in the Club. As co-ordinator of scoring information from around the course during the Spalding Masters, the PGA Championship, and the Russell Grace Inter Provincial Tournament, Alex was unsurpassed. It never crossed anyone's mind that anyone other than Alex would fill that role when important tournaments were held.

Alex won the Junior Championship in 1989. There was a certain irony in the victory. The previous season Mark Mangos joined the Club shortly before the championship qualifying rounds were due to be held. Mark had been on a 7 handicap previously but had been out of the game for a few years and his handicap had lapsed. Keen to play in the championships Mark got in three quick rounds. These qualified him for a 17 handicap and thus a place in the Junior Championship field. Mark, knowing he was better than that, requested a handicap that would allow him to play in the Intermediate division. His pleas fell on the deaf ears of handicapper Alex Gallagher and so Mark qualified for the Junior Championship. Making easy work of the early rounds he met none other than Alex in the final and prevailed with little trouble. He was possibly the most able winner of that title in its history. Perhaps it was poetic justice when Alex gained his success the following year. Earlier in 1988 Alex won the Junior Stroke Play Championship. Alex was elected to Life Membership in 1988.

M W (Maurice) White was the son in law of Jimmy Mowat, our first Professional. Maurice was first elected to the committee in 1971. He was elected Vice President in 1974 and President in 1977, filling that role for two years. Maurice returned to the committee in 1988 and remained a committee member until the advent of the Board of Management in 1994. For the majority of his time on committee Maurice chaired the Finance Committee, sometimes as its sole member. Maurice was an early advocate of the Board form of management and was active in promoting the concept and in assisting in setting up the constitutional details to enable it to function.
For his contribution to Club administration over a lengthy period Maurice was elected to Life Membership in 1991.
Noel Copestake joined the Club in 1960. Few have given as much to the Club in the course of our history as has Noel. First elected to the committee in 1985 Noel remained there in various roles until the advent of the Board in 1994. Noel assumed the Vice Captaincy in 1989, and the Captaincy a year later. Following three years as Club Captain Noel was elected President in 1993, an honour he held for two years. In the last of these he took his place on the Board in its inaugural year, the constitution providing for the President to be an automatic Board member. Noel's contribution to the Club through his promotion of Twilight Golf, and his leadership of the 'Wednesday Firewood Gang' further evidenced his dedication to the Club.

In 1984 Noel won the Junior Championship. He has had a long association with the selection and management of Pennant teams over the years. In recognition of his work in the interests of Golf Noel was elected to the Bay of Plenty Eagles Golfing Society in 1995, later becoming their Secretary/ Treasurer.

Noel was elected to Life Membership of the Tauranga Golf Club in 1997, soon to be joined in that elite company by his wife Peg. These two appointments represented a remarkable and unique achievement, one that would have been applauded by every member who had been privileged to experience the service these two gave to the Club over so many years.

Bernie Child came to the Club from the Manawatu where he had worked as a contractor using heavy machinery in his work. A very practical man it was behind the scenes where Bernie flourished. He was project organiser for the 'Vets' for a number of years and, organiser or not, he was ever to the fore when work required to be done. Few who have not had the experience of working at some of the many projects Bernie and his peers have completed over the years would appreciate just how valuable Bernie's contributions have been. The Club is much the richer for his contribution. We enjoyed his little plaque on the drinking fountain behind the first tee: 'A fountain of youth built by a child'. The fountain was his idea and entirely his own work. It stands as an indication of the commitment Bernie has to his fellow members. He became involved in administration as a member of the Veterans' Golfing Society. In 1995 he was honoured with the Presidency of that organisation, a job he did with his characteristic dedication.
In recognition of his commitment to his Club, and to his selfless contributions of time and energy over many years, Bernie Child was elected to Life Membership in 1997.

K D (Keith) Dawkins was an excellent cricketer who rapidly adapted to golf despite a grip that the experts frowned upon. Natural talent can overcome a lot. Keith was in his prime years as a golfer when he won the Senior Championship on four occasions during the five years from 1963 to 1967. Only Doug Furrie intervened to prevent Keith sweeping five in a row.
In 1972 and 73 Keith had a taste of committee work as Vice Captain to Keith Frith. This was a most useful apprenticeship in Match Committee work. In 1983 Keith again got the call and completed another year as Vice Captain to Bob Allen before taking on the Captaincy in 1984. Again in 1995 when it became difficult to find anyone to stand as Captain Keith volunteered to fill the position. As would be expected he led the Match Committee through another successful season. In his half-century and more of membership Keith served the Club with distinction in his own quiet manner.
A member of the Eagles Golfing Society Keith was elected to Life Membership of the Tauranga Golf Club in 2000.

E A (Ernie) Craig was elected to Life Membership in 2007. The vital role played by Ernie in ensuring that the administration of the Racecourse Reserve continued to serve the interests of the two primary tenants has been detailed in Chapter 3. While it is difficult to visualise what may have happened had Ernie not been so diligent in pursuing his plans for the future administration of the Reserve we can be confident that the Club would have found themselves in a much less secure position than it now holds. The Racing Club also honoured Ernie with Life Membership in recognition of his work in the interests of the Reserve.

D G S (David) Mowat has been a Club member for well over 50 years. He was first elected to the committee in 1967 and served as Captain in 1969 and 70, as Vice President in 1971, and as President in 1972 and 73. In 1989 he was again elected to committee, serving until the Board became a reality in 1994. Four years later he was encouraged to stand for one of the elected positions on the Board. In 1999 David was appointed to the Board Chairmanship, a position he held for 3 years.

In recognition of his contribution to Club administration over an extended period David was honoured with Life Membership in 2006.

In over 100 years 23 men have been made Life Members of the Club. While all of these men have richly deserved the honour bestowed upon them by a grateful Club there are many others who have contributed much over the years. The names of many of these will be found scattered throughout this history. Below we pay homage to a selection of those whose service added real value to their Club over the years and we apologise to those many others who must, for one reason or another, go unrecorded, though not unappreciated.

C W (Colin) Johnstone joined the committee as Vice Captain in 1956, graduating to Captain in 1958. Elected Vice President in 1960 Colin assumed the Presidency in 1963. For one period in our history there was a tendency for committee members to follow a progressive path, spending two years in each of the executive positions before stepping up. This had the advantage of providing continuity from one

year to the next and each officer would be well versed in the requirements of the new position when he reached it. Colin was the first to follow such a path. The advantages of such a progression were obvious. As the trailblazer Colin proved well versed and efficient in all that he did for the Club over a lengthy period.

R G (Roy) Bathgate followed Colin through the ranks. Roy was an accountant by profession and brought much of the meticulous nature of that discipline to his work on committee. Serving as Vice Captain in 1958 Roy progressed to the Presidency in 1965. Through no fault of his own Roy served just one year as President before being defeated in a 'bloodless coup'. Other members of the committee went down with him, some voluntarily withdrawing in protest at what they considered to be an unjustifiable vendetta. For some reason that 1966 Annual Meeting was held at the 'Down Under' Coffee Lounge in Central Tauranga. Those present will long remember the meeting for the currents that stirred beneath the surface. In retrospect the break in committee continuity that followed that evening did not make for a happy and settled Club over the next two or three years.

Jim Reid and his wife Jean were very well known members who began their golf at the old Te Puna Golf Club. It is believed that some members of Te Puna formed the nucleus of what became the Otumoetai Golf Club. The details appear lost in the mists of time. Both Jim and Jean were very supportive of Tauranga Golf Club through the fifties, sixties, and into the seventies. Jean took on the catering role during the fifties and was admired for the quality service she provided. A very keen Intermediate level golfer Jim was known for his advocacy of the 'corkscrew grip and the K address'. Jim survived the 1966 coup to continue in his role as Captain but it was not until 1970 that he was finally elected President, an honour he had probably earned some years previously. Jim's golfing wisdom was recognised on a wider level through his services to Bay of Plenty Golf. There he rose through the ranks to assume the Presidency from 1971-73. Jim was elected to Life Membership of that organisation in 1985 in deserved recognition of his service over many years.

Dr R S (Rod) Rowe was a member of the committee when Bruce Cunningham, at that time Town Clerk to the Mt Maunganui Borough Council, initiated a move to establish a new Golf Club on land adjacent to the Tauranga Airport. There were restrictions on heights and buildings on the area owing to Airport activities. These caused Bruce to believe a golf course might well be the ideal solution. Coincidentally this was at a time in the early Seventies when membership of the two existing courses was at a premium and another course was seen to be a virtual necessity. In 1971 a committee made up of representatives of the Tauranga and Mt Maunganui clubs was formed to promote the concept. Rod Rowe took a special interest in this and selflessly ignored the prospect of almost certain progression through the committee ranks at Tauranga in order to see the Omanu Golf Club successfully established. He was ultimately to be rewarded with election to the Presidency of the new club.

D M (Des) Wilson joined the committee as Vice Captain to Sol Kanapu in 1969. It was a period when committee posts were turning over rapidly. Des was to move up to Captaincy the following year and to Presidency one year later. Des was not one to be very happy as a 'Back Bencher' in any organisation

he belonged to and, after two years as President, he became active in the Bay of Plenty District Golf Association where he assumed the Presidency from 1977-79. From there he went on to represent the Bay as their Councillor on the New Zealand Golf Association (now NZ Golf). In recognition of his service to BOP Golf Des was made a Life Member of the BOPDGA in 1988.

R B (Bob) Eaton joined the Club in 1963. First elected to the committee in 1977 Bob took on the Vice Captaincy in 1978 before filling the Captaincy for three years. Vice President to Keith Frith, Bob moved into the President's chair in 1983 when Keith moved aside with a sigh of relief. Later, when the Board of Management was in operation, Bob's experience was again called upon and he was elected to serve a term there. It is probable that the high point of Bob's golfing career came in 1987 when he was a member of the Junior Pennant team that won the Bay of Plenty final at Lake View.

D W (Dan) Dougherty was elected to the committee in 1989. Following a rather more low key coup than that of 1966 Dan made a rather meteoric rise to become President just a year later, serving in that capacity for three years. During his years as President the Club dramatically improved the quality and range of equipment available to the Greens Staff. For this Dan deserves a lot of credit. The purchase of up to the minute equipment to mow greens, fairways, and surrounds, immediately improved the efficiency of the staff and the appearance and quality of the course. It was a bold step as it meant the Club was forced to borrow heavily to finance purchases but in retrospect it was the right move. While present and future members continue to carry a burden of debt they also benefit from the better course conditions now prevailing.
In the new Millennium Dan became heavily involved in the administrative side of Bay of Plenty Golf as a Selector, Team Manager, and eventually President. He was active during the period when Bay of Plenty became the predominant competitive Province in New Zealand Men's Golf. Many believe Dan was instrumental in inculcating a spirit of commitment amongst team members that overcame a previous over-emphasis on the social aspects of Tournament golf. This lead to continuing success for Bay teams at National level. Fittingly Dan was made a Life Member of Bay of Plenty Golf, the organisation that arose out of the amalgamation of Men and Women's golf in the Bay.

Gary Baker joined us from the Manawatu Golf Club. An ideas man, who was prepared to put in the effort to see that many of these came to fruition, Gary was elected to the Vice Captaincy in 1990. He and Noel Copestake made a strong and innovative team heading the Match Committee. When Noel accepted the President's chair in 1993 Gary took over as Captain, serving two years in that role. With the advent of the Board of Management he took a brief break from committee work until returning as Vice President in 1997. A year later he was elected President, a position he held for the next three years. As President he was automatically a member of the Board over that period. Gary's contribution to the initial launch of Business House Golf is detailed elsewhere but it is clear that his influence was pivotal to its success. In the realm of Thursday 'Ball in the Bucket' golf Gary was much to the fore through his organisation and his innovative ideas.

MEN'S REPRESENTATIVE GOLF

As mentioned earlier Tauranga won the BOP Senior Inter Club Shield in 1951 with the help of two outstanding players in Jack Bateman and Fred Ward. It was not until the Michael Nicholson era beginning in the Seventies that Tauranga again enjoyed success at that level, annexing the Shield in 1974, 75, and 76, before becoming the first winners of the Championship Pennant Series in 1978. During this period a talented team of 'Young Guns' supported Michael. The team included John Ward, Jim Lancaster, and Noel Johnson. All these represented the Bay of Plenty with distinction at Inter Provincial level. Through the Eighties Mt. Maunganui reigned virtually unchallenged in the Championship Pennant Series so Tauranga had to wait until 1993 to again taste success. Further wins followed in 1994, 96, and 99. In addition to the four mentioned above prominent team members involved in those wins included Bruce Burbery, Eddie Burgess, Jay Carter, Blair Murdock, and Gavan MacFarlane. The victorious 1996 team were Runners Up in the Johnnie Walker National Inter Club Championship held in Wellington. That team comprised Mike Cannell, Martin Hall, Andrew McNair, Eddie Burgess, Mike Nicholson, and Blair Murdock. Stuart Browne managed the team throughout the season. This Wellington visit may well have been the last occasion on which a Tauranga team was outfitted in our official Club blazers. These had to be borrowed from a group of older Club members, as few, if any, more recent members now owned them.

Further success at BOP Senior Championship level came in 2006 and 2008 featuring new players including Michael Melling, Andre Arthur, George Kinghorn, Scott Trebilco, Jared Pender, Matt Moorehead, Kevin Smith, and Toby Pudney. Eddie Burgess added his experience to this mix. 2011 proved to be a vintage year for our Senior Pennant players with both the Championship, and the Senior A teams winning their BOP finals.
For the Championship team the precocious talents of Sam Davis, David Feeney, Karl Knedler, and Ben Shanly were reinforced by the experience of Eddie Burgess, Blair Murdock, George Kinghorn and John Waretini. Karl's father Peter ably managed the team throughout the season.

A judicious mix of youth and experience also featured in the Senior A team where Jason Ornberg and John Laing provided the experience, James Cannon, Jin Hwang, Oliver and Will Coxhead, the youth. John Laing, a one-time stalwart of Kaiangaroa golf managed this team together with playing for it.

At Intermediate and Junior Pennant level Tauranga have been much less successful. During the 19 years of Shield competition Tauranga failed to win at Intermediate level. It was not until 1980, 30 years after BOP Inter Club competition began, that a Tauranga Intermediate team was successful. Under the system prevailing prior to the present Zone structure Tauranga met Opotiki in the final at Omanu. This day was so memorable in our history it is worthy of further comment. Captained by Norm Robson, the team included Syd Carswell, Ashley Norman, Peter Chadwick, and David Mowat. The Tauranga team became very concerned when Ashley had not appeared half an hour or so prior to tee off. Someone got on the phone only to wake up a somewhat hungover Ashley who flew into his clothes before breaking all records in driving from Otumoetai to Omanu. Norm Robson, teeing off one group ahead of Ashley, caused a delay by stopping near his ball on the first fairway and beginning a search for his car keys that he claimed to have lost. When he sighted Ashley hurrying from his car Norm fortunately 'found

the keys'. The delay was enough though Ashley's early progress seemed to indicate it was all rather pointless. Four down in almost as many holes Ashley suddenly came alive to win comfortably with holes to spare. Elsewhere the standard of golf was very high for Intermediate players, most having to shoot close to, or under, 80 to succeed. As the final match approached the 18th green Peter Chadwick's approach finished to the right of the green with a set of gang mowers intervening on his line of play. When no relief was offered the rest of his team dragged the offending mowers aside and Peter chipped successfully to remain square. With two wins, two halves, and two losses the teams finished tied on three points each so a sudden death play off was required. Team members looked at one another, most none too keen to carry the responsibility. Finally someone said: 'Norm's the man for the job'. And so he was. There would be few more competitive players at that level than was Norman Robson. His nerve held as he calmly parred the first extra hole while Johnny Tai, of Opotiki, three putted from well away from the pin. The final chapter in the story came when Norm, arriving at the Tauranga Clubhouse to proudly present the hard earned Pennant, found he did not have it. Eventually it transpired he had placed it on top of his car while he loaded his clubs at Omanu before driving off. It was never found and another had to be obtained from BOP administrators.

It was to be another 18 years before an Intermediate team was again successful. A team for which Ray Pittams, Mike Sherratt, Colin Gray, Ralph Bills, Steve Stephens, Gary Baker, Brent Hickisey, Chris Best, Alan Bush, Nigel Rose, and Andrew Reid all appeared at some time throughout the pennant season won the final played at Te Puke in 1998. The team was player-managed by Bruce Simister, a man who gave much to the encouragement and management of pennant teams over many years. Further success followed in 2003 when Tauranga scored the trifecta with success at Senior Championship, Intermediate, and Junior level, an epic achievement in our history. Members of the Intermediate team were Robbie Aitken, Ralph Bills, Jim Costello, Colin Gray, Ian Humble, Chris McAlpine, Klaus Niermann, Mike Sherratt, and Paul Smith. The Junior team that year included Alan Brown, Roger Craw, Graham Fowler, Ian Given, David Hermitage, Roy MacGregor, Ernie Pratt, and Bernie Priestley.

Junior teams were successful four times in the old Inter-Club Shield years, bringing home the trophy the first year it was held in 1950 and again in 1955, 56, and 1965. Since the Pennant format was introduced in 1971 they have been victorious in 1983, 87, and 2003. The 1983 team were successful in the final at Whakatane in the last year before the Zone system began. The Tauranga team included a number of 'grey haired gentleman' including Bill Good and Jack Hill. At the presentation someone made the observation that Tauranga had at last won their first Junior Pennant since the series began. A wag at the back called out: 'it looks as though the same team has been trying all those years'.
Junior golfers do not get many opportunities to compete in a team contest over a full weekend so the BOP Pennant finals provide a memorable occasion for them. This was certainly the case for the 1987 Junior team who competed against the other Zone winners in the final at Lake View. Tauranga team members were Peter Brown, Bob Eaton, Kevin Moynahan, John Robinson, Neville Robinson, and David Mowat. Gary Hardaker had been an important member earlier in the season before his handicap moved down a division.

Staying together at the Ngongataha Hotel enabled great team spirit to develop and, having seen off the challenges of Waiotapu and Kaingaroa on the Saturday, it was only necessary to take two wins from the highly rated Opotiki team on the Sunday to secure the Pennant. Although the top pair from Opotiki played exceptional golf to go through the weekend undefeated our other four came through to gain the win. Neville Robinson memorably summed up the weekend when he commented: “This tournament has been my Freyberg Rose Bowl. I will never reach that level of play but being a member of a team at my own level, and helping that team succeed, has been the highlight of my golfing life”. He spoke for all the team.

THE LABOUR WEEKEND TOURNAMENT

The Tauranga Open Championship was first played in 1934. From the start it was a three-day event played over Labour Weekend. The Saturday play featured two rounds of stroke play. These served as qualifying rounds to sort the field into groups of 16 to contest match play over the following two days. The first sixteen qualified on gross to form the championship division, the remainder on nett scores. All contestants were assured two matches while those defeated on the Sunday afternoon round could play in a Stableford competition on the Monday morning should they so wish.
For many years the second sixteen became the ‘Calcutta’ flight with spirited bidding taking place on the Saturday evening as individuals and syndicates vied with one another to secure the most favoured ‘horses’. In later years it became apparent that some players were setting themselves to qualify in this second sixteen in order to be in a position to lay bids upon themselves. Consequently the organisers altered the conditions so that a draw was made after the qualifying rounds to establish which of groups two or three would form the Calcutta group. This partially thwarted those ‘setting’ themselves to profit from a sudden show of form beyond that which their handicap indicated they were prone to display.

Labour weekend had long had the reputation of featuring severely inclement weather so competitors had to be prepared for wind and rain, especially during the qualifying rounds on the Saturday. The weather could generally be expected to improve on the latter days, the finals almost invariably being played in glorious conditions. One year in the early seventies visitors and locals alike arrived on the course early on Saturday morning to find it virtually unplayable owing to very heavy overnight rain that continued to fall. Auckland players in particular, accustomed as they were to their courses being closed for days on end following such rainfall, suggested that they might as well return to their hotels as there would be no play that day. “Stay” we assured them. “The rain will stop shortly and the course will dry out rapidly. We will then start after lunch and reduce qualifying to just one round”. They looked at us as though we were several shillings short of the full quid, they looked at the lakes of water on the eleventh and eighteenth fairways, they looked at one another and they shook their heads in the certain knowledge there would be no play today. How wrong they were. By eleven am the sun was out, by noon the field was away from the first tee, and all signs of water had gone from the worst affected fairways by the time they were reached. From that year on the format of the tournament never again featured two rounds on the Saturday. The single qualifying round later in the day proved very popular, especially amongst those who were enabled to travel from their homes that morning and thus save a night’s accommodation.

H D (Harold) Brinsden won that first Tauranga Open, following up with a further three successive wins before local man Norman Green, who also won three in a row, broke his dominance. Multiple winners were a feature of the tournament over the succeeding years, Fred Ward winning six times, Don Boone five, Noel Johnson, Owen Kendall, and Michael Nicholson each four times. These were all outstanding players who each represented the Bay of Plenty with distinction on many occasions. Noel Johnson, who learnt his golf in Tauranga before moving to Whakatane, fashioned a remarkable record by winning his fourth title in 1999 twenty-five years after winning his first.

While outstanding championship winners make for an interesting history of the tournament it is often the 'bit-part' players who confer upon the event its special quality. This was certainly true of the Labour Weekend Tournament. From the start it attracted an enthusiastic field from a wide range of clubs from Auckland, The Waikato, The King Country, and The Bay of Plenty. The Maungakiekie club of Auckland built their representation in the event to as many as twenty-five over the years, with the same faces appearing year after year. Who from that time would forget the likes of Nick Burmaz, Ian (Mouse) McKendry, Dick Talyancich, Auctioneer supreme Peter McCullough, and their ilk?

The tiny Matiere club from the King Country came in such force that almost their entire male membership must at times have been entrants. The rapport between that club and our own grew to the point where a summer fixture was established with reciprocal visits being organised to play cricket and golf matches between members of the two clubs, the hosts billeting their guests and families for the occasion. Noel Copestake was instrumental in initiating these exchanges. They will be remembered with much pleasure, not least by the children of our members. The children were usually billeted separately from their parents and enjoyed the novel experience of life on a farm and perhaps the freedom from parental supervision.

The Labour Weekend Tournament flourished in an age when life was more relaxed. People seemed to have more leisure time and a greater willingness to travel away from home in order to participate in organised events. Whole families came on these trips, the wives getting together to enjoy their own activities while the men played golf. Social activity involving the men and their wives (the concept of partners being little considered at that time) was catered for in the clubhouse in the evenings.

Calcutta Sweeps, though illegal, were exceptionally popular and usually built into large prize pools. Sometimes it was necessary to advise the likes of Jim Rossiter, Russell Christie, or Bill Graham,

Norman Ducker, Ken Carter, and Peg Copestake all have the distinction of having scored an albatross at the sixth hole. Though the American commentators insist on calling this a double eagle we like the original, more descriptive, term. In any event the feat is a rare and meritorious achievement. Each of these three-under-par scores was recorded using the old equipment and they are especially notable for that reason alone.

policemen members all, that it would be wise of them to leave for home at a certain point of the evening. This they did without demur and the clandestine operation was able to get underway. Before liquor licences were granted to Sports Clubs these operated illegal bars and club members who were policemen found it appropriate to turn a blind eye so they could enjoy the same after match social hour as did their playing partners. The law is indeed an ass in certain situations. It was a relief to all when enlightened legislation allowed responsible clubs such as our own to legitimise their activities. Though it is now possible to run a Calcutta Sweep legally it is ironic that their attraction has long since passed. This may be because people find a legal activity less attractive though a more likely explanation is that there is such a plethora of gambling opportunities now available that Calcuttas attract little bidding in comparison to days gone by. Certainly they were well past their 'use by' date before they were finally put to rest in our club environment.

Something similar happened to the Labour Weekend Tournament. From the days when you almost had to put your name down for the next year's tournament at the closure of the current one participation steadily declined until, in the nineties, it became uneconomic to continue to promote the tournament. The attraction of other activities, the extension of weekend trade, the reluctance of people to travel and accommodate themselves away from home, all these and more contributed to the demise of the tournament. Several attempts were made to revive it without success. These included offering competition for women and alternative formats but nothing came of these initiatives. Perhaps those who remember the 'old days' with affectionate nostalgia have a genuine basis for such feelings. Life does appear to have been more relaxed in earlier years and the Labour Weekend Tournament is but one of the casualties of the high-pressure age we have inherited.

THURSDAY GOLF

At our Club Thursday afternoon vies with Saturday afternoon as the most important day in the realm of Men's Golf. It was not always so. The first mention of any semblance of organised golf on a Thursday comes from the recorded history of the Tauranga Veteran Golfing Society. Shortly after the Second World War a small group of elderly golfers began meeting on both Tuesday and Thursday afternoons to enjoy informal fourballs. Gradually every second Tuesday developed into a day when an informal draw was made and from this the Veteran Golfers Society evolved in the early fifties. Tuesday remained as Veteran's day until 1957 when Thursday was adopted as their official day. Gradually other members began to seek a mid-week game and these called themselves Businessmen to distinguish themselves from the Vets. As their numbers increased the 'Businessmen' became more assertive and it was not long before the first few grumbles about 'those old buggers in front' began to surface. Eventually the Vets decided to adhere to the old adage that discretion is the better part of valour and gracefully reverted to their original Tuesday afternoon draw. Naturally there were those amongst the older players who decided they wanted to continue their Thursday golf and thus a group of these continue to precede the 'Ball in the Bucket' brigade each Thursday afternoon, even to the present day. It was not until well into the new century that satisfactory terms were established so that a lasting truce could be established between the two groups. Under mutual agreement those not participating in the ball in the bucket draw

still play off at the head of the field as part of the overall draw so that the field flows as well as can be expected under a multiple tee start involving the large number of participants the day attracts.

The life of any living system is subject to the process of evolution. The game of golf may not be considered to be a living system and yet it does display many of the characteristics of life. Those early veteran golfers first decided to satisfy their mid-week craving for a bit of competition by playing simple 'haggles' or 'Nassaus' as the Americans call them. These would usually be played for a maximum of 'a bob, a bob, a bob'. As weekends merged into the working week the attraction of a break in the normal Monday to Friday routine became more and more attractive to a wider range of working people. Consequently those who could do so began to 'put a line through' Thursday afternoon appointment diaries in order to be free to head for the greener acres of the golf course.

In the mid-eighties Bruce Simister became one of these as he found running a retail business left little opportunity to enjoy golf on a Saturday. On joining play on Thursday afternoons Bruce was disappointed to find that those participating did so in regular fours that played together week after week. Nothing wrong with that perhaps but would it not be a good opportunity to meet new people and discuss some of the issues that might arise in business? It did seem that more could be made of the afternoon. The idea began to spread until there were a dozen or so who were keen to form drawn fours and have a little competition between the groups so established. At first the winning team would receive $20 from each of the losing teams. This was fine when there were only two or three teams but as the concept became more popular the reality that one team got $100 or more while the rest got nothing became a little difficult to accept with good grace. Consequently a scale of reward based on the number of teams in the competition was instigated. Someone then found a 10-litre paint tin in the locker room and knocked a hole in the top so each potential participant could place his named ball in this bucket. Prior to tee off these would be drawn in groups of four from the bucket and away the teams would go from midday onward. So began the 'Ball in the Bucket' brigade, the same system, and perhaps the same bucket still being used today.

To add variety to the team competition a mathematical formula was instigated with fresh combinations being employed from one week to the next. Everything is based on Stableford points earned at each hole. One week the formula might require the first two scores to be added, the result then multiplied by the third. On another occasion the first and second scores are added, likewise the third and fourth, the two sums then being multiplied together. The variations are endless and often challenge the mathematically impaired. There have been those who swear that multiplying one by zero gives a different result from that obtained by multiplying zero by one, while the 'order of operations' rule taught to every third form student is a great unknown to many a successful businessman.

While the team entry remains at $20 the potential financial wins and losses have escalated as the variety of 'extras' within the group has expanded. The basic 'Nassau' became $5, $5, $5, while a range of 'Stars' gradually evolved. Gaining a star added 50c to the pair's total earnings. These stars included the usual birdies, weasels, and nearies, and in addition such exotic creatures as gritties, fannies, and jesneys. To the uninitiated it might well seem as though he had arrived on an alien planet where the

game of golf had evolved along a different path. Very likely the same ingénue would be astounded by the amount of money required from him to settle all of these at the table afterwards. Of course he would then find that all the money that changed hands would stay on the table to cover the cost of the required refreshments. He might also find himself receiving his share of a team prize. The Professional also runs an individual competition in conjunction with the team competition where a two, a good Stableford score, or a well-played 'hidden hole' might also produce a handsome reward.

GLOSSARY

Weasel - A shot holed from off the green.
Nearie - Nearest the pin on a par three provided the ball is on the green.
Grittie - Par following a bunker stroke.
Fannie - A tee stroke failing to reach the Women's tee.
Jesney – Nearies are carried forward if no one is on the green with their tee shot. If these have not been settled by the time the final hole is played the nearest the pin after three shots on the 18th wins the accumulated stars.

An extension to the Ball in the Bucket Brigade evolved as the 'Baker's Dozen'. A small group from within the regular Thursday players decided to make an out of town trip to enjoy courses they had not played. The first such trip was planned for Napier in 1991. Gary Baker was supposed to be one of the touring group but had to pull out at the last moment. Though there were never a dozen Gary was somehow thought of as the extra loaf and so the name came into being. Ten players made that initial trip, travelling together in a mini-van and staying at Ormly Lodge alongside the Napier Golf Club course at Maraenui. Since that initial adventure trips have been organised each year. The destinations have included the Manawatu, Dunedin, Christchurch, and even the Gold Coast. The travelling party eventually reached a head count of 32 and many the tales that are told, or often not told, of these memorable tours. Those intending to travel make voluntary weekly contributions to the pool, while a three putt results in a compulsory contribution.

In the middle years of the first decade of the new Century another Thursday group became established. Utilising the same 'ball in the bucket' draw technology this group assembles prior to 8am and tees off from the first and seventh tees. The entry fee at time of writing stands at $2, the stakes are set at one, one, two, and first prize is a golf ball and a small chocolate bar. Depending on the number of entries the next several accumulators of Stableford points receive one golf ball each. The group early voted to not reward twos in order to allow for more balls to be available to those scoring good Stableford scores. Naturally a number of regulars recall scoring a two the week following their vote being recorded against rewarding this particular feat.

OUTSTANDING TAURANGA CLUB PLAYERS

M N (MICHAEL) NICHOLSON

Michael began playing golf following a Football (Soccer) accident when he was 14. A promising footballer Michael took up golf in an attempt to put power back into his damaged wrist. Football's loss proved to be Golf's gain with Michael reducing his handicap to 1 within two years and never returning to his promising football career. Michael was unusual in his approach to practice as he spent untold hours on the tiny practice fairway between the 11th and 18th fairways hitting wedge shots. After some time his wedge had virtually no grooves left on its face. Somehow the timing and power he learned to put into playing these wedge shots carried over to the longer clubs, even to the driver. Throughout his competitive career Michael's ability to play recovery shots was legend. Where he learned to play these is a bit of a mystery but learn them he clearly did. A great strength of his game was the ability to visualise the way the ball would behave in unusual situations.

Michael stands supreme amongst those who have represented both the Tauranga Club and the Bay of Plenty. At Club level he won our Senior Championship on 12 occasions and headed our Pennant team for at least 25 years. While based in Whakatane he won their Senior Match play Championship in 1978, 79, and 80. He added the Whakatane Stroke Play title in 1977, 78, and 79. To further demonstrate his command of the Whakatane course Michael won the Bay of Plenty Open there in 1970, 74, 77, and 82. At Bay of Plenty level Michael set a record of 20 consecutive appearances in the National Inter-Provincial Championship variously known as the Freyberg Rose Bowl, The Government Life Tournament, and later The Tower Tournament when Government Life was renamed Tower Insurance. Michael's first appearance in the team was in 1970 when he was just 16 years old, his last in 1989. In all he played 136 matches winning 64. In the great majority of these matches he was playing at number one and therefore meeting the best golfers each rival team put forward. In all Bay of Plenty representative fixtures Michael played 260 individual matches.

At National Championship level Michael's record reads:

1971 NZ Under 18 Champion.

1972 NZ Boys Champion. Under 23 Men's NZ Champion.

1973 NZ Amateur Champion - also Top Qualifier. NZ Foursomes.

1974 North Island Amateur Champion.

1977 North Island Amateur Champion. NZ Foursomes.

1984 NZ Mixed Foursomes.

At International level Michael was selected for the New Zealand Junior Team in 1971 and 73. In 1974 he represented NZ at the Eisenhower Tournament held in the Dominican Republic, and in 1975 he was a member of the NZ team that contested the R and A Trophy at Royal Durban Golf Club in South Africa. Further National honours came in 1975 with selection in the Sloan Morpeth team to play Australia.

Michael ended his long association with the Tauranga Golf Club when he joined the Professional ranks, not as a player, but as a Club Professional with the Mount Maunganui Club. After some years at Mount Maunganui Michael moved to Australia late in 2009 where he joined the Brosnan Group as Manager of their Golf World Branch in Kawana in Queensland. All those who were associated with Michael during his time in Tauranga will long remember him with respect and admiration.

NOEL JOHNSON

Noel was another good young player who was a contemporary of John Ward, Michael Nicholson, and Jim Lancaster. Like them Noel was selected to represent Bay of Plenty Freyberg Rose Bowl teams of the Seventies and Eighties. Like Michael Noel spent some years in Whakatane where he won the Stroke Play Championship in 1987 and the Bay of Plenty Open in 1984. Noel was a multiple winner of the Tauranga Open played at Labour weekend.

E A (EDDIE) BURGESS

Eddie came to Tauranga with his family from Wellington when still at Primary School. He had already set himself the goal of becoming a top golfer before joining Tauranga and emulated Michael Nicholson by spending many an hour hitting wedge shots on our small practice fairway. Surprisingly Eddie won our Senior Championship on just the one occasion, his reputation tending to be built in other tournaments.

Misunderstanding the rules has cost many a golfer dearly. Our most infamous incident arose in the 1983 Senior Championship final between Brian Roderick and Michael Nicholson. Playing the 13th hole in the afternoon round Michael was on the green in three while Brian, having been out of bounds, was alongside the green in five. As Brian's caddy moved towards the flagstick Brian made a gesture that Michael interpreted to mean Brian was conceding the hole. When Michael lifted his ball Brian asked him why he had done so. In subsequent discussion Brian stated he had been asking his caddy to remove the flagstick. Bob Allen, the Captain, was refereeing the match. Bob was not a qualified referee and he awarded the hole to Brian though Michael should have replaced his ball under penalty of one stroke. Had this happened it is probable Michael would have won the hole and perhaps gone on to win the match. We will never know. The incident left Michael three down rather than one down. Michael showed his fighting spirit to square the match at the 18th, only to lose at the third extra hole.

Many opinions were expressed in relation to the incident. The facts may be summarised as follows. First it is unlikely that Brian would concede before chipping. Had he holed out he would have forced Michael to get down in two putts to win the hole. Secondly Michael should not have accepted Brian's gesture before seeking confirmation of its meaning. Vague concessions are often made and it is wise to seek confirmation. Thirdly had Michael known the rules he could have put his case with a good chance of success. The incident highlighted the need for trained people to referee important matches and other fixtures. Fortunately since courses for Referees were instigated in 1986 our Club has had an enthusiastic core of qualified people available.

In a follow up to the above incident Michael was playing an Inter-Provincial match for Bay of Plenty when he marked and lifted his ball from the fringe of the green in the belief it was on the green. Realising his mistake he notified his opponent that he had incurred a penalty. The opponent claimed Michael had lost the hole. A referee, who happened to be a prominent Auckland administrator, was called. He agreed with the opponent that Michael had lost the hole whereupon Michael protested that he had been in the situation previously and requested the referee to consult the Rule Book before making a binding decision. The official did so and, somewhat shamefacedly, ruled in Michael's favour.

At pennant level Eddie was an automatic choice in the strong and successful Championship Teams of the 1990s. At Schoolboy and Under 23 level he had an enviable record in local tournaments, winning both the Spalding Masters and Davidson Cup Match Play titles on more than one occasion, the former five times.
In 1993 Eddie represented New Zealand at under-18 level versus Australia, having played in the Clare Hingston Trophy fixture in Christchurch the year before.
In 2000 Eddie reached the pinnacle of his career by winning the New Zealand Amateur Championship. Soon afterwards he turned Professional with the intention of playing the Asian Circuit but was frustrated by a lack of opportunities. Gaining tournament entries proved extremely difficult and Eddie eventually applied for reinstatement as an amateur.

JAY CARTER

Jay has been associated with the club from a young age. His father Jack has served both the Club and the Bay of Plenty Association in administrative roles while his Grandfather George was a popular member in an earlier age. After reaching high standards as a Junior that culminated in his selection in the New Zealand under 18 team to Australia in 1995 Jay spent a year developing his game under the tutelage of Mal Tongue at Manor Park in Wellington. He then returned to Tauranga where he and his father took on the contract to run the Pro Shop business at the Club. The business initially employed Doug Milne, previously professional at Whakatane, to allow Jay to serve his apprenticeship under a PGA Professional and so qualify as a fully-fledged PGA Professional himself. The service provided by Jack, Jay, and their associates has been outstanding.

BRUCE BURBERY

Bruce joined the Club as a junior in the years before there was much encouragement to juniors from many senior members. Juniors were often regarded more as a nuisance than as an asset by a number of those members. With no background in the game Bruce gripped the club in a way that felt natural to him with his left hand below his right. With this grip he was soon able to hit the ball a very long way. The subtleties of the game seemed of little interest to him at that stage. When playing with his school friends he was mainly concerned with how far he could hit the tee shot. After that he was inclined to head for the next tee, the finer arts of chipping and putting holding little interest for him. Once when playing with Ken Fraser, donor of the Fraser Cup for the Schoolboy Championship, and myself Bruce was persuaded to try the ‘proper’ right hand down grip as we attempted to convince him that there was little future for him in the game unless he changed. After trying the new grip with mixed success he stood on the 18th tee saying: ‘I have had enough of that. I’ll hit one my way.’ With that he launched a drive to the foot of the hill, a very long drive in that era of the wound ball and laminated-wooden headed driver. We complimented his effort before suggesting he hit another ball using our suggested grip. He did so and the ball finished about 40m ahead of the first. From that day onward he stuck to the new grip and was rewarded with both length and accuracy.

Always a threat to anyone in Match Play Bruce was not to win the Senior Championship until the year 2000. He then claimed to have been trying to win it for 40 years. He was a very proud and deserving winner. He repeated that victory ten years later in 2010. A very valuable member of our Senior Pennant

teams over the years Bruce had great success in Police and Inter-Services Golf where he won the latter New Zealand Championship on more than one occasion. For the Police he represented New Zealand in 'Test Matches' versus Australia.

JIM LANCASTER

Jim Lancaster lived adjacent to Pemberton Park. As a boy he was employed to cut Margaret Mowat's lawn. One day he asked her if he could have an old golf club he saw in the garage. Margaret said she thought she could do better than that and gave him a couple of better clubs that she had. With these he started hitting balls around the Park outside his fence, probably against local by-laws. One day I noticed he used the 'left hand down' grip. He said he had only seen Bruce Burbery hit a ball and that was what Bruce did. Jim soon adjusted to a conventional style and in 1969 became the youngest winner of the Senior Championship before Michael Nicholson took that record away from him just one year later. In that same year of 1970 both Jim and Michael were selected in the Bay of Plenty Freyberg Rose Bowl team to compete in Invercargill, pioneers in a trend that saw representative golf teams getting younger and younger in average age.

At Club level Jim won the Senior Championship again in 1978 and 1988. At one stage he turned Professional in order to run a business at the 9-hole course and Practise Range that operated at Te Maunga opposite Bay Park during the seventies and eighties. Having soon regained his amateur status he continues to play quality golf to this day

MARTIN HALL

Martin was another junior who learnt his golf in Tauranga before making his mark further afield when winning the New Zealand Maori Championship in 1998.

GAVAN MacFARLANE

Another quality player to come through the junior ranks at Tauranga Gavan had a golden run in the early nineties, winning the Senior Championship in three of the four years from 1992 to 1995. Gavan represented New Zealand at under-18 level versus Australia in 1994. In 1992 he placed third in the World Junior Stroke Play Championship in Aberdeen, Scotland. Partially as a result he was elected BOP Sportsman of the year. Later he joined the Professional ranks, serving an apprenticeship at the Hamilton Golf Club. Gavan's father Ian was, for some years, the Manager/Selector of our Senior Pennant team.

JOSH GEARY

Josh learned his early golf at Otumoetai before holding joint membership at Tauranga where, as a fifteen year old in 2001, he contested the final of the Senior Championship. On that occasion the experience of Gavin Smillie proved just a little too much for the young man who, even then, showed much of the quality play that would eventually take him to the Professional ranks. After joining the Mount Maunganui Club Josh continued to demonstrate his liking for the Tauranga course when achieving spectacular success in under-23 events and in the Carrus Tournament held on the course.

JARED PENDER

Jared is the son of Jim Pender, a racehorse trainer based on the course next door. Jared spent much of his time on the adjacent fairways while growing up. An independent personality Jared seemed reluctant to accept advice during his early years and perhaps this hindered his golfing development. As he matured and his game developed to a standard where he became an automatic selection in Bay of Plenty teams the difficulties of the past were left well behind. A strong young man with an excellent swing and the ability to hit the ball a very long way Jared earned New Zealand selection in the Eisenhower team that played in Melbourne in 2008. Soon afterward he turned Professional but, like Eddie Burgess before him, he found opportunities hard to come by. The developing American players have a huge advantage in being able to temper their games in the fiery cauldron of competitive College Golf. Our own young players might well consider the advantages of emulating Sir Bob Charles and getting much more experience courtesy of New Zealand Golf before attempting the move to Professional competition.

KEVIN SMITH

Kevin was already a low handicap player when he moved here from England. During his time in Tauranga he experienced success when representing both his club and his province before attracting the attention of the National selectors and consequently being selected to represent New Zealand at senior level. He featured with distinction on a number of occasions when playing the Carrus Tournament against the professionals and leading amateurs on his home course. Kevin moved to Melbourne early in the new century.

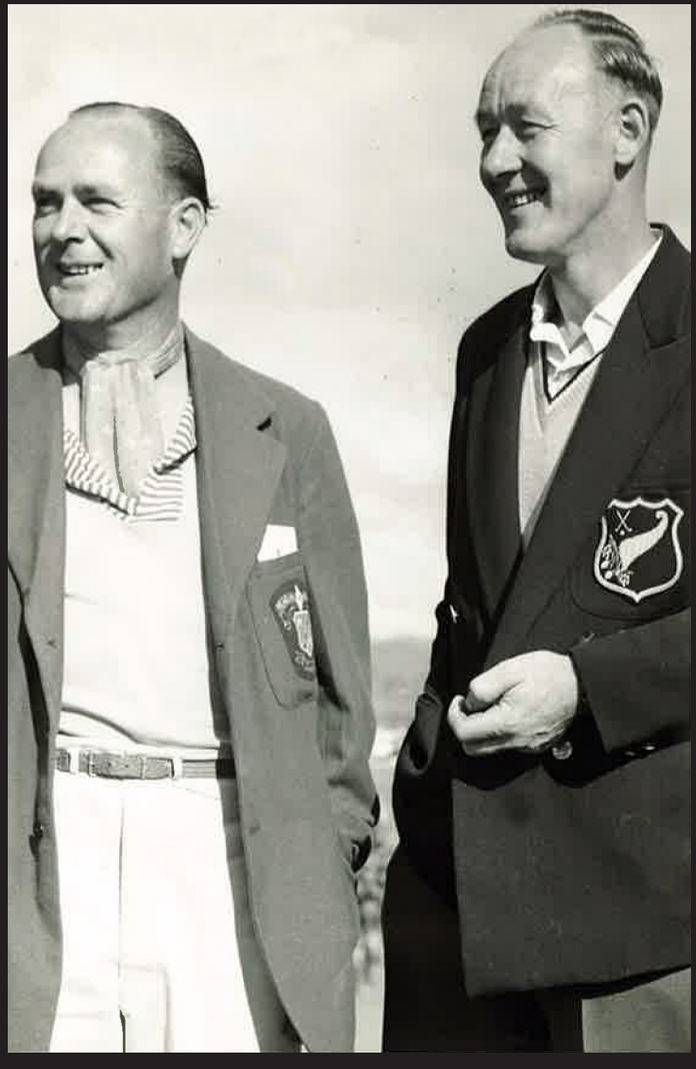
Ron Holden was popular around the Club over many years. His standard stroke stayed close to the ground and moved in a comparatively sharp curve to the left. To see him start the ball out some 45 degrees right of the target line and have it curve back to the green was a sight to treasure. On occasion the ball refused to swing back to the left and that led to some fine entertainment for Ron's playing partners. In the days when the practice range to the right of the 4th hole was still a scrub-covered swamp this would occasionally happen to Ron's tee stroke on that hole. To see a ball aimed for the middle of the swamp sail unerringly there was enough to reduce even the kindest of companions to helpless laughter. It was always best to have the honour there in case that should happen. Ron is the only player known to have hit a ball out of bounds into the Bus Depot when playing the 10th hole. On that occasion his low flying tee shot struck the Ladies' tee marker, flew straight back past him, ran right across the 8th fairway and through the fence.

LABOUR WEEKEND TOURNAMENT - 1952

Above: pictured from left to right Visitor, Alan Davidson, Visitor, Jim Mowat.
Caddies - Rob Mowat and Robert Arthur.

Left: A.L. Davidson
Life Member

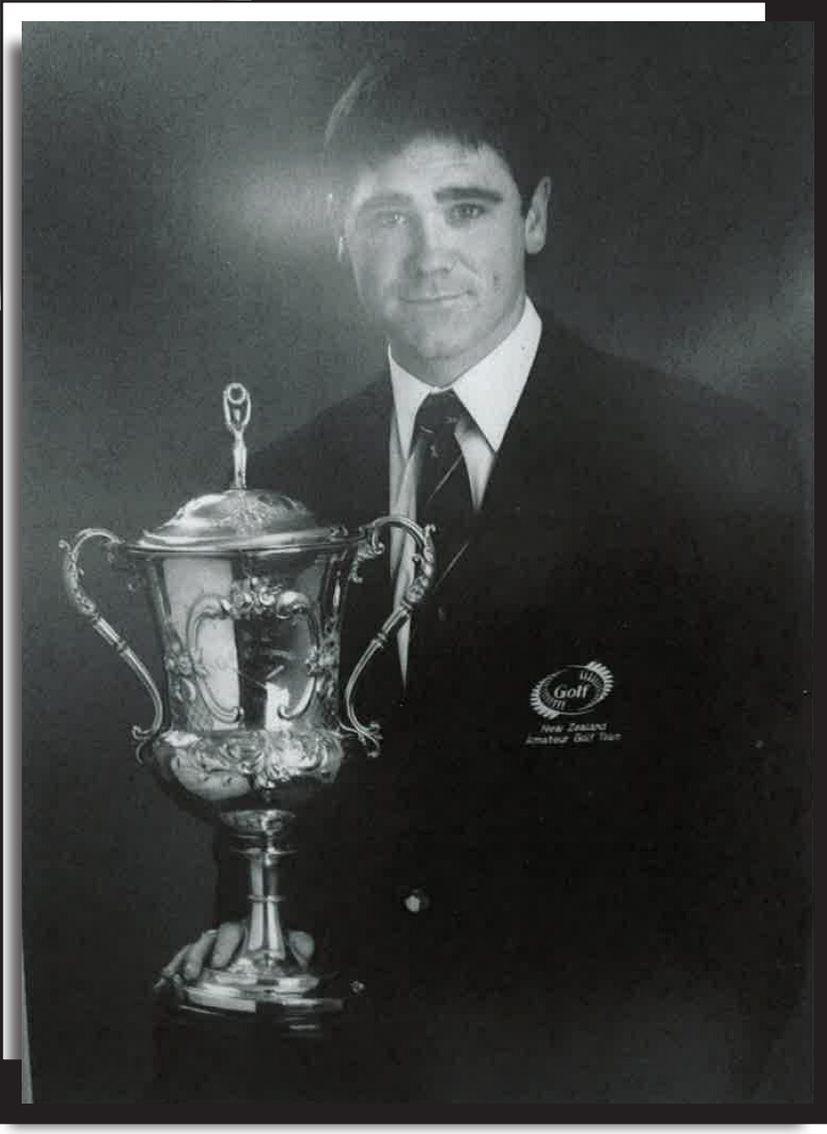
Above: Life Members 1996.
M White - A Davidson - K Frith
A Gallagher - E Galbally - J Edwards



Right: John Nevlle and Doug Furrie.
Two fine match players.

MICHAEL NICHOLSON

NZ Amateur Champion 1973



EDDIE BURGESS

NZ Amateur Champion 2000

Above: Labour Weekend contenders circa 1950.
Gary Taylor (Hamilton), Cary O'Niell (Tauranga), Paul O'Brien (Tauranga), Jack Lloyd (Mt Maunganui).
Jack Lloyd had the unique record of playing in forty consecutive Labour Weekend Tournaments.
The barefoot caddie is 11year old Brian Ducker.

Right:
Rotorua Golf Club clubhouse.

Noel Hockin at right.
Jim Mowat second from left.

Above: Ken Carter, Paul O'Brien, Peter Pollett Enjoy a day at Wairakei

Right: BOP School Champions in 1971 representing Tauranga Boys College
- all members of Tauranga Golf Club.

Back Row:
Alan Neilson
Graeme Bigham,
Brent Sutherland
Jim Lancaster

Front Row:
D.G.S Mowat
Ron Vogt
Bruce Burberry

Below: All proudly dressed up in club blazers before departing on an interclub visit during the sixties.
Back row: Dick Wilson, Bill Bongard, Eric Hucheson, John Neville, Harry Jones, John Nicoll, Doug Furrie, Barry Budd
Front row: Peter Harford, Laurie Carrington, Roy Bathgate, John Kiddie, Tui Harvey, Norm Robson, Sandy Balfour, Jock Tennent

Left: Senior Pennant team 1994

B. Burbery
B. Murdock,
J. Carter
E. Burgess
D. Dougherty (President)
G. McFarlane,
M. Nicholson
I. McFarlane (Manager)

Left: Mens Championship Pennant Team.

WINNERS
Baywide Championship for 2011

Back L-R:
Blair Murdock, Sam Davis, John Waretini, George Kinghort, Eddie Burgess, Ben Shanly, Peter Knedler (Manager)
Front:
David Feeney,
Karl Knedler

Right: Mens Senior A Pennant Team.

WINNERS
Baywide Championship for 2011

Back L-R:
Jason Ornberg, Oliver Coxhead, Will Coxhead, James Cannon, Jin Hwang, John Laing

Above: Mens Championship Pennant Team.

WINNERS Baywide Championship for 2014
Back L-R: Karl Knedler, Sam Davis, Cam Neal, Blair Murdock, Sean Blomquist
Front L-R: Chris Posa, Justin Rasmussen, Dave Cooke

Right:
Handicap Pennant Team.

WINNERS Baywide Championship for 2014
Back L-R: John Laing,
Murray Warner,
Trevor Loader,
Bryan Patterson
Front L-R: Richard Norris,
Vinnie Aston,
Brian Benjamin,
Lindsay Klee
Absent: David Blacke,
James March

Mens Senior B Pennant Team.

WINNERS Baywide Championship for 2014
Bill Anstis, Richie Semple, David Blacke, Paul Thomas, John Laing, Byron Willis,
Nic Kersop, Jamie Whiting, Liam St Clair, Harm Drost, Jordan Cooke
(no photo available)

CHAPTER EIGHT

WOMEN'S GOLF

Women, or Ladies as they were then known, were accepted as members from the earliest years of the Club. The initial subscription of 5/- was half that of male members and remained at a discount until the 1990s when it was moved that all senior members, men and women, should pay the same subscription. From the beginning the Club was run by men, for men. In common with worldwide practise the course design was intended to cater for the way men played the game and women had simply to make the best of it by playing from forward tees. Nothing much has changed in that regard although recent club and ball developments have meant that some of the original design features of our courses offer a more appropriate challenge to the women players of today than they once did.

Life Member Rennie Wallis (nee Daines) told a story from the earliest days of golf at Gate Pa that perhaps illustrates the standing of women in the club at the time. The women, ever inclined to be more innovative and adventurous in their competitions than were the men, decided to hold a Flag Match for their Saturday competition. At the time their club day was on the Saturday prior to the men's starting times. Rennie described the event as follows: "there were about a dozen of us and we were each told to bring along a flag in our bags. We did this and each of us planted our flag at the point where our handicap strokes ran out. A sea of waving flags greeted the first men as they approached the final green at the end of their rounds. On entering the clubhouse these men told us in no uncertain terms what we could do with our flags! Our Captain dashed out red-faced to remove the offending obstructions".

Rennie recalled some of those early Lady Members: Mrs. Cook (Margaret Wrigley), Mrs. Wickham (Nan Daines), Mrs. Maltby (Violet Carr), Mrs. Hanna (Elsie Sweet), Mrs. Heald, Mrs. Jordan, Mrs. Saunders, Mrs. Ripley, Miss Phyllis Bateman, Miss Lynn Moller, Miss Nancy Snodgrass, Miss May Cameron, the three Goodyear sisters (Frances, Annie, and Eva), Miss Samuels, Miss Nora Wallis, and Miss Ivy Litten.
Ladies Championships were at first played in two grades irrespective of handicaps. The first sixteen qualifiers were designated as the seniors, the second sixteen as juniors.

TITBITS FROM THE LADIES CLUB MINUTES

1937: There was a discussion on the separation of the Men and Ladies' sections of the Club. It was unanimously decided that it would be unsuitable to change at this time.

1940: The first sub-committee was formed. It was to be responsible for the cleanliness and tidiness of the clubhouse. (Women clearly knew their place in the scheme of things). The Lady members were active in supporting the War effort by raising funds for the Patriotic Shop.

1944: The competition fee was set at 5/-.

1946: The services of a woman were secured to attend to Afternoon Teas on Wednesdays and Saturdays. The Businesswomen requested permission to play their competitions on Saturday afternoons. (It is not recorded what the reaction of the men was to this request!).

1947: A recommendation from the AGM that three starting tees be used in turn by the three grades was discussed. (At the time the Ladies were always drawn in their own handicap grades). A secret ballot was held to decide which day was favoured as Match day.
The size of the Ladies' Committee was increased to thirteen. (How did they ever reach an agreed decision?)

1948: A new Local Rule was adopted for the Fourth Hole: 'if a player from the tee plays her first ball from the gully she has the option of playing it or picking it up. If she decides to play the first ball, and takes a stroke, she must hole out with that ball'. (Was this a product of a committee of thirteen? Thankfully we now have better worded local rules - comprehending this one must have been more difficult than playing the hole).

1950: Competition fees were raised to 15/- for the season. Locker fees were set at 10/- pa. Another Local Rule was adopted for the troublesome Fourth Hole: "a ball played from the tee failing to reach *cut* fairway is Out of Bounds. Play second shot from the tee and, in the event of the first ball passing through the rough grass at the top bank, first ball is in play". (Was this really considered to be an improvement?).

1952: There was a Special General Meeting called to discuss the notice of motion that starting times on Club day (Wednesday) be from 12.00 to 12.45. This was not agreed to.
A Ways and Means Committee was to be established to raise funds for the Building program planned to alter and enlarge the clubhouse.
The hole-in-one fund fee was 1/- pa reducing to 6d the following year if not collected. (Anyone successful was awarded the entire pool with which to 'shout'. On occasion someone would be unfortunate enough to hole out soon after another had done so only to find the 'cupboard was bare').

1953: It was determined that the results of Ladies' competitions and other Club news should be published in the BOP Times.

1954: The hole-in-one fund fee was increased to 1/6d. A new Local Rule was adopted for play of the Eighth Hole. It read: "should the tee shot hit the second power pole the tee shot may be replayed. In addition if any pole interfere with the line to the green the ball may be moved away to a safe position no nearer the hole".
A vote established Club day as being Wednesday.
1955: Dr. Jean Reading established a competition for Girls of school age in order to encourage wider participation by them.
The BOP/TV Ladies' Association split from the Waikato/King Country Association.
It was suggested that the social side of competition day was being lost with the system of morning and afternoon start times. A three-tee start at 10.30 was promoted as a way of rectifying the problem.

1956: The Saturday Ladies' start time had been agreed to from 9.30 to 10.30am.
There had not been enough interest to continue with Jean Reading's School Age competitions.

1957: Mary Shanks started golf this season and reduced her handicap to 26, winning the Junior Championship, the Junior Jubilee, and the trophy for the most improved player. It was suggested that Senior players should assist and guide this promising young player and see that she have the opportunity to play with low handicap players. (Traditionally low handicap players did not get drawn with those on longer handicaps).
The Club cardigan colour was to be Navy Blue.

1958: There was another request to change the colour of the cardigan as Rotorua, Matamata and Te Puke already have Navy Blue as their club colour.

1960: Advice was received from LGU Executive member Anne Mark that from June 1st. it would no longer be necessary for any player to sign an extra-day Score.

1961: It was reported that Mrs. Rennie Gordon was assisting in compiling a History of the Club that would be published and issued as a souvenir booklet at a price of 30/-. (This presumably refers to the proposed publication first worked upon by Joan Mirrielees that was not published owing to lack of funding. Some of the material collected then has been incorporated into this publication).

1962: A proposal to allow the wearing of shorts on the course did not find favour.
1965: The resolution to start C-Graders on Tuesdays was rescinded. (C-Graders were players who had not yet earned a handicap of 36). It was determined to trial new start times for Wednesday play. Approximately six groups of handicapped players would commence play from tee 7 from 9am. C-Graders were to follow them. All others were to start from number one tee at 9.30am.

1966: The membership limits were eased to allow for 300 A-Category and 50 B-Category Women. B-Category was to be accorded priority as vacancies arose. The Ladies' AGM voted to have separate Club days for Junior and C-graders on Tuesday, and for Senior and Intermediate players on Wednesday. (This was probably greeted with relief by members of both groups, especially the C-Graders who were always under pressure from the more Senior players behind them, and understandably did not find the Seventh the most welcoming of starting holes. They would not be the only members to hold that sentiment.)

1969: The Club committee requested that in future the Ladies use the profits from their tournaments to meet their own expenses. (Unbiased opinion would readily concede that over the years the women have husbanded their financial resources better than have the men.)

1970: Bermuda Shorts were to be permitted on the course but not in the Clubhouse.

1971: The dress regulations were again extended to allow the wearing of Slacks on the course, but only Slack Suits would be acceptable in the Lounge. (Presumably the sky had not fallen the previous year when the first few brave souls wore shorts).

1974: Nen Sim became the first woman ever to be elected to the Club Executive.

1977: It was proposed to provide for a nine-hole handicap for Veteran Lady members who found it difficult to complete full rounds. Play was to be from the Eleventh to the First hole inclusive. This was seen as a means of encouraging these members to continue their membership rather than retire, or move away to less hilly courses as some had done in the past.

In this regard Tauranga led the way when introducing this abbreviated form of the game prior to its widespread adoption by NZ Golf. Later we were to become one of the first Clubs to promote Nine Hole Golf to younger players in addition to this group of older women.

The power poles on the left hand side of the 8th fairway caused many a player to lose a stroke or two and a collective sigh of relief went up when, in the Fifties, these unwelcome obstructions were removed. Local rules did not normally allow for a replay should you be unfortunate enough to strike a pole. Why the 1954 rule referred to in the minutes quoted above only applied to the second pole is a mystery. Balls were as likely as not to ricochet out of bounds after striking a pole and Murphy's Law ensured that seldom was a ricochet favourable to the player. Perhaps the most spectacular happening was when one player's drive struck the pole nearest the tee, flew back over his head, and disappeared into the bunker that then bordered the 7th green. Though his playing partners were amused the player was not. A bunker shot over trees to the fairway was certainly daunting. He would have been better to have declared it unplayable and gone forward to play again from the tee though some 'expert' would probably have told him he couldn't do that. (Incidentally a correctly worded local rule would not allow an optional replay. If a replay was to be allowed it would need to be compulsory.)

PROMINENT WOMEN PERSONALITIES

The following profiles are of a random assortment of women members who have made a mark through the years. They are not in any particular order, chronologically or otherwise. They are simply memories and anecdotes that came to mind to recent or present members who were asked for their suggestions. All those recognised below have made an indelible impression upon our history in their own particular way, some in competitive play, some in administration, some in each of these fields. All have been recognised by their fellow members as having contributed greatly to the very life-blood of their Club. We salute them all.

MISS ANNE MARK

Miss Mark joined the Club in 1935. She recalled that sheep then grazed the course and most greens were fenced. The course was the original layout that included holes in the racecourse oval. The 'Hummocks' and the 'Drop', both in the area of the present third, were difficult but exciting holes quite fondly remembered.

Miss Mark tells her own story:

"My first experience in helping Mrs. Hanna with the catering was in finding sticks to use as kindling to get the fire lit in the enormous Range in the Racing Club kitchen, and then cutting firewood to satisfy its insatiable appetite. I first served the Ladies' Committee as Handicap Manager in 1938, and from then on periodically until 1954. I held every office except President. I didn't think I was the type for that. I think I won the Championship six times. We did not play it during the war years". (Miss Mark did win the Championship on six occasions but would almost certainly have been successful in those 'no competition' years of 1941, 42, and 43, as she had been the winner in 1940, and again in 1944 and 1945. The other successes came in 1950 and finally in 1953 immediately before the 'Wickham era' began.)

Miss Mark continued:

"In 1954 we formed the Bay of Plenty Ladies' Golf Association and I was its President for three years. I then captained the Bay of Plenty/Thames Valley Russell Grace team until 1963. During that time we won the Cup three times and were runner-up once.

In 1955 I was elected to the LGU Council. The Ladies' Golf Union was the National governing body at that time. It has now amalgamated with the Men's governing body to form Golf New Zealand. I remained a member of the LGU Council until 1963, being honoured with the Presidency for the final two years. (It seems I overcame the aversion to accepting that role). In 1963 I had the wonderful experience of serving as non-playing Captain of the New Zealand team to the Commonwealth Tournament in Melbourne. In that same year the Tauranga Golf Club elected me to Life Membership. Despite all my previous experiences I rate that award as the most moving experience of my career in golf".

An exceptional sportswoman, an efficient, knowledgeable administrator ever ready to help those who sought her advice, Anne Mark's sense of humour and special capabilities set her apart. She was further

honoured when made a Vice-President of the British LGU, and a Life Vice-President of the NZLGU. Anne died at Tauranga in November 1983. She has been sorely missed.

MISS UNA WICKHAM

Una Wickham was born in Tauranga and began playing at a young age on a small nine-hole course. Armed with just one club and a putter Una followed in the wake of her parents. Her father was a very keen cricketer and encouraged Una to take an active part in that game and in all other sports she may have had access to. As a result Una excelled in tennis, hockey, and cricket as a boarder at Sacred Heart Girls' School in Auckland where she was a student from 1937-39. In 1940 Una enrolled at Auckland Teachers' Training College. On graduating from there she was appointed Sports Mistress at Diocesan Girls' School. One year later she graduated with a Diploma of Physical Education from Otago University. About the same time she started to play golf seriously and quickly demonstrated her considerable talent. As a member of The Grange Club she had reduced to a handicap of four by 1948 and eventually played to a low of plus two.

On a trip to England in 1953 Una was contacted by the Manager of a New Zealand representative team that was in England at the time. One of the team had been forced to return to New Zealand on account of illness and, in Una's words: "by the greatest of good fortune I was asked to fill the gap".

Una played with distinction even though equipped with "the wickedest set of clubs ever seen at that level. Two woods, three irons, a bunker club, a putter, and a borrowed eight iron". In that same year she played in the British Open at Troon, and again at Portland the following year. In both years she claimed she was "early eliminated". Not without a fight we would warrant. One aftermath of the exposure New Zealand women were then having to International competition was the call for longer, tougher courses in this country to better prepare the top women players for these contests. It was clear that our short and open courses fell well short of the standard required to extend our most promising players so as to condition them to compete with the best overseas. Calls for the simple remedy that these top women should regularly play from the men's tees were generally ignored. In addition club committees, dominated as they were by men, were not much interested in redesigning courses to suit women members. The best Una was able to do on her home course was to see some of the forward tees eliminated. Consequently those on the 2nd, 6th, 7th, and 16th were eliminated though that on the 7th has since been reinstated. Seldom do the best women players get to play from the back tees at holes like the 3rd, 11th and 13th.

Una first joined the Tauranga Club in 1954 and was selected that year to represent Bay of Plenty (later Bay of Plenty/Thames Valley) in the Russell Grace Inter- provincial Tournament. That year the team won the tournament and by 1956 Una had been selected as number one, a position she retained for twenty years. The team followed the 1954 win with further wins in 1955, 59, 64, 66, and 75. At National level Miss Wickham represented New Zealand on eight occasions including Tasman Trophy and Commonwealth contests. In 1959 and 69 she won the Amateur Championship of New Zealand and in 1968, in a tribute to her longevity in the game, won the Mellsop Cup - the New Zealand Amateur

Stroke Play Championship. Her unparalleled sporting abilities were showcased by her selection to represent New Zealand in Cricket. Una also represented Auckland at hockey while in tennis she won the Championship at Sacred Heart (now Barradene College) in three successive years. Has any athlete, man or woman, equalled or surpassed such a record?

Dress was much more conventional and officialdom much more hidebound in Una's heyday. Nancy Hare recalled that when Una returned from England where she had been living she was selected to make her Russell Grace debut and having suffered a spell of ill health she opted to wear black slacks when the weather turned nasty on the first morning. Not only were the LGU officials scandalised but influential Herald Sports writer Terry Mclean saw fit to write half a column the next day deploring the "dreadful attire" of this newcomer, and claiming that such garments were quite out of place on any golf course, let alone at an event of National significance. This was not the only time Una ran into controversy on the issue. One year she featured in the New Zealand Championship final and requested permission of the LGU to play in Slacks as the weather was cold and unpleasant, conditions that adversely affected her health. Permission was refused.

At Club level Una won the Tauranga Senior Championship on no less than sixteen occasions, the first seven in succession starting in that first year of joining in 1954. Olga Johnson (5 times), Pat Kidd (three times), Peg Copestake (twice), and Kath Johnstone (once) interrupted Una's winning streak over the succeeding years until Una's final triumph in 1980.

In 1975 Una was honoured with election to the executive of the Ladies' Golf Union of New Zealand (LGU). There she excelled in her administrative role, especially in the area of recognising and developing potential talent amongst young players. This was an interest she had exercised during her time as a teacher at Tauranga Intermediate School where she had encouraged John Ward, Noel Johnston, and others to start the game at a young age. Both John and Noel went on to represent Bay of Plenty in the Freyberg Rosebowl as the Inter-provincial Championship was then known. When the inaugural New Zealand Mixed Foursomes Championship was scheduled to be held in Wellington in 1973 Una suggested to the young Noel that they should try their luck as a team in the event. Noel accepted with enthusiasm and the pair annexed the title in style, winning their preliminary matches by the convincing margins of 6/5, 4/3, and 5/4, on the way to a convincing 3/2 win over a Wellington pairing in the final. In her self-effacing style Una had nothing but praise for the form shown by her young partner.

Una's untimely death in 1983 was a shock to all in the golfing fraternity. Her memory was celebrated through the institution of the prestigious Una Wickham Memorial Match Play Tournament that was held at Tauranga for many years.

MISS JOAN MIRRIELEES

Miss Mirrielees was the first to undertake a compilation of the history of the Tauranga Golf Club, beginning the research for this as early as 1974, and presenting an incomplete and unpublished version in time for the Jubilee celebrations of 1986.

Born in 1903, Joan came to Tauranga with her family in 1910. Her father, A J Mirrielees, was a pharmacist in the town and a very active member of the original club based at the Tauranga Domain. He maintained his interest when the Club moved out to the Racecourse Reserve in 1914 and was largely responsible for the planting of a great variety of trees on the Reserve. Many of these survive to this day adding both beauty and strategic difficulty to the golf course. Joan was encouraged by her father to take up the game from an early age. Joan maintained this interest throughout her life, so much so that she was able to achieve victory in the Rotorua Ladies' Golf Club Annual Veterans' Tourney in 1965, shooting a meritorious 89 to annex the title.

Joan graduated as a teacher in 1924 and taught at all levels in schools throughout the North Island. In 1938 Joan went to Bradford in Yorkshire, England, as an Exchange teacher, later moving on to Lytham St. Anne's, well known to New Zealanders as the scene of Bob Charles' Open victory in 1963.

Back home in New Zealand Joan was active on a number of fronts including a stint as the hostess of the Women's Hour and Shopping Report on local radio 1ZD (now BOP 95 FM) in 1959 and the early sixties. For many years she filled the role of editor of the Tauranga Historical Society Journal, researching and publishing many invaluable articles about the early history of the district. In 1984 Joan's contribution in this sphere was recognised with the Societies' Heritage award. Another special honour came Joan's way when she was presented with the Key to the City in 1975. Credit for the early work done on this history goes to Miss Mirrielees. She would have loved to see her efforts culminate in a published version but, sadly, that was not to be achieved in her time.

MRS EVELYN SIM. (NEN)

In 1974 Nen Sim became the first women member to be elected to the Executive of the Club. In later years other women members served on the committee following a successful resolution to allow for a representative from the Women's committee to join the Executive. Nen, on the other hand, was a pioneer, being elected in open competition with male nominees. No better pioneer in the role could have been found. Nen had considerable experience on the Women's committee having served as handicapper and for many years she had written a weekly column of Ladies' Golf News in the Bay of Plenty Times under the pseudonym 'Bunkered'. Contrary to the fears of some on the 'Men's Committee' Nen did not play the part of a militant feminist upon joining the committee. Instead it soon became apparent that she was there for one purpose only, to look after the interests of all members of the Club, both male and female. In her quiet and pleasant manner Nen did much over the next eight years to change the mind set of those members of the committee who still retained some of the old concepts of the club being run by the men for the benefit of the men. Nen has a logical mind and her contributions to discussion were always to the point and frequently indicated the best path to follow. During Nen's time on the committee the social life of the Club experienced a period of enhanced activity with successful dinner/dance evenings complementing the regular Opening and Closing day highlights. In 1985 Nen was honoured with Life Membership of the Club. Few could be more worthy of the honour.

MRS. ELSIE HANNA came to Tauranga in 1922. She won the Senior Championship in 1924 and 1926. She served on the Ladies' committee from 1926 to 1939. In 1937 it was recorded that she presided

over an Annual General Meeting at which the following were in attendance: Mesdames Maltby, Mowat, Mayfield, Page, Auld, Kirkby, Ronayne, Sinclair and Jervis together with the Misses Humphries, Mark, Gillanders, F, A, and E Goodyear. Interestingly the meeting was held in the Tauranga Council Chambers, the clubhouse facilities being quite inadequate for an evening meeting. Mrs. Hanna was a pioneer in catering for such events as Inter-club fixtures when water had to be heated in an outside bath and small spirit burners were utilised for boiling kettles. Mrs. Hanna was elected to Life membership at some time prior to 1948 and was the first woman to be so honoured by the club.

MISS FRANCES GOODYEAR became a member with her two sisters, Annie and Eva in 1927. Membership was small in those years and all members became actively involved and worked hard for the good of the Club. The sisters were no exception. Frances was a schoolteacher and it was not unusual to see her dismiss her class a few minutes early on certain golfing afternoons. Grateful pupils were happy to polish her clubs, clean balls, and put water in the radiator of her Ford motorcar. Frances recalled interclub matches being arranged with players coming from Rotorua, Whakatane, Thames, Te Puke, Waihi, Matamata, Cambridge, and Paeroa.

MISS EVA GOODYEAR was interviewed on tape in 1993 when she was well into her eighties and provided us with some of the earliest memories of golf in Tauranga in those pioneering years. She recalled the old Links at the Domain with the blue Irises and the Flag Lilies though she was obviously not then a golfer. Her father Canon William Goodyear had come to Tauranga in 1896 having been appointed by the Church Mission Society to serve as Supervising Maori Missioner for the Bay of Plenty. He had arrived in New Zealand in 1878 and was canonised in 1913 to recognise his sterling work for the Mission.

PHYLL, DAWN and HELEN HARTLEY were another group of three sisters who were early members of the Club. They joined in 1929 and Dawn would sometimes accompany Mr Mirrielees when he was planting trees. She recalled his criteria for spacing the trees was to ‘hit a ball, plant a tree’. Dawn remembered the wires around the greens to keep the sheep out. She was forever ruining her stockings clambering over them. The accepted mode of dress for a young lady on the course was grey pullover, grey culottes, and grey stockings. Rather a contrast to the young women glamorising the courses of today. Dawn remembered Kit Hardy and Alison Wilcox from those early days.

PHYLL BATEMAN joined the Club in 1931. Both she and her brother Jack were devoted to the sport and were dedicated Club members. Phyll served on committee from 1947-49. Her recollections of the early days included committee meetings held at night in hired rooms and having to hit over the road into the racecourse when playing McKinleys. Personalities Phyll recalled included top visiting players Bessie Gaisford (twice New Zealand Ladies’ Amateur Champion), Ruth Hodgeman, and Elsie Heald. Rennie Daines, Hannah Bartlett, Mrs. Page, Mrs Sanders (wife of a Colonel, but not *the Colonel),* Claire Mayfield, Audrey Gamman, and promising junior Kathy Moloney were some fellow Club members of whom Phyll had pleasant memories.

MARGARET MOWAT joined in 1936 when her husband arrived from Gisborne to take the position of

resident Professional to the Club. Margaret learned her golf on the family sheep and cattle Station at Ngatapa where the family laid out a nine-hole course on the area surrounding the homestead. She was rather proud of the fact that when she first played the Poverty Bay Golf Club's Awapuni Links she gained her official handicap, thus proving that the play at home had enabled her to develop a swing that stood up to the standards of the Town players.

Soon after arriving in Tauranga Margaret was asked to take on the Secretarial role with the Ladies' Committee which she did. She recalled that they met at Violet Maltby's home in 13th. Avenue. Claire Mayfield was the Captain and "dear old Elsie Hanna" was President. Margaret recalled the era as a happy time with the Ladies working together to put on wonderful spreads when hosting visiting teams. Mrs. Hanna was famed for the wonderful Potato salads she produced and no one could make and add the dressing quite like her. Myrtle Ripley was especially instrumental in the drive to establish a new clubhouse in 1938.

Margaret was still playing regularly two or three times a week, and to a very creditable level, until well into her eighties. Throughout she pulled her own clubs and she and her regular Monday group of similarly aged ladies played at a pace that would outstrip many younger players of today.

In 1978 Anne Mark and Rennie Wallis nominated Margaret for Life Membership. The committee sought further information and nothing eventually came of the nomination.

RENNIE DAINES will best be remembered as Mrs Rennie Gordon while much later in life she became Mrs Wallis. As Miss Daines Rennie won the Ladies' Championship three times in succession from 1920 to 1922. She served three years as Captain in the Nineteen Forties at which time she also became Mrs Gordon. Some ten years later she served a three-year term as Ladies' President. A strong supporter of the Club from its early years at Gate Pa Rennie continued her association with, and support of, the Club throughout her life. She was the second Woman to be elected to Life Membership following the election of Elsie Hanna.

NELL SILSON joined the Club in the thirties. She lived at Katikati and drove to golf and home again after the day's play. Club competitions were then held on Saturday afternoons. The road to Katikati was rough and particularly treacherous in winter. Driving home on dark winter evenings must have been a real challenge yet Nell seldom missed her Club Day.

JOYCE CARNACHAN joined in 1931 and served on committee for many years during which she organised the catering. She served the Women's committee as Captain and later as President. Joyce was a selector for the Russell Grace Teams and in 1963 was elected to the executive committee of the TVBOP Ladies Golf Association, serving as Vice President until 1967. In 1972 the Tauranga Golf Club elected Joyce to Life Membership in recognition of her service to the Club over many years. Those who played with Joyce remembered her with affection and with not a little envy for her special touch with the putter.

AMY SMITH joined in 1936 and moved away from town two years later. In 1948 she returned and began a long association with the Club, retaining membership until 1999. A committee member for two

years Amy won many competitions, represented the Club at Pennant level, and was chosen to play for TVBOP against the Waikato/King Country team.
One year an epic contest developed for the Elsie Hanna Cup. The original conditions stipulated an 18 hole replay if the match was square after the 18th. Amy and Jean Ellis played three rounds before Jean won! The conditions of competition were promptly changed so that a decision would be reached at the first time of asking.

BERNICE WILLOUGHBY was a member from 1939 until 1999. She was another to win many competitions in her time. Bernice was a member early enough to remember the original clubhouse shared with the jockeys. Sometimes bales of hay were stored at one end. Occasionally these served as extra seating. Bernice fondly recalled scoring eagles at the sixth and fifteenth. Golf bags were much lighter then. Slung over the shoulder, as was the custom, they were more than heavy enough, especially towards the latter stages of a round. She remembered preferring the Bromford golf ball costing 1/9d. Bernice recalled Junior players always showing due deference to their elders in those times, perhaps implying that things were not quite the same today.

ANN BRANCH was a member from 1939 until 1991. She was a committee member in 1941. Her husband A J (Bronco) Branch owned a Sporting Goods store in the town that still operates under the name 'Broncos'. Ann was one of the first members to wear slacks when playing, a trend much frowned upon by the more traditional of members, and certainly one that had long met with the disapproval of the hidebound members of the LGU hierarchy. What would they have thought of the on-course fashion of the young women players of today?

Bronco was a fine teaching Professional who gave lessons to Tauranga members, and others, over many years. His pupils were recognised for the slow tempo of their swings, and for the distinctive pause at the top of the backswing. Some felt his methods led to somewhat mechanical swings as opposed to more free flowing 'natural' swings. Whatever the rights or wrongs of these opinions there could be no denying the success enjoyed by his pupils. Notable amongst the more recent of these has been Peg Copestake, twice winner of our Senior Championship.

PEG COPESTAKE joined the club in 1961 having been introduced to the game by Edna Galbally. Peg soon gained her handicap and then was offered a course of lessons by Bronco Branch. Responding to

Peggy Turner, playing the knoll one day, pitched short of the bunker. The ball leaped the bunker, bounced between bunker and green, and ran unerringly into the hole. Ray Hay may have upstaged this. Ray was an unusual golfer who tended to mishit a series of three Iron strokes until close to the green when he was prone to finally hit one over the green. On one occasion Ray's tee shot at the fifth flew low and fast before striking a tree behind the green. From there it bounced back across a bunker onto the green and into the hole. These things happen in golf yet many an excellent player goes through life without being able to claim a single ace.

the opportunity Peg spent many hours practising after her school-teaching day was completed. She recalled Bronco's methods did not involve hitting a ball for the first lesson or two, and new pupils were not allowed near a golf course for at least three months. This could be very frustrating to the keen beginner. The season following these sessions with Bronco saw Peg's handicap down to single figures, a level she was able to maintain for many years. Although playing to one's age is a not an uncommon feat amongst male players Peg is one of the few women we know to have achieved this.
A strong commitment to the encouragement of junior players saw Peg an early disciple of the 'Gillian Bannan' method of introducing youngsters to the game. Consequently she travelled to local schools with a trailer load of clubs, hoops, mats, buckets and flags, to teach groups of about twenty children the rudiments of golf.
Peg served on the executive committee of the club and in 2000 became the first woman to be elected Club President, an honour very much deserved following years of involvement in so many aspects of both the Club and the game itself. Notable amongst these have been her commitment to spreading the word on the Rules of Golf and, along with husband Noel, to the organisation of Twilight Golf.

To recognise her outstanding service Peg was elected to Life Membership in 2005. In joining husband Noel in receiving this distinction they became the only married couple to have been so honoured. Sadly Peg passed away in December 2011 within days of her return from a much anticipated trip to Melbourne to follow the fortunes of the players competing in the President's Cup. It was wonderful that she was able to enjoy every day of that great event featuring the American team versus the rest of the World, excluding Europe.

EDNA GALBALLY joined the Club in 1943 having arrived in Tauranga the previous year to take up a teaching appointment in the two Primary Schools at Otumoetai. As Committee member, Secretary, Handicapper, and Saturday Supervisor Edna spent 23 years as an officer of the Tauranga Ladies' Golf Club. Her quiet efficiency, her wealth of golfing knowledge, and her encouragement both to committee members and players made her a greatly valued member of the Ladies' Club. For her services over so many years she was elected to Life Membership in 1994.

NANCY HARE joined the Club in 1946. She served the Ladies' Committee as Vice Captain, Captain, and President. Nancy won the Junior Championship soon after joining and, in 1975, reached the final of the Senior Championship where she met Una Wickham who was in her usual matchless form.

Women golfing personalities especially recalled by Nancy included Doreen Blundell (Juno) of the Mount Maunganui Club, Linda Caruthers, Joyce Carnachan, Merle Carter, Cookie Grant, Ruby Poynter and Rennie Gordon.

OLGA JOHNSON came to Tauranga from South Africa in the 1950s. She and husband Eric were members for 34 years before joining the Mount Club when Eric found our hills rather too difficult to negotiate. During their time at Tauranga they were wonderful Club members, both fully involved in all aspects of club life. Even after resigning they were regular contestants in the Friday night Twilight competitions where it was not necessary for Eric to play the hilly first six holes. Olga was an exceptional

Sportswoman who excelled at Golf, winning the Club Senior Championship in 1961,63, 64, and again in 1970.

At National level she and Una Wickham combined to win the 1959 National Foursomes, and in 1962 Olga tied with Susan Grigg of Christchurch in the New Zealand Stroke Play Championship for the Mellsop Cup.
Olga was a member of the BOPTV Russell Grace teams of 1964, 68, and 70, and in 1964 she won the BOPTV Senior Championship. In 1976 she shared the same title with Miss E Fleming and Mrs. V Fraher. In later years Olga further demonstrated her sporting prowess with considerable success in Veterans' swimming events.

NAN WEBSTER became a member in 1952 and was active for many years. She particularly remembered early golfing partners in Cookie Grant, Pat Kidd, Dos Green, Vera Park, Freda White, Ruby Strang, and Maisey Hardy. Her own personal highlight was holing an Iron shot for an eagle two at the tenth hole. In earlier days members took their own cut lunches to golf and it was a pleasant innovation when professional catering was introduced. She enjoyed especially the services provided by Mrs. Polley and later, by Mrs. Anderson. Both these ladies made an indelible impression on those who were members in that period.

JOYCE WATERWORTH joined the Club in 1954 and was competitive at senior level over many years. She represented the BOPTV team at Russell Grace Inter-provincial Tournaments in 1957, 58, 59, and 61. She recalled that there were seven members of the team at that time with no set reserve so one member had to be left out each time. When Anne Mark was the Manager of the team she did not enjoy telling anyone they would not be playing the following day. To overcome that problem Anne would get the message across while the team relaxed in the Motel hot pool by pinching the unlucky one on her bare bottom. Joyce knew because it happened to her once.

MARY PARKINSON (Nee Shanks) and her sister **JO DAWKINS** began playing golf in 1957 at which time their father Arnold was still an active player. Harry Bradmore, ever one to encourage the young player, gave Mary a book on Golf for Ladies. This must have set her in the right direction for she went on to win both the Junior and Senior Club Championships and, in 1982, the Senior BOP Champion of Champions title. While Mary and Terry resided in Northland she added the Mt. Denby Senior Championship title to her tally. During her competitive career Mary represented both Bay Of Plenty and Northland at Inter- Provincial level.

JOYCE EDWARDS joined the Club with husband Roy in the mid-fifties and soon became involved in many facets of club life. She was a committee member as early as 1957 and took on the secretaryship one year later. In 1958 Joyce became Vice-Captain and Handicapper, served as Captain from 1961 to 63 and as President from 1964 to 68. In that final year of Presidency her administrative talents were recognised further afield and she was elected Northern Delegate to the BOPTV Association in 1968, 69, and 70. From 1972-77 she was Vice-President of the Association and served as its President in 1978-79.

In 1980 Joyce was elected to Life Membership of the Tauranga Golf Club and was still enjoying a few holes well into the new Millennium. Many wondered how Joyce managed to retain so youthful an appearance as the years went by. I am sure it was a reflection of her positive outlook, her interest in those around her, and her general zest for life. The game of golf does seem to keep a lot of participants in good health and spirit longer than is the case with many other people.

ALISON FAULKNER, who joined in 1960, recalled with pleasure the stricter etiquette that prevailed in an earlier age. Dress requirements were quite rigid. The initial Club uniform comprised grey skirts and navy cardigans. Subsequently a uniform featuring green skirts, a cream jersey, and a navy blouse replaced this. Another change meant the ladies all had to get Air Force blue skirts and jumpers with the Club insignia if they wanted to be up to date. Alison remembered Mrs. Robertson, Mrs Wagstaff, and Noeline Leech as caterers who went out of their way to ensure their service was to the satisfaction of all members. Alison recalled Nen Sim's overseer role of the Social and House side of Club activities as being exemplary.

SHIRLEY EATON joined in 1963. In 1978 Shirley was the Ladies' Club Captain and remembered that a highlight in the competitive history of the Club occurred that year when a team made up of Una Wickham, Val Hemingway, and Susan Harkin won the Bay of Plenty section of the Peter Stuyvesant National Team Championship played at Omanu. The team was made up of the three Club champions at Senior, Intermediate, and Junior levels. The sponsors then flew the team to Wellington, all expenses paid, to contest the National final at Heretaunga. The team did well to finish in fourth place out of a field of thirteen teams. Peter Stuyvesant was a popular brand of cigarette and tobacco companies were very active sponsors of a wide range of sporting events at that time. They sponsored a similar team event for male golfers.

NOELINE SHIEL joined the Club in 1972. In 1987 she was elected to the Club Committee and continued to serve that committee until 1994 when the Board of Management was instituted. In that same year Noeline was elected Vice-President, the first woman ever to occupy that position. Noeline was an outstanding Chairperson of the Social Committee putting an enormous amount of time, energy, and imagination into the role. With husband Des providing unstinting support and assistance Noeline did much to foster club spirit at a time when counter attractions in other spheres made it more difficult to encourage members to support Club activities. The work Noeline and Des did in facilitating Friday night Twilight golf was truly appreciated by those who enjoyed that activity over many happy years.

DOROTHY GARLAND came to Tauranga from Reporoa in 1973. She served the Ladies' Club as both Captain and Vice-Captain and also served as President of the BOPTV Association for four years during which time Jocelyn Glen assisted her in the role of Secretary.

ROSEMARY CLARK joined in 1981 and made an immediate impact on the competitive Club scene. At the end of that first year she annexed the Senior Championship. From 1991 to 1997 she won the title on another five occasions. Another four successive championships fell to Rosemary from 2001 - 2004. Her ten championship victories are second only to Una's sixteen. Rosemary was the Club Stroke Play

Champion in 1991,92, 93, 94, and again in 97. Inter-Provincial honours came Rosemary's way in 1981, 82, 83, 86, 87, and in 1991.

LYN GOODHEW began her golfing career in 1982 at the Springfield Club in Rotorua before moving back to Tauranga a year later. Within two years she was elected Ladies Vice-Captain, a position she held for two years before moving up to Captain for the following two years. In the established tradition that had ensured continuity of policy over many years Lyn went on to serve as Ladies President for the two years ending in November 2001. Ever willing to serve she substituted for President Robyn Anderson when the latter was absent for a part of the following year.

In 2003 Lyn became actively involved with Nine-hole golf by assisting new players to understand the Rules and etiquette of the game following on from the clinics provided to them by the Club professionals. In 2008 she began serving as assistant to Alison Holdem in the administration of the Nine-hole section of Women's Golf.

ALISON HOLDEM learned to play the game in 1983 at the Ngawaro Club on Hugh and Biddy McCarroll's sheep and cattle farm at Pyes Pa. Alison held the position of Club Captain at Ngawaro and won the senior championship there in 1991. The Ngawaro Club was established by Hugh and existed for a considerable number of years before the property was sold and the new owners were not prepared to continue the course. Many members moved to the new Renner Park course that had then become established in Oropi Road.

Alison joined Tauranga in 1985 while still retaining membership at Ngawaro and soon moved onto the committee, being elected Vice-captain in November 1993, Captain in 1995, and President in 1997. Almost immediately upon completing these six years of service to the Women's committee Alison was elected to represent the Central Zone on the BOP/TV Association. She completed a six-year term in that role in 2006.

Alison became involved in the Nine-hole program with Phyll Sandlant from 1998 to 2008 before taking over as Nine-hole Convenor when Phyll retired from that position. In addition to her work for Women's golf Alison served a term as a member of the Board of Management.

ANNA BRABYN grew up in a farming district east of Whanganui called Mangamahu where there was a country course of just twelve holes and featuring the usual small fenced greens. These were a bit trickier than those usually encountered on such courses as they were electrified and hence extra caution was required near them. The course was sometimes closed when necessary farming operations were being performed as the course was laid out on a private farm.

Both Anna's father and his sister represented New Zealand and won National titles so it was inevitable that Anna should follow them in playing the game. She was a member at Mangamahu from 1971 until 1994 winning the Senior championship on 18 occasions. While still a member there she joined Whanganui's Belmont Golf Club in 1977 in order to further her game. There she won the championship on a number of occasions and also furthered her administrative experience through Club Captaincy and a term of four years on the Board of Management. Belmont had moved into that form of management

structure somewhat earlier than had the majority of clubs.
Representative honours followed with Anna appearing in Russell Grace teams for Manawatu/Whanganui for ten years. In the following three years she represented the same District in the Masters team before moving to Tauranga in 1995. Anna has been a member of Tauranga Golf Club since 1996 winning the Senior Championship on three occasions with perhaps more yet to come.
Anna's talents were immediately recognised in her new District where she represented the Bay of Plenty at Master's level for a further twelve years. In her fifteen years of Master's golf Anna was on the winning side on seven occasions, a remarkable record. During this period Anna was asked to serve as a selector for New Zealand Women's Golf becoming convenor of selectors soon afterward. Management of National teams followed involving a number of overseas trips to tournaments such as the Queen Sirikit Tournament, the Espirito Santo World Cup, the Tasman Cup, and a number of Asian tournaments.
In 2005 Anna was elected President of the Tauranga Golf Club and continued in that role to become easily its longest serving President. As President she was automatically a member of the Board of Management where her wide experience and her wisdom proven invaluable.

HAZEL CASEY learned to play golf as an eleven year old on a farm course at Waiotahi near Opotiki. Her uncle Jack Carter taught her the game. He was the father of Tauranga members George and Doug Carter, and thus the grandfather and great-grandfather respectively of the men of Golf Fusion, Jack and Jay. The greens at Waiotahi were fenced and the cows kept the fairways to a reasonable height. Hazel was armed with just three clubs, a wood, an iron, and a putter. Her first "subscription' took the form of five large fruit tins. These were required to line the five holes the course boasted. Hazel had difficulty finding these as few families could afford large tins of fruit in the difficult years of the early thirties. A couple of years later the family moved the short distance to Nukuhau North where the sub. was five shillings, quite a lot for a schoolgirl to find at the time. After marrying during the war Hazel and Bill later moved to Tauranga where they joined the Mt. Maunganui club in 1963. In 1970 application was made to join Tauranga where membership was restricted and 'B' membership only available at the time. Forty one years later Hazel was still an active member. Early on Hazel became involved in assisting Adrienne Coad with helping the 36+ ladies to learn the rudiments of the game and gain their handicaps. Later Ali Smit took over from Adrienne. No professional lessons were offered the beginners so Ali and Hazel did the best they could to inculcate good swing habits into the group. When Ali left Hazel took over as the 36+ supervisor. She loved the role and took great pleasure in seeing "her girls" progress and become competent and valued members of the Club. To cover the cost of some

During the 2007 Carrus Tournament Emily Perry of Lochiel recorded the best round (65) ever by a woman player on our course. Playing off the blue tees Emily scored birdies at the first; second, fifth, seventh and seventeenth holes, together with an eagle three at the sixth. Her only blemish came at the fourteenth.

Professional tuition Hazel organised raffles and the resulting lessons with Rick proved very valuable to the women. Not satisfied with the great job she was doing with the beginning ladies Hazel became involved teaching school children to play. In this she was helped by Joyce Paris and Fay O'Neill.
When Nine Hole golf got underway Hazel was asked to look after the Saturday morning group. She loved doing this and continued as long as she was able to do so. She wanted to place on record her appreciation for the help and advice that Rick Barker gave to her in getting the new ladies started and on their way to earning their handicaps. For her dedicated service to 'her girls' over many years Hazel Casey was elected to Life Membership of the club in 2000.

NINE HOLE GOLF

The 1977 move by the Club to institute a nine hole handicap for women in order to cater for the needs of an older group of members who were finding it difficult to complete full 18 hole rounds on our demanding course proved to be the successful forerunner of a movement that was to have a major impact in later years. Perhaps inspired by the success of One-Day Cricket, administrators of New Zealand Golf began a campaign to institute Nine Hole Golf on a National scale. At the time NZGolf recognised that the wave of interest in the game that had flowed through New Zealand during the Sixties and Seventies had now ebbed and they were searching for ways to encourage more people to take up the game and join clubs. Nine hole golf was seen as a game that would appeal to younger working people, and to mothers with young families, as it would not commit them to as much time away from the responsibilities of modern life as did the Eighteen hole game.

Tauranga Golf Club officials were quick to see the potential of Nine-hole Golf and the Women's Committee immediately began to actively pursue the concept. Phyll Sandlant was an early volunteer to step forward and offer to lead the promotion. Her report on the evolution of this new form of the game follows.

Phyll Sandlant reports:
"In February 1998 Tauranga advertised for women who would like to 'have a go' at Nine Hole Golf. We intended to start a group at Tauranga, the first in the Bay of Plenty. Professional coaching was offered and it was hoped the idea would appeal to young mothers, working mothers, and perhaps grandmothers. It is, after all, a game for life.

We were overwhelmed with the response when 96 women registered on the first call. With the invaluable assistance of our Professional, Rick Barker, coaching groups were organised. When each clinic finished the beginners would play a few holes accompanied by members of a wonderful group of volunteers who would walk with them to encourage and assist them in following Rick's instructions. At the same time these volunteers would ensure the newcomers learnt aspects of etiquette and course management. Later we introduced the women to the mysteries of Match Play, Stroke Play, Stableford and Par competition.

The inaugural BOPTV Honda Nine Hole Tournament was held at Tauranga in 1999, thus recognising the lead that Tauranga had assumed in promoting this form of the game.

Women's Nine Hole Golf is now an integral and important sector of our Club. A full program of organised competition on Tuesday mornings caters to a full field of members in the category. The game is here to stay. The popularity of this form of the game is obvious and it appears there will be no diminution of interest from beginners and older members alike".

(While nine-hole membership is also available to men there has not been the same response from them. This may be that men are better able to find the time to devote most of a day to their game, or perhaps a more likely explanation is that there has been much less encouragement provided to them. The dedication to the cause of Women's Nine Hole Golf shown by Phyll Sandlant and her team, and by those such as Alison Holdem and Lynn Goodhew who followed, has clearly been the vital ingredient in the success of the program. In is also clear that the establishment of Nine Hole Golf represented a significant financial bonus to the Club as it provided additional income at a time when clubs throughout New Zealand were finding it difficult to balance their books.)

In recognition of her outstanding contribution to Women's Golf as Captain, President, and pioneer promoter of Nine Hole Golf, Phyll was elected a Life Member of the Club in 2006.

OLGA JOHNSON

NZ Stroke Play Champion 1962

UNA WICKHAM

NZ Amateur Matchplay Champion
1959 and 1969

NZ Strokeplay Champion 1968

NZ Representative 1955 - 1970

1975 Pennant Squad
Front Row: Ivy Duckmanton, Jo Dawkins, , Noeleen Shiel,
Pam McEwan, Anne Petrie, Heather Melville, Diane De manser
Back Row: Pauline Brooks, Juanita Ebbett, Karin Edmonds, Peg Copestake,
Betty Balfour, Patsy Wagstaff, Jan Rice, Renee Hill

Tauranga Ladies
Opening Day
1968
Fashions had
become more
relaxed by this time.

Right-Left:
S. Eaton, B. Burns,
M. Allen, B. Prentice,
Z. Wark, F. Sherson

"Tauranga Ladies Golf Club officials check the draw for yesterday's final day play in the club's annual open tournament. From left they are Miss A Mark, secretary, Mrs J Cullen, club captain, and Mrs J. Edwards president.

Junior girl golfers were rare indeed in the fifties.

From left:
Cathy Moloney
Jean Henderson

Above left to right - Joyce Waterworth,
Linda Carruthers, Violet Maltby,
Betty Anderson, Ruth Anderson (caddy)

Left: Mrs J. Carnachan
president of the womens club

Above - Winter Golf
Back Row: Sam McDowell Una Wickham
Front Row: Joyce Carnachan, Phyll Cambie,
Maisie Warnes, Ursula Hutton,
Mary Randall, Dos Green

Doris Scotland - Fay Davidson

Above left - right
Dorothy Jackson, Merle Carter,
Nancy Hare, Elva Evans

Miss Anne Mark

Weekly News October 1959.

The new champion, Miss Una Wickham (Tauranga), after she had been presented with the cup and flowers by Miss E.B.M. Nutt, president of the New Zealand Ladies Golf Union.

THIS MONTH'S WEDDINGS

(Pix by Photo News staff unless otherwise credited).

To start off our wedding feature this month we are delighted to publish these pictures taken at the reception after the marriage of Tauranga's most eligible youngsters, 77-year-old Rennie Gordon, and Roy Wallis who says, with a saucy wink, that he's over 80. Roy is a very well known figure in the racing world. He's a life member of the Bay of Plenty Racing Club and spent 30 years as a committee member. His wife was a keen tennis player and is a life member of Tauranga Golf Club. The reception was held at the home of the chief bridesmaid, Una Wickham who is pictured at right in the group, BELOW, with Bob Silson, the bride and groom, and Jack Scotland.

After a brief honeymoon in Rotorua, the couple returned home to Tauranga.

CORRECTION. Last month in our caption to the McFarlane-Sands wedding we apologise for crediting the bride with a Maxwells Road address; it should have read Macville Road, Mount Maunganui.

Life member Rennie won the Ladies' Championship as Miss Daines in three successive years from 1920.

CHAPTER NINE

VETERAN MEN'S GOLF

The Tauranga Veterans' Golfing Society was officially launched in 1952. John McKenzie was the inaugural President with Dick Phelan as his Secretary. To celebrate the Silver Jubilee of the Society in 1977 the then President, G A (Bill) Sanders, and Past President, K C (Ken) McIntyre, produced a history of those first 25 years. I can do no better than to print their history as they presented it to their members at that time and then move on to cover the succeeding 44 years during which the Society has flourished in a manner that would be a revelation and a source of great pleasure and pride to the founding members. In Bill Sander's words in his preface to their document: "We hope that all who read this History will be caught up in the spirit of our founders and those who followed them over the past 25 years".

Here then is the history of those first 25 years as compiled by Bill Sanders and Ken McIntyre.

THE BEGINNING

Like most beginnings, what was to become our Veterans' Society started in a very small and somewhat obscure way. Shortly after World War Two a small group of elderly golfers began meeting by arrangement on Tuesdays and Thursdays to make up friendly Four-balls so as to enjoy some easy going and pleasant golf. Under these idyllic golfing conditions the ranks of those originals began to grow and, with growth, the natural corollary was organisation. Attendance became more regular and someone soon decided that every second Tuesday a draw would be made at 12:45 pm. All who wished to play were asked to report prior to that time. Shades of the past were beginning to cast future shadows!
At this point it is appropriate to ask who were those old timers who started it all. Names start to emerge including Dick Phelan, Gavin Wallace, Tom Long, George Munroe, Harry Bradmore, John McKenzie, Ron Galloway, George Willcock, Len Belk, Jimmy Mowat, Arthur Towsey, and Johnny Walker. Doubtless there were others but if the written record fails how can the best of memories make up for that? Many of those mentioned had served the Golf Club well and four of them, Phelan, Towsey, Bradmore, and Willcock, were made Life Members. We salute those original few who started something that has given such joy and golfing pleasure to so many veterans of the future.

Like Topsy, what was to become our Veterans' Society, grew slowly but surely. In late 1952 the first records began to appear and a group organised themselves into the Veterans' Association with John

During his time as professional to the Club Greg Holst scored an ace, and five successive twos at the par three fifth hole. Some years earlier, when the hole was much shorter and played from a tee in the North West corner across a row of trees, Robert Mowat claimed thirteen twos in fifteen consecutive rounds.

Above: A happy group in the renovated lounge in the nineties. The No-Smoking signs were now prominent.
Marge Kirk, Dorothy Garland, Amy Smith , Nan Webster, Joyce Waterworth, Bernice Willoughy

Above: Prominent Veteran golfers during the seventies and eighties.
left - right: Bill Johns, Bill Saunders, John Farmer, Alan Davidson

Mckenzie as President and Dick Phelan as Secretary. With a great deal of courage the fledgling association decided, in 1953, to stage a five-day tournament from the 9th to the 13th of November that year. At the time the Association boasted just 23 members of which eight were on the committee. This was not unusual in many an organisation of the time. In any event the tournament must have proven to be a success as it was to be the forerunner of 24 annual tournaments to come.

During the first five years John McKenzie and Dick Phelan continued in office with their committee and Annual General Meetings would number no more than twelve to fifteen members. Play continued along the original lines until 1957 when Veterans' day was changed to Thursday. This was not a problem as there were no Weekday Starting Sheets though sometimes a ball shoot was used. Thursday also gradually evolved into Businessman's day and as their numbers increased so did the mutterings about 'the old buggers in front'. Diplomacy finally came into it somewhere and 'the old buggers' changed their day to Tuesday where it has remained to this day.

Another change took place in the mid fifties when the Veterans' Association renamed itself the Veterans' Society in order to distinguish it from the NZ Veteran Golfers' Association. Early members were never loath to dip into their own pockets to support the Society. For example we find that on the 4th of April 1957 when £3.15.0 was due to the NZVGA four members paid £1 each to meet the bill. It is not recorded what became of the extra five shillings.

As early as 1955 the Vets had organised a summer competition known as the 'Angus Plate'. The donor was Gavin Wallace who was often referred to as 'Angus'. His trophy was awarded to the player with the best three nett medal rounds out of five nominated by the committee. About this same time trophies were donated by Dick Phelan and George Willcock for annual competition and these, together with one later donated by Frank Macklow, are still contested on our annual calendar. Dick and George each embellished their trophies with prizes that the winners could keep. The winners were instructed to make their own purchase and send the account to the donor. In the following year a winner, assuming incorrectly that he could do the same, sent off a bill to Dick Phelan who promptly forwarded it to the committee. The committee did accept responsibility for the payment but made it clear the donors had not undertaken to supply the prize on an annual basis. The committee also wrote a letter of apology to Mr Phelan.

Membership of the Society remained fairly static until as late as 1965 when Ken McIntyre can recall reporting to Jack Babington outside the Pro Shop where Jack was busily engaged in scribbling names on the back of an old envelope. Those who had reported were given a numbered disc and these were later drawn from a hat. On that day four were sent off the 7th tee, four off the 3rd, and two fours off the first. That was it and the field, about the standard number for that time, were away.

THE ANNUAL TOURNAMENT

In organising their first five-day tournament in 1953 the Executive were assisted by Miss Anne Mark and Mrs Rennie Gordon (Later Wallis). The Society reported a credit balance of £13.8.9 that, the

secretary reported, would be adequate for preliminary expenses.

At that time few clubs held such tournaments and those tournaments that were held appear to have been given NZ status for the 'principal event'. Thus at our first tournament 56 starters competed in four Match Play flights for:

(1) The NZ Premiership - the first 16 gross qualifiers. Won by V Mortenson of Te Puke.
(2) The BOP Handicap - the first 16 nett qualifiers. Won by R H Phelan of Tauranga.
(3) The Tauranga Handicap - the second 16 nett qualifiers. Won by A Sharpe of Northcote.
(4) Gate Pa Handicap. Won by G Willcock of Tauranga.

The tournament was operated from the old cottage style clubhouse behind the 18th green. First prize for the 'NZ Premiership' was a magnificent dinner set donated by Johnny Walker. It caused some consternation because of its value, especially relative to other division prizes. Later such problems were sorted out and the amount spent in each division became more or less equal.

For the 1954 tournament Ron Galloway and John McKenzie donated Cups, Gavin Wallace a Silver Plate, and Johnny Walker a Rose Bowl. In doing so they set the pattern under which the tournament was run over future years. In 1958 Ted Bartlett donated the Honours Board that still hangs in the clubhouse. In the same year, and again in 1959, Galloway, McKenzie, Wallace, and Walker all gave money to be used to provide personal awards to the winners of their respective trophies while George Willcock provided the prize for the final day Stableford. During the same year D C (David) Collins donated the Plate that is still in use for the National Vets' Championship. David was a winner of that championship and had earlier captained the New Zealand Cricket team long before it became known as the 'Black Caps'. He and Ron Galloway had also given trophies to our local Veterans' Society for competition in a 'Yankee Tournament'.

In contemplating all of the foregoing one cannot help but be impressed by the way in which this handful of enthusiasts did all in their power to stimulate the interest of players of their day. As the number of entrants in the Five Day Tournament grew other trophies were presented. These include Dr John Mark's Trophy (1966), George Mole's Trophy (1973), Cliff Colson's Salver (1974), and Basil Coxhead's Salver (1977). The names of our trophies bring back memories of so many wonderful personalities who gave so much to the development of the Society and to the Golf Club itself.

In 1959 we held our first New Zealand Veteran Championships, the winner of the main event being W J (Billy) Castell, a member of our own Club. Almost every day for many years Billy would head for the Golf Course right after closing his shoe store on The Strand. He would then play two balls over as many holes as he could fit in, rarely having to move more than five or ten paces between the two balls. Maurice White was once scheduled to play Billy in the final of the Intermediate Club Championship. Maurice asked Jim Paterson the day before how Jimmy thought the match would go. "He will beat you by whatever margin he thinks appropriate" was the candid, if undiplomatic response. So it proved the following day.

In 1964 Tauranga were again hosts to the New Zealand Championship with Frank Macklow of our Club the winner on that occasion. The last time the Championship had been held here was in 1959 with E S Toogood of Poverty Bay the winner and Frank Macklow runner-up.

A perusal of some entries in the old Minute Books can be full of interest. Take for instance the financial summary following the initial tournament in 1953. It reads:
Entry fees were £85.10.0 and a donation made total receipts £90. Trophies cost £60.0.4, Printing £7.15.6, Petty Cash and Secretary's Expenses £7.1.9, Lime Juice £3.16.6, Tauranga Golf Club Green Fees £5, which left a balance of £6.5.11 profit.
Also of interest is a list of the Secretary's purchases of victuals for the 1961 tournament covering the Cocktail Party and lunches. Here they are.
Cocktail Party: 6 Whisky, 3 Gin, 1 Brandy, 1 Sherry, 12 Beer (Dozens presumably), 15 dozen sandwiches, 15 dozen savouries, 6 bags potato chips and 2 lbs. of salted peanuts.
Lunches: 6 quarts milk, 4 cut loaves, 4 dozen cakes, 2 dozen scones, 3 dozen Cottage Pies, 6 lbs. Blade Steak, 6 Kidneys, 2lbs. tea, 8lbs. sugar, 2lbs. ham, 3lbs. tomatoes, 12 lbs. potatoes, 1 bottle tomato sauce, 1lb. cheese, 1 pkt. Gravyquick, 2lbs. onions, 2 large pkts. of frozen peas.

All this was just part of the Secretary's job. No wonder it was a difficult post to fill. Those of our members who have served on the Veterans' Committee know that the job is no sinecure, particularly when it comes to tournament time. The planning, the need for detail, the frustrations, and all the general organisation required in order to present a successful tournament call for a great deal of expertise. How fortunate then that we have had the splendid assistance of Anne Mark and Rennie Gordon (Wallis) over these past 25 years. Together these two performed all the clerical work involved in the tournament until the early Sixties when Miss Mark took over on her own. In the minutes of the meeting following that first 1951 tournament it is recorded that "our thanks are due to Miss Anne Mark and Mrs Rennie Gordon for the smooth and capable running of the tournament". Every successive committee has echoed the same sentiment over the past 24 years. It is noteworthy that both ladies were made Life Members of the Tauranga Golf Club.

After work one afternoon I was getting my clubs from the Trundler shed ready to do some practise. It was during Veterans' week. An elderly gentleman came in dragging his clubs slowly behind him. "My goodness" I said. "You do look as though you have had a hard day out there".
"Hard day" he said. "You have no idea. These old buggers are really tough. The one I played today was eight under his handicap. I had to go to the 22nd hole to beat him".
He did not seem to register where this explanation might have positioned him in relation to his own performance.

At the Society's 25th Jubilee Tournament Prize Giving the 1977 President, Bill Sanders, presented Miss Mark with a Silver Coffee Pot in recognition of her 25 years of wonderful service as Tournament Secretary. All living Past Presidents subscribed to this handsome gift. This thoughtful and generous act is worthy of record and in Chronological order those who contributed were Past Presidents Ken McIntyre, Kevin Thomson, Eric Blomfield, Ossie Simmonds, Cliff Colson, Len Woods, and Ken Golden. During the presentation Club President Alex Gallagher also paid tribute to Miss Mark and she replied to all those present in her usual charming and eloquent manner.

Regular Old Timers attending our tournaments have been Barney Barnett (Waikato), Eddie Edwards (Christchurch), Jim Forbes (Mirimar), and Alf Sharpe (Auckland). The latter played his last Tauranga tournament at the age of ninety.

Over the years many a character has played in our Tournament and some very amusing incidents have arisen but time and space prevent us delving too deeply into these. However one Old Timer who wished to remain anonymous sent in the following anecdote that we felt may prove useful to present day veterans. We Quote: "From the third tee this player drove his ball straight into the scrub which then extended across much of the hill and was very difficult to extricate a ball from. He then played a provisional ball that was a screamer right between the two pines at the bottom, one of which is now defunct. This left a short Iron to the green. A search for the original was made and his ball located. The player did some quick thinking. He would require one stroke, or even two, to get in the clear, then another towards the gap with no guarantee of success. His silent conclusion: I can't better my provisional and might do worse. His response followed in seconds. "That is not my ball. Can't hold up the field. Let's press on." So saying he played to the green, sunk the putt and halved the hole in fives. His opponent, of course, was up one good Dunlop 65. Little wonder so many of us found it difficult to make the grade in Veteran's Tournaments!

THE OLD TIMERS

In our earlier text we made mention of those men who founded our Society and, as there were so many interesting characters amongst them, no history would be complete without some short biographical details of them, and of those who followed in their footsteps.

JOHN McKENZIE

Our first President, John was a recent arrival from Scotland. He was liable to suddenly appear quite unexpectedly in full Highland Dress. He was President from 1953-56, again in 1960 and 1964, and yet again in 1967, seven times in all. A golfing stylist John hit a good, straight ball with a minimum of effort. As a raconteur of no mean talent he loved the telling of a tale. His mellifluous Scottish accent had undoubted appeal and his training as a Minister in the Church of Scotland ensured his delivery commanded attention. John was one of the first Vets Ken McIntyre played with upon first joining the Society and he recalls John addressing him all day as "young Man". Ken was then 58 years old!

In later years John lived alone and when asked how he fared in the kitchen his response was: "My boy, I have many friends upon whom I call not long before dinner, but early enough to allow them time to put another potato in the pot. Never the less, when forced into providing for myself, I always manage

a five-course dinner. I have two Whiskeys, a boiled egg, then two more whiskeys". John was one of the original Broadlands Finance Directors and many a veteran made good investments in Broadlands on the strength of his advice. Broadlands for many years donated a handsome trophy for our annual tournament while the McKenzie Cup is one of John's personal donations.

DICK PHELAN

Dick was made a Life Member of the Golf Club and served as Secretary to the Tauranga Veteran Golfers' Association, as it was then known, from its inception in 1952 until 1956 after which he continued to serve on committee. Dick donated the Phelan trophy for which we still compete. A fine golfer he retained a single figure handicap for many years. It is recalled that one Saturday after holing his final putt on the 18th green he quietly remarked: "Well, I have played to my age". He was 76 at the time. An indication of Dick's skill and longevity as a player is evident from the fact that he won the Senior Championship in 1930 and, 47 years later, was runner-up in the Junior Championship to then 16-year old Robbie Meyer. That 1976 Finals Day was one of the very rare occasions when the weather has been unkind to the finalists with wet, cold, and windy conditions prevailing throughout most of the day. In spite of that, or of the disparity of sixty years in the ages of the two, it was not until the 35th hole that Dick finally succumbed to his young rival.

Dick objected strongly to the term 'Die-hards' that was used to identify the over 70 division in most Veterans' Tournaments and it is for that reason that we still use the term 'Veteran of Veterans' in our Tournament.

GEORGE WILLCOCK

George was a kindly and enthusiastic gentleman in the true sense of the word. A past President of the Golf Club, George was made a life member for his services over many years, especially his work in the role of Honorary Secretary during the War years. The Willcock name is commemorated in the playing of the popular Intermediate Handicap Match Play event for the Willcock Cup as part of the Saturday Club Programme.

One day Grant Silvester said to me:
"Keep your eyes open for green tees on the fairways".
I asked what on earth he meant.
"Well it is Veteran's week and there is a placing rule" I was told.
I indeed found green tees on some fairways. It seems some of the old chaps had perfected the technique of palming a green tee as they lifted the ball prior to placing it. At the end of the process the ball would be perched on a tee, not resting on the grass. Having played the stroke they would not want to give the game away by bending to retrieve the tee. Holes such as the 11th, the 15th, and the 16th became reachable with a second stroke when played with 'brassie' from a teed lie. Little wonder it was hard to beat these wily characters.

ARTHUR TOWSEY

Arthur was another whose services the Club recognised by conferring Life Membership upon him. He is best remembered for his efficient management of the Bar over a long period dating back to the days of the old Clubhouse behind the 18th green. A martinet in his domain, woe betides anyone who overstepped the bounds of propriety. For many years a six o'clock closure was the rule despite the fact that the entire operation was outside the law applying at that time. Many a member narrowly avoided losing a finger or two as the shutter came down precisely on the hour. Fortunately the stairs then ran down at the back of the Bar and, if you were in the know, and Arthur was in a good mood, you might just grab a quick one on your way out from the back door of the lounge where it opened onto the stairs. Whilst on the subject of the 'Nineteenth Hole' it seems that the Veterans' must have been a 'dry' society for, in 1960, a subcommittee waited upon the Club Committee to ask if Bar facilities could be made available on Tuesdays and Thursdays. This was granted much to the relief of many a member.

Dr JOHN MARK

Johnny was perhaps the most dedicated of all who served the Veterans' Society. He was President for five years after previously serving on committee. For two years John served as both President and Secretary and, as he himself put it, general factotum. This was occasioned by the fact that no one at the Annual General Meeting was willing to accept the role of Secretary so it was left to the committee to fill the post. This they never did so Johnny simply carried on. Possibly the task of running the Tournament was beginning to look formidable enough to discourage potential Secretaries and, when Harry Du Faur resigned in 1965 after three terms in the job no one was anxious to succeed him. Harry had established a very efficient Secretarial Management System which few felt they could emulate.

John Mark and his sister Anne developed the Tournament draw system we use so that a player does not play with his opponent until he meets him in a match. When John died in 1967 the Mount and Tauranga Veterans began playing for the Mark Memorial Shield to recognise his work for Veterans' golf. In 1965 George Mole and Ron Horman presented this shield for competition between the two clubs. In 1966 Dr Mark presented a trophy for our annual Tournament and it was fitting that this was presented to the winner by his sister Anne following the Jubilee year Tournament in 1977.

HARRY BRADMORE

Harry was another to be honoured with Life Membership of the Golf Club. A foundation member of the Veterans he continued a program of planting and care of the trees on the course that had been initiated by Mr Mirrielees in the first years of course development. In this Harry was assisted by his son Maurice, another keen golfer with a real interest in improving the aesthetics of the course. Another son, Alan, was a victim of World War Two. Alan is remembered through the Alan Bradmore Memorial Trophy that is contested in the Saturday Programme.

GAVIN WALLACE

Gavin was our second President and also served as Treasurer for a number of years. He stimulated a lot of interest in Veteran activities and retained a lively interest in the society beyond his playing days. He donated a number of trophies during his membership.

JIMMY MOWAT

Born in Scotland Jimmy was the first Professional appointed to the Club in 1936. He was a foundation member of the Veterans and a regular Tuesday/Thursday participant from the earliest beginnings. Long after his reinstatement to the amateur ranks members, both male and female, would seek his advice on the finer points of the game. His interest in course development served the developing club well over a long period of time. When Jim and his wife Margaret sold their property, which is now the Tauranga Girls' College, the turf on their tennis court was rolled up and delivered to the eleventh green where Grant Silvester laid it. It provided an excellent surface from the beginning and continues to do so today. Margaret was also an enthusiastic golfer and active participant in club affairs. She made a great job of catering for our first Veterans' Tournament in 1953.

FRANK MACKLOW

Frank has only recently had to give up golf. A perfectionist the slightest deviation from a straight shot down the fairway would see him on the practise fairway ironing out the problem prior to heading home. On the committee in his first year of joining the Vets he later served five years as Treasurer. Frank twice won the New Zealand Veterans' Championship, first at Tauranga in 1964 and again in 1965 at the Hutt Club where he defeated Harold Black. In 1969 Frank was runner-up in the Championship.

SYD RANDELL

Syd, along with others, claimed responsibility for the lone pine tree between the 13th and 17th fairways. Originally there were three but two were removed after careful analysis revealed the one reprieved caught the most balls. Syd served the Tauranga Golf Club as President from 1954-56.

OTHER PERSONALITIES

There was the dignified ex school master Noel Gibson whose greatest profanity was "oh drat it". A noisy opponent, caddie, or fellow competitor would immediately be quelled by a single look cast down from his full height of six feet. He was one of four to be given a presentation upon achieving the age of eighty, a tradition that still survives in the society. The other three were Harry Bradmore, Percy Maude, and Johnny Walker. Percy will be remembered for his home made trundler, and for his tees made from sections of milking inflations cut to different lengths and strung together with an old boot lace. Following Percy could be something of an ordeal as he was prone to shed tees, pieces of trundler, and articles of clothing as he went along his way.

Harry Smith contributed much towards the new Clubhouse built in 1954. When it was undergoing its first alteration Harry claimed: "they can knock down those walls but they will need a bulldozer for that corner. I laid those bricks myself". They did in fact survive that first alteration but not the next.

Where do we stop? There are so many that could be mentioned. Men like Les Woods, Frank McFadyen, and Bob Innis, all served on our committee and are still with us in 1977. Later we will attempt to cover events and people from 1970 onwards. In the meantime all veterans salute and thank the 'Old Stalwarts' who pushed the boat out on its first days of a successful and rewarding voyage.

THE LADIES

Our association with the Ladies' Club goes back as many years as we have existed, as far back in fact as to our earliest Tournaments when Margaret Mowat volunteered to handle the catering before any sort of regular canteen existed. The Ladies always helped at the tournaments with afternoon teas and Mrs Wardrop will be remembered for her kindness in providing baskets of goodies for our midweek games, and also for the wonderful floral arrangements she set up in the clubhouse.

The first organised matches between the ladies and ourselves were played for a shield that still resides somewhere in the clubhouse. The ladies could not find a way to register a win for the shield and the contest gradually faded away. In those early times the two groups alternated the supply of afternoon tea and the results were impressive. As a fuller catering service became available at the Club it became inappropriate to continue the self catering and those marvellous afternoon teas became a distant memory.

More recently we have established 'Melbourne Cup Day' when the Vets entertain the Ladies at a golf match held on Cup Day, the first Tuesday in November. The Ladies compete for a Cup presented by Mr and Mrs Tom Dick. The Ladies have christened it the 'Fillies Cup', while the men play for a tankard engraved 'Co-operation 1972'. This was given to the Vets by the Ladies in appreciation of the assistance given to them during the staging of the Russell Grace Inter Provincial Tournament held in Tauranga that year. The day is an important one in our calendar and involves sweepstakes on the Cup and a social afternoon culminating in a live showing of the big race.

As a measure of appreciation for the co-operation shown the Vets by the Ladies Club we presented them with a tray for competition amongst themselves. Each year we send a cheque to provide a personal prize for the winner. This spirit of co-operation engendered so many years ago is still as vibrant today. As an example we relinquish a Tuesday so the Ladies can stage their Championships and, a few weeks later, they give up one of their days so that we can stage the Mark Trophy fixture with the Mount Maunganui Vets. May such happy associations long continue.

> Editor's Note: This arrangement no longer applies as circumstances changed in 2013 so as to make it untenable.

THE PRESENT

From 1970, when Ken McIntyre was President, the Society began to grow dramatically and this growth was indisputably tied to the general influx of retirees to the Tauranga area and to the reputation and popularity of Veterans' golf at the Tauranga Golf Club. In three years our numbers increased from 50 to 100 and the old starting board disc system, designed for just 48 people, became taxed to its limit. Eventually our members became frustrated with starting delays and waiting times of up to two hours before they were able to tee off. When membership reached 120 there was no choice but to institute an advance weekly starting sheet. Many members disliked this system feeling it might destroy the friendly social atmosphere that arose when everyone arrived and left together. Fortunately this did not prove to be the case.

Up until this Jubilee year Veterans have been accepted from age 55 but in an endeavour to contain our numbers to a manageable level that limit has now been raised to 60 years. Our roll now stands at 130 plus. All the trophies presented years ago by some of the founding members are still regular features of our annual programme. A notable addition to the trophy list came in 1976 when Colin Cathie gave the Society the Cornelius Cup, named for his very successful racehorse of that name. This fine cup is contested as a Match Play event with the final being held on Club Finals Day. This has become recognised as the major award contested by our members over the season. In addition to presenting the cup Colin arranged for a debenture, the annual interest from which would provide funds for a personal prize to be awarded the winner. This was a most pleasing and generous gesture by Colin.

A notable achievement of recent times was the feat of one of our members, Bill Johns, to hold a single figure handicap for 50 consecutive years. Bill, or "Dummy " Johns as he has been affectionately known for many years was honoured by the Tauranga Golf Club with the presentation of a silver salver to commemorate this remarkable feat, most of which was achieved prior to his moving to Tauranga.

Cliff Colson, President of our Society in 1974, has done an enormous amount of work for Veterans' golf over recent years. He has been a committeeman, Treasurer, Secretary, and President. His work has been recognised by his current appointment as Vice President of the NZ Veterans' Association. It is hoped that this will lead to the Presidency in 1978.

The story of our Society has so far been one of men who have been prepared to give generously of their time, their talents, and their material resources. As the Society has grown it has required a high level of organisational expertise and we have never lacked for volunteers with the necessary skills. It has not been possible to cover all aspects of our history in this publication, nor to pay personal tribute to all those many people whose ideas and practical assistance have contributed so much to the success of the Society over the past 25 years. What has been done has been achieved in a wonderful spirit of friendship and camaraderie that would be hard to match elsewhere. The solid base that has been established over the first 25 years augurs well for the years ahead. We hope that in telling this story we have rekindled some of the wonderful spirit of the past so that the ideals of our founders may burn brightly into the future.

So ended the History of the first 25 years of organised Veteran Golf in Tauranga as compiled by Bill Sanders and Ken McIntyre.

THE SUCCEEDING YEARS

When Bernie Baker became President of the Society in 1993 he inherited a number of papers relating to past happenings within the Society. These included a copy of the above history of the first 25 years and, upon reading it, Bernie was prompted to initiate the production of an album to record the Officers and activities of the Society on a year-by-year basis. This album commenced in 1974 as this was the earliest year for which full committee details could be discovered. In his preface to the album Bernie recorded that, in 1985, the committee of the Society approached the Golf Club committee with the proposition: "That the Vets carry out projects, mutually agreed, that will benefit the course and

members. In return the Club management will not charge the Vets course fees for their annual five day tournament". This proposal was agreed to and, although the five day tournament is now consigned to history, the Vets have continued to support the Club through a wide variety of projects and services right through to the present day.

Peter Steward warrants special appreciation for his immaculate calligraphy and fine photography that grace the pages of the album from its birth in 1993 until 2004 when Peter's failing eyesight made it impossible for him to continue the work. His back-dating of the album over the 20 years prior to 1993 must have required many hours of meticulous work before the album was ready for presentation to the Society. It is to be hoped that the album will be updated from 2004, and continue to be maintained as an invaluable record of the activities and administration of the society.

While many individual veteran members had provided voluntary services to the Club over earlier years it was not until 1985 that official projects began as a routine part of the Society's year. In that year the following projects were successfully undertaken under the leadership of President Phill Johnston:

- Provision of a new Golf Club flag
- Overhaul and maintenance of the ball washers on the tees
- Improvements to the first tee surrounds
- Repainting of the Men's locker room
- Stripping and repainting the walls in the Dining Room.

Phill Johnston, a fine sportsman who played both golf and tennis until very late in life, probably holds the record for the longest continual membership of Tauranga Golf Club. This was commemorated through the planting of a Pohutukawa tree to the left of the 14th green. An accompanying plaque records that Phill was a member from 1936 until 1996.

In 1986 President Wally Calver saw the following projects to fruition:

- Construction of a brick entranceway adjacent to the 10th green. This was to commemorate the 75th anniversary of the Club. The bricklaying expertise of Andy Graham was especially valuable in this undertaking, the bricks being chosen to blend with those featured on the Club House at the time. Unfortunately those bricks are no longer discernible, having been plastered over presumably to match the Club House.
- Replacing stolen and vandalised bunker rakes.
- Painting 11th tee shelter.
- Painting trundler shed interior.
- Assisting with sweeping and removing cores from greens. This assistance continued twice yearly until 2008 when machinery was hired to do the job. Walter Tombleson and Peter Baveystock come to mind as two who participated in this work at virtually every coring throughout the period.

In 1987 under President Noel Payne the Society:

- Provided the Club with a Walkie Talkie set to enable communication with the starter on tee 11.
- Rebuilt the surrounds of the first tee.

- Assisted with the design and construction of the new 9th green.
- Purchased and installed eight additional ball washers.

In 1988 Bert Krause was in the Chair and the Society:

- Purchased and installed an additional six ball washers.
- Provided a new blade attachment for the Toro mower.
- Regraded the route to the fifth green and constructed a trundler park at the same hole.
- Repaired and sealed the area by the Pro Shop.
- Built bark gardens with mowing strips by tenth tee and beside trundler shed.
- Assisted the staff to spray paspalum in eradication program.

In 1989 under President George Mason the Society:

- Built a new bark garden adjacent to the eleventh green.
- Built an observation tower forward of seventh tee.
- Upgraded the first tee. This included installing a block wall.
- Assisted staff in cleaning around bunkers prior to Finals Day.
- Erected new tee marker boards.
- Felled and removed dead trees.
- Cleared the old garden in front of the Club House.
- Repaired and rebuilt block work on the sixth tee.

In 1990 under President Bill Vinnecombe the Society:

- Erected a wind screen along the fifteenth hole boundary.
- Planted new trees, particularly on fifteenth hole and behind fourteenth green.
- Removed trees felled by storm.
- Erected new tee marker boards.
- Cleaned and painted trundler shed exterior and Club House veranda.
- Assisted staff in spraying for eradication of Cape Daisy.
- Improved drainage around 5th and 7th greens and 8th fairway by installing soak holes.
- Constructed a pathway to the side and rear of the 7th green.

In 1991 under President Merv Kelly the Society:

- Completed ground works around 7th green and 8th tee area.
- Rebuilt and repainted the fence behind 8th green and 9th tee.
- Supplied and erected pipe rail to ladies 3rd tee.
- Maintained gardens, an ongoing project.
- Erected new club sign at Cameron Road entrance.
- Maintained ball washers, another ongoing project.
- Purchased new blue tee markers.
- Supplied material and constructed steps to the 2nd tee.
- Installed pipe and chain fences on path to Club House.

In 1992 under President John Newman the Society:

- Built a set of steps and laid a path from the 3rd green to 4th tee.
- Laid a path from the 11th tee to fairway.
- Laid a path from the17th green to 18th tee.
- Continued planting and development of “Vets’ Dell” below 3rd tee - now somewhat neglected.
- Installed a plaque at the 11th tee entrance gate.

In 1993 under President Bernie Baker the Society:

- Installed a garden and steps at the 5th tee.
- Supplied and installed a second flagpole on Club House.
- Assisted in remodelling several bunkers in association with the Greens Staff.
- Replaced stolen or vandalised tee markers.
- Provided and installed fairway distance markers.

In 1994 under President Paul Munn the Society:

- Painted all the seats around the course.
- Refurbished the starting sheet display cabinet.
- Installed gauge to indicate water level in reservoir.

In 1995 under President Bernie Child the Society:

- Repainted the car park lines.
- Financed and constructed new practice nets beside the reservoir.
- Assisted in the installation of new course irrigation system’
- Trimmed the skirts of most trees that come into play.
- Cut up firewood for sale.
- Installed the David Coates memorial seat at the 10th tee.

The reference to firewood and skirt trimming above suggests that the Noel Copestake led group of Wednesday volunteers was initiated around that time. There has been a hard core of regulars on that team since, the core changing only as the years take their toll and new volunteers step forward. It would be interesting to know just how much the Club has gained from the activities of this group, both in terms of actual cash provided to specific projects, and in the amount saved in the costs of removing dead trees, trimming trees, tidying up fallen branches, and supplying firewood to the Club House. It would be difficult indeed to estimate the value gained from ‘Dads’ Army’, as the group is known, since its inception. While the group as an entity deserve the accolades of us all some inevitably stand out. Without Noel’s enthusiastic example it is very doubtful the group would have survived more than a year or two, or perhaps even got started. Deserving of special mention would be Jim Swainson. Jim’s expertise with a chain saw has made a huge impact on the overall health, appearance, and ‘playability’ of the trees on the course.

President in that year of 1995, Bernie Child, continues to lead projects as late as 2008 even though he retired as project manager in 1999. Bernie’s ability to design, develop, and maintain equipment has been a revelation to all who have worked with him. The Club recognised his immense contribution over many years by conferring Life Membership upon him.

In 1996 Ron Holden was President of the Society.

- One major project highlighted Ron's year. This was the construction of a Caddie Car shed abutted to the Greenkeeper's building beside the practise range. The Society provided the materials, then designed and constructed the building.
- On-going activities included the maintenance projects mentioned earlier.

In 1997 under President Ted Otway the Society:

- Painted the Course Managers Staff facility.
- Painted the distance marker blocks.
- Repaired paving at the first tee.
- Repaired the path to 5th tee with bitumen seal.
- Laid rubber matting on the above path.
- Fixed new Colour Steel cladding, gifted by Longrun Industries, to the inside of the Clubhouse fascia.
- Realigned and relaid a path from 17th green to 18th tee, including new timber railing.
- Poured concrete storm water channel beside 18th tee.
- Poured concrete to form a storm water catchment off the car park. Redrilled the existing soak hole to a depth of 8m.
- Installed irrigation to serve the shrubbery on the path to the 18th tee and to the bank of the 2nd tee.
- Purchased a new fairway irrigator and associated hoses.
- Fabricated a 1.8m wide steel roller for use behind the greens mower.

In 1998 under President Matt Sproule the Society:

- Laid a storm water channel along the pathway over the causeway.
- Resurfaced paths on the 4th, 5th, and 11th holes.
- Arranged and financed drilling and piping of soak holes at a number of locations.
- Financed and constructed the erection of pipe railing beside the roadway past the10th green.

In 1999 under President Joe Loughlin the Society:

- Completed projects commenced in 1998 including the design and installation of a sliding roof over the sand-storage bin in the implement shed area.
- Maintained the car park lines and garden areas.

In 2000 under President George Riley the Society:

- Donated $6000 to be used to finance an upgrade of the path at the 1st tee and that from the 3rd green to the 4th tee.
- Purchased and installed a compressor and air pressure cylinder in the implement shed.
- Installed piping to wash down area for golf carts.
- Maintained paint work on pipe fencing and car park lines.
- Contributed funds to Ladies' shrub planting project.

In 2001 under President Ross Ellison the Society:

- Donated $4500 towards purchase of fairway irrigator and the support of Junior Golf.
- Installed drinking fountain by 1st tee. The “Fountain of Youth” built by a Child. This project was an independent Bernie Child enterprise.

In 2002 under President Peter Walker the Society:

- Donated $12 000 to the Club. All but $400 of this came from the firewood team.

In 2003 under President John Turnbull the Society:

- Carried out regular maintenance work. Mike Champion’s work in maintaining ball washers was especially noteworthy.
- Assisted the Club program to replace trees around the course by donating $200 from Society funds. A number of individual veterans contributed independently to that programme.

In 2004 under President Mike Sandlant the Society:

- Provided funds for the construction of an appropriate lectern for use in the clubhouse. Joe Carr voluntarily did the actual woodworking to bring this to fruition.
- Improved the surrounds of the toilet block beside the 13th tee.

In 2005 under President Ian Anderson the Society:

- allocated $2000 for the purpose of sealing the path from the 11th tee to the fairway.
- painted the rails indicating out of bounds on the 10th hole.

In 2006 under President Bob Diprose the Society:

- assisted in tidying the course prior to the Carrus tournament.
- assisted in the coring program by sweeping and removing corings - a regular project.

In 2007 under President Hugh Boughtwood the Society:

- laid a new sealed path from the 5th green to the 6th tee incorporating reconstruction and resealing of all sealed areas around the 6th tee/8th tee complex. This was jointly financed with the firewood team, and supervised by Denis Smith. Peter Bourne was involved in the planning while a number of members provided their labour.
- relaid the path alongside the 15th tee by removing invading tree roots and surfacing with crusher dust.

In 2008 under President Jim Miller the Society:

- allocated $2000 for the renovation of the practice nets. This work was carried out in 2009.

In 2009 under President Phill Simpson the Society:

- allocated $3000 for an upgrade planned for the 15th tee and surrounds.

In 2010 under President Ross Fletcher the Society:

- provided finance for the connection of the water supply from Cameron Road to the fountain at the 13th green.
- Contributed $4000 towards the establishment of the turf nursery developed beyond the third fairway.
- Veteran volunteers helped in laying Windsor Green stolons on the 18th fairway and the turf nursery – a full day project.

Ray Pittams

Ray heads the list of those members who have achieved the feat of playing to or below their age on a number of occasions. While other multiple winners include Pat Kendall, Clive Sheerin and Cliff Breeds, none approach Ray's record. During the Spring of 2013 Ray played his fiftieth such round and followed that up within days with his fifty first.

Ray retired from farming in the Waipa Valley of the King Country and moved to Tauranga in 1977. Having been a regular visitor to our Labour weekend tournament Ray had a soft spot for the Club and sought membership only to be told membership was closed to all but those boasting a National Handicap. Consequently Ray joined Omanu and was admitted to Tauranga as a restricted B category member in 1980 before finally gaining full membership. Ray first played to his age at the age of 71 in 1996 and has achieved the feat each year since with the exception of 1999 when he was 74. Ray became a valuable member of our Intermediate Pennant team and featured in the winning team of 1998. To cap his membership at Tauranga he won the Intermediate Championship in 2012.

Cliff Horsburgh was playing the eleventh hole one day in the company of a gentleman who was claimed to have been the Captain of a Club in the Manawatu. Cliff's tee stroke was seen to ricochet from the roof of the stable out onto the fairway. As Cliff set off down the path towards it the visitor enquired if perhaps he should play another. Upon Cliff asking why he would do that he was informed his ball was out of bounds. "No. It is in the fairway" protested Cliff. "Yes but it has struck something out of bounds so that is what counts" was the response. After Cliff gained support from the other two in the group the visitor grudgingly conceded the point with the statement: "Well, that is not how it would be handled at our Club".

CHAPTER TEN

THE WOMEN VETERANS' GOLF CLUB

This organization was launched in 1987 under the enthusiastic instigation of Jean Mack and Phyl Carter, the latter being recognised as the first president. Phyl and her husband Reg were wonderful Club members who both participated fully in Club activities over many years. When the undulations of our course became rather too much for Reg in his latter years they became members of the Omokoroa Club where they again participated very fully. Their home was adjacent to the entrance of that Club and Phyl took on the role of caterer to the Club for a number of years during which she provided a magnificent service.

Tauranga women members who were actively involved with Phyl in establishing the fledgling Lady Veterans' Group included Hazel Casey, Marg Calver, Mona Lilly, Kath Christie, Joan Standford, Shirley Morris, and Shirley Crawford. This group were ultimately elected to form the committee when the inaugural AGM was held in November 1988, Marg Calver serving as the first elected President.

At that first meeting it was decided to request that members should make a $2 donation each year to maintain membership. A further donation of $1 was requested so that a presentation could be made to the caterer Mary Goodjohn who gave up her day-off in order to cater to the group on the one Monday each month when the veteran women held their competition day. Mary was most gratified to receive a kitchen slicer from the proceeds of this collection. Hardly a personal gift but very practical as the kitchen was, at that time, ill equipped for the functions it served.

In 1989 a tradition was established whereby members would travel by bus to Okoroire during the October coring week in order to enjoy a round of golf followed by a group luncheon at the hotel there. Twenty-nine ladies made that first trip and enjoyed a wonderful day out. The costs were interesting. The bus cost $8 per head, green fees $5, while for lunch there was a choice of an $11 buffet or a three course meal for $15.

From those early years it was established that the AGM would be held in November and take the form of a Christmas lunch preceding the meeting. Fifty-two members attended the AGM of 1989.

In July 1990 ten veteran ladies from each of the Omokoroa and Mt. Maunganui clubs were invited to participate in the monthly competition so beginning a tradition of Inter-club visitations. In November 1990 another step was made in the direction of establishing relationships with other clubs when an open Christmas Hamper Tournament was staged in association with the BOP/TV Lady Vets Association. These tournaments were organised into five zones within the District with Te Puke, Omanu, Mt. Maunganui, Otumoetai, and Tauranga members being eligible to compete in the Tauranga event. The Veterans negotiated a reduction of $100 on the $500 fee normally charged for the use of the course. One hundred and five players participated in that first event.

At this stage in the history of the Lady Vets no subscription had been required beyond the initial $2 donation upon joining. Despite this the club had been able to build a surplus as the result of raffles, the Okoroire trip, the Christmas function, and other activities. Consequently the Treasurer was able to report to the AGM of 1990 that the Bank balance was near to $400. The ladies responded to this

healthy situation by donating $200 towards the cost of upgrading the Ladies changing room. It was further resolved to continue to hold the Christmas function on a Monday in November not designated for competition although some members were in favour of holding the meeting following a morning round of golf.

Mixed events in cooperation with the men vets proved very successful and popular with all those who participated during those earlier years. Following such an event in October 1992 the men donated three dozen balls to the lady vets to be used as prizes on their competition days. By 1993 membership had risen to 92. An informal ten holes of golf were organised to precede the Christmas luncheon and AGM that year. The Treasurer was able to report a profit of almost $600 on the year's activities leading up to the 1994 AGM. Clearly the organization was in very good heart. Much of the profit generated was the result of the generosity of members both in donating prizes for the raffle table, and in purchasing tickets in those raffles. I wonder how often someone won the prize they had donated.

From the beginning the Lady Vets affiliated themselves to the BOP/TV Lady Veterans' Society with members paying a joining fee of $5. The District Society organises four official tournaments each year at two-monthly intervals in addition to a 'Home Links' teams competition and the Christmas Hamper events held in the five zones. All these events are open to women aged 55 and over. The tournament events are run in age groups, the highest of these being for golfers of 75 years or more. Shirley Crawford represented Tauranga on the District committee for a number of years before handing over to Kath Christie, another stalwart supporter and promoter of Veteran Ladies' Golf.

In 1994 members voted in favour of travelling to Walton rather than Okoroire for the annual bus trip. The subsequent trip proved very successful. The inclusive cost of $20 for bus transport, green fees, and lunch at the Walton Club being considered very good value indeed. This experience opened up the idea of varying the destination chosen for these trips from year to year and in 1995 the trip was made to Paeroa. Though some found that course a little too undulating for their liking the trip was voted a success by the majority who travelled there. The reaction to course steepness was intensified by a later trip to Waihi following which it was cautioned that greater care needed to be exercised in selecting future venues as members were "not as young and fit as they once had been".

The equitable distribution of golf balls as competition prizes appears to have been a contentious issue over a number of years. A Special General Meeting was even called in 1995 to debate the issue. At the meeting a proposal to divide the competition into three groups was lost and a subsequent motion to award balls based on Stableford points in one grade was carried by a wide margin.

In 1996 the Club was requested to stage the Home Links Teams event but when the Club Management required payment of $10 per participant the event was transferred elsewhere. The Lady Vets committee did try to negotiate a better deal with Management and were very disappointed that their pleas fell on deaf ears. They felt they had been let down by their own Club as the fee sought appeared to be excessive in comparison to those charged by other clubs in the District.

By 1999 Nine Hole members had joined the monthly competitions and were integrated into the field. Play was now organised in fours and it was reported the caterer was unhappy with this format, as the pace of play was slow in comparison to the earlier play in threes. This caused a delay in completing the round and players coming in for lunch. The committee resolved to continue with play in fours. The Players' Committee advised that the Lady Vets should accept players on handicaps up to 54 as this was now an official handicap under the new Slope system.

By the turn of the century membership had grown to include 102 Eighteen-hole members and 23 Nine-holers, though the average attendance was seldom much over forty-five. BOP Zone tournaments catered for fields of 120 and more to show that Veteran Golf was strong throughout the District. A team from Tauranga travelled to the Tauhara course in Taupo to claim the first ever victory for the Club in the Home Links Competition. The successful team included Hazel Casey, Sybil Grant, and Fay Horan. Perhaps inspired by this success the Club voted to have more competition days with official draws being made for the first and third Monday of each month. Kath Simmonds was seen to be doing an excellent job of organising the nine-hole players on these days.

Carmel Country Estate sponsored a tournament in October 2002 that attracted a field of 102 from a wide range of clubs. While the tournament proved an unqualified success the sponsorship sadly was not continued beyond that year. Bay Radiology continued to sponsor the popular Grandmothers' Tournament for several years until 2005 when Palmer's Garden Centre became involved for the first time.

In 2003 it was proposed that the Lady Vets no longer be represented on the Players' Committee. While the committee resolved to formally object to this their objection was not successful and there has been no restoration of that representation.

It appears that Veteran Lady Golfers all became Veteran Women in 2005 in keeping with other female golfers throughout the Country. In that year the President's report noted that research had determined that the first AGM was held in 1988 with Marg Calver elected President. Prior to that it would appear that Phyl Carter had been recognised as presiding over an unofficial organization the year prior. Notable amongst the women elected to office in 1988 was Shirley Crawford who served on the committee almost continuously until 2005. Shirley was elected President for the 2002/3 years and represented the Club at District level for several years. For the record the following statistics taken during the 2006 season showed the average attendance to be 25.6 Eighteen-holers and 10.7 Nine-holers. The largest field hosted 34 of the former and 18 of the latter. Understandably most members are 'fair weather players' and attendance falls dramatically when rain threatens.

By 2007 accumulated funds had reached such a level that the committee voted to donate $400 to the Club with the suggestion this be used to provide decorative Planter Boxes. Total sponsorship through the season amounted to $515 with Gate Pa New World, Aussie Butcher, PaknSave, Fresh Fruit of Chapel Street, and BB's Coffee Shop of Fraser Cove being willing supporters. The Grandmothers' tournament attracted 92 entries, an indication of the strength of Veteran Women's golf.

In 2008 the group instigated an Interclub fixture where they invited veterans from Matamata and Te Puke to visit. A special general meeting the same year voted unanimously to reduce the qualifying age from 55 to 50 though a 55+ tournament was still held with Golf Fusion providing $800 worth of sponsorship, an exceptionally generous gesture indeed.

After many years of a roll-up starting system the veterans instigated a draw for their Monday competition, the change being accepted with enthusiasm by the vast majority of participants. It is nice to know where and when you are starting well in advance of teeing off.

Kathy Gregg, in announcing that she would be retiring from the presidency at the end of the 2010 season, donated a trophy to be known as the Women Veterans' Presidents Trophy. The competition format for this would be the prerogative of the serving President each year.

Club funds had again reached a healthy profit and the sum of $500 was donated to the Golf Club with the suggestion that a rail be installed to assist descent from the sixth tee. This had not appeared by 2011.

The 2010 tournament was open to players 50 years and over and again attracted a strong field of some 90 players. Sponsorship of $1000 from Althorpe Village ensured the success of the tournament. Greerton Lotto meantime had established an on-going sponsorship involving $30 vouchers and three golf balls per month while Artisan Jewellers sponsored the Pairs tournament.

In 2010 Connie Breeds retired from organising the summer golf programme, a job she had done with enthusiasm and efficiency for a number of years. Beryl Smith and Adrienne Coad volunteered to continue the work so ensuring this successful initiative would continue. Over the years Women's golf has not suffered from any lack of well qualified, enthusiastic volunteers to take on the many roles that need to be filled in providing for the administration of both the playing and the social side of golf.

Trophies played for during the season include the Jean Mack trophy over three rounds of Stableford play for women of 65 years and over, the Birdie and Founder's Trophies, each presented by Phyl Carter, the Joan Standford Memorial tray awarded to the player scoring most Stableford points on the day of the Club Birthday in June, and the Val Western Putting Trophy. The Grandmothers' Trophy for the best Stableford was donated by Tom and Edna Dick who also donated the Fillies Cup awarded to the woman recording the best Stableford score on Melbourne Cup day when the Veteran men invite the Ladies to join them for golf and sociability.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

ADMINISTRATION

In 1904 it was a Man's World run by men for the benefit of men. In the realm of golf this was possibly even more pronounced than it was elsewhere. At the original Club based at the Domain women were welcome so long as they did not interfere with the 'proper playing of the game' as practised by the men. This is evidenced from Local Rule 9 of the card that read: " On Saturday afternoons Gentlemen may pass Ladies on any part of the course". Rennie Wallis' recollection of a Flag Match played by the Ladies on a Saturday in the early years of golf at Gate Pa, as described in Chapter 11, further emphasises the position women golfers held in the Club hierarchy. The Club Committee, which controlled all things related to the course, the finances, the clubhouse, social activity, employment, and men's competition golf, was made up entirely of men until the election of 1974. That year marked the emancipation of women golfers at Tauranga. Evelyn (Nen) Sim, backed by the strong support of a large contingent of women members, threw her hat into the ring for election to the 'Men's Committee'. Nen's election was never in doubt and she proved to be a wise choice to represent the women of the Club and an invaluable member of the committee over a significant period.

The constitution had never stood in the way of women serving on the committee and, had the women wished it, their voting strength could easily have seen women elected at any time prior to Nen's pioneering success. Under the constitution women could have been elected to any position on the committee, even that of Men's Captain! Possibly they were perfectly happy to run their own affairs during the week and let the men get on with the complexities of maintaining the course and facilities. Women did have full voting rights at annual meetings and could thus influence major issues should they so wish. We can also be sure that many a committeeman listened carefully to what his wife had to say before casting his vote on certain contentious issues.
The women members were very efficient in the organisation of their own affairs. Their competition programming, their handicapping, their social activities, were all organised with enthusiasm and expertise. In many of these respects they could have shown the men a thing or two, and probably sometimes did.

For four years Nen Sim carried the women's banner on the Club Committee until 1979 when joined by Loeta Hutcheson. At the AGM in August 1978 the women members moved to have a woman member appointed to the General Committee annually. The motion was eventually carried on a show of hands after the voice vote had proved indeterminate. Some of the opposition to the move came from the fact that the opportunity already existed for women to have adequate representation. Hadn't Nen Sim already demonstrated that? Loeta Hutcheson was subsequently appointed to the position and was followed by Peg Cross in 1980. From then until the advent of the Board there were usually two women on committee, one elected and one appointed. Noeline Shiel was an elected member from 1987 through to 1994, a record term for a woman member. Later in 1994 when the Board became a reality Noeline was elected Vice President. Perhaps this paved the way for Peg Copestake who became the first woman to be elected Club President when she succeeded Gary Baker in 2000, a landmark event for the new Millennium. It had taken nearly 100 years but now the emancipation of women within the Club was complete with a woman being elected to the highest office. It was not long before Anna Brabyn was to continue the trend by assuming the Presidential chair.

The advent of the Board of Management in 1994 inevitably resulted in the committee becoming redundant in the form under which it had existed over the previous ninety years. This made little difference to the administration of specific groups such as the Women, the Veterans, or the Thursday players. It did have quite a profound influence on the administration of Men's competition golf. Where previously a Match Committee, the members of which were drawn from the Club Committee, had supported the Captain and his Deputy they now became part of a stand-alone group with restricted responsibilities. Further these officers had once been part of a strong committee responsible for all aspects of Club management. Now they had responsibilities essentially limited to managing Men's competition golf including representative golf. This appeared to make the job less attractive and it became difficult to find people willing to stand for positions on the Men's Committee. In addition life styles had changed and many members, through work and family commitments, could not find the time to make themselves available for committee work. Those who did step forward often stayed for only a year or two with the result that continuity was tenuous at best. This was an unfortunate and unexpected disadvantage arising from the introduction of the Board system of Club governance. Gradually the problem resolved itself as the Saturday men came to realise the importance of consistent leadership and a level of continuity began to flow through their administrative structure once more.

The concept of a Board of Management to control the financial aspects of the Club began to be discussed seriously in the early nineties as other Golf Clubs around New Zealand began to adopt this form of management. An informal investigative group consisting of Ted Bold, Rex Edmonds, Barry Jensen, and Bruce Simister reported to Committee in August 1994. They recommended that a Board of Management be established to handle the business aspects of Club management with a separate committee to control the playing and social aspects of club life. Maurice White and David Mowat were appointed to join that group which would then prepare a final document to present to a Special General Meeting of the Club. Honorary Solicitor Bruce Gordon was of immense value in assisting the group to draft the appropriate wording that would be needed both to present the concept to Club members, and to amend Club rules appropriately in the event the proposals should be adopted. Ultimately 187 members signed the attendance register when the proposals were presented, and adopted, on the 17th

At the fifth hole one summer morning Noel Hockin, then Secretary Manager, holed in one during a round that started before 6 am. This was the day after the Races and punters, as was normal in earlier years, had been parked on the 8th and 9th fairways the previous day. First of his Sunday morning four to climb up to the elevated tee Noel discovered that someone had been "caught short" the previous day and deposited human waste in the centre of the tee. Feeling duty bound to clean up this disgusting mess Noel did so before teeing up and playing the perfect shot which duly reached the bottom of the hole for Noel's first and only hole in one in 45 years of playing the game. That day must have proven to be an awfully long one for Noel who was never one to shy away from a celebratory drink or three.

of October 1994. At the AGM a month later Bruce Partridge and Joyce Paris became the first elected members of the Board. Club President Noel Copestake and Player's Representative Paul Munn joined them to form the nucleus of the new Board. In accordance with the new rules these four then invited Ian Cross and Jackie McDonald to fill the remaining positions

Inaugural Chairman Bruce Partridge had a difficult two-year term as the Board strove to establish itself in a club environment that was not entirely supportive. In spite of the democratic process by which the Board came into being there were those who lamented the demise of the previous committee system. To their mind the Board had too much power, the players and their committees too little. The Players Committee suggested they should act as the Greens Committee in addition to their other responsibilities. The roles of Board, Committee, and General Manager were clearly not yet established in the minds of all participants. Attitudes changed as successive Boards began to convince Club members that the Club was able to make real progress under the new management structure. The financial position, a problem for as long as anyone could remember, improved under Board management, the clubhouse was virtually rebuilt, the Pro Shop was enlarged and made more attractive and, most importantly, the course showed continual improvement in appearance and playing quality. While some would claim these improvements would have been made equally quickly under the old committee system it is difficult to believe that to be true. Progress under the old system had been stalled for far too long.

Aylene McGregor, who had done an excellent job in a role she had taken on with some reluctance, continued to act as Manager during 1995 though she was unwilling to take on the more onerous responsibilities associated with the role now envisaged for the General Manager. The Board subsequently appointed Chris Linn to fill the position. He took up the new role in October 1995. The work of the inaugural Board was made more difficult as a result of this selection as the new manager proved somewhat less than satisfactory and after three years a replacement was sought. In December 1996 Bruce Partridge stood down from the Chair, citing pressure of work. Bruce remained on the Board until the AGM of November 97 when the Board elected Joyce Paris to fill the Chair. Jackie McDonald stood down in 1996 and was replaced by Barbara Glynn who, soon afterward, was appointed Chairperson. By November 1997 Barbara had a new look Board to Chair with Bruce Simister and David Mowat as the elected members, Michael Sandlant and Noelene Shiel as President and Player Representative respectively, while Barbara and Ian Cross continued as the invited members. The first task of the new Board was to appoint a General Manager to replace Chris Linn. Barbara led the panel that recommended the appointment of Grant Scoones who took office in March 1998. The two proved to work very well together. Barbara was a strong Chairperson who established excellent procedures for future Boards to follow. At one stage of her term the Trustees of the Golf Club Trust were expressing doubts as to the ability of the Board to run the affairs of the Club. These were powerful personalities who wanted to impose conditions upon the Board before they were willing to loosen the purse strings by which they held the Trust funds. As an accountant Barbara had sound financial skills and was able to approach these people and convince them that both she and the rest of the Board had both the wisdom and the expertise required to utilise the funds in a responsible manner. In the end the Trustees were pleased to wind up the Trust and make the funds available to the Board to be used in the Clubhouse rebuild. The willingness of the trustees was made especially evident when Avon Carpenter, a long-standing Trustee, seconded the motion to proceed with the clubhouse redevelopment program. In doing so Avon assured the AGM attendees of June 2000 that the Trustees were unanimous that the decision to wind up the

Trust and make the funds available specifically for the clubhouse project was in the best interests of the long term future of the club. Without Trust funds of $230 000 being made available it is doubtful the project would have been completed.

In October 1998 Grant Scoones presented the Board with a Business Plan for the years 1999 to 2004. In this plan the Mission Statement read: “To provide a quality golf experience for all players in surroundings of excellence”. A month later he presented a second paper entitled: “Club Leadership Guide”. In this he states: “Board members must provide leadership. They must be as good at their job as they expect the General Manager to be. The GM must be the Chief Executive Officer, and seen to be that. The Board must give the GM and the Club strategic direction. The Board must formulate policy and empower and enable the GM to implement that policy. The Board’s mission is to achieve the objectives of the membership. The Players Committee is to be responsible for the playing and social aspects of Club life and is to report to the Board via the General Manager”.

Current and future Boards might do well to study these two papers and note the concepts they outline. Together they provide much of what might best serve the needs of an evolving membership.

Barbara Glynn completed her term as Chairperson of the Board following the 1999 AGM of the Club. Barbara could be well proud of the progress made during her term. She was chiefly responsible for guiding the Board through the difficult period of uncertainty that precedes the wisdom of maturity. The dramatically remodelled and modernised clubhouse stands as a monument to her endeavours. Though building did not commence on the project during Barbara’s term in office the initial concept was developed, and the funding put in place, during those years.

The new Board elected David Mowat to the Chair and invited Jim Verran and Alison Holdem to serve as invited members. President Gary Baker, Player Representative Peg Copestake, and elected member Tony Gallagher completed the Board of six. Two major projects occupied the Board at the time. These were ensuring that the best possible result was obtained from the clubhouse redevelopment and that the condition of the fairways be improved. The story of clubhouse development is told elsewhere in this History.

Two options appeared to be available to improve the playing quality of our fairways. The first would involve a major commitment to developing a comprehensive fairway watering system, the second to introduce fairway grasses that would thrive during our driest summers without the need for additional watering. Estimates at the time suggested it would cost $300 000 to $500 000 to set up full fairway watering, plus another $50 000 per annum in running costs. There was no guarantee that the required volume of water would be available in perpetuity.

David Ormsby, our advisor from Turf Research, was invited to meet with Club representatives to present the case for establishing a suitable Cynodon cultivar on our fairways. Windsor Green was considered to be the most suitable of those available. This grass had been successfully introduced to a number of Northern Clubs, notably Gulf Harbour where the World Cup had been staged within twelve months

of establishment. David gave estimated costs of $7000 to $10 000 per fairway using imported turf. A decision was made to trial Windsor Green on the 11th and 13th fairways and the contractor supplied and planted stolons into these in November 2001. This experimental planting was made possible by a grant of $25 000 from Renner's Bar and Pub Charity. Members of the Board waited anxiously as the new turf slowly established itself and spread across the bare ground. Meanwhile Club members were dubious about the prospects for the turf and unhappy with the inconvenience of lifting balls from the developing areas. Many were critical and vociferous in their claims that the Board had made a very unwise decision. The eventual success of the fairway conversion program will be told later in this story.

Following the AGM of 2001 the new Board consisted of elected representatives David Mowat and Bob Birch, invited members Margot McCool and Richard Cashmore, President Peg Copestake, and Player Representative John Roberts. It was noted that the objective of increasing membership had seen some degree of success with total membership increasing from a low of 855 in 1997 to a healthier 1109 in 2002. These figures do not tell the full story though as senior membership, not total membership, is the important factor in relation to Club finances.

The Board determined that it was not logical that the President should continue to chair General Meetings of the Club as the Board were the body responsible for the Financial and Administrative functions of the Club and consequently the Board Chairperson was best positioned to conduct such meetings. The Club adopted this policy.

David Mowat completed his three years as Board Chairman in November 2002 and was replaced by Richard Cashmore. David was elected to the Presidency and so remained on the Board. Bruce Calderwood and Tony Reynish were newly elected Board members. One of this Board's first responsibilities was to appoint a Greens Superintendent to replace Murray Clark who had decided to step down in order to reduce his responsibilities. Brendan Allen was appointed and he made an immediate and significant impact in the role. It was unfortunate that he was induced to move to bigger things in Auckland before he had time to fully develop his ideas for our course.

The Board had long recognised the difficulties that were associated with the Financial and Membership years being significantly different. Consequently plans were made to align these in order to facilitate budgeting and other issues of financial management. Changes were adopted by the AGM of 2003 with the result that the financial year now concludes on January 31st with the AGM required to be held before April 30th. The opportunity was taken at this meeting to present a major upgrade of Club rules. This was adopted without serious opposition.

During the period of this Board a number of major alterations to the course were made. The 5th, 7th, 10th, 13th and 17th holes were altered significantly, while minor alterations were made elsewhere. Opinion on the value of these to the playing quality of the course will differ from one player to the next but it would be true to say that not all such alterations have been widely accepted as being positive steps forward.

It was interesting to note in the Board minutes of June 2003 that the Board directed their Chairman to attend the next meeting of the Men's Committee in order to stress to them the importance of that committee focusing their energies on the responsibilities allocated to them through Club rules. These were to attend to the needs of Men's competitive golf. The Board was concerned that the Men's Committee appeared to concentrate much of their energy on matters relevant to the Board and Management, and that the direction of much of this was negative. This was an example of the difficulty some individuals and groups found in adapting to the new management structure of Board and Committees. Gradually the structure has been accepted as the benefits it confers have been recognised and most groups have learned to concentrate their efforts in furthering the interests of their own members. The Men's Committee has understandably had the most difficulty with adapting to its role as for some 90 years their members had effectively managed all aspects of the Club's affairs through their various sub-committees.

Included with the August 2003 Board minutes is a paper entitled 'Where are we Heading'? This was presented to the Board by President David Mowat and discusses a number of aspects of Course and Club development that continue to be relevant to future planning. Over the years Committees and Boards have discussed many topics and put forward many ideas worthy of consideration by those who follow them. An occasional perusal of these ideas from the past might well prove a rewarding exercise for future administrations.

The 2004 Board received a report from David Ormsby of the NZ Turf Research Institute in which he recommended the Club concentrate on encouraging Browntop in the greens. While Poa annua may be seen to dominate over the winter months the Browntop would prevail from September through May and so provide an excellent playing surface over most of the year. To encourage Browntop more aeration and deep root encouragement was needed. The greens should be oversown with Browntop following each renovation. This represented a throwback to earlier times in the fifties and sixties when grooving and seeding with Browntop was a standard annual procedure on our greens. Sometimes progress is made in a circular fashion. Other recommendations harking back to an earlier age were to keep the pH (acidity) level low between 4.9 and 5.3. Nitrogen levels were to be moderate and Potassium level low (below 3%). I have to wonder when, and why, we got off the Browntop track that had previously proved so successful. Mr Ormsby also stressed that the Cynodon fairways would require careful thatch management to provide the best possible playing surface. This has proved only too true. Opinion throughout the Club on the merits of Cynodon fairways was at this time still divided though the Board was united on the need to push forward with the program. Brendan Allen and David Ormsby presented a summary of the main points for and against the contending strategies of Cynodon versus full fairway watering to the Board in 2004. The following points were made.

Water requirement

Full irrigation would require 1020 cubic metres of water per day.

The club had resource consent for only 200 cubic metres per day from the stream and was unlikely to be granted additional rights.

Town water supply would be prohibitively expensive.
Bore water availability is questionable at best, and expensive. The Racing Club bored to 1500ft to get 75cubic metres per day at a temperature of 40ºC.

Reticulation
Cost estimate for full irrigation to fairways was $446 000 plus GST or $500 000 if the greens and tees reticulation was to be upgraded in conjunction.

Maintenance costs
Current maintenance costs on the two Windsor Green fairways was approximately $3500/ha/annum.
The other fairways with travelling irrigators cost approximately $3000/ha/annum.
Over time this difference would disappear as the cost of controlling Poa annua on the Windsor Green fairways reduced.

Extra cost of maintaining irrigated fairways
Irrigated fairway does not mean perfect fairway. Additionally there is a cost spiral involving extra fertiliser, extra use of fungicides and insecticides, extra system maintenance and extra mowing. This extra mowing means an increase in costs through additional fuel, staffing, and machinery maintenance and replacement costs.
Without major drainage and regular renovation work the fairways would become very wet in winter. All this meant the additional costs associated with irrigated fairways were conservatively estimated at $40 000 per annum plus another staff member at $25 000 minimum. This estimate was in line with what had been found at other courses.

Comparative playing surface
Compared to the existing fairways Windsor Green is

1) Far superior from January to April,
2) Superior in May, June, November and December,
3) Similar from July through to October.

Their conclusion
Developing Windsor Green is a far superior strategy for the Tauranga Golf Club to adopt than that of irrigating existing fairways. It will be cheaper to introduce, no more costly to maintain, and will give better playing surfaces longer term.

Faced with information such as this, and with the evidence developed from the first two trial fairways, the Board had no difficulty in adopting a policy to convert all fairways to Windsor Green (a Cynodon variety) as rapidly as resources would allow. While this variety does show winter dormancy in line with other warm weather grasses it still provides an adequate playing surface through the dormancy period. Over the following years improved techniques were developed to convert fairways using stolons harvested from our existing fairways. While keeping costs down there were disadvantages associated with this as conversion was piecemeal and members were inconvenienced as individual fairways were

taken out of play for varying periods. Even so this was less intrusive than would have been the case had the course been closed completely while all fairways were converted simultaneously.

On leaving the Club in 2006 Brendan Allen provided the Club with a summary of some of his thoughts for the future of the course. He was strongly in favour of the Windsor Green introduction, gave pointers as to the management techniques he had found most successful with it, and felt that the fairways would continue to improve over several years as the Windsor Green dominates and weed invasion by Poa annua and other species is reduced. He was also supportive of the strategic development plan provided earlier by Alex Glasgow and adopted by the Club in General Meeting as a blueprint for future development. Brendan stated that the plan was sensibly aimed at meeting the needs of the mid to longer handicapped player, the emphasis of the plan being on modernisation rather than development. The message was to make the most of what we have, not aim for something we cannot be. In the context of Brendan's comments it is interesting to note that George Kinghorn, one of our 'young guns', wrote to the Board in 2004 to suggest he felt the Board should concentrate on providing better course conditions rather than attempting to provide additional length and difficulty. George felt that the present course design provided a great environment and a good test of golfing prowess for Club members and visitors alike. Many a Club member would endorse those sentiments with enthusiasm.

Bunkers on the course were a topic of much official debate at this time. They have probably been the topic of many an unofficial debate throughout the history of the Club. Brendan was of the opinion that the feature bunker on the Knoll should be eliminated for a number of reasons, most important of which was that it was a danger to staff when operating machines. Eventually the bunker was remodelled and now appears to be destined to survive as an important visual feature on this signature hole even though it is the destroyer of many a promising round. One of the justifiable criticisms of this bunker is that it severely penalises the poorer player amongst us while having virtually no impact at all upon the play of the more talented. This is in conflict with the valid theory that hazards should be placed so as to penalise the good player who strays rather than the poorer player who is well capable of penalising himself without the need for course intervention. The visual nature and the strategic position of this particular bunker probably determine that it remain as 'the exception that proves the rule'.

Brendan's parting shot was to the effect that the bunker upgrade program formulated by the Course Development Group should be put into action immediately as "further member input will only unnecessarily delay the process". Most of the program was proceeded with though not to the satisfaction of all. While bunkers do add considerably to the workload of the Greens staff they also serve a number of important roles. Commander Harris claimed they could be placed so as to act as lighthouses guiding the safe route to the fairway or green. A number of those he designated to serve that purpose have been removed, presumably because they were considered to serve no useful purpose and added to the cost of course upkeep. Not all would believe their removal was justified or beneficial. The role of bunkers as hazards is often poorly understood, perhaps because of the pristine condition of most seen on Television, and because the extremely talented players seen there have so little trouble recovering from them. In spite of this bunkers have proven to be a very efficient and fair way of providing a means

by which a wayward stroke might be penalised.
The Board that was elected in 2005 had a new look about it. The members were Richard Cashmore as Chairman, Anna Brabyn (President), Kevin Steward (Captain), Bruce Calderwood, Murray Goodhue, and Margot McCool. Now that a very successful clubhouse upgrade had been completed this Board turned its attention to the Pro Shop. This was seen to provide an important first impression to newcomers to the Club and its condition at the time was not in keeping with the standards the Board aspired to. Plans for the upgrade were prepared in 2004 and the new-look facility was completed in time for 'Golf Fusion' to move in during February 2006. The new operation headed by Jack and Jay Carter introduced a new standard of service to members and visitors alike. 'Golf Fusion' was required to operate under a new agreement that required them to extend the role to one considerably wider than had previously been the case. This they have done with the result that the level of service provided to members and to visitors alike would surely not be exceeded elsewhere in this country.

The 2006 Board appointed Graeme Duncan, previously based at Inglewood, and a native of Scotland, to the vital post of Greens Superintendent. Graeme proved his worth quickly and the course continued to develop as it had done in recent years through the skill and application of men of the ilk of Brendan Allen and Murray Clark.

Richard Cashmore retired from the Board in 2007 and was replaced as Chairman by Murray Goodhue who unfortunately served for just that one year. Consequently the Board of 2009 had something of a new look about it with new members Richard Craven and Michael Smith joining Anna Brabyn, Bruce Calderwood, Murray Goodhue and Margot McCool.

Richard Craven was thrust into the Chairman's role rather sooner than he may have anticipated when the 2010 elections saw Graham Cathie and Bob Diprose elected to join the President and Captain. These four invited Richard and Margot to continue in their roles. Richard stood down from the Chairmanship after just the one year so adding to the instability that is inevitable when management roles turn over too quickly. Following the 2011 AGM Graham Cathie was appointed to the chair after just the one year on the Board. Michelle Towersey and Evan McKain were invited to join the sitting members.

SECRETARIES AND MANAGERS

Any organisation whether commercial, charitable, public or private is very dependent upon one particular person to act as the hub upon which the business of the organisation revolves. In the first years of our Golf Club that person was the Secretary, a role filled by Mr John Bull until he was elected Captain. The job was then elevated to Honorary Secretary/Treasurer and filled by Mr G A Ward though the honorarium, if any, must have been very small based on the level of expenses quoted in the BOP Times of the day. Perhaps Mr H B Mountfort, who was said to chase about the Township to collect subscriptions in order to be able to pay to have the Gate Pa Links mown ready for the new season, was the first to really get the Club established on a more secure financial basis. At one time the firm of H B Mountfort and Company was very prominent in the town. It was an Agricultural and Horticultural Supply

Company headquartered in Harington Street where a Produce Market now trades. Later the company moved to the corner of Cameron Road and 12th Avenue before being taken over by Dalgety's who continued to trade there until themselves merging and fading into history under the Wrightson banner.

Colin Evitt was possibly the first professional to take on the job of Secretary/Treasurer following on from a series of Club members who had served in an honorary capacity. Col, as he was known, was a partner in an accountancy practise in the town. Though Col only held the job for a couple of years before moving to Hawkes Bay he established procedures that were to serve the Club well into the future. When Col vacated the job in 1957 he was replaced by N H E (Noel) Hockin, a colleague who had moved to Tauranga from Whakatane. A keen sportsman Noel had been active in cricket and golf at Whakatane, both in the playing side and in administration. From 1951-53 he had been President of the Bay of Plenty District Golf Association. First appointed Secretary/Treasurer to the Club in 1957 Noel was promoted to the newly created post of Secretary Manager shortly afterward and became involved full time at the Club before retiring in 1967. With his background in sport and his professional qualifications in accounting Noel was a real asset to the Club. He was strong on public relations, a genial and friendly host, and a true gentleman in the old-fashioned sense of the word. His appointment was an inspired one and set the standard for those who were to follow.

As the job moved from Secretary to Secretary Manager and finally to Manager three men stand out as having brought something special to the role. A number of others came and went without leaving a lasting legacy in their wake. Noel Hockin was the first of the memorable trio. The next was R J (Royce) Lahood.

Royce Lahood was recruited from Inglewood where he and his brother Sonny owned a Snooker Parlour and a Dry Cleaning business. Like Noel, Royce was active in both golf and cricket as both player and administrator. At Inglewood Royce had not been averse to active involvement in pitch and ground preparation for cricket, nor in voluntary work at the Golf Course as required. Appointed to the Secretary Management job at Tauranga in 1970 Royce filled that role until 1983 when he retired. Royce was exceptional in the field of public relations. He knew every member by name and greeted each with warmth and enthusiasm thus giving him or her the impression that they were both respected and valued as Club members. Even more impressive was his ability to recall the names of those visitors who came once a year to play in the Labour Weekend Tournament. These would be visibly surprised and delighted to be welcomed back by first name. Even green fee players who visited only occasionally were sometimes surprised to be greeted by name.

The role of Club Manager is not an easy one to fill. In addition to good public relations the Manager is expected to be an expert Financial Manager, a good communicator, a convivial host, an excellent Personnel Manager, a promoter of the Club, a Tournament organiser. If in addition the incumbent should have an understanding of the game of golf including course management and player psychology this would certainly help him or her to better fill the role. To expect to find all this in one person is to expect the near impossible. Royce was no exception. His weakness was in the office side of the job where, were it not for the assistance of Henry Becker and others, Royce would have had difficulty in keeping

everything up to the standard required. Henry was a retired Post Master who took up golf only upon his retirement. Late to the game he became a true enthusiast claiming to find a new secret, and even a new swing, each time he went out to hit practise balls. Henry served not only as assistant to Royce but also at one stage took on the job of Secretary to the BOPDGA.

Those who worked with Royce will remember him with great respect and admiration. During his nearly 14 years as Manager the Club was involved in a high level of activity. On the competition side the Men's North Island Championship and the Women's Inter Provincial (Russell Grace) Tournament were each held. These were additional to the regular Amateur tournaments, and to the Spalding Masters and PGA Tournaments. Major clubhouse extensions were undertaken and irrigation installed to tees and greens. Water was sourced from the Kopurereroa stream for the first time. Social activity reached a peak with Twilight Tournaments and Friday night meals proving popular. The pool table was at the height of its popularity, which added to the conviviality throughout the Club. Bar trading remained outside the law and application had to be made for a new Booth license to cover each special occasion. Under cover of this a large supply of liquor would be purchased to meet future needs up to a year ahead.

The third member of the 'Great Triumvirate' was appointed in 1998. Grant Scoones served in the New Zealand Air Force before taking on Sports Management. Before his appointment to Tauranga Grant managed the Port Nicholson Yacht Club and was CEO of Squash New Zealand. Grant was the first to truly serve the management role in the Club. He had the vision to see what needed to be done in order to set the Club on a sound financial base and the drive to lead the Board towards that goal. The major weakness in the financial management of the Club had been a failure to set subscriptions sufficiently high enough to enable course and clubhouse development to progress at the level most members would consider desirable. From the very beginning subscriptions had been set at a level to cover little more than annual running costs. No provision had been made for machinery replacement or course improvement. Staffing was kept at minimal levels. Any expenditure beyond this had to be borrowed against the hope that future members would eventually repay the debt. Whilst it is perfectly reasonable to expect future members to cover a share of development costs it is not reasonable to expect them to cover daily operating costs. This failure to maintain subscriptions at such a level as to cover annual operating costs and also provide for the replacement of plant and machinery had placed a burden upon the Club's resources throughout much of its history. Many an AGM featured long discussions on the question of subscription increases. Successive committees were frustrated as they presented thoroughly researched documentation to justify subscription increases that would enable them to meet current costs and also put aside funds for the future only to have these voted down or substantially reduced. The 1970 AGM will probably best be remembered for an amendment by Mr Fookes to the motion calling for a $5 increase in subscriptions. The amendment was to limit all subscription increases to a maximum of $3. The said gentleman (a banker) was thereafter known as "Three dollar Fookes".
The Club still suffered under the same burden of debt resultant upon this type of thinking twenty-three years later. The 1993 AGM received a proposal from the committee to increase subscriptions by $20 per member. It was claimed from the floor that adopting this proposal would result in a serious fall in membership. An amendment was then put to reduce subscriptions by $30 on the basis that this would encourage new members to join. When this was defeated another amendment to the effect that no

increase be made was carried and another committee was frustrated in their desire to move the Club forward.

Nothing much had changed by the time Grant Scoones was appointed in 1999. The previous manager had been asked what he intended to do to prevent the Club running up deficits. His answer was that he would resign if the Club ran at a deficit the following year. There was a deficit, of course, though whether he honoured his pledge or was encouraged to move on is a moot point.

It has to be said that the Club environment was in a state of change at the time Grant Scoones came onto the scene. These changes were conducive to the Club moving forward in a manner that had not proved possible in the past. Central to this was the fact that the Board of Management was now firmly established, Board members understood their role and the Board was slowly gaining the confidence of a majority of the membership. The strength of the Board style of management lies in the restricted role the Board has. It is responsible for providing the best Course and Clubhouse facilities possible under prevailing circumstances. It must do this while ensuring that Club finances, staffing, and forward planning satisfy membership requirements as far as is reasonably possible. The Board was not to be concerned with running competition golf, with promoting social activities, nor with the numerous, and often trivial matters, that committees of the past often found themselves involved with. Consequently Board members were expected to devote their energies to a concentrated sector of Club governance with the expectation that this would lead to better husbandry of financial resources. Similarly the General Manager was not contracted to involve himself in the organization of competitive golf. This was to remain the responsibility of the sectional committees. Inevitably there were areas related to competition where the Manager did become involved. These mainly related to major events such as the Five Course Classic and the Carrus Tournament, not to normal Club competition.

Another change related to the attitude of members. Who, even ten years before, would have believed that the Club would vote in General Meeting to raise women's subscriptions to the same level as men's? Further who would have believed that the Club would vote to allow the Board to raise subscriptions by up to 5% without reference to members? These changes were made in the first few years following the introduction of the Board and were symptomatic of changing attitudes. Where once sectional groups would lobby their members to attend AGMs and vote against progressive moves there was now wide recognition of the need to consider the greater good of all members, both present and future. It may well have been thought that those attitudes that had previously stifled Club progress had now been relegated to the past. In that regard judgement must remain suspended as subscription levels at the end of the first decade of the twenty-first Century remain at levels below those many administrators would consider necessary if the twin goals of covering current costs and building reserves against future capital needs are to be met.

In order to facilitate its role the Board appoints a General Manager to implement the policies it decides upon. In addition the General Manager is expected to bring forward ideas for the Board's consideration. Grant Scoones enjoyed the advantage of moving into a more responsive environment than did his predecessors. Equally importantly he was the right man for the time. With no background in golf,

and no desire to spend very much time socialising in the lounge, Grant was able to apply all of his energy and enthusiasm to the task of improving the Club's financial status and its facilities. In this he was certainly successful. He was instrumental in driving the building project that gave the Club an excellent clubhouse at a very competitive cost. His organisation of Cafeteria and Bar facilities, and his employment and supervision of the staff to run them, have provided members with outstanding service. The service provided by Jack and Jay Carter and their team in the Pro Shop has been a revelation. As each year goes by the golf course, the most important aspect of the Club, looks more and more the sort of course any golfer would be keen to play. Green fee players invariably give the course the thumbs up. Yes, there will always be critics but members with open minds will have no difficulty recognising the progress that has been made over recent years. It is no coincidence that progress in terms of course and clubhouse facilities, staffing, and financial stability has been most pronounced since Grant Scoones was appointed in 1999. It was unfortunate that Grant decided he was not willing to extend his term of service beyond 2011. In his fourteen years as General Manager he achieved a great deal on behalf of the Club. He had proven to be the right man for the role at a time when it was vitally important that the Club move positively towards a sound financial future. His legacy is likely to gain even greater recognition as we move forward from the base he established.

The new look Board that was installed in 2011 employed an outside consultant, Peter Dale, one time CEO of NZGolf, to advise them on an appropriate management structure to serve the Club's future needs. It is too early to comment on the success or otherwise of the new directions the Board resolved to follow.

Jim Paterson told a few stories in his time. Some may have come from a lively imagination but there always seemed to be a ring of authenticity to them. Once he told us of a visiting American player who came into the shop one morning, paid his green fee, and spent some time discussing the characteristics of the different brands of balls Jim had available. After due consideration he settled upon a dozen Dunlop 65s and headed for the first tee. Jim went out to wave him on his way. After some limbering exercises and a few practise swings our man teed up and took a lusty swing, missing the ball by a narrow margin. Two air shots later he stowed his club and ball in his bag, turned to Jim saying "It is not much of a golf course anyway" and headed back to the car park.

GLEANINGS FROM THE CLUB MINUTE BOOKS

As noted earlier no Minute Books from the first 40 years or so exist to this day. Perhaps this is not the serious problem that it might seem to be at first glance. I say this because, having pored over dusty minutes from as far back as possible, the overwhelming impression has been one of the enormous amount of trivia that has occupied the time of committee members throughout the years. While this is not said to disparage the work successive committees have done it would be obvious to anyone going through the books that they do not truly reflect the value of that work. Much of the important work of a committee is done at sub-committee level and is not recorded in the full committee minutes.

The following excerpts have been selected to provide a timeline of events that have had some significance in the history of our Club.

1954: The new Clubhouse was completed in its present position at a cost of £5750. The furnishing committee raised another £1034 to purchase tables and chairs.

The AGM reaffirmed that the required dress for men in the Clubhouse during the season was to include a jacket or Club blazer. The committee were to decide on the colour and style of the blazer to be adopted as the official Club blazer.

1956: £25 was allocated to assist the Greenkeeper to attend the NZ Greenkeepers' Conference in Dunedin. Imported sand was tried in our bunkers for the first time. The Labour Weekend tournament fee was set at £1:10:0, meals not included.

1957: Noel Hockin replaced Col Evitt as Club Secretary.

It was resolved that schoolboys could play in the school holidays for 2/6d per week but only if accompanied by a member. The price of the traditional meal of 'pea, pie, and potatoes' was to increase from 1/6d to 2/3d.

1960: Tauranga invited Te Puke and Mt. Maunganui Clubs to send two representatives each to play in our fixture with the Waikato Eagles.

1961: Subscriptions were set at £12 for men, £10 for women, and £20 for a married couple. Trials were conducted with the 1.68-inch American ball in New Zealand. It was found acceptable.

1962: USGA Handicapping system adopted. Membership was closed for the first time but reopened a month later.

1963: The causeway across the gully at the 4th hole was raised to provide a level crossing. Trials were conducted with Papamoa sea sand in the bunkers. Research was conducted on the feasibility of using water from the Judea stream. It was found to be much cheaper to remain on Borough supply. No positive results had been gained from trial drilling for water.

1964: Entry fee for Labour Weekend Tournament set at £2:10. This included three lunches at 5/- each. A profit of £70 was made.

1965: The committee approved Professional charges of £1:10 pa for club storage, £2:10 for storage and cleaning, and £3:10 if you wished to include shoe cleaning. Greens committee reported fairways had been mowed in August for the first time in 6 weeks. The BOPDGA had been advised we were concerned that some local clubs were not applying the handicapping rules properly. C G Wilson Ltd. were the successful tenderers for Clubhouse alterations, their tender being for £15 586.

1966: A proposal to sell draught beer was lost. One month later a draught beer trial was approved. One committee member dissented on the grounds that it would not be good for 'the decorum of the Club'. Another thought it might conflict with the law, apparently overlooking the fact that the entire operation of the bar was outside the law of the day. One month after draught beer sales were introduced consumption was reported to have reached an average of 100 flagons a week.
A new course assessment gave an SSS (Standard Scratch Score) of 69.05.
It was resolved that junior players not be allowed in the lounge except on tournament days or by permission of the Secretary Manager or Club Captain.
1967: Membership closed and limits set. The power poles on the 8th fairway had now been removed.
1968: The appointment of a permanent third greenkeeper was approved.
1969: Flagon beer price was increased to 25¢ per jug.
1971: Match committee advised men's 17th now designated a par 4 in line with the guidelines in the handicapping manual. An application was made to stage the 1973 Russell Grace Women's Inter-provincials.
1972: Play over rule to be discontinued. A delegation from the RSA Golf committee requested that the decision to charge outside competitors in their tournament a $2 green fee be rescinded. This was unsuccessful.
1973: It was resolved to purchase a house at 1368 Cameron Road and sell the Club's section off Hynd's Road. An offer of $5000 was accepted for the section. McKinlay's Paddock made available for practise but very little used. A Pool table was purchased at a cost of $970. It was felt necessary to introduce crowd control for Finals Day on account of the large galleries being attracted. $40 000 was allocated for Clubhouse extensions.
1974: M Nicholson selected to represent NZ in Eisenhower team. BOP Association approached for a ruling re local clubs (notably Mt Maunganui) not observing handicap rules over summer.
1975: Twilight tournaments were introduced. A local rule was introduced banning attendance of the flagstick and requiring all four balls to be holed prior to retrieval. This was to protect the area surrounding the hole in winter. (This was an illegal rule in conflict with the Rules of Golf.)
1976: A plan was introduced to clean up the area to the left of the 7th hole at a cost of $12 000 for the development of a Driving Range. This was subsequently rejected by the AGM of 1977.
1977: Reciprocal agreements were negotiated with the Cronulla Club of Sydney and with the Invercargill Golf Club. Three-tee starting was tried for the first time. The tradition of honouring Life Members at Finals Day was initiated.
1978: In view of reported cases of gambling associated with Pool games it was resolved to impose tighter controls and to deal severely with offenders. Les Hill resigned and was replaced by Lyn Gillon. As Mr Gillon did not require the house it was rented at $40 per week. Bob Burstall and Willis Faulds were reported to have surveyed and named all of the trees on the course. 'Play the Lie' instituted. Prior to this a 'placing' rule had applied all season only to be lifted the week prior to the Championship qualifying rounds! A long-term lease had finally been successfully negotiated with the Minister of Crown Lands. A water easement re the stream had been obtained and consequently a $48 000 irrigation scheme approved.
1979: The Pine trees adjacent to the car park were felled. The Gum trees beside them were given a safe life of 5-10 years. (They remain more than 30 years later). Friday night meals were proving

successful. Because of the uncertainty that still prevailed over the hours the bar could legally be open wine would only be available until 7pm. The minutes record there were 29 greens on the course. (I doubt this count). Warwick Nicoll gave $200 to be held in trust, the interest to cover the prize associated with the Nicoll Cup.

Installation of the Harvin irrigation system was completed in June. In response to some conflict between committee members and the green keepers the chairman of the Greens Committee, Des Wilson, said this: “In no way will I, or can I, instruct the Greenkeeper in the carrying out of his duties. My job is to provide a bridge of communication between him and the committee and to assist him with his programming.” The Racing Club were keen to install a 2200m starting point. This would project into the 11th fairway. Pegs were placed to show the positioning. (Fortunately this development was not approved).

Lance Bedford, an engineer, gave estimates relating to the Driving Range proposal. Earthworks were evaluated at $15 000, drainage at $2 000, and grassing at $5 000.

1980: A Special General Meeting voted to proceed with the Driving Range at a cost of $20 000. This same meeting approved the realignment of the entry road to separate Golf and racing areas. The 9th tee would move forward and the project would be at no cost to the Golf Club as the Racing Club would finance it through a raffle.

1981: The par of the 17th hole was increased to 5 with a stroke allocation of 15 on the motion of R Eaton and K Frith. A motion to allow junior members access to the Club lounge wearing Club jerseys rather than jackets was defeated. All male members using the lounge must wear jackets. Our rental doubled from $1 000 to $2 000, set for the following five years. During development, and afterward, the Driving Range area was to be classified as a ’lateral hazard”. (This was again contrary to the rules of golf as there is no such thing as a ‘lateral hazard’ in those rules).

1982: Driving range opened with Alan Snape being authorised to provide practice balls for members though members were permitted to use their own. Members who were improperly dressed were to be served from the side bar that opened to the Dining Room. The greens were now mown four times per week.

1983: The BOP Association advised that the larger ‘American’ ball would be mandatory in all competition under their jurisdiction. R Lahood attended his final meeting in June after 13.5 years service. The local rule re flagstick and four balls in the hole was rescinded. Reciprocal rights with Invercargill were discontinued. At the AGM a move to equate men and women’s subscriptions was defeated. Men’s were set at $225, women’s at $205. Long-playing membership was confirmed as applying after 40 years membership and age 65. Subscription was to be 50% of senior subscription.

Apparently the 1980 agreement with the Racing Club to finance the shift of the access road had been unsuccessful for it was now recorded that agreement had been reached on the issue. The clubs would now share the cost estimated at $10 900.

1984: The condition of the course over summer prompted 54 members to sign a petition claiming the greens were awful, the tees bad, weeds prolific, and the state of the trees unacceptable. (We had however developed some good paths during the employment of the then greenkeeper). The greens were now mown four days each week. Alan Snape requested release from his obligation to supply range balls owing to the high attrition rate. The response was to pay him $2 000 per year as Range supervisor and grant him $500 to help defray losses over the previous two years.

1985: Concern was expressed at the slide in membership. There were 23 vacancies in Men's A category. New membership limits were set for 1986. These increased Men's A to 375 with 25 discretionary places, Men's B to 125, Ladies' A plus B to 350. Fairway bunkers on the 8th were authorised. The requirement for men to wear a jacket in the lounge was deleted from regulations as a result of a motion to the AGM.
1992: The trimming of tree 'skirts' was very favourably received. The new eighth green was opened.
1993: A report from the NZ Turf Research Institute was very favourable to the condition of the course, especially the greens. This reflected very well on the work of Grant Patterson and his staff.
The Championship pennant team had won the BOP Pennant for the first time in fifteen years. Michael Nicholson gave praise to the younger players in the team. The junior programme had done much to bring about this success. The Board of Management concept was first mentioned as being worthy of consideration. Lack of financial support for the Golf Club Trust was seen as a matter of some concern.
1994: It was reported that the existing irrigation system made it difficult to maintain the greens to their best potential. The system had been poorly laid with sub-standard piping having been laid too shallow resulting in frequent breakdown. An urgent upgrade was required before the course development plan could be properly instigated.
The May committee meeting that year was disrupted by the breakout of a fire in the Bar. As luck would have it Neil Marson left the meeting to collect his wife Shirley from an appointment. He returned immediately to enquire why there was "steam" emanating from beneath the Bar slide. On looking out towards the Bar I said "that is not steam. Those are flames." Rapid action followed and the fire was extinguished by using all the available extinguishers from upstairs and downstairs though not before substantial damage to the interior of the Bar had been sustained. It transpired that the women volunteering to do Bar duty that day had cleaned the ash trays by tipping the butts into a waste bin under the Bar as was usual. Unfortunately on this occasion there were apparently some incompletely extinguished butts in the trays and several hours later the bin burst into open flames. Another example of the hidden dangers of smoking! It was fortunate the monthly committee meeting was scheduled for that Monday evening and that Neil had an errand that took him from the committee room at the critical moment. But for these circumstances the Clubhouse would certainly have been a total loss before the Fire Brigade had reached the scene. Some thought it may have been better if the clubhouse had been destroyed and a new one built under insurance. Such thoughts ignore the serious loss of Club records, cups, trophies, and other paraphernalia that would have resulted. The minutes report that the meeting reconvened after the committee had "distinguished" the fire and the Fire Brigade had attended to check that there was no further risk.
1995: The Players Committee wrote to the Board requesting that they, the Players Committee, should act as the Greens Committee. The Board reminded the committee that they, the Board, were responsible for ensuring that the course was presented in the best possible condition for the benefit of members. To facilitate this they had appointed a highly qualified Greens Superintendent and charged him with the responsibility of achieving this. As with other staff he would report directly to the General Manager.
1999: The AGM approved the establishment of the position of Club Captain, such elected member to chair the Players Committee and to serve on the Board. The membership category of Intermediate was also approved.
The Golf Club Trust were now willing to wind up and to transfer their funds to the Board, such funds to be utilised in the proposed Clubhouse modernisation. Ismo Torvelainen and Russell Black were

co-opted onto the Building committee for their expertise in structural engineering and design work respectively.

The Board was to seek approval to borrow up to $600 000 for the project. This was reduced to $400 000 when the Trust indicated $230 000 was available through them.

2001: Turf advisory consultant David Ormsby met with the Board to discuss the establishment of Cynodon Fairways.

2002: Resolved that the Board Chairman, rather than the President, should chair General meetings of the Club.

2003: Plans were initiated to align the financial year with the membership subscription year. This would confer a number of advantages in budgeting and general administration of the Club. This was ratified at the AGM that year together with a comprehensive revamp of the Club Rules.

Doubts were expressed in relation to the establishment of the experimental Windsor Green fairways. Climatic conditions had not been conducive to a rapid spread of stolons and some Board members were questioning the decision to proceed. Consequently the Board resolved to delay further development until more positive results were seen.

2004: David Ormsby recommended Browntop be encouraged on the greens by facilitating deeper rooting through coring and improving aeration. Greens should be over sown with Brown top at each renovation. The pH level should be low (4.9-5.3), Nitrogen levels moderate, and Potash levels low (less than 3%).

Greens Superintendent Brendan Allan presented a comprehensive report on the Windsor Green fairways in which he expressed great confidence in their future under our conditions. Fairway improvement would be a continual process over several years as the Windsor Green becomes dominant over Poa annua and invasive weeds. In the same paper Brendan praised the Alex Glasgow development plan as being sensibly aimed at the mid to longer handicapped player with an emphasis on modernisation versus development. Brendan's advice was that we should make the most of what we have, not aim to be something we cannot be.

A paper on the upgrade of the Pro Shop was presented.

2005: Golf Autoscore demonstrated their computerised scoring system following a number of improvements they had made following an earlier demonstration in 2002 when several deficiencies had been evident. The Board decided to purchase the improved system at a cost of $8500 plus service fees of $200 per month. Golf Autoscore was installed in Nov. 2005. and met with immediate acceptance by members and officials alike.

2006: Brendan Allan prepared the course for the first Carrus Professional Tournament in May before leaving for Auckland Golf Club. His parting comment was that the Club should proceed with the proposed upgrade of bunkers as further member input would only delay the process unnecessarily. His report also recommended the removal of the bunker on the Knoll as it was dangerous to staff, served no purpose other than to penalise poorer players, and was difficult to maintain.

The father and son team of Jack and Jay Carter began operations from the renovated Professional Shop.

2009: The Board adopted a new Course Management Policy Document. The degree of success these strategic plans achieve will be revealed as time goes by. Judgement must be reserved at this time.

CLUBHOUSE REDEVELOPMENT

In February 1999 the Board established a Facilities Advisory Group (FAG). This group was tasked with the responsibility of advising the Board on the development and modernisation of the clubhouse facility to a standard more in keeping with a modern sports club providing food, beverage, and administrative services to a membership of more than 1000 together with annual visitor numbers in excess of 5000. This was in keeping with the Mission Statement adopted by the Board that reads: “To provide a quality golf experience for all players in surroundings of excellence”.
The members of the group were Gary Baker and Tony Gallagher, representing the Board, Russell Black (Architectural Draftsman), Ismo Torvelainen (Engineer with Martin, McCaulay, Morton Ltd), and Grant Scoones (General Manager). Later Alan Rydings volunteered his services as a qualified Quantity Surveyor/Estimator willing to assist with the tender process and with supervision of the contract as construction developed. Both Board representatives Gary and Tony had extensive experience in the construction industry while Russell, Ismo, and Alan had proven expertise in their respective fields. While Russell and Ismo were each paid for their professional services all three attended meetings and site visits on a voluntary basis as Club members wishing to contribute to the development of their Club’s facilities.

The Board called a Special General Meeting in July 2000 for the purpose of placing before the membership a proposal to completely redevelop the Clubhouse. The building had first been erected in 1954 and had been extensively extended and refurbished on two subsequent occasions. In spite of this the clubhouse was overdue for a further upgrade in regard to the facilities it was required to provide and to the structural integrity of the building. The roof was of particular concern in the latter context. The Board had identified a number of areas where substantial expenditure would be required in the short term should a complete rebuild not be proceeded with. These areas included the roof, the lounge ceiling, all electrical and plumbing services, the floor coverings, the Bar and Kitchen units, and the outside decking. In view of all this necessary maintenance the Board recommended that the most appropriate solution would be to completely rebuild the structure above the existing basement level thus preserving the existing changing and storage rooms. The advantages of this approach were seen to be wide ranging. They included the urgent replacement of the roof, the creation of an appropriate and obvious front entry to the Clubhouse leading directly to the office, provision both of alternative entry points for players and much needed upstairs toilets. The provision of a committee room on a third floor level would be a welcome addition. A special attraction would be the enhanced views possible from all points of the clubhouse resulting from the installation of larger, more modern windows throughout the upper levels. The poor visibility from within the clubhouse had long been a source of frustration to many a member. The concept proposed would open up sweeping views of the course, the racecourse, and in particular the superb vista provided by the hills to the East. Ultimately the views that were revealed when the new clubhouse was opened to the membership proved to be every bit as rewarding as had been anticipated.
The Board did consider the idea of building a completely new clubhouse possibly located to the West of the putting green but rejected this as being impractical owing to financial considerations. The cost of

such a project was estimated to lie in the region of $1.3 to $1.5 million and it was considered it would be imprudent to take on a debt of some $1m even if a loan of such magnitude could have been negotiated with our Bank.

Alternatively the cost of building over the existing basement and foundation was estimated at $630 000 of which $230 000 would be available following the wind up of the Golf Club Trust. This Trust had been set up following the sale of the house owned by the Club and located in Cameron Road near the Reserve entrance.

Concerns were expressed during the meeting that the Board should be paying off debt rather than incurring more by going ahead with the development. The General Manager was able to explain that term liabilities had totalled $440 000 in August 1998 at which point the Board had claimed that this debt would be paid off within six years. In fact all but $82 000 had been paid off by August 2000 meaning that $358 000 had been paid off in just two years. This indicated the Board's financial policies were working and gave Board members the confidence to recommend the Club borrow the required funds to complete the proposed development. Subsequent to the presentation the Special General Meeting authorised the Board to borrow up to $400 000 to complete the proposed development. Had the Trustees not resolved to wind up the Trust and make the funds available the project would not have been viable. In addition to the $230 000 in cash provided by them the Trustees resolved to write off a loan of $130 000 owed to the Trust by the Club. This had been advanced some years previously to enable the purchase of urgently required course maintenance machinery.

Financial sustainability was the first priority of the Board when considering the proposal. They were meticulous in their planning in order to ensure the budgetary goals were both conservative and sustainable. The Club's auditors, Murray, Crossman and Partners, were able to report that, while results might vary significantly from those forecast, these variations were likely to be positive rather than negative as a result of conservative forecasts and probable growth of membership, the latter a hopeful consequence of the proposed upgrade. Financial projections for the subsequent years indicated the level of borrowing now envisaged would have little impact on subscription levels over succeeding years with repayments being amortised so as to require both present and future members to bear the cost.

Miden Construction, the principals of which were club member brothers Denis and Michael Smith, were awarded the contract in a fully competitive and open tendering process. The majority of sub-contracts also went to club members again in open tendering. While these were the responsibility of Miden Construction it is probably true that they "sharpened their pencils" to give their club the best possible price. For that the Club should be very grateful. For the record club member related firms or individual contractors who were involved included Stewart Browne Electrical, Tauranga Hardware and Plumbing (Brian McCord), Don Allen Painting and Decorating, and Helen Fritchley Interior Design.

During construction the normal business of the Club was planned to be as free from interruption as possible. A temporary office was located adjacent to the putting green and food and beverage services relocated to the trundler shed. These arrangements proved highly satisfactory, the informality of the

Trundler Shed hospitality centre being well received by the majority of members. The atmosphere created in that centre owed much to the tolerance and cheerful cooperation of our caterers Peter and Tania Robb, our Bar Persons, and to our Professional Rick Barker who was required to run his business in reduced premises and was inconvenienced in a number of other ways.

When the new facility opened in April 2001 with a champagne breakfast the membership at large, including some who had been sceptical earlier, were delighted with the appearance and overall ambience of their new clubhouse. General Manager Grant Scoones who had been instrumental in developing the original concept and in driving its progress, the entire Facilities Advisory Group who had planned and monitored every step of the development, and the Board members, none of whom ever wavered in their belief in the value and viability of the new look clubhouse, could all be justly proud of the part they had played in bringing an ambitious concept to fruition.

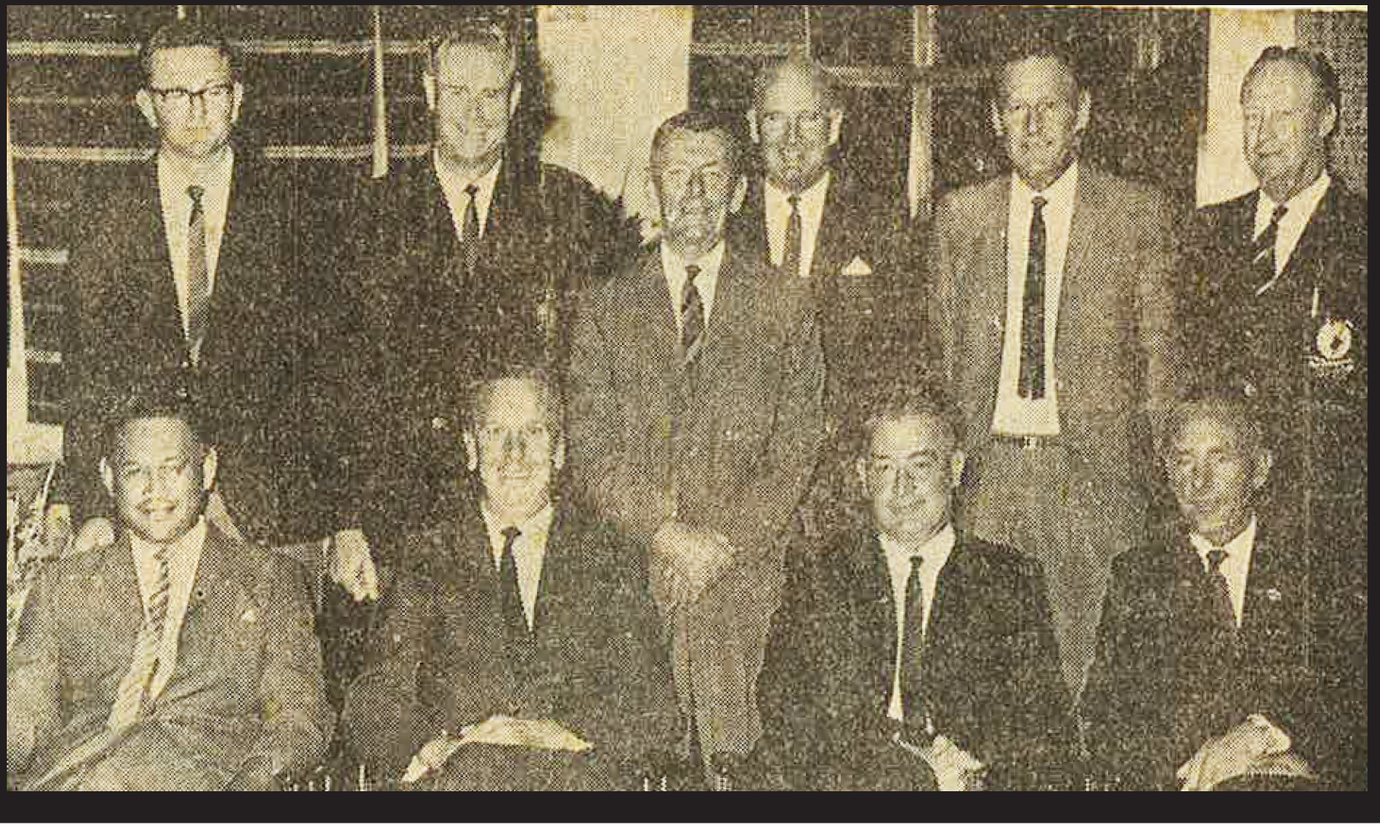
BEFORE

and **AFTER**

the Clubhouse prior and post the 2000 rebuild

Above - Life Members who contributed greatly to Club Administration over many years.
M. White, E. Galbally, A. Davidson, J. Edwards K. Frith, A. Gallagher

Below - "The new committee of the Tauranga Golf Club, elected at last night's annual meeting, is front row from left, S.B. Kanapu, club captain, A. S. Bluett, president, W.L. Peters, secretary-manager, J. Reid, vice-president. In the back row from left are D.G. S. Mowat, E.W. Hutcheson, E.F. Warnes, O. Evans, A. L. Davidson and L. Ennis, the vice-captain.



CHAPTER TWELVE

RESIDENT PROFESSIONALS

JAMES MOWAT

The Rotorua based Professionals, Mr. Hood and Mr. McCormack visited Tauranga in the early years though Tauranga had no resident Professional until 1936 when James Mowat accepted appointment to the position. James was born in Montrose, Scotland in 1895. Montrose lies North of St. Andrews on the coast and is home to one of the oldest golf courses in Scotland. It was founded in 1812 and is reputed to be the ninth oldest course in the World. After playing limited golf as a boy James enlisted in the 10th. Highland Light Infantry in December 1914 and served first in France where he was twice wounded. He was drafted back to Montrose for short convalescent spells at home before returning to the Battlefield. He ended the war fighting the Turkish forces in Mesopotamia, now known as Iraq. The Battalion was on the way home after the armistice in 1918 when it was diverted to quell an uprising in the Khyber Pass. As a result James was the last of all the men from Montrose to make it home after the war.

The prospect of life as a clerk in the Railways had little appeal to James after his experiences during the war and it was not long before he set sail for the USA where he at first worked for his uncle Bob who owned a shoe business in New York. A year or so later he met up with another man from Montrose and they responded to the growing demand in America for people who had some knowledge of, and experience in, the game of golf. Men from Scotland were highly regarded in that context. Most of Jim's work in America was involved in Golf Course design though he did fit in some teaching and playing. His reputation must have been well established as he was on one occasion invited to partner the then US Open Champion Gene Sarazen in an exhibition match in Miami against Leo Diegel (twice winner of the USPGA Championship) and Mike Brady, the latter being widely known as the Bridesmaid on account of his numerous second placings in major championships. In this match Jim scored seven birdies, his side prevailing without the need for Sarazen to contribute anything to improve their combined card.

Major Tournament winners to have played our course at some time in the past include:

Peter Thomson – Five times British Open Champion. Also placed 4th in US Open.
Kel Nagle - Centennial British Open Champion. Also 2nd US Open.
David Graham - US Open and PGA Champion Top five in Masters and British Open.
Tony Jacklin - British and US Open Championships.
Billy Casper - Twice winner US Open. Also Masters Champion and 3 times second placed in PGA Championship, 4th in British Open.
Sir Bob Charles – British Open Champion. Tied 2nd PGA Championship, Twice tied 3rd in US Opens.

James work and other experiences in America brought him into contact with a number of well known personalities including Jack Dempsey, the great heavyweight boxing champion known as the ‘Manassa Mauler’, Jack McDonald the superb sprinter termed the ‘Australian Blue Streak’, and Tommy Armour, then the most respected golf teacher in America. During Jim’s time in the Shoe Store in New York Damon Runyon, the renowned storyteller would often visit the shop to sit in a big old leather chair and ‘spin the breeze’ with Uncle Bob as the latter cobbled at his bench. Runyon’s short stories later formed the basis for the Broadway Musical ‘Guys and Dolls’.

One day an American friend who had recently returned from a trip to New Zealand said to Jim: “New Zealand is the place of the future. That is where you should go”. Soon afterward an advertisement appeared in an American publication seeking applications for the position of Professional at the Poverty Bay Golf Club. Jim applied, was duly appointed and, in 1929, he ended his nine year sojourn in the USA to set sail for a country he knew very little about. He spent seven years in Gisborne where, in 1934, he married local lass Margaret McIldowie. Soon afterward, while visiting Rotorua, he met with some Tauranga golfers who enticed Jim to move to Tauranga to take up the position of Professional there.

The Rotorua Golf Club course at Arikikapakapa was a favourite with Jimmy. On one occasion he stood on the ninth tee and said to Margaret who was caddying for him: “If I can par this hole I will be out in 30.” He promptly birdied that beautiful par three to be out in 29. We never did hear what happened in the second nine holes.

It must have been very difficult to build a business as a Club professional in those times. The great depression was still casting a long shadow over the World economy, club memberships were not large, and the course was only open for eight or nine months each year. James supplemented his income by giving lessons to Te Puke members in addition to serving his home club though the trip to Te Puke took a good deal longer than it does today. The Mowat farm and orchard, now the site of Tauranga Girls’ College, contributed further to the needs of the growing Mowat family.

In 1940, with the Second World War in full swing and less and less golf being played, James decided there was little point in persevering in the role of Professional and submitted his resignation. Soon afterward he applied to be reinstated as an Amateur. This was granted by the Golf Association on condition that he have no association with golf in any manner for a stand down period of five years, a condition much more stringent than those that prevail in this modern era. Following this enforced withdrawal, broken only by clandestine lessons in the back paddock for some of his old pupils who became desperate for guidance, James resumed life as an Amateur golfer. Along with Margaret he participated fully in club activities, including committee work, and played regularly two or three times a week.

Jimmy Mowat was one of many memorable characters to have graced our links. Renowned for the quality of his short game he holed more than his fair share of full iron shots, sometimes after asking an incredulous companion to hold the flag for him. Surprisingly he was never to score a ‘recognised’ hole in one in spite of achieving the feat several times when playing unaccompanied rounds during his time

in America. A stickler for the etiquette of the game, a true student of its rules and history, Jimmy Mowat was a lover of all aspects of this great game. Sadly, in 1958, he succumbed to Prostate Cancer at the early age of 63. With the treatment available today he would surely have enjoyed many more years of golf. As it was he fought on longer than expected and, despite being essentially bedridden for most of two years was able to shoot a 76 in his final round, this being at a very late stage of his illness.
James Mowat, professional golfer, was ahead of his time in many ways. How he would love to have contributed to, and participated in, the wave of popularity the game has enjoyed over more recent times.

JAMES A PATERSON

James A Paterson was appointed to the vacant Professional position in 1953 and served the Club in that role until 1972. Prior to his appointment members seeking professional instruction were accommodated by A J (Bronco) Branch who owned the Sports Store in Central Tauranga still known as Broncos. Bronco was never attached to the Club but was authorised to give lessons and provide equipment to any member requiring assistance.

Jim was born in England where his father was a Professional who had learned his trade in a region where Harry Vardon, one of the greatest players of all time, was located. Vardon had an enormous influence on the game throughout Britain and in the United States where his barnstorming tours in the company of fellow Jersey Islander Ted Ray were instrumental in introducing millions of Americans to the game in the early years of the Twentieth Century. The golfer of today may not recognise that when he or she locks the ‘pinkie’ of their top hand over the forefinger of their bottom hand in gripping the club they are adopting the ‘Vardon’ grip, introduced to the game by this great player and teacher and now used almost universally. An older generation of players would have been told early in their golfing education that it was essential that they adopt the ‘Vardon’ grip. Harry Vardon was to influence the senior Paterson and inevitably much of Vardon’s method and philosophy of golf was transferred to the younger Paterson in his teaching. Few, if any, Professionals at that time could expect to make a living from tournament golf so when Jim joined the Professional ranks it was as an apprentice learning the trade. There was time to compete in some of the tournaments that were held and Jim had the thrill and the honour of winning the Dutch Open on one momentous occasion.

Another great English player with whom Jim had some association was Henry Cotton. Henry was the man who restored British golfing pride by winning the British Open for Britain after Americans had dominated the famous championship for many years. The popular Dunlop 65 golf ball that many older players will recall having played in earlier days was named for the 65 Henry posted in that famous victory. Cotton was resident in the same area of England and Jim met him in tournaments and on other occasions. One story Jim told was of playing in a tournament where no local rule had been posted to allow free relief for an embedded ball on the green or anywhere else for that matter, the embedded ball rule having not then been added to the Rule Book. Henry Cotton, having requested and been denied relief for a ball so embedded on the second green, proceeded to play a wedge stroke resulting in a large divot being removed from the green. A local rule was promptly introduced and soon afterward the Rule Book was amended to allow relief for a ball embedded both on, and through, the green.

After learning his trade in England Jim came to New Zealand to take up the resident Professional's position with the Wanganui Golf Club at their Belmont course. A few years later some of our members made a trip to Wanganui where they met Jim and, being impressed with his personality and teaching skills, encouraged him to apply for the position at Tauranga. This Jim did and soon he and Barbara and their two sons were on their way North. Some years later twin daughters were born to the couple.

When Jim settled into his new role at Tauranga he found the available facilities to be rather less adequate than those that prevail today. The Pro Shop was located downstairs in the Clubhouse adjacent to the Ladies' locker room. When the new Pro Shop was opened beside the first tee the Ladies Locker Room was expanded to fill the space it now occupies. Both the Professional and the Lady members were relieved to leave behind the cramped accommodation they had been forced to share for so long.
While some members found that Jim's quiet manner and distinctive accent made it hard for them to grasp the skill concepts he was endeavouring to pass on to them others reacted very positively to his teaching. There is little doubt that his own swing was one that would serve as an ideal model for any aspiring player. One of the best lessons an observant player can have is to watch a really good golfing stylist practice. The easy rhythm, the perfect timing and the understated power tend to find their way into the observer's own practice sessions. Jim Paterson was a very good example of a player to study in that context. His iron shots in particular had a special quality about them. The ball would start out low then climb higher towards the end of its flight before dropping quietly to the green. Unfortunately Jim's tournament play was plagued by a nervous system that frequently did not allow him to demonstrate his true ability. In spite of that he was competitive, often finishing near the head of the field amongst those Professionals competing in New Zealand at the time. On the basis of those performances he was selected to represent New Zealand in the two-man Canada Cup team. This was the forerunner of the present day World Cup.

Employment as a Club Professional has seldom been a lucrative career in New Zealand. When Jim took over the post in Tauranga the vast majority of players were of a generation that had lived through the depression years as well as the Second World War. As a result they were cautious in their spending habits and few people in the town would have been considered wealthy in any case. To help the family income Barbara worked at Hartleys on the Strand. When Barbara died at a relatively early age some of Jim's motivation seemed to desert him and it perhaps came as some relief to him when the committee decided it was time to seek another to fill his position.
Throughout his twenty years at the Club Jim served loyally and with cheerful dignity. He assisted with work on the course when required over the summer months and was ever willing to assist in other areas when the need arose.

GREG HOLST

G T (Greg) Holst took up the position of Professional to the Tauranga Club in November 1972. Greg made a strong impression on the subcommittee that interviewed candidates on that occasion. It would be fair to say that Greg was the outsider in a strong field of four who were short listed for the position, his short listing probably justified by the fact that no one on the committee seemed to know much about

him. At interview he sold himself very well indeed moving to the top of the prospects as a result of the energy, enthusiasm, and progressive ideas he believed he could bring to the job.

Greg completed his schooling at St. Kentigen's College in Auckland before signing on with a Scottish professional, Graham Gordon at the old Remuera Golf Club. On completing the apprenticeship he played the Australian Professional circuit for four years with no more than moderate success. The great Australian player and noted teacher Norman von Nida coached Greg for a period at that time.

Having never quite achieved the promise the selection committee saw in him Greg returned to Australia in 1980 to open a Sporting Goods Store, later returning across the Tasman again to take up a position with the Mount Maunganui Golf Club. He now holds the position of Professional with the Carrington Golf Club in Northland.

During his time at Tauranga Kevin Wiltshire, one of three brothers who graced our junior ranks served an apprenticeship with Greg before going on to a successful career as Professional to the Ngaruawahia Golf Club.

ALLAN SNAPE

A P (Allan) Snape was appointed to the position in 1980. Allan was very promising at a range of sports during his school days in New South Wales during which time he played at representative level in rugby, cricket, tennis, athletics, and golf. This was at a time when boys were less inclined to specialise in one sport at the expense of all else. Many would argue that the former practise tended to produce more rounded individuals than is often the case today. On leaving school Allan attended Business College where he gained an excellent grounding in salesmanship and general management skills. These were to serve him well as these are the areas that often let down those who serve as Club Professionals. For nine years the Australian Golf Company PGF employed Allan. In those years he gained invaluable insight into the finer points of Golf equipment.

A two-year working holiday to the United Kingdom and Europe followed in 1966. In the UK Allan won a prestigious Amateur tournament called the Mosely Golf Open before returning to New South Wales where he gained representative honours and won a number of tournaments including an Australian Foursomes title.

A member, who had best not be named, hooked one onto the road off the 14th tee. The club 'slipped from his grip' in his words and followed the ball out onto the road where it struck and broke the windscreen of a passing Holden. This created a difficult situation that required a good deal of diplomacy to keep a 'Cap' on possible recriminations. The same 14th tee has been the scene of several incidents including a serious one when an errant club lodged over the power lines beside the road causing a short circuit and bringing down a line. A certain ex member of the Greens staff remained subdued for some time after that incident.

In 1969 Allan got on a ship to visit relatives in New Zealand and has been in this country ever since. He immediately hit the headlines in New Zealand winning five important Amateur titles in that first year. His only failure came in a semi-final loss to Ted McDougall in the New Zealand Amateur Championship. These successes encouraged him to try the Professional game. Consequently he served a 12-month trainee period as required in order to gain entry to the NZPGA. In 1971 Allan played with moderate success in Asia and Europe. The highlight of this trip came when Allan played in, and made the cut, in the Centennial British Open.

Allan married in 1971 and held down two jobs while trying to play in as many tournaments as possible, managing to win some 14 Pro-Ams along the way. Success in the New Zealand Club Pro Championship came on two occasions.

The pressures of this life while supporting a family of three children proved too much and, in 1978, Allan accepted the professional position at the Flaxmere Club in Hawkes Bay. Though Flaxmere proved an enjoyable experience Tauranga appeared to offer better prospects and Allan took up the position here in 1980. Disaster struck in 1986 when a major fire swept through the Pro Shop and Trundler Shed destroying the shop and stock, together with some 256 sets of members clubs. The Club held a special golf day raising substantial revenue that was presented to the Snape family to help Allan get re-established.

In 1988 Allan resigned his Tauranga position and became attached to both Omanu and the Western Bay (Omokoroa) Clubs. He also established a coaching circuit through the Coromandel, setting up shop at Whangamata through holiday periods. Allan was instrumental in getting the Golf Range developed off the end of the Omanu course. This was a private undertaking involving some business partners of Allan's.

Some years later Allan was diagnosed with Prostate cancer. This ultimately spread to his spine. Despite this Allan determined to get back to playing golf as soon as possible. Sheer determination saw him graduate from walking with a frame, to doing so with two sticks, then unaided. Eventually he was able to stand to hit a few balls. Finally he managed to play 18 holes, even carrying a light bag to do so. By the end of 2009 deterioration of the spine was so bad that Allan lost the strength to remain on his feet and life in a wheelchair became the only option. This was a sad final phase in the life of a talented sportsman who never lost his zest for life.

Jeff Macnab must hold the record for holes in one scored on our course. During his years as a member Jeff scored five of his seven lifetime aces on our course. An excellent golfer who played representative golf at Provincial level Jeff learned to play in Scotland so he was well equipped to handle those windy days that severely test most players. Jeff may well have become known as the peripatetic golfer as he was at various times a member of Omokoroa, Omanu, and Mt Maunganui Golf Clubs in addition to his membership at Tauranga. Jeff served several years as a member of our committee during the Eighties including a term as Vice-Captain.

RICK BARKER

Rick began his golfing life in Northland at the age of ten when he became a junior member of the Helensville District Golf Club. He recalled being the only junior member at that time, an era when clubs were less welcoming of juniors than is now the case. The junior subscription at Helensville of just 10/- was no indication that juniors were unwelcome at that club however.

Rick won his first open senior event when just 14 years of age and, by age 16, was winning 72-hole open events against opposition much older and more experienced than himself. Rick's first success at this level was a victory in the Kaipara Open where he headed a former NZ representative and National amateur champion in Bruce Stevens. At the under 18 NZ Boys' Championship he finished in second place.

At Provincial level Rick represented Northland in the Garrard Shield and Freyberg Rosebowl teams of 1975 and 76, and the Auckland Garrard Shield team in the following two years. His amateur career peaked in 1975 when he annexed the NZ Stroke Play Championship and was leading amateur in the NZ Open. Partnered with Phil Reid, Rick won the NZ Foresomes title of 1976 and later in the tournament he was beaten in the NZ Amateur Plate final.

Rick joined the Professional ranks in 1978 and won his first event, the Waikato PGA Championship, the following year. Rick then tried his luck on the Australian circuit with little success though he did manage a win in a small Pro-Am at Royal Melbourne. Following on from his Waikato PGA win in 1979 Rick won over 40 Pro-Am events throughout New Zealand and the Pacific Islands over the following eight years.

Highlights of Rick's professional career included:

- Third place in the NZ PGA Championship,
- Second place in the American Samoa Open,
- Third place in the Tahiti Open,
- Third place in the Pacific Harbour Open,
- Third place in the Raratongan Open,
- Winner of the 84-hole Fijian Hotel Pro-Am.

On another occasion Rick was credited with the lowest round scored in the NZ Open of that year.

By 1986 Rick had decided that he had probably gone as far as he could as a Tournament Professional and he accepted the job as resident professional at the small Otumoetai Club in Tauranga. Two years later the Tauranga position became available when Alan Snape moved to Omanu and Rick was appointed to the job. For some years he maintained the shop at Otumoetai while serving full time at Tauranga.

In 2006 the Club upgraded the shop and, in conjunction with that, the Board revised the role of the Professional so that it would include extended participation in the activities of the club and its membership. Rick did not feel he wished to be involved in this extended role and did not apply for a renewal of his contract. Consequently he completed his service as the Club's professional in 2006 to go into an unrelated business.

JAY CARTER AND GOLF FUSION

Jay began as a junior at the Tauranga Club while still a schoolboy. He developed into a player of considerable promise and, upon leaving school, spent time in Wellington developing his game as a full time student under Mal Tongue. When the Professional contract was up for renewal at Tauranga Jay and his father decided to put in an application to run the business. The Board had made it a priority to upgrade the Pro Shop and now advertised a contract to operate the business. This contract extended the role of the Professional to an extent that had not previously been envisaged.

When the contract was awarded to the Carter team Jay was not then a member of the PGA. In order for him to become a member it was required that he serve his time under a full member. Doug Milne, previously Professional to the Whakatane Golf Club was therefore employed as the PGA Professional. This arrangement remained in place until Jay graduated to full membership of the PGA.

Members were soon able to appreciate the new services introduced by Golf Fusion as the business is known. A fleet of new Golf Carts arrived and were available for hire by members and visitors alike, the new look Pro Shop was soon stocked with a wide range of equipment, lessons were readily available, junior clinics were developed, and the Pro Shop staff acted as starters to get the field efficiently on its way. Buckets of practice balls were made available for use on the Driving Range and later the Card Issuing machine was located in the Pro Shop for easy access by members. Staff would even accept bookings and cancellations as part of the service offered. Manufacturer demonstrations became a regular feature of the service and many a member took the opportunity to try out new clubs to see what these might do for their game.

The story of Jay Carter and Golf Fusion is still unfolding at time of writing though there is no doubt the concept has changed the nature of the services offered to our members.

Playing to your age is an achievement any golfer would be proud of. This feat is becoming more common as more players live on into their older years in robust good health. Prominent members of our Veterans Society, Pat Kendall and Clive Sheerin, maintained quite a competition between themselves as they seemingly vied to outdo the other in adding to their total number of rounds to, or under, their age. Neither of these redoubtable proponents of the game however was able to match the feat of another of the Society, George Reilly. George must have established the record for our Club as the youngest to achieve the feat when he returned a 67 at that age.

Peg Copestake, to the best of our knowledge remains the only woman member to have achieved the feat.

Junior golfers are now given every encouragement to participate from an early age. It was not always so. Many older members, especially male members, made early pioneers in this category less than welcome. Junior girls were even fewer in number than were the boys so the reaction the ladies may have had to them is difficult to assess. We suspect it would have been very supportive. During the Fifties Michael Cambie and Robert Mowat qualified for the Club championships only to draw objections from their seniors who claimed that as these two schoolboys did not pay full senior subscriptions they could not be eligible for such competitions. Jimmy Mowat and others took up the cudgels on behalf of the boys and eventually their arguments were upheld allowing the boys to participate.

James Mowat demonstrates the swing and golfing attire of an earlier generation.

Rick Barker with Manager Aylene MacGregor and Secretary Jeanette Acott

SPORT

75th Anniversary for golfers

THE Tauranga Golf Club celebrates its 75th anniversary this year with a series of functions being held over Queens Birthday Weekend.

The club has developed from a handful of members who played over a nine hole course extending from the present Tauranga Domain to Sulphur Point, to a club of almost 1000 members with a modern clubhouse and a fine 18-hole course at Gate Pa.

As the club grew in numbers it saw the need for an attached golf professional and in 1936 James Mowat was appointed.

Born in Montrose, Scotland in 1895, Mowat served in the Highland Light Infantry in World War I. He then went to the United States where he spent 10 years as assistant to a golf course architect.

In the early 1930s he came to New Zealand and was appointed as professional to the Poverty Bay club. Following a chance meeting in Rotorua he was invited to try his luck with the Tauranga club.

Some of the older members still recall his method of tuition, specially his technique for bunker play.

The course was virtually closed down during the Second World War and Mowat regained his amateur status, becoming an active club member, a committee member and an active organiser of veterans tournaments.

His late wife Margaret and his family have all been well-known members of the Tauranga club. One son, David, is a past president; another, Robert a past senior champion; and his daughter Jean (White) equally prominent in the women's section.

Shop lessons

In the years immediately following the war there was no official appointment as club professional but Bronco Branch, who owned a sports shop in town, was authorised to give lessons in his shop and on the course and many current players started their golf careers with his instruction.

The 'Bronco' swing, with a visible pause at the top, can till be seen on the course.

In 1954, Jim Paterson, then professional at Belmont, Wanganui, was appointed to Tauranga.

Paterson had served his apprenticesip with his father, another Scot, at Hastings in Sussex.

While filling the role of professional at a couple of clubs in England he also played the tournament circuit, proving financially successful.

He then decided to try his luck in New Zealand.

Tauranga members will remember the large gallery which watched, in 1960, his exhibition match with Kel Nagle, then the British Open Champion. The match finished all square, both scoring 68s.

Exhibition

In 1961 he played an exhibition match with Bob Charles, Charles winning 2 and 1 and later, in another exhibition match with Billy Casper. Casper, without having seen the course, went around in 65.

Paterson retired in 1972 and still plays regularly at the club.

Greg Holst was appointed professional in 1973 coming from a teaching position at the Cronulla club in Sydney.

He had been playing golf for 19 years, turning professional in 1964 and proving successful on the Australian pro-am circuit.

He eventually returned to Australia and was replaced by another golfer from Australia, Allan Snape.

A natural athlete, Snape played cricket for New South Wales and was vice-captain of the under-21 team when Doug Walters was captain.

Tennis

He also played A grade tennis, with tournament successes at provincial and national level.

Snape began playing golf in 1959 and in 1960 was Combined High Schools' champion, and junior champion of The Lakes in Sydney every year from 1962-65.

In the next few years he won 15 different tournaments.

Snape turned professional in 1971 and played in the tournament circuit in the Far East and Europe.

In the British Open at Birkdale he was among the leaders until the 'fatal' last round.

Coming to New Zealand in 1978 he was appointed professional at the Flaxmere Club in Hastings and, more recently, he accepted an offer to come to Tauranga.

He is sought after as a teacher by many of the country's leading players and, because of his excellent manner and friendly disposition, he has made many friends.

Special competitions will be held at the Tauranga club on Saturday and Sunday, as will social functions on Friday, Saturday and Monday, to celebrate the 75th anniversary of the club.

HOLST . . . formerly of Cronulla

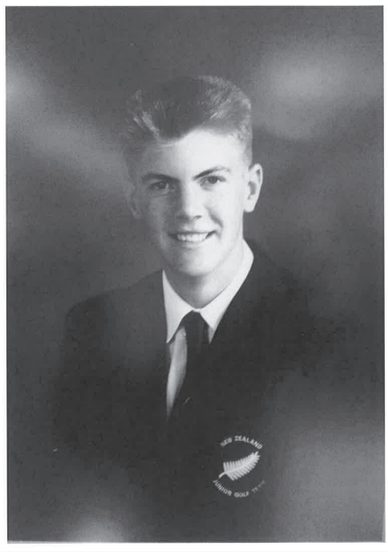
Greg Holst joined us from the Cronulla Club in Sydney.

PATERSON . . . exhibition matches

James Paterson demonstrates the classic English swing.

SNAPE . . . sought after as a teacher

Alan Snape - a gifted all-round sportsman



Jay Carter - a local lad who has become a talented teacher.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

GREENKEEPING

There could be no more important function in the management of a golf club than that of ensuring that the physical environment should satisfy the aspirations of the majority of members. As all who have sat in a clubhouse for any length of time will realise it is very difficult to achieve that end. The “experts” who are eager to inform all who will listen as to what is wrong with the way the course is managed are legion. In spite of this, and in spite of the difficulties presented through lack of surplus funding to achieve all that might be desired, conditions on the majority of New Zealand courses are remarkably good. In this regard Tauranga is no exception and it is probably true that members have enjoyed above average conditions compared to those prevailing elsewhere in New Zealand throughout most of our history.

In the early years green keeping was very much a matter of keeping the grass growing and regularly mown. The machinery used to achieve this was not specifically designed for golf course work with the result that greens tended to be well-grassed but slow, fairways weedy and stalky, the rough long, thick and difficult. Bunkers, where they existed, were generally unkempt and highly variable in playing characteristics. On many courses greens were mown just once a week, usually on a Friday ready for the weekend play.

While Mr Coles, Mr Reeves, and other early members of staff did a very good job with the equipment and knowledge they had at the time it was not until the appointment of Grant Silvester in 1951 that Tauranga Golf Club entered the modern era of scientific Golf Course Management. That aspect of our history, and the history of Golf Course Management in New Zealand is best presented by detailing Grant’s career in the service of the Club.

GRANT SILVESTER

Grant Silvester took over the role of head greenkeeper in 1951 and remained in the role for a further 21 years. Up until that time the role had been seen more as that of a grass cutter and general labourer than that of a manager of fine turf. The work of Sir Bruce Levy, Ernie Madden, and others, which ultimately led to the publication, in 1949, of the booklet, “The Construction, Care and renovation of the Golf Course” marked the beginning of a new era in turf culture. It is to the great credit of Grant Silvester that he very quickly recognised the value of the research that had been done, and continues to be done, through the work of the New Zealand Institute of Turf Culture. Coming to the job with no preconceived ideas Grant proved the right man in the right place at the right time. Prior to the work of Levy and his associates well meaning farmers and others had dominated Greens Committees. These men promoted grass growth through the use of lime and superphosphate, as they would have done in growing pasture. This proved to be the antithesis of what was required and greens throughout the country suffered from a host of deficiencies until staff and administrators gradually began to adopt the “acid theory” of fine turf culture identified through the research. It was the beginning of a movement that would see rapid improvement in playing conditions on courses throughout New Zealand and it is to Grant Silvester and the members of the Greens committees of the time that we owe gratitude for ensuring that Tauranga Golf Club was in the vanguard of that movement.

Obviously not everyone accepted the new philosophy of turf management and there were many 'clubhouse experts' who disagreed very vocally with what was being put into practice. Nothing has really changed has it? In desperation Grant agreed to let some of these 'expert' grass growers put their theories into practice. The seventeenth green was divided into four quarters, three of which were allocated to different theorists, the fourth remaining under Grant's management. Within less than twelve months the three sections under amateur control showed poor grass cover, disease, a muddy surface, and other undesirable features. That under professional management exhibited good grass cover with healthy colour and appearance and a good putting surface. The 'experts' were silenced, at least temporarily. Unfortunately there was an ongoing downside to the experiment as, for some years to follow, one could look down upon the green from the 'Knoll' and distinguish the four separate sections. Members had to endure varied conditions on the green for quite a lengthy period.

Grant Silvester was brought up on a small farm overlooking the Waimapu estuary and caught many a flounder there. Upon leaving home he set up an orchard and glasshouse property on the part of Courtney Road now known as 22nd Avenue. It was his neighbour Jimmy Mowat who suggested to Grant that he would be ideally suited to the Greenkeeper role that had become available at the Club. After ensuring that he would have some flexibility in meeting the demands of both his orchard and the greenkeeper role Grant accepted the job with some trepidation. He accepted that he had all the practical skills required but he had no experience of golf, golfers, or the special requirements of sports turf. Having accepted the challenge he took it upon himself to gain the necessary knowledge as quickly as possible. In doing so he became the first at Tauranga, and amongst the first Nationally, to recognise the value of the research done on turf culture. Encouraged by Alan Davidson, Jimmy Mowat and others, Grant visited other clubs to study their methods. He went to greenkeepers' conferences, often accompanied by Greens Committee Chairman Alan Davidson, and in time became recognised as a man other greenkeepers could approach for advice in the knowledge that they would 'get the right oil'.

Equipment in Grant's tenure was basic to say the least. Essentially it consisted of a set of gang mowers towed behind the versatile Ferguson tractor, a set of Overgreen mowers behind which the operator would walk, and an Attco hand mower used to mow tight spots such as the edges of bunkers. An old model T Ford with a small tray served a great variety of transport requirements. This Model T had to be started with a crank handle though it was extremely reliable and generally started easily even on frosty mornings. When required Grant would bring his own Gravely tractor from his home property. The Gravely was a very versatile machine to which could be attached a number of implements including a rotary hoe, a sickle bar mower, and a rotary mower. Later Grant developed a rotary broom to sweep cores into rows for easy removal from the greens. He also adapted an old Morrison lawn mower as a grooving machine for use on the greens.

In spite of this paucity of equipment and the fact that the Green Staff consisted of the Head Greenkeeper and just one assistant the course was kept in very good order throughout the year. Initially there were significant areas of deep rough which were mown with the sickle bar mower just two or three times a year. One such area was the ridge between the first and second fairways, another along the left of the seventh. A ball in such an area was often unable to be found. Later the course began to be mown from

boundary to boundary and the rough became restricted to small isolated areas.

Towards the end of Grant's time at the Club he became more and more proprietorial toward the course. It was almost as though it was his private park and to some extent he resented the golfers who came daily to make a mess of it by chopping up the fairways, walking their trundlers too close to the greens and tees, and otherwise making a nuisance of themselves. There are still those of us at the club who would not dream of taking a trundler across a tee, or close to a green for fear of provoking a roar of wrath from the ghost of a greenkeeper past. One could understand Grant's feeling that the course belonged to him as there can be no doubt that Grant Silvester put his heart and soul into producing the course in the best possible condition day by day, month by month, year by year, throughout his many years in the job. His signature remains to this day as so many of the tees, greens, bunkers, and other features of the course were reformed or developed during his tenure. He brought the course into a new age and laid the foundation for much that has followed.

Grant left the Club to take on the role of Superintendent of Parks and Reserves for the Western Bay of Plenty District Council and later, with his wife Faye, retired to live in Mangonui, North Auckland, where he continued his love of fishing.

THE POST SILVESTER YEARS

Les Hill replaced Grant in 1973 and was able to maintain the rate of course improvement that members had become accustomed to. Golf Course maintenance is like so many other aspects of life: unless you strive for improvement it seems you are doomed to go backwards. Les was enticed to join us from Rotorua by the offer of a salary of $3900 and the prospect of accommodation in a house owned by the Club. This house was located at 1368 Cameron Road almost directly opposite the entrance to the Racecourse Reserve and Mr. Hill took up residence there that year. To finance the purchase of this house the Club sold the section they owned off Hynd's Road behind the Substation.

Les Hill was an excellent Greenkeeper, well versed in the modern concepts of Turf Management. During his tenure the course was well maintained and was further improved under his guidance. Unfortunately he pushed himself too hard in attempting to get as much done as possible. He virtually ran around the course and this self-imposed pressure could not be sustained indefinitely. In 1978 Les took up an appointment with the Pukekohe Club where he continued to produce playing conditions of which he could justifiably be proud.

Following a period during which a number of employees served short terms in charge of the course Alan Martin was enticed from Mt. Denby, the Whangarei headquarters of the Northland Golf Club. One of our members played Mt. Denby subsequent to this appointment and, upon mentioning that we now had Alan in charge of our course, the laconic response from the Mt. Denby member was to the effect that "we would now enjoy some excellent paths on our course."

Grant Patterson was appointed in 1980. Grant was a New Zealander who had been working in Australia for some years where he had considerable experience in developing golf courses from scratch. Interestingly one of his reasons for wishing to move back to New Zealand was so his children could

attend school here. He felt the New Zealand education system was superior to that in Australia. It is almost certainly true that the membership in general did not give Grant the credit his abilities deserved. When he began his time at Tauranga he inherited a course that, despite the best intentions of those involved, had not experienced the level of professional care that had prevailed during the Silvester/Hill period. Consequently the greens were suffering from gross mineral deficiency, the turf was weak and readily susceptible to disease, and the general state of the course was well below that which should have prevailed at the time. No Course Superintendent could have been expected to rectify those conditions over night. Grant Patterson was no exception though the evidence at the time suggested he took the correct steps to get course management back onto a sound foundation. By the time he resigned to move back to Australia in 1985 it was clear that the course was well on the road to recovery.

The next significant appointment was that of Murray Clark in 1995. Murray had been in charge of the Poverty Bay Golf Club's Awapuni course in Gisborne. Not long before he moved north he had been responsible for preparing that course for the Freyberg Rosebowl as the Inter-provincial Men's Team Championship was then known. During that tournament the Awapuni greens were given unusually high praise for their exceptionally good condition. I had the pleasure of playing them the week before the tournament and can truthfully say I have never experienced better greens. They were fast and very true. Some of those who were players or spectators during the tournament afterwards vouched for the extremely high standard of putting those greens promoted. Clearly Murray knew what was required to produce greens of that quality. Awapuni is near the coast and so is natural sand country that is ideal for the promotion of the fine turf grasses best suited to golf greens. Tauranga posed a different challenge, one that Murray proved, over the next few years, well able to meet. In his favour an excellent team of assistants aided him. The needs of the Club had by this time built up to the stage where it was considered that four full time assistants were required in order to groom the course to the higher standard now considered appropriate. Naturally there were members who believed this to be an unnecessarily high number but if the Club wished to satisfy the more exacting demands of the modern player then there was little choice but to supply the manpower to do the job. In contrast to earlier, more relaxed times, when greens were mowed twice weekly, fairways mowed boundary to boundary, and bunkers given an occasional tidy up, greens were now required to be mown daily, fairways contoured and more frequently mown, and bunkers and surrounds manicured regularly. All of this is labour intensive and the staff must attempt to fit everything in and around people playing the course. Collectively somewhere in the vicinity of 1000 rounds are played each week of the year.

By 2002 Murray Clark began to feel he would like to relinquish some of the responsibility he then held and an agreement was reached whereby he would step down to an assistant role if the Club were able to attract a suitably qualified Course Supervisor. An outstanding young candidate in Brendan Allen applied for the position and was duly appointed. An old student of Tauranga Boys' College, Brendan had almost completed a Business Studies degree at Waikato University when he decided he preferred the idea of an outdoor life and joined the staff of the Hamilton Golf Club at their St. Andrews course. On completing an apprenticeship there he moved to become second in charge at the Russley Golf Club in Christchurch where he experienced quite different climatic and soil conditions thus broadening his experience and knowledge.

During the few short years Brendan spent as Course Supervisor at Tauranga he made a tremendous impact on all those with whom he was associated. Not only did he bring a wealth of experience disproportionate to his years, he introduced fresh ideas and methods that continued to influence course conditions and policy long after his departure. Whilst the Club administration would dearly have loved to retain Brendan's services they were unable to compete with the resources available to the Auckland Golf Club of Middlemore who soon became aware of Brendan's outstanding ability and made him "an offer he couldn't refuse". We could only wish him well and lament that we had not been able to enjoy the benefit of his expertise over a much longer period. It will be surprising if Brendan does not have a lasting impact on green keeping practise throughout the country.

In 2006 Graeme Duncan was appointed to fill the role vacated by Brendan. Graeme came to us from the home of Golf, Scotland, via Inglewood Golf Club in Taranaki. This was the same club from which we recruited Royce Lahood, a man who contributed so much to our Club while serving in the capacity of Manager from 1970 to 1983. Graeme demonstrated early in his tenure that he had clear ideas on how he wanted the course to develop under his methods and simply got on with the task of achieving those objectives. Again conditions are different here to those in Taranaki or in Scotland. None the less the principles of growing fine turf and maintaining it over extended periods do not differ markedly from place to place. As Graeme became familiar with the subtle environmental differences of our course that need to be taken into account he grew confidently into the job and soon produced course conditions right up to the expectations of the majority of members. Perhaps he will be most remembered for his bunker construction. While the reconstruction of the bunker fronting the Knoll has added greatly to the frustrations so many of our members experience when playing that hole there is nothing inherently wrong with the bunker or its construction. Any perceived problem really lies in the inadequacy of our techniques to deal with genuine hazards. Shallow bunkers with low lips, as are common on New Zealand courses, hardly constitute hazards.

The first trial of sand imported from outside the course for use in bunkers was made in 1956 when one truckload of river sand was purchased. It was not until 1963 that Papamoa beach sand was finally used in bunkers throughout the course thus relegating the fine pumice previously used to history. It was definitely an improvement though the pumice, when dry and fluffy, had been excellent to play from. Unfortunately it did not remain in that state for long. Sanding of greens was considered over many years before it was finally introduced. Grant Silvester and others had observed that those areas of the greens where players had spread sand when recovering from bunkers appeared to offer a better environment to Browntop and Chewings Fescue than did other parts of the green. Bruce Levy and his associates had proven the value of sanding on the Hokowhitu greens but would it confer the same benefits under our very different soil and climatic conditions? Michael Nicholson was probably the man who did most to push for the introduction of sanding on our greens. A member of the Greens Committee from 1985 to 1993 Michael had seen the value of incorporating sand into the greens on courses he played at Provincial and International level, both in New Zealand and Overseas. There was plenty of opposition however. The Club had received a report from the New Zealand Institute of Turf Culture advising that the technique would not be suitable on our greens. This was backed up by Les Hill who applied for his old job at Tauranga when Alan Martin resigned. At interview Les commented: "we would

be wasting our time to sand greens at Tauranga". In spite of these and other objections Michael, then Chairman of the Greens Committee, finally got the OK from the committee to proceed with a sanding program. Surprisingly this was not to be a trial using the putting green, or some other area, for a year or two to prove the worth or otherwise of the program. The risky approach of committing all the greens to the program was instead embarked upon from the beginning. Fortunately the doubters were soon proven to be wrong and the program was here to stay with obvious on-going advantage to the course and its members.

Sports Turf preparation is both an Art and a Science. Those charged with that preparation make decisions that prove advantageous at some times and not at others. Tauranga Golf Club has been fortunate that the long-term trend resulting from the totality of decisions reached has been one of steady improvement to the general benefit of both present and future members. The decision to sand greens, the installation of an adequate irrigation system, the establishment of Windsor Green fairways, and the instigation of daily mowing of greens have been amongst the most significant decisions made by the Club during its first one hundred years. While each has been made in the face of opposition, each has proven to be of enormous benefit. In March 1984 it was reported that the greens were being mown four days per week. This was a clear improvement on the twice a week schedule that had prevailed for many years. It was considered that Saturday morning mowing would be beneficial but the cost at $60 per time, or $3000 per year, was prohibitive. Sunday morning mowing would be even more costly. It was not until the 1980s that daily mowing, including weekends, was instituted. The availability of better machinery allowed this to be completed quickly and efficiently. No one would have contemplated such a program in the days of the Over-green mowers when the operator walked behind the machine.

Throughout our history there have been those who disagree with the way our course has been managed. It may be difficult to appreciate that fine turf greens cannot be kept in 'tournament condition' 52 weeks of the year. The courses the Professionals play on the USA and European PGA Tours are brought to a peak for those events. This process may take place over several months. It is the same for the major events we stage. Turf grasses do not respond well to constant close mowing and rolling but this is what is required to produce tournament greens that are fast and true. The Greens Supervisor must temper the desire of members to experience 'tournament conditions' on a regular basis with the need to protect the health of the greens throughout the year. Sadly some Club officials over the years have not appreciated this and have agitated for conditions that are simply unsustainable. Should such views ever prevail the long term consequences would be serious indeed.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

WATER SUPPLY

The problem of obtaining adequate water at reasonable cost exercised the minds of successive Greens Committees over many years. The first supply was sourced from the Borough Council and was piped from Cameron Road and then pumped around the course from a small pump shed located behind the 11th tee. There was no storage tank so pressure depended upon the demands placed on the Borough supply by householders. The pipe system did not reach as far as the greens at the southern end of the course so they tended to deteriorate badly in the hot dry days of summer. The sprinklers were of the garden variety fed by hoses attached to taps near the green margins. Consequently they required shifting two or three times in order to cover the entire green. Daytime watering was unpopular with members but a necessary evil. Grant Silvester was especially diligent in watering at night whenever practicable even though this meant he had to drive to the course at inconvenient times through the night in order to move sprinklers.

In 1963 the possibility of obtaining water from the Kopurereroa stream, which runs in close proximity to the western boundary of the Reserve, was first investigated. This concept was deferred indefinitely as it was considered to be a much more expensive option than continuing to utilise the Council supply. However the cost of Council water soon began to rise and it became once again imperative to seek a more permanent solution to the supply problem. In 1970 Brown Brothers from the Waikato were commissioned to investigate the prospect of obtaining water from a bore and promising sites were located near the stables on the 11th and to the west of the first tee. It was decided to sink a bore at the latter site and this initially produced adequate supplies from a depth of some 45m. In July 1971 the Club minutes record that a quote had been obtained to extend the reticulation system to cover all greens at a cost of $5000 while another $12 000 was to be spent on the bore, deep well pump, motor and accessories. This work was proceeded with by utilising a $16 000 loan from the ANZ Bank which was guaranteed by a group of members. The terms of repayment were that $4000 was to be repaid in the first year, followed by a minimum of $1333 per year for nine years. The interest rate was fixed at 7.5%. The completed system was still very basic and still involved placing and shifting sprinklers while the teeing grounds were not yet part of the network. Furthermore the flow from the bore gradually diminished and even though the present reservoir was constructed nearby it soon became apparent that the supply was never going to keep up with the demand. Forced to look elsewhere the committee again investigated piping water from the Kopurereroa stream. Fortunately the water quality was found to be appropriate for turf irrigation and the Club was granted a Water Right. Today water can be pumped from the stream to the 100,000-gallon reservoir at the rate of 7500 gallons per hour. Initially it was planned to have a smaller reservoir but when Royce Lahood contacted the Boys' College Mathematics department to check the dimensions required he decided that adding an extra metre to the quoted radius would add little to the cost and be on the "safe side". Little did Royce know what an enormous difference that 1m would make to the capacity of the reservoir but in hindsight it was a serendipitous decision on his part as the modern reticulation system the course now boasts is required to pump out a great volume of water when performing at full capacity.

The next development came in 1978 when after a long negotiation a new long-term lease was arranged with the Commissioner of Crown Lands. With renewed confidence in their long term tenancy the Club approved the expenditure of $48,000 to install full water reticulation to all tees and greens, including

automatic sprinklers. Again the ANZ Bank approved the required finance, granting the Club another ten-year term loan to complete the project. The system was installed under the direction of a club member who, though a qualified Civil Engineer, was neither experienced nor expert in the field of water reticulation. The Club were later to learn to their regret that designing and installing a reticulation system is a job for a specialist in the field. For the next 17 years the Greens staff did their best with a system that proved more and more unreliable until it became obvious that the Club would never achieve the standard of course presentation they desired unless they “grasped the nettle” and replaced the system with a modern, professionally designed, reticulation network incorporating top quality components.

Subsequently the Greens Committee submitted a proposal to the Club for the installation of just such a system by the company known as Northern Irrigation at a cost of $196 000. Approval was gained and the system completed in April 1995. It was wonderful to see the coverage of greens, tees and surrounds that eventuated when the system was first switched on and it was not long before the benefits to the turf could be seen. The water system had finally become a major tool in enabling the staff to achieve the ideal environment to suit the growth of quality sports turf. The cost of the system remained a burden to be carried by the membership for a number of years to follow but few would argue the decision to proceed was not a wise one. There were some problems encountered as more pressure was placed upon the system, the main one being one of “hammering” in the pipes where their laying had not been up to scratch in some areas. This resulted in some blowouts and leakage that frustrated staff and imposed upon their limited labour resources. Fortunately problems became less frequent as solutions were found. The problems that were encountered illustrated once again the fallacy of cutting corners when building something that is expected to perform reliably day-by-day, year-by-year. In this case the problems encountered were probably the result of using non-specialist labour for the actual installation

Will we be extending the watering system to include fairway watering in the future? It seems unlikely from this perspective. The cost of installation would be high but not insurmountable in a more affluent future. Of more concern would be the high cost of maintenance and the probable difficulty in obtaining

The Club is fortunate that incidents of interference through balls being stolen from fairways have been rare over the years but they do happen. On one occasion two visiting competitors in the 28-hole open Tournament had this happen to them on the 10th hole. Not knowing their rights under the rules they returned to the tee and played out the hole. They were of course entitled to replace the moved balls without penalty. The two strokes this cost them meant that one at least missed out on a high placing. Though the Match Committee was sympathetic to their plight there was nothing they could do to alter the outcome as they had ‘put another ball into play under Stroke and Distance’.

a sufficient quantity of water, a resource that will become increasingly scarce as Global warming and population pressures continue to develop. For these reasons the Board of Management, early this Century, initiated the development of “Windsor Green” fairways. The decision to do so was made in consultation with David Ormsby of the New Zealand Sports Turf Institute. Other Cynodon species were considered before the decision to go with Windsor Green was made. Properly managed this grass thrives under hot dry conditions without the need for any applied water. Windsor Green has obvious faults, chief of which is the period of dormancy it undergoes in winter. Even then it provides a very playable surface, something that could not be said of the drought stricken fairways encountered in many a previous summer. The wisdom of the policy to convert our fairways becomes more and more apparent as the years go by.

The first trial introduction of Windsor Green was made in 2000 when it was incorporated into the 11th and 13th fairways as a trial. The fairways were first sprayed with Roundup to eliminate all existing growth. The contracted supplier used a machine that simultaneously cut grooves, shredded the turf, and laid the shredded material in the grooves. This was an expensive exercise, the price to the contractor alone being $17 000, while our own staff spent many hours ensuring the implants had the best chance of survival. Conditions for growth that first summer were far from ideal with the result that those who were promoting the development of these new fairways had some anxious moments as the material struggled to become established. The doubters, of whom there were many, claimed the Executive had made a serious error of judgement. Fortunately conditions improved and a solid carpet of turf was finally achieved. That was not the end of the doubts however as the staff had to learn how to manage the new turf to achieve the best playing conditions and to ensure these were maintained through the growing season. Fortunately Brendan Allen was enthusiastic about the new turf and developed a management program that was successful in achieving these ends. Cynodon species, and Windsor Green in particular, have an extremely vigorous and robust growth form and require quite severe mechanical treatment to achieve ideal fairway conditions. This meant increased mowing while regular grooving had to be implemented in order to maintain turf vigour. These requirements increased the demands upon staff resources, a factor partially offset by lower needs for fairway watering.

It was Brendan’s belief that the groovings from established fairways could be used to spread the Windsor Green to other fairways. Consequently he piled up large stacks of these with the intention of trialling this technique. Unfortunately some members of the Board were not totally convinced that the policy of introducing Windsor Green throughout the fairways had yet proven to be the correct option for the future. While they debated the issue the stored material deteriorated and became useless much to Brendan’s disappointment. It was not until after Brendan’s departure that a trial was finally undertaken, the second fairway, and part of the sixth, being “seeded” with groovings in 2005. Though establishment was slow much was learnt from the trial and the final result was successful following a second season of growth.

In 2006 the remainder of the sixth fairway was planted. On this occasion the Pukekohe supplier delivered truckloads of turf that were then manually cut into narrow slices, an arduous job indeed. These slices were then fed by hand into grooves that had been previously cut into the fairway after the

existing fairway grasses had been eliminated with herbicide. Faced with a shortage of volunteers to perform this final task Manager Grant Scoones contacted local Backpacker Hostels and soon young people from many Countries including Austria, Argentina, Belgium, England, Scotland, Germany, and Italy joined the working group. These young men and women were keen to earn some cash and proved to be willing and diligent workers with the result that the job was completed within three days. While this method proved successful, and much was learnt that might have enabled subsequent plantings to be carried out more efficiently, there were obvious drawbacks. The turf alone cost $7000 while the labour requirement was very high. In view of these factors it was decided to continue the establishment program using our own material obtained by grooving our existing fairways. Unfortunately this has meant the program has progressed at the rate of just one fairway per year. At least this minimised the inconvenience to members caused by taking each treated fairway out of play for several months. The eighth and tenth fairways were successfully converted to Windsor Green in 2008 and 2009 respectively with minimum disruption to play as staff became more adept at handling this new technique. The program lapsed in 2010 before resuming in 2011 when a successful conversion of the 18th fairway was achieved. At this stage there was still much to be done to convert the remaining fairways.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

TREES

During the depression years of the Thirties then President Mr A J Mirrielees saw an opportunity to use the Government unemployed relief worker scheme to enhance the Golf Course environment through an extensive tree planting program. Ultimately many thousands of trees were planted as shelterbelts, strategic course components, and as purely ornamental trees. Mr Mirrielees worked with those trees that were available to him at the time and in general the selection and placement of these have stood the test of time. Over the years some specimens proved less than ideal and were removed and often replaced with more suitable varieties. Others have died, become diseased, or been damaged or blown over by the strong winds that sometimes sweep the area. Controversy has arisen over almost all moves to remove any particular tree and yet, once they have gone, they are soon forgotten and people wonder what the fuss was about.

The most cosseted tree on the course was perhaps the Japanese Weeping pine (Pinus patula), also known as the Waterfall pine, which once graced the ridge between the first and second fairways. The protective shelters erected around it were blown down, cows trampled it, rabbits burrowed under it, golfers occasionally struck it with ball or club, and mowers knocked bark off it. Despite all these setbacks it flourished and enhanced the ridge for many years until it finally lost a battle with the elements during a storm in 1979.

Bruce Burbery, Murray McDonald, and occasionally others of their friends were early "golf ball entrepreneurs" on the course. As youngsters they would find balls at various popular spots and offer them to members at 1/- for a good one. At this price Dunlop 65s and Spalding Hot Dots were keenly sought. The boys had to be on the alert for, should Grant Silvester sight them, he would chase them from the course, sometimes before they had time to take their prize finds with them. In time Bruce accumulated enough 1/- pieces to purchase a new Peter Thomson driver from Jim Paterson. Jim encouraged Bruce to try his new purchase on the first tee. Jim came out of his shop to watch, knowing that he might see something spectacular from the long hitting youngster. The first drive finished Pin high left, the next right. As Bruce prepared to hit a third Noel Hocken appeared from his office. "We do not allow more than two balls from the tees in practice" said Noel in his most formal and forbidding managerial manner. While Jim looked sheepishly the other way Bruce headed up the fairway to retrieve the balls and head to the second tee. Jim, guessing Bruce would not be able to resist the challenge of driving to the second green headed across there. Grant Silvester was on his faithful 'Fergie' beside the green so Bruce waited for him to move away but Grant waved him to play. Bruce drove, the ball carrying far enough to strike the engine cover on the tractor leaving a considerable dent, and flying past Grant's ducking head. Jim sneaked quietly back to his shop while Bruce anticipated a right bollocking but Grant took it all in good part.

Bert Goulding planted the Moreton Bay Fig beside the clubhouse around 1920. It is as fine a specimen as can be seen anywhere, including its native Australia, and, though it creates problems for the clubhouse situated alongside, few would be prepared to advocate its removal. Mr Goulding was also responsible for supplying and nurturing the two Canadian Redwoods behind the Knoll.

Joyce Carnachan donated the Jacaranda by the fourth green while Keith Lusk planted the three Kauris on the second tee during the late thirties. The latter three showed little growth until released to the light some twenty years later. The date palms that were once more prevalent on the course originated through the children of one member sneaking dates from the kitchen cupboard and throwing the stones out the window to destroy the evidence. Eventually the stones germinated, the misdemeanour was forgiven, and the young palms transplanted to the course where they flourished unless becoming victim to a misdirected sweep of the mower.

Over the years many people have contributed to the planting, nurture, and ongoing care of the trees on the course. Harry and Maurice Bradmore, Fred Washer, Frank and Maisie Warnes, and Willis Faulds were especially involved during mid-century years when many strategic fairway trees were introduced. Bill Kennedy of the Tree Society, though not a golfer, donated many fine specimens. He was also the driving force behind the development of McLarens Falls Park and has been responsible for much enhancement of the City and surrounds through the donation of trees and the encouragement given to others to become involved in planting specimen trees. Many other people have donated trees over the years and the tradition continues. Around the turn of the new century members were given the opportunity to donate $100 to purchase suitably selected trees which were then planted, each with a small plaque recognising the donor. This project was very well supported.

Bob Burstall, an authority on trees, was based in Rotorua with the Forest Service. In 1979 he and Club identity Willis Faulds did a thorough survey of the trees on the course during which they identified 102 different species and estimated there were over 7000 individual trees and shrubs. For some years Mr. Burstall was regularly consulted on the program for the planting, care, removal and replacement of trees. His expertise in that role was invaluable and added much to the development of the property.

In recent years the “Firewood Gang”, recognised elsewhere in this publication have undertaken the task of controlling and encouraging the proper growth of trees on the course, an essential task that was sometimes neglected in the past as evidenced by the large number of multi-trunk and poorly shaped trees that we do have. The work of Jim Swainson has been particularly valuable in this context. “Arbor Care Ltd” has provided annual tree maintenance under contract funded by the Racecourse Reserve Committee.

COMMEMORATIVE TREES

In addition to being honoured with Life Membership of the Club a commemorative Deodar (Cedrus deodar) was planted between the sixth green and seventh tee as a permanent reminder of the contribution Mr Mirrielees made to the Club. This was the first of a number of commemorative plantings that have been made either by the Club itself, by groups within it, or by family members.

Beside the entrance path to the clubhouse stands a European Olive from Galatos in Greece. This was planted by members of the RSA Golf Group in memory of New Zealand men who died in the Cretan Campaign. Beside it stands a Magnolia (Michaela dolposa) planted in 1983 in memory of Una Wickham, our greatest woman golfer. Three flowering cherries were planted adjacent to the tenth tee to enhance the setting for a dedicated seat placed there in memory of David Coates by his family. The family of Norm Roberts planted a Kauri behind the fourth tee in his memory. As we walk from the fifth green behind the seventh green we pass a Kauri tree planted in memory of Jack Pattison, son of member Brian Pattison. This Kauri has since been joined by a matching Kauri donated by Tony Reynish and Jackie MacDonald. These two trees will, in time, form an imposing backdrop to the fifth green when viewed from the tee. Long serving professional Jim Paterson is commemorated by a Rimu planted near the fourteenth green by his family while close by can be seen the Pohutukawa commemorating Phill Johnston's 60 years of membership. A fine Gingko tree was planted in memory of Henry Becker to the right of the seventeenth tee. Henry was a keen golfer in retirement, served as assistant secretary to Royce Lahood, and at one time was secretary to the BOP Golf Association.

The **Dorothy Garland Competition** was contested by teams of committee members from the Zones of the BOPTV Golf Association. Each year Dorothy donated a Camellia to be planted in honour of the winning team. Tauranga successes can be seen in the Camellias planted beside the first tee. The Ladies Club also planted a Camellia in the garden beside the trundler shed in memory of Peg Cross (Later Bates).

The tradition of planting a tree in commemoration of past members whose association with the club gave them special pleasure is to be encouraged though it is important that tree selection and siting need to be authorised by the Club Administration to ensure that the long term policies of the Board are not compromised. A welcome alternative to the planting of a tree would be the donation of a bench seat beside an appropriate tee. The seat beside the 12th tee, donated in memory of Joe Loughlin by his family, provides a welcome resting spot where players can pause while they contemplate how to handle the difficulties that await them on that challenging hole. The daughters of Barbara Carlisle went a step further when they erected an elaborate shelter below the fifth tee in memory of Barbara. Golfers can sit in comfort and safety while waiting for the players ahead to complete play from the tee. This was an appropriate and most welcome addition to the facilities around the course. In earlier times Harry Butts, who played on the old Domain course and later at Gate Pa, showed his appreciation of the pleasure he had derived from membership by donating seats for every tee on the course. These were custom built seats with a fitted rubbish bin at one end and a water container at the other. On Fridays a member of the green staff would empty the rubbish and replenish the water container with clean water. Patent ball washers were unknown at the time and the water and associated cloth were well-used accessories. Mr Butts was a very well known identity in the Town, it being his custom to walk down to the Strand each morning, summer and winter to swim in the harbour. He kept this up until well into his eighties. It must have kept him in fine fettle for it was claimed he collected his BNZ superannuation longer than any other ex-employee of that venerable institution.

In the World at large trees serve a wide variety of vitally important roles. This is no less true on Golf

Courses where they may be used to enhance the strategic design of particular holes, to provide shelter and shade, to beautify the landscape, and to encourage bird and insect life. Unfortunately many a course in New Zealand has been designed as a series of tree-lined avenues with little attempt to provide variation through the use of strategically placed bunkers, mounds, or other features. Such courses may be challenging but they do lack the variety that distinguishes those courses that provide the most stimulating golfing experience. Tauranga is not free of such holes but fortunately the topography of the course lends itself to a good measure of variety between holes and within single holes. Careful planning and wise future development are necessary if the “member friendly” character of the course is to be preserved for the benefit of future generations. Sensible selection, placement, and culture of trees will be an important aspect of those aspirations. Mistakes have been made in the past. Some trees such as the Casuarinas planted to the right of the second fairway are totally unsuited to the role for a variety of reasons. They are not attractive specimen trees, they shed acidic litter that kills the grass around their base and, as they age, they spread large shallow roots over a wide area. Similar criticism could be made of Pinus radiata, Macrocarpa, and others that are far too common on our courses. Alex Glasgow, a senior advisor with the New Zealand Sports Turf Institute said in a paper on Golf Course Tree Planting that “the only good thing about yellow macrocarpas is that they don’t live too long and most of them are now coming to the end of their lives”. The Japanese flowering cherries that attract large numbers of Tuis in Springtime unfortunately are readily spread in the droppings of those beautiful birds. As a result they threaten to become a major weed problem if that is not already the case. How much better it would have been had Kowhai and Kaka Beak been planted instead to encourage the Tuis. There are many other attractive native trees that may well have found a place on the course though hindsight is indeed a wonderful thing and perhaps Mr Mirrielees, and those who followed, had little choice but to use what was readily available and affordable at the time.

For many years any tree growing on the course appeared to be treated as though it was untouchable. This was unfortunate, as trees on a golf course primarily need to serve the needs of the game. While well placed, well groomed, trees are an important adjunct to the landscape of a golf course the course is not, nor should it be seen to be, a Botanical Garden.

In many cases early specimens were allowed to grow as they wished with the result that many grew into multi-trunk specimens that cannot now be readily trained to gain pleasing shape and form though Arbor Care and our own chain saw artiste, Jim Swainson, have made valiant efforts to do so. Many of these trees, especially the less desirable conifers, are past their best days and it is to be hoped that a continued program of removal and replacement will see an improvement in both the aesthetic, and strategic value of trees on the course.

In earlier times branches were allowed to grow down to ground level making it difficult to get under them, let alone play any form of recovery shot should you be unfortunate enough to be a few yards off line. In other situations trees close to greens and tees caused severe shading that led to weak turf subject to insect and disease damage. Happily a more enlightened approach has been taken in more recent times with real benefit to both the quality of the turf and to the enjoyment of the player. Longer standing members will remember the sense of relief that flowed through the membership when

the skirts on most of the trees were raised during the eighties. Fashionably attired golfers, women in particular, could now expect to complete the round in something close to the sartorial state in which they commenced their round, having not been forced to crawl under low hanging branches in order to get into position to play some sort of recovery stroke.

CHAPTER SIXTEEN

TWILIGHT GOLF

There are few pleasures to match that of wandering over a golf course on a balmy summer evening. Should the drives be booming down the centres of the fairways and the putts nestling into the bottoms of the holes so much the better, though something less on the scale of golfing excellence will not significantly dampen our enjoyment. For this reason vast numbers of golfers throughout the Country, from raw beginner to seasoned expert, look forward to the onset of Daylight Saving and the start of Twilight Golf. Residents of Tauranga are no exception though interest has not been consistent through the years.

Twilight tournaments were introduced to Tauranga in the summer of 1974/75 when willing volunteers would organise roll up starts, simple prizes, and a light meal to follow the golf. These weekly events were rotated over different week nights in an attempt to cater for those who might have commitments on particular nights. On account of the lay out of the course, the ninth hole being well away from the clubhouse, these events were played over ten holes simply because the tenth hole finished right by the car park. The first year realised a profit of $186 thanks mainly to the splendid catering provided by a large team of volunteers led by Nen Sim. Nen kept meticulous records where she listed the income and expenditure each night together with many other relevant details including the menu, recipes, and suggestions for improvement. From these records we learn that on one night in January 1975 seventy people were served a meal. To cater for that number the menu included nine roast chickens served cold, four pounds of corned beef, and fourteen pounds of tomatoes. A potato salad included five pounds of potatoes plus a range of complementary ingredients. Cole Slaw and a bean, corn, carrot and onion salad were also available. For this sumptuous feast the princely sum of $1 was charged and yet the profit shown was more than $26. The price of a meal increased to $1.50 the following year with the objective being to build up a pool of funds from which to purchase a number of items that it was felt the kitchen lacked. This objective was successfully achieved under Nen's efficient management. At the end of the 1976/77 season items such as a Zip Water Heater, an extra refrigerator, an electric fan, and a selection of kitchen utensils were purchased from accumulated profit. By this time the catering for Twilight Golf was a joint effort involving Nen and her volunteers together with Mrs Anderson, the Club Caterer. It was a most amenable arrangement. Though a large number of women volunteered to assist Nen those who carried most of the burden were Nen herself, Joan Frith, Mavis Ward, and Joyce Gallagher. What a wonderful job they did so willingly.

While these early events were popular with a group of loyal devotees, mainly regular club members, the concept gained additional impetus when Noel Copestake became involved. Under Noel's leadership a small team gradually evolved a streamlined system that allowed a large field to play their ten holes, enjoy a social hour, a pleasant meal, and a generous prize table each Friday evening. All this was provided at very moderate cost and attracted Club members and visitors alike. Certain key personnel including treasurer, card checkers, bar persons, and barbecue cooks arrived each Friday to play their parts, usually sacrificing their own chance to play so as to ensure that all ran smoothly for the participants. Noel himself started the field, having developed a starting program that ensured that the field flowed freely. He was never known to play in the field himself in all the years he was involved. In addition to acting as starter Noel filled the roles of sponsorship organiser, Master of Ceremonies, and occasional bar tender or barbecue cook as required. He hardly missed an evening in all the time he

was involved. Noel's wife Peg was always there to lend support and it was often Peg who did much of the prior work in buying a stock of prizes from which a selection could be placed on the table each week. Of the other members of the team Joan Brown kept track of the finances, Bruce (bow tie and all) and Marge Anderson checked the cards, Ian Dale, Peter Heeney, and Steve Stephens tended the barbecue, while John Robinson, David Mowat, Des and Noeline Shiel frequently served as bar tenders. Noeline and Des never left before the clubhouse, including the bar area, was clean and tidy ready for the weekend golf. Mary Goodjohn was the caterer through most of those years and she co-operated fully in ensuring that there were ample side dishes to supplement the barbecued offerings. Later the barbecue was used on alternate weeks with Mary providing the full meal on other occasions.

From small beginnings, when sixty participants would have been considered an excellent field, the popularity of twilight golf increased until fields of 100 or more were not unusual. The record attendance reached a staggering 158, rather more than could comfortably be accommodated. Since there was never any way of knowing how many might roll up between the scheduled starting period from 4.45 to 6pm the starter had to be very flexible in order to satisfy everyone. To facilitate play for such large numbers four separate courses, each with its own printed card, were developed. Course A covered holes 1-10, while course B covered the same holes but started from the 7th. tee with players moving to the 1st. tee after completing the 10th. hole. Course C covered holes 3-12 while course D played through 11- 18, then through holes one and two. These courses all start and finish in reasonable proximity to the clubhouse and special starting sheets were developed to co-ordinate the timing so that groups passing through common tees were not inconvenienced. These proved to work very well even under the requirements of large fields.

To ensure all contestants were fairly treated regardless of the holes they played three different 10 hole cards were developed. Had the regular 18 hole card been used this would not have been so as players would have received different numbers of strokes depending upon the particular course they played. The new cards solved that problem. While the stroke allocation initially confused some players our card checkers, Bruce and Marge, were adept at explaining the system to them. The stroke allocation on these cards followed a different principle to that used on 18 hole cards where fairness in Match Play is the aim. With abbreviated rounds and Stableford scoring the aim was to allocate low strokes to holes where it was most difficult to score Stableford points, typically long par three and four holes. This was quite the reverse of the allocation appropriate to Match Play.
The heyday of Friday Evening Twilight Golf came in the Seventies and Eighties and, as with many other activities, circumstances changed and interest began to decline. Somewhat reluctantly Noel was persuaded to step aside from his involvement in order to see if others could rekindle interest. This does not appear to have been achieved despite the effort made. Perhaps it was just a case of the trend line turning inexorably downward. Has not the same thing happened with Indoor Cricket, the game of Pool, and the playing of "skinners" after golf on Saturdays?

To compensate for the decline in one form of Twilight Golf another form has arisen. Gary Baker, a prominent administrator throughout the Nineties, arrived from the Manawatu and soon began promoting the concept of Business House Golf, a development that had been particularly successful at

Hokowhitu. With the encouragement and assistance of Noel and others Gary oversaw the instigation of a Wednesday evening competition that initially attracted fourteen teams, each consisting of four players.

The number of teams grew rapidly as the popularity of the competition became widely recognised in the Business Community and soon reached the maximum possible field of 36 teams. In spite of the large field of 144 the play flows relatively freely with everyone usually back in the clubhouse by 8pm. following the 5.30 start. The best three of the four Stableford scores of each team are counted to decide the winner of the teams match each night and also aggregated throughout the season. Team and individual prizes are awarded each evening and, at the end of the season the top teams in both Stableford and Match Play throughout the year are awarded major prizes.

Once again ordinary Club cards were used in the early years of this competition until some anomalies became apparent. For example a male five handicapper starting at the sixth tee would receive all five of his strokes in the ten holes he played whereas the same player starting at the fourteenth would receive only one stroke. A new card was consequently designed so as to be as fair as possible to all participants. Two principles were considered in allocating strokes on the new card. The first was that players starting on any one of the 18 holes should receive as close to one half of their handicap as possible. A secondary requirement was to consider the relative difficulty of scoring Stableford points on a particular hole. These two principles are not entirely compatible so compromise was a necessary part of the process.

At first no consideration was given to developing a handicapping system for twilight golf as participants were all members of Tauranga or other local Clubs and simply used their Club handicaps. As the popularity of the events grew an increasing number of participants with no Club affiliation became involved, especially in the Business House competition. It became obvious a handicap system especially designed for Twilight Golf was needed. At first the handicapper used his discretion in dealing with those who returned particularly good scores. This soon led to dissatisfaction as real or imagined disparities arose in the way similar performances were treated. In particular there appeared to be a reluctance to allow handicaps to move outward with the result that one really good performance could render the competitor uncompetitive for the remainder of the season. A feature of Nine or Ten Hole golf is that players are often able to produce exceptional scoring which they would be unlikely to sustain through the full 18 holes. A regular club handicap is not necessarily a sound guide to a player's likely performance over the shorter course. To overcome these problems a new system was developed using suggestions found in the NZGA Handicapping and Course Rating Booklet. This suggested that a player should score about 2.2 points per hole when playing to their handicap. On that basis 22 points was the expected score over ten holes so a buffer zone was set from 20 to 23 points inclusive where no handicap adjustment would result. Points below 20 would allow the handicap to move out one-quarter stroke to a maximum of one stroke. Points from 24 to 26 inclusive would each incur a half stroke reduction, while any points above 26 would each reduce the handicap by a further stroke. Thus someone scoring 30 points over the ten holes, as happened more often than might have been expected, would find themselves cut 5.5 strokes.

David Mowat who would, each week, print out a new list of handicaps incorporating both the Friday-night players and the Business-House team members developed this system, and a Computer program to handle it. Non-scoring holes were counted as scoring one point when reviewing cards for handicap purposes. Peg and Kim Copestake became expert at checking and adjusting cards and isolating those that needed to be kept for the handicapper. When the Dot Golf Computer system was installed the technicians wrote and incorporated the Twilight Handicapping system onto the Club computer software. This program has saved countless volunteer hours since its introduction.

Under the regular handicapping system women were at a clear disadvantage when competing against men in the Business House competition. In recognition of this they were given a bonus of two points to add to their scores. Once the Twilight Handicap system was fully operating and men and women were being treated in exactly the same way for handicapping purposes it became clear this bonus was no longer justified and it was discontinued.

Twilight Golf proved to be a winner. The Club gained through the facilities being used during evenings when they would otherwise be deserted, potential members were exposed to the attractions full membership does offer and, most importantly, a large number of people were enabled to enjoy themselves in truly pleasant surroundings. It is to be hoped that some day a reinvigorated Friday evening Twilight program will supplement the Business-House competition.

Over the years many people have given their time to ensure the twilight programmes have run successfully and efficiently. Sometimes these have been Committee members, more often members who have simply enjoyed the opportunity to be part of a convivial group helping to provide pleasure to others and value to their Club. They deserve our admiration and our gratitude.

CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

HANDICAPPING THROUGH THE YEARS

Until the advent of the modern handicapping system developed by the USGA in the sixties handicapping was in the hands of a handicapping committee that may very well have consisted of a single appointee. The committee had a poorly defined mode of operation and essentially used their best judgement as to when to cut and when to increase a player's handicap, and by how much. These decisions were not made arbitrarily; it just seemed that way to a lot of players especially on those occasions when a cut was made. Men and women had quite different systems, the women having a much more stringent system under which their handicap was based on the best golf they played and one good round could place a player on a handicap to which they might well struggle to play for the next few months. Reviews were done at six monthly intervals and if the one good round was not repeated the player might be let out a stroke or two. Consequently players often found themselves quite uncompetitive for long periods. In addition women were required to earn their first official handicap by playing a round in not more than 36 strokes over par and many a tear was shed when a promising round was destroyed by a single really bad hole. This often happened at holes such as the Gully and the Knoll that claim many victims other than novice women. At times those bunkers at the Gully must have seemed three metres deep and the sides of the Knoll virtually insurmountable. Never the less the day would eventually arrive when that magic score of 108, or better, was achieved and the champagne could be uncorked. What a thrill and a relief it must have been!

Men on the other hand had it easy. Upon joining they were automatically placed on a 24 handicap and it was then up to them to learn to play to that, or better, in order to become competitive. It is possible that the memories of older members become confused as age creeps up on them but there are those who recall that virtually all members in those times eventually learned to play to their 24 handicap and usually improved upon it. In more modern times some seem satisfied to remain on more generous handicaps up to 36. (The slope system may result in men playing off course handicaps even higher than 36). Perhaps the challenge once offered to the 24-handicapper to become competitive is no longer there.

The handicapper would usually be generous to the novice and allow him a degree of success before "wielding the axe". My own experience of the system came in my first season when, after a few months, I began to play with a mild degree of success whereupon I picked up the occasional remark about "burgling". Very politely, as then befitted the approach of a junior to a senior member, I approached the handicapper, Mr Warwick Nicoll. "Excuse me Sir", I said, "I am starting to get a bit of gentle ribbing regarding my form. Should you not be reviewing my handicap downward"? His response was to the effect that it would happen soon enough. "You haven't won enough just yet". When the axe finally descended a few weeks later it did so with a vengeance, my handicap falling by some ten strokes over a period of two months or so.
Both men and women were allowed only three quarters of their handicap when playing Stableford or Bogey (now called Par) competitions, and also three quarters of the difference in handicaps when playing matches. A score of 36 points would often be sufficient to win a Stableford competition and 40 points or more was very rare. Women would have considered 36 points exceptional.

When, in 1962, the NZGA adopted the USGA system for men golfers the task of the handicapper

became quite onerous. The system was based on the best 10 of your last 20 rounds and, prior to the advent of the personal computer, these records had to be kept manually for every player. As each new score was entered the oldest would be dropped and the handicap, if necessary, recalculated. Arnold Shanks took over the role of keeping track of all this as part of his many duties as Barman and House Manager. It became a common sight to see Arnold poring over cards and record books covering the entire pool table and surrounding area. A number of modifications and improvements have been made to the system since the first version was introduced but the essential basis of the best 10 of the last 20 rounds still applies ensuring that handicaps change quickly so as to more accurately represent current form. No handicapping system will ever achieve the ultimate aim of placing everyone on an equal footing because we humans are far from perfect. There will always be those seeking to gain an edge and Tauranga, like every other Club around the Country, has had its share of those who have found ways to do this. They soon become well known, if not well respected.

In 1995 a complicated system called Calculated Course Rating (CCR) was introduced in an attempt to equate scores made on different days on the same course by allowing for changing conditions. This system proved totally impractical, was widely 'honoured in the breach', and finally abandoned to the relief of all who attempted to operate it.

The next genuine step forward was made in September 2000 with the adoption of the 'Slope' system, the aim of which is to allow players from different Clubs to compete on an equal footing irrespective of the course they are playing. Essentially the system measures how much more difficult a particular course is for the 'Bogey Player' compared to the 'Scratch Player'. This measurement results in a theoretical slope line running between the scratch player and the "bogey" player that is then extrapolated to include players on handicaps beyond those limits. It is interesting to note that Tauranga's Slope Ratings of 117 for men and 120 for women, as measured from the standard tees, are each slightly above the average rating of 113. The course is clearly not as "easy" as some have suggested over the years.

For many years it seemed apparent that Tauranga members were not well served by the Course rating System. Certainly the Club's record in Bay of Plenty Intermediate and Junior Pennant fixtures supported this view. The introduction of the Slope System appears to have brought with it a more equitable comparison between the courses in the Bay, and probably beyond. The Club does seem to have been more competitive at these levels in recent years. Course ratings depend upon the subjective decisions of those appointed to do the job and are thus subject to human error so there is no way of confirming or disproving any assumption people may make about the relative fairness between ratings. There will always be discrepancies, both real and imaginary, but these will reduce as rating committees become more experienced and skilled.

The combination of the USGA Handicapping System, The Slope System, and accurate Course Rating, have gone a long way towards providing a "level playing field" for all registered golfers. The amalgamation of the National organisations controlling Men's and Women's Golf in New Zealand has resulted in a Handicapping and Course Rating system common to both. The development and widespread adoption of computerised handicapping and card analysis has made what were onerous and time-consuming tasks quite simple. Over the course of its history Tauranga Golf Club has not been slow to adopt the

latest ideas and improvements that have been developed to assist in the playing of the game and in its administration. When computerised handicapping and card reading were first introduced the Club was amongst the first to trial the available systems. Fortunately we did not jump straight into one of the first available systems, preferring to wait, correctly anticipating that improvements would inevitably follow. As a result we were able to install Golf Autoscore when it first became available. In 2005 the Board approved this installation after presentations convinced them that the deficiencies noted in 2002 had now been remedied. The cost involved a purchase price of $8500, and a monthly service fee of $200. It is arguably the best available system by a considerable margin and the administration and the membership have been well pleased with its performance.

It is possible that Tauranga was the first Club in New Zealand to have an opportunity to use computerised handicapping. During the Eighties a computer based handicapping program was written by some students and staff of Tauranga Boys' College and demonstrated to committee members of the Club. The demonstration was successful in the sense that it accurately recalculated handicaps as new data were entered. It was even able to demonstrate that some of the records entered manually had not resulted in correct recalculation of handicaps. This was hardly surprising in view of the number of records that had to be kept, and the manual calculations that had to be made. Arnold would indeed have to be congratulated on the overall accuracy of the handicap records he kept. Obviously the College could not offer a free service so suggested that they would do a weekly input of all men's cards for a fee of $50. After some consideration the offer was declined and computerised handicapping had to wait for a few more years before being introduced.

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

PERSONAL EXPERIENCES

ARNOLD SHANKS REMINISCES

Arnold joined the club in 1948 and was active as a player until 1967 when he took over the role of club steward and bar manager, a role he filled until his retirement in 1983. Arnold's courteous manner, his patience, his quiet efficiency, his genuine interest in members and visitors alike, all contributed a great deal to the popularity of the club. His generosity in providing beautiful floral arrangements for the lounge with flowers from his own Bethlehem property was greatly appreciated. All who enjoyed his service and his cheerful friendliness will remember Arnold with affection. Here is his story in his own words.

"I came to Tauranga from Ardglass Northern Ireland in 1927 with my golf clubs - a Mills cleek (like a short driver) and an old mashie. I played initially as a country member and enjoyed Open Tournaments. I farmed at Oropi and had to get feeding-out done a day ahead so I could be free on Saturdays between milkings. The Tauranga course was well laid out and well kept. I did not get any serious practice but played reasonably to an 18 handicap. We enjoyed our golf very much and prizes were not considered very important. At the end of the season we received a voucher covering any successes during the season and we would buy what we wanted and take it out to the Club for prize giving in November. This was all very convivial though it would be rather impractical today.

In time the membership outgrew the rather primitive clubhouse and a bigger and brighter one was built on the present site. The facilities in the new building were good. The bar instead of being a cubby-hole was well planned and a decent size. The crates of beer were kept in a locked cupboard under the stairs. This meant they had to be carried up manually. The bar was run by Arthur Towsey, a commercial traveller, and a real personality around the club. The job was a labour of love carrying no salary. In the bar Arthur ruled. Early players would be caught as they arrived and made to do their share by carrying up crates of beer. He opened and closed when he felt like it as no one else imposed restrictions or, if they did, no one bothered with them. In earlier times each case of beer or bottle of spirits was labelled with the name of a member for "personal delivery" at the club before leaving Guiness Brothers, the suppliers. This was the method used to get around the law that had no way of licensing clubs such as ours.

As the bar was quite small there was no room for two to serve behind it so there was often a crowd waiting. The dining room was to the left and the lounge to the right. The latter was well furnished and carpeted with landscape windows giving excellent views of the 6th and 18th greens.

With better facilities inside and out the Club boomed and it was not long before the new clubhouse was too small to meet the demands placed upon it. Arthur Towsey, a bachelor up till then, was fading in his barman role and he was soon to marry his Landlady and disappear from the scene. A new man took over. He had an English name which I forget. He seemed to spend a lot of time cleaning his ear!

Noel Hockin was our secretary, a job he had done for some time on a small honorarium. He then became full time Secretary Manager on a salary. One day, talking to Noel, I said to him, mostly as a joke that had I known the Barman's job was up for application I would have applied. Noel just laughed. It really was a joke as, not being a drinker, I did not patronise the bar and had no idea of its inner workings. By 1964 there was talk of enlarging the clubhouse again. The changing rooms were too small, Jim Paterson's shop was much too small, and the trundler shed was only a small building rescued from the Mowat property when it became the Girls' College. Consequently a new trundler shed was built incorporating a good-size Pro Shop and plans prepared for clubhouse extensions. The enlarged changing rooms expanded into the area previously occupied by the old Pro Shop beneath the dining room that, along with the lounge, was extended out towards the 18th fairway. The building plan was a major project for the Club and caused much discussion and controversy amongst the members with many strongly in favour and many against. With the assistance of the Club's Bankers and a good take up of debentures by members the work was eventually completed.

There was one small hitch. The chap who was steward and barman decided it would be too much upheaval for him to cope with during the extensions and he handed in his notice. Noel Hockin informed the committee he had a solution to that problem. He rang me and said did I remember telling him I would have been interested in a job at the Club. I'd quite forgotten all about it but he said the job would only be a temporary one until the alterations were complete and everything had settled down once again. After that the plan was to appoint a married couple to handle catering and the bar. I thought it would be a nice change for a while as I was doing little apart from growing a few flowers and greenery

for the shop run by my daughters so I said that yes, I would fill in for the short term.

It is always exciting to do something new. A temporary bar was set up in the back of the trundler shed. Fortunately there was hot water and wash up facilities but it was still pretty primitive, just a counter on trestles to serve from, a few tables each side of an old carpet runner, and enough chairs at a pinch. Knowing it was only a temporary inconvenience the arrangement was accepted in good spirit by members and there were a lot of happy times there. Jim Paterson was a great help to me at that time, always pleasant and willing to give a hand in tidying and cleaning up what was a less than ideal facility. I did enjoy the company and the change of life style. It was an interesting job. The alterations went ahead on schedule and no one was greatly inconvenienced. The new caterers took over and I went home to the life I had been leading. At the Club all was settled and going smoothly, or so I imagined. For my part I know I missed the company.

As part of the official opening of the new facilities there was a social evening and dinner in the clubhouse. I did not go but later heard it had not proved to be the success anticipated. The golf day had been a success and the dinner tables very nicely set up with several quite elaborate decorations. Obviously the new husband and wife team had gone to a good deal of trouble to make a good initial impression. There was a big crowd but unfortunately the caterer was not familiar with hungry golfers. There were to be two servings but practically all the food disappeared at the first of these and many went home hungry and dissatisfied. It was a bad start but allowances had to be made for the new staff. They would improve. After all they had come with glowing credentials from an Australian firm. Things did improve for a time though there were doubts. The barman was slow with service and with giving change. I think the members missed a familiar face behind the bar and someone they could tell their golfing woes to.

One day, not too long after the opening, I had another ring from Noel Hockin. Could I come out to a committee meeting at the clubhouse that evening? The House Committee were there - Noel, Arthur Bluett, Owen Evans, Jim Reid, and Frank Warnes. The new caretaker couple were leaving and they would like me to take over the Bar and Clubhouse maintenance role. The job would be full time including running the bar and cleaning the clubhouse and changing rooms, a much bigger job than I had been doing before the alterations. The committee had worked out a schedule of duties, hours of work, and pay. The hours were long and the pay not very high but I felt it would be interesting and pleasant working with people I knew. After giving the matter some thought I accepted. If it didn't work out from my point of view or that of the committee I could always resign. At least I would have something to fill the rather empty life that lay ahead. Everyone was pleased. The committee were free of the responsibility of advertising the job and all that would have entailed. It was intended I would start work the following Monday but even that did not go to plan. Whenever the previous barman required a day off during the week the gap had been filled by Bill Drummond, a retired engine driver. Bill was a nice quiet man who was to continue in that role on my days off. On the Friday prior to my official start I had a call from Noel. There had been an accident. From the bar storeroom there was a lift for bringing up full beer crates and other supplies and returning empties to ground level. Old Bill was lowering the lift with a load of empties when the cable somehow slipped and the cage suddenly came down, crushing Bill's forearms and trapping him. Someone freed him and he was rushed to hospital where he stayed quite a long

time. He never quite got over the trauma of the accident. It turned out the cable had been too loosely wrapped around the spool and had gradually tightened, leaving some slack that eventually allowed the cage to drop suddenly.

So it was that my job began a few days earlier than planned. Noel handed me the keys of the bar and said: “This is your bar. You are in full charge”. He did have a spare key of course and I think when I was not there he would nip in for a quick one. That Saturday morning I started my new career. It was fun really, long hours but not hard work once I was organised and before the novelty began to wear off. The committee had made up a time sheet for me. Monday was cleaning up day, 4 hours. Each changing room took an hour or more, then there was cash to tally, the bar to restock, the lounge to vacuum. If there had been a Sunday tournament or function this latter took at least two hours. Flat out it was a hard four hours work. Theoretically I worked 44 hours a week and had Monday afternoon off together with a full day off on Fridays. For this I received £20/6/0 or £17/7/4 net of tax. This was in 1967. If, as occasionally happened, the course was closed as a result of bad weather I didn’t get paid for the day.

We had no liquor license so the whole set up was illegal but the law turned a blind eye. Sometimes on a Saturday or Sunday evening someone would ring to say there was a traffic officer parked down the road so everyone leaving would be extra careful. There was never a serious accident, only the occasional scrape on the way home. One chap had a minor run in with a tree on the driveway out to Cameron Road. It was difficult to get the bar closed. Even though we were illegal there was an attempt to stick to the six o’clock closing time for licensed premises but there was a hardened core of drinkers, including Noel, who would stay and stay. I often had trouble getting the slide down and it was often well after 6:30pm by the time I did.

I also said I would do the flowers, a task that had been done off and on by some of the ladies. Somehow it became part of my job as I had plenty of flowers and enjoyed seeing them in the clubhouse. Usually I had three or four large arrangements and they were always admired, even by some of the men. That chore took some time as the flowers had to be picked freshly every day but I soon got into a routine. I did all I could to keep the clubhouse clean and tidy and no one complained in the time I worked there. Much later, on an economy drive, the committee decided the staff were getting too much free service at the kitchen so we were cut back to just morning and afternoon teas. Previously I had got my lunch free, now I brought sandwiches from home. I did say: “no lunch, no flowers” but after a week I got tired of the bareness and went back to my arrangements.

Gradually conditions in the bar changed. Instead of bottled beer we changed to draught beer in flagons, then to small casks with a pressure pump. Eventually, following the next building extension, two large tanks and a proper pressure system were installed. That made the serving of drinks and the handling easier but increased the cleaning work. I carried a good stock of spirits and soft drinks and graduated from a small refrigerator to a large commercial style model.

The time passed with no special excitement. Noel’s rather casual book keeping and business supervision gradually deteriorated and the committee decided it was time for a change. Noel had been a hard

worker for the Club, both as an honorary Secretary and as a Secretary Manager. I was sorry to see him go. He had always been very considerate to me. At the time I seriously considered throwing the job in but I didn't. Not long after leaving Noel fell from a ladder while painting his house and died shortly after.

Curly Peters replaced Noel. Gradually my pay increased but not, I think, to the full award rate, and certainly not to reflect the work that I did. The Club membership was always growing in that period. There was talk of further additions to the clubhouse, plans were made and there was another upheaval in the offing. Curly did a good job as secretary though his assistant, Henry Becker a retired post master, did a lot more than his fair share and, upon his retirement I think that Pat Massey did the lion's share of the work. I carried on cleaning, serving in the bar, and doing the flowers while avoiding getting involved though I could sense Pat was not too happy with her lot at times. I would sometimes have a few holes of golf during the summer months when things were quiet. I would play round to the 6th on my own, or sometimes with an occasional lone visitor. I missed playing very much. I used to stand at the window overlooking the 6th green or watch the players coming up the slope to the 18th green and wonder if I would have the chance to play again.

Eventually another round of clubhouse extensions was started. The whole upstairs area was doubled in area and a basement area excavated underneath to provide a storage room with lock up facilities for spirits, bottled beer, and the like. This meant a lot more work for me. Vacuuming the lounge and rearranging and cleaning the tables could take all morning. The committee did employ window cleaners to clean the windows both inside and out where previously I had done the inside and occasionally make a special trip to do the outside. A new social committee decided to run dinner dances, a sit down dinner and a band for dancing. That meant another big rise in the work required of me. We would borrow long tables and extra chairs from the Racing Club while all our small tables would be carried out and stacked on the veranda. I would get people to give a hand but on Sunday morning everything would have to be put back in order to be ready for the players coming in to the bar in the afternoon. Those were very long weekends, especially as some party lovers would stretch their evening out well into the small hours of Sunday morning. It was often 2 am before I got home and then it was back to clean up in the morning. The final result of the extensions was very successful. While the work was going ahead I would take home off cuts for firewood and there were often other items piled to go to the dump that were too good to waste so I would salvage those too.

Kitchen staff came and went, committees changed year-to-year, new members arrived and older ones departed but I carried on as usual. The same Vets came to their Annual Tournament, the same players to the Labour Weekend Tournament. It was nice to see their faces year after year. The bar usually ran smoothly. I changed from the old tin box for the cash to a hand operated cash register, then to a fancy one that had me tied in knots for a time. That slowed down service until I got used to it. Getting the big gas cylinder up to the bar was a major effort. Occasionally I would manage to get one of the boys who played to help me up the stairs with it but they would dodge me if they could. I would then have to back the van up to where the suppliers had delivered the cylinder, manhandle the cylinder into the van, drive the van round to the porch end of the lounge under the Moreton Bay, get the thing out and roll it along the lounge floor and into the bar. It was quite a task. Every now and then someone would come

to inspect the bar. There was never a complaint.

Another change and another secretary, a nice chap from Inglewood called Royce Lahood. Royce was another who was very good at delegating jobs and once again Pat Massey found herself doing most of the office work so far as I could see.

Royce was an ideal public relations man and easy to get along with. He fitted in very well and was soon right at home in the Club. One day he was doing something urgent so he brought the handicap books to me and asked if I would finish them for him. He explained the system and soon I got into the job. Royce never again did that job. It was interesting doing it but very time consuming. Any little bit of spare time I had was taken up doing handicapping. Hours of work spread over the week, masses of cards spread over the pool table, and the pins to move on the handicap board ready for weekend play.

Tuesday was Royce's day off and sometimes Pat would tell me to go and have a game with the Vets. I would go off in the first group then rush in to get ready for the first few wanting drinks. It was very nice but a bit of a rush so I did not do it very often. Pat was a delightful woman who was wonderful to work with and a great asset to the Club. I think she also made Royce look good for the amount of work she did on his behalf.
The seasons slipped by, one year much the same as the last. The wages did improve but the work seemed to get harder and harder. Perhaps I just got older and older. I wish I had kept a day-to-day diary of all the things that happened. It is very hard to recall the sequence of events but I did enjoy the job because of all the good people I met and worked with over those years'.

Those who knew Arnold and his little Morris van would empathise with his description of this manoeuvre. Arnold and the van were both small of stature and you can be sure the task would have challenged much bigger men with more suitable transport. There was a fascinating incident involving this van and a blackbird, if something extending over a period of months could be called an incident. Arnold's van had a mirror mounted on the front right hand wing as was common at that time and he would park the van where the bar manager still parks at the back of the clubhouse. One particular blackbird would perch every day on the wing and look at himself in the mirror. Of course he did not recognise himself but saw a rival in the mirror and would hop around the back to remonstrate with that rival. Finding nothing he would come to the front again. He would continue this for an hour or more and for day after day eventually wearing a ring of paint off the van right around that mirror.

DAVID MOWAT REMEMBERS

My earliest memories of the Club are of hunting for golf balls in the hydrangeas that fronted the clubhouse where it faced the 18th green. My brother Robert and I would be waiting for our father as he enjoyed the after match conviviality with his friends in the old wooden cottage that served as clubhouse. As children we were not permitted within its hallowed walls. Sometimes we would go further afield in search of balls and tees, the latter being quite common near the men's tees but rare indeed near the ladies'. Strange that. At home we would use our finds in company with a couple of old irons to hit balls around our paddocks which now make up the Girls' College at Gate Pa.

When I was about twelve my parents signed me up as a junior member though I was far more interested in cricket, tennis, rugby and yachting at that stage. In any event juniors were not made very welcome at that time and not for quite a few years into the future. My father, the first professional to the club but then back in the amateur ranks, was keen to see a change in that attitude which is why he signed me up. I caddied for my father or one of his friends on occasion. This was before the days of trundlers and we were especially called upon for tournament days when carrying your bag through 36 holes was a daunting prospect.

My first real commitment to the game came in 1957 when I took a year off university in the belief that I needed to reawaken my enthusiasm for study. A vacancy arose as assistant to Grant Silvester on the green keeping staff and I gained the position through the influence of my father. Grant had been our neighbour at Gate Pa for many years and my father some years previously had suggested to Grant that he would be ideally suited to the green keeping role. Grant and the committee concurred and so began a significant era in the development of the course. I recall working with Grant with a good deal of pleasure. Grant could be a hard task master but very fair and patient, in passing his knowledge and skills on to me and to others. Though Grant had come to the job with little in the way of the special knowledge required of the modern green keeper he was practical, adaptable, and a ready learner. He, along with Charlie Leach of Taupo, was to become instrumental in raising the standards of green keeping throughout the Bay of Plenty. While accompanying Grant to meetings of the BOP Green Keepers' Association it was soon apparent to me that the other members paid a great deal of respect to the views of these two men.

The machinery we had to work with was minimal compared to the specialised and sophisticated machinery operated by our present-day staff. An old Ferguson tractor hauled a set of three gang mowers that I would use four days a week to mow the course from boundary to boundary during the active growth season. There was virtually no rough. For two days I would mow length wise up and down the fairways, then crosswise for another two days. This was necessary to combat the Paspalum stalks that would otherwise have turned the fairways into hay paddocks in appearance. I remember some summers when the stalks did get away and Jimmy Paterson would be ashamed to charge visitors green fees to play the course. These days it is difficult to find Paspalum anywhere in the fairways and the old local rule allowing Paspalum stalks to be plucked has long since gone from our card. I was very happy doing my mowing job when the sun was shining. On those days I would sing all the popular songs of the day, tunelessly but enthusiastically, as I drove the faithful Fergie around the fairways.

On Tuesdays and Fridays Grant would change from his big work boots to his sand shoes or “running shoes” as he called them and mow the greens with the Overgreen mower which he had to walk behind. This would take virtually the full day so was done only in preparation for Ladies’ day on the Wednesday and for the men on Saturdays. There was no possibility of mowing the morning of competition. For a few weeks leading up to the Spalding Masters, and later the PGA, the greens would be mown daily and members would certainly notice the very significant improvement in speed and trueness. While professionals such as Bob Charles claimed these greens were as good as anything in the country it should be remembered that they played them in January when the greens would clearly have been much better than in the winter months when the local season was in full swing. We always found it ironic that the course was virtually deserted from November to March, the period in which the greens and fairways were at their best.

The bunkers were filled with fine pumice sand that we dug from a pit located at the back of the fourth tee. This we did by loading the old Model T Ford shovel by shovel full. On Wednesdays the ladies would not realise we were up in the pit behind them as they teed off and we would hear some rather unladylike language if their shots did not go to plan. The gully was of course notorious for the problems it caused, especially to those trying to earn their handicaps. There was no automatic handicap allotted to women at that time. Unlike men who were given a 24 handicap at the outset whether they could play to it or not, the women had to earn their initial handicap by playing to 36 or better. Until they achieved that women players would be in a state of limbo and many an attempt to qualify foundered in the gully or in the bunkers surrounding the green. The pumice in the bunkers was light and fluffy and good to play out of when dry but when wet it packed down like cement. We would then plough it up with the little Gravely tractor and in doing so a bit of clay would be added to the pumice with the result that the next time it rained the cementing effect would be even worse. We needed to add new sand fairly frequently and it was hard work.

The Gravely was a marvellously versatile workhorse. We used it with a variety of attachments to stir up the bunkers, to mow the heavy rough in places such as the bottom of the gully, to rotary hoe the ground in new tee and green construction, and to pull a small coring machine. Grant was an ingenious man and he developed a rotary broom, driven off the Gravely, for sweeping corings into rows for easier removal. Another machine he came up with was a groover that he made by adapting a Morrison reel mower for the purpose. It worked very well, though labour intensive. At that time we would groove the greens twice a year then over sow them with the standard 3:1 Brown Top/Chewings Fescue Mix. With improvement in the science of turf management, led by the newly established New Zealand Institute of Turf Culture based at Palmerston North, and the installation of an effective greens irrigation system the need for reseeding gradually disappeared. The new watering system must have been a great relief to Grant who had been in the habit of driving back to the course at night to shift sprinklers.

Another machine I recall was a vicious looking spiking machine. This was developed in conjunction with Edward’s Engineering, a local company run by prominent member Roy Edwards. His widow Joyce is a Life Member of the Club and a wonderful example of how the game of golf can keep you young in spirit.

The spiking machine consisted of large, heavy, octagonal shaped steel wheels with ten-inch knives bolted to the corners of each wheel. This was dragged across the greens and the design was such that the knives penetrated deeply then 'kicked' back as they emerged. This was effective in breaking up the compaction that develops under the greens as a result of the pressure exerted by people and machinery passing across them.

The professional at that time was J A (Jimmy) Paterson. His business would be very slow over the summer and he would join us from time to time when we had extra work. Jimmy had a truly likeable personality and got on really well with Grant and I but he had virtually no confidence in using machinery of any kind. It was not wise to ask Jim to back the trailer down to the rubbish tip at the top of the gully below the implement shed unless you were prepared to haul the trailer back out of the pit later! Other than this occasional assistance from Jim green keeping was a two-man job for many years. There is no doubt the course was less well cared for than it is today. We simply did not have the manpower, the machinery, or the financial resources to facilitate something better. None the less I am confident the membership got the very best that the circumstances of the time allowed, just as they do today. It is interesting to note that I was paid about £11 in 1957, the same as a senior subscription for a year so it required 50 members to cover my salary as the assistant green keeper. The same would be very nearly true today, the senior assistant's salary being covered by some 50 members. Of course there are more assistants today so the cost of maintaining the course is relatively much higher.

There were many memorable moments in my time working on the course. Perhaps the most memorable involved a lesson in the unexpected dangers of smoking. In those pre-OSH days life was a little less regulated. When we needed to remove a row of trees along the left of the 14th fairway Grant came up with the novel idea that we would dynamite them out of the ground. He would use an auger to drill a hole down below the bole of the tree, place a stick of dynamite and a fuse then move on to the next tree. I would then light the fuse, retreat a safe distance to observe the result, then tow the tree away to the dump. By the time I returned the next fuse would be ready to light. Everything worked beautifully for the first few trees, the timing was good and each tree came easily from the ground. Then, returning from the tip once again, I noticed Grant move away from the next tree in line so I bent down, matches in hand. Boom! The tree was blasted out of the ground inches in front of me before I could touch a match to the fuse. Grant, who was often prone to pause in his work to roll and light a cigarette, had done just that after setting the charge and had then automatically touched the match to the fuse before moving away. Fortunately I was not hurt, only severely shaken. We were able to see the comic book humour of it a little later.

On Friday afternoons Noel Hockin, then Club Secretary, would come out from town with our pay packets and Noel, Grant, Arthur Towsey and I would spend a pleasant hour or two sitting on beer crates inside the little bar discussing all manner of things. This made for a very pleasant end to the working week. Those three people had a huge impact on the development of both the club and the course over a long period and I count it as a privilege to have had the opportunity to gain from their collective knowledge and understanding of so many aspects of club and course management. A year or two later after the clubhouse had been upgraded some members complained regarding the Green Keeper coming

into the clubhouse on a Friday with his working clothes and boots on. Though there was no mud on the boots and the clothes were tidy working gear these few complainants obviously felt his presence was inappropriate. Although officialdom never told Grant to stay away he did hear there had been a complaint and he reacted by moving his Friday evening custom to the Greerton Hotel down the road. This was all a bit sad and perhaps a sign that things would never be quite the same again.

The story of Commander John Harris, Alan Davidson and his plastic models, and Grant's endeavour to replicate these on the ground has been told elsewhere. As a member of the Greens Committee I was able to participate from the sidelines in much of this development. While I regret not being present when Commander Harris walked the course I did gain significant insight into course design and construction from being involved, as a member of the Greens Committee, in the follow up over the succeeding months. Grant and Alan were assisted greatly by the experience and skills of local earth moving contractor Garth Renner. Garth had an empathy with them and could interpret what they wanted very readily and he was genuine in his wish to achieve exactly the effect they were looking for. It was a real team effort with a result that would, I am sure, have pleased John Harris though I don't think he saw the final outcome. The majority of holes underwent some degree of change. Some bunkers disappeared, others were introduced, mounds appeared in strategic places and greens were extended to provide extra depth. In the opinion of some excellent judges the developments transformed Tauranga into one of the more interesting courses in the country. We simply do not hear complaints from members or from visitors that the course is boring to play as does happen with regard to quite a number of New Zealand courses. The manager of an Auckland representative team once commented to me: "I wonder if your members fully appreciate the course you have here. Tauranga is really three courses in one. Those first six holes take us down into the valley and out again. They are full of variety, both of terrain and design. The middle six offer a variety of challenges while the final six represent more typical flat country golf". To add to that description Michael Nicholson, Tauranga's outstanding amateur, put it this way: "Those final six holes have a way of sorting the men from the boys". How prescient that comment was can readily be understood by those who had the privilege of watching Michael in the final stages of many of his championship matches, or in watching another outstanding club member in Eddie Burgess come from behind to win another under 23 stroke play title over those last few holes.

Next time you tee up on the second hole take a look at the three Kauri trees on the right front. Back in 1957 the tee was very different from the way it is now. The tee was in two narrow terraces with tall bracken covering much of the area. One day Grant directed me to clear the bracken away from the Kauris to "release them". I had barely realised they were there, hidden as they were by the bracken. From the moment of their release from the shade and competition provided by the bracken they began to thrive and we can now see what 50 years of unrestricted growth does for Kauris. Apparently they had been hidden under the bracken for some 20 years since Keith Lusk planted them in the Thirties. Incidentally the women's tee was then sited on top of the ridge between the first and second fairways some distance forward and to the right of the present position. The outline of the tee can still be seen. Close to that tee was a large blue gum and if you drove up to, or beyond, that tree when playing the first you had achieved a notable feat. Today such a drive would be considered less than adequate by many men club players and perhaps by a few women as well. Such has been the advancement made

in equipment. Whether that is for better or for worse remains a matter of debate.

At the beginning of the following year I headed back to University and it was not until three years later that I found myself back in Tauranga at something of a loose end. While deciding where my future lay I was asked to fill in once again on the course as the assistant had resigned and Grant needed some help. I was happy to do so for a short time though it turned out to be for most of the year. At some stage in the year Garth Sim, Principal of Tauranga Boys' College and husband of Life Member Nen Sim, was playing on the course with my old First XV coach Pat Keenan. Spotting me they stopped and wanted to know what I was doing mowing grass when they were short of Science and Mathematics teachers. They would be happy to recommend me to the recruiting officer who was to be in town the following week. I found out the money was not too bad so much to my surprise I soon found myself studying at Christchurch Training College. I had never had any inclination to be a teacher prior to that time and yet I signed on under Garth the following year and spent the next 31 years at the College. So ended my green keeping career but certainly not my interest in all things relating to the great game of golf.

A regular Friday afternoon four made up of three Businessmen and the Club Professional were inclined to play for a dollar or three. One of the Businessmen, who had something of a reputation for absentmindedness, was busy totting up the state of his financial obligations as the others teed off on the 15th. When they prepared to play their second strokes two balls were located on the 16th fairway, the Pro's was well up the middle, while our man's was nowhere to be seen. He was adamant that his tee shot had been 'straight down the middle'. After some time of searching under leaves that had accumulated in the fairway he put his hand in his pocket and there was his ball. 'What the hell is going on here' he said as he strode back to the tee. On another occasion a group were following the same gentleman and were about to play to the third green when they realised there was no flag to play to. Eventually someone spotted the flag being carried in the 'slope arms' position up the path leading to the fourth tee.

MEMORIES OF TAURANGA GOLF CLUB FROM BRIAN DUCKER

My father Norm Ducker was a schoolteacher and a keen sportsman. In April 1949 when I was six years old we shifted from Thornton to Tauriko where Dad was to be their new headmaster. He had been a member of the Whakatane Golf Club where he had won the Championship in 1947. He joined up with Tauranga in that first year of 1949, playing off a handicap of four throughout most of the following six years.

There was no such thing as organised golf for children of Primary School age at that time and as a consequence I spent a large amount of time on Saturdays, and an occasional Sunday, caddying for my father. Once or twice a week I would play the back nine as the Tauriko School House was only a couple of miles from the course. There was a rule that sons could play with their father members for free on days other than competition days and I played for years with just a cut down jigger which was a hickory shafted club with the approximate loft of a three iron.

The course lay out closely approximated that of the present day though changes were always envisaged. The fifth hole was always a problem and changes were constantly made to try and improve the situation. When we first arrived the tee was at ground level to the left of the fourth green while the hole ran along the boundary fence to a small green that was barely visible and surrounded by Toitoi clumps that often trapped a wayward ball. Later a long narrow green was constructed more or less where the present green lies. The pin was still invisible even when a new raised tee was installed further to the left and well back in the corner.

The remaining holes are still in the same place but one has to think hard to recall the many subtle changes these holes have undergone. The greens were all smaller and there were very few bunkers in 1950. Now most holes have them. Virtually all the greens have been built up and enlarged while the back portions have been raised and extended. The 2nd, 4th, and 8th greens in particular were small and steeply borrowed. Now they are cut into the hill resulting in helpful upward sloping backs to those greens. The base of the pin on the Knoll was invisible from the tee as the green was flatter and thus much easier to putt on than is the case now. The bunker in front was installed in Dad's day. The turf was cut away at the top exposing a pumice "bullnose" face and balls rolled down it to a flat shelf at the bottom. Dad, not always the most confident of bunker players, would sometimes take a putter and bang the ball into the bank and up onto the green. At that time the Knoll green was relaid to provide a larger, lower, surface. For months the substitute hole was a very short par three played with a chip from the front of the 7th tee to the putting green. The cards were not changed and the score made there was recorded as the score for the 12th.

The 3rd green was another to be significantly altered with the bank on the right being built up to prevent the automatic roll around onto the green, and to provide some space for bags and the trundlers that were just beginning to make their appearance.

In 1950 there was a wasteland of scrub, gorse, and blackberry all the way down the left of the 7th fairway from the tractor shed to the bottom of the gully. A shank or severe slice from the 4th tee would

disappear into impenetrable jungle. The 4th tee was well below its current position and the shot was played uphill to a pin of which you could only see the top half. The path to the green dipped down to swamp level before sloping upward to the green. Great was the delight when this path was built up a little to ease this climb back out of the gully. It has been further built up on at least two further occasions.

The 18th green was quite different in shape then. It was essentially square with a false front and a slope at the back running up towards the old clubhouse. The holes were all named and though I remember most of them to this day you never hear them identified this way any more. I feel that is really a pity. Sixty years ago most members referred to many of the holes by name rather than number. Today this applies to the Knoll, and perhaps the Gully and The Crescent. I wonder how many members today would recognise the 15th as Kaharoa. That hole was then played as a par five. It was later reduced to a par 4 and by memory was then made the number one stroke hole. Dad always maintained the feature tree for which the 18th is named was not a Moreton Bay fig at all but I fear the Australians may disagree with this view.

The scorecards always carried the handicap allowances on the back. From memory you were allowed three quarters of your handicap in Par (then Bogey) and Stableford competition and five eighths of the difference in handicap match play. This later became three quarters in line with the other competitions. As 24 was the maximum handicap for male golfers no one ever got more than a stroke a hole in Stableford competition. The very idea of anyone getting two shots on a hole would really have upset the old timers. Strokes were owed on different holes in the two forms of play so the card featured two different handicap allocations. Handicaps were based on the two lowest rounds over the previous six months and it seemed handicaps hardly ever went outwards. Playing to your handicap (36 points) was a real achievement and everyone congratulated you on the merit of such a performance.

On Race Days the course was essentially closed to allow for parking on the fairways and for safety reasons as many holes ran adjacent to areas where horses were stabled, loaded into floats, or saddled. I do remember Dad playing on one race day though. We were on the 13th when the horses thundered past. Clods of earth flew everywhere but even more impressive than that to a ten year old brought up very strictly by a father who did not swear was the sound of non-stop, very loud, cursing by the jockeys as they positioned themselves for the run home. Large wooden observation stands were sited on the fence around the crescent and these required a local rule to clarify the relief available.

I remember as a kid finding an earlier scorecard with different names such as Alpha and Omega for the 1st and 18th. There were other fascinating hints of earlier times. I recall someone telling a story of long ago before the Club owned a tractor. The tee boxes were filled with sand as the wooden golf tee had not then been invented and players teed the ball on a small pile of sand. The tee boxes were battery cases or similar that sat on the ground. Someone made a bet on the 14th tee that he could hit his ball from the top of the sand in the box and reach the green. The result was one box virtually destroyed which the green keeper had to replace by wheeling a new one in his wheelbarrow all the way down to that very distant tee. The following week, or so the story went, another group were discussing the incident and inevitably another wager was made. The result was the same and the long suffering greenkeeper was

once again required to trundle that long distance with a second replacement box.

The rules of the game are under constant revision and there have been dramatic changes over the years. The elimination of the Stymie is well known. Less well known is that prior to the early Fifties the penalty for a lost or out of bounds ball was only that you had to put another ball into play (count the stroke only). My Dad and others found it very hard to accept that you now had to penalise yourself both stroke and distance. They considered this a very harsh penalty for a poorly played stroke.

I recall Peter Thomson playing an exhibition match around 1953. He was the new British Open Champion and his opponent that day was Alex Murray. Thomson had a long, upright, elegant swing and he played some glorious shots though he was no match for Murray that day. On the 8th Murray found trouble on the left and had to chip out just past Thomson's drive. Thomson then played a short iron close to the pin only to see Murray hole his 3rd stroke and win the hole when Thomson could not sink the birdie putt. At the 13th Thomson's drive was longer than anyone could recall seeing. He then hit a three iron across the corner to the edge of the green, an achievement unheard of in those days. I remember Dad dropping a pine cone beside the fence to mark the distance the drive had travelled. The most remarkable memory I have is of an event on the 15th. Thomson drove into the edge of the Lawsoniana trees that then lined the left boundary. His ball lay in some longer grass right by the edge. As he went to chip sideways his club slid down a low branch he had apparently not seen and he completely missed the ball. His comical look of total amazement was matched a minute later with one of sheepish embarrassment when, after successfully chipping out, he had to go to Murray and confess he now lay three.
At the speeches later Thomson praised the course as being the best groomed in all of New Zealand. I was impressed but my father said that he probably said that of all the courses he visited in order to please the locals. Peter Thomson went on to claim further British Open titles and become recognised as a great champion. From our point of view, if not from their's, it is sad that the super stars of the game no longer have to tour the small clubs of the World in order to cash in on their success.

I saw Thomson again in the late Sixties when he played in the PGA Championship at the Mount. He had filled out somewhat with age and his swing was more round arm in the style of Mike Souchak. I was playing too but I did not have the nerve to approach him and ask him if he remembered the exhibition match at Tauranga and especially that air shot!

I witnessed two holes in one while caddying for Dad. Mick Cambie achieved the feat into a gale on the 14th one Sunday afternoon. Mick was a big wide shouldered bloke who thrashed at the ball with tremendous power. On the tee he addressed the ball by lifting the club head a foot or so off the ground then tapping down behind the ball before making a series of such taps, each about half the height of the previous lift. When these taps finally ceased he would freeze for an age before launching with all his might at the ball. The distance achieved was often spectacular, the direction frequently wayward. For the hole in one he played a three iron under windy conditions that were such as to leave other players short when playing the driver.

(Editor's note – Mick had other eccentricities on the golf course. I recall him once dribbling a ball off

the 18th tee. Before it had even stopped rolling he had another ball out of his pocket. This he tossed a few feet in front and, charging forward, he cracked it on the half volley an enormous distance towards the green.)

The other hole in one came during the final of the Senior Four-Ball when Dad's partner Cary Arneil holed out at the Knoll during the afternoon round. As I have said the base of the pin was not visible from the tee in those days and when I suggested the ball might have gone in the hole I was ignored. Nor was there any acknowledgement of my good guess when the ball was found in the hole. My pair went on to win the match just one up and, back in the clubhouse, Billy Castell, one of the opposing pair, announced that he had scored a two only to lose the hole. I remembered that he had actually holed out in the alternate hole only a couple of feet from where his ball settled. Of course I said nothing (I would have had my ear clipped for butting in) as Billy's version made a good story. One outcome of their win was that Cary, handicap 2, and Dad, handicap 4, were selected to represent the Club in the BOP Champion of Champions Foursomes which they duly won.

On another occasion I heard that Ron Parkes, a gentle man and a fine golfer, had made an ace at the Gully. I got excited but Dad explained that Ron had duffed his first shot into the swamp before holing his next for a three – a result known as a busted eagle. This was just subsequent to the rule change that imposed a penalty stroke in addition to counting the original stroke and his fellow competitors were disappointed that Ron's perfect shot had not earned him a deserved birdie as would have been the case a month or two before.

During those years when I caddied regularly Fred Ward was the Club's best player and always the man to beat in the championship. Fred was the manager of McKenzies Department Store in town and had been a pilot in the Air Force where Dad had also served so they got on very well. At the time Fred did not play a lot of golf and I seem to remember he got married about that time when he was probably in his late thirties. He seemed an old man to my young eyes. One year Fred went off and played in the New Zealand Open finishing 19th. He came back with a centre shafted Schenectady putter that he had been awarded as a result of his placing amongst the amateurs in the field. The putter aroused much discussion, especially with regard to its legality, though Fred, like everyone else, continued to use his old blade putter.

In the first qualifying round of the1952 Championship Dad shot his best ever score, a 70, to lie equal with Fred. Unfortunately Dad was ten strokes worse the following week but still qualified second. He went on to meet Fred in the final where he went down 3/2. On the day before that final Dad had played in the 36 hole final of the Aquilla Cup where he lost to Billy Castell. Dad was very disappointed to have lost two thirty six hole finals in the one weekend despite scoring birdies on eleven of the fifteen par five holes played.

I remember Fred once hitting his ball into the top of the bank above the swamp at the Gully. We eventually found the ball embedded in the muddy bank. Fred worked the toe of his club behind it before flicking it out and, while it was still airborne, hitting it onto the green. Worriedly I asked my father if that

was legal to which Fred responded saying “they probably wouldn’t approve of that at The Masters”. I need not have fussed, Fred was always unfazed and simply accepted the good with the bad. It was typical of him that he had not bothered with taking a drop and trying for a miracle shot to rescue a point.

Another example of Fred’s equanimity that has remained with me happened at the final hole during a Labour Weekend Tournament. At the time important events on the Club calendar such as the Labour weekend Tournament were eagerly anticipated, intensely contested, thoroughly discussed and dissected for months afterwards. In the annals of the Tournament the epic battles between Fred Ward and Andy Fletcher were legendary. A J Fletcher was a talented golfer, a long hitter and a fierce competitor. Regardless of the quality of the field it seemed that Fred and Andy always met in the final at Labour Weekend. The Honours Board reveals that Fred usually prevailed. One year they reached the 18th all square and both made the front right of the green with their second strokes. Both longish putts finished close to the hole and the gallery anticipated concessions and a move to the first tee to continue the contest. Fred knocked Andy’s ball back to him but Andy made no move to reciprocate whereupon Fred made a quick stroke, and laughed before holding out his hand to congratulate Andy as the ball slipped by the hole. I was horrified that such a mighty encounter could end like that but it was typical of Fred to take defeat in that manner. On another occasion the pair went to the 3rd extra hole before Fred secured another title when Andy duffed several successive strokes in the gathering gloom.

The veteran golfers of the time were my friends and many gave me welcome encouragement. If we were playing on a Sunday they would often allow me to drop a ball and play the last couple of holes. Dick Phelan was one of those men. Dick had established the Tauranga Rimu Company and had thus been responsible for giving Tauriko its name for you won’t find that word in any Maori dictionary. Harry Smith and Maurice Bradmore were always there with an encouraging word and they let me have a hit when the opportunity arose. Ron Galloway was a very good single figure player. He had a new maroon Vanguard motorcar while George Thorne had an identical car, even to the colour. There was a story of the two of them racing them up Waihi Road on their way home from golf but stories like that were not for a boy’s ears and I heard no more. Alan Davidson was a young man at the time and regarded as a promising player who was just starting to make his mark in Club affairs. He too took an interest in me at a time when most players would have known who I was but chose to ignore my presence as I dragged my father’s heavy home made trundler around the course. Lew Gamman was an exception, always friendly and chatty. Visits to town were not complete without a visit to the Sports Depot in Wharf Street where Alan McBride or, more likely, Lew would sell me a small piece of Meccano while chatting to Dad.

Other players I remember include Paul O’Brien who played off a six handicap and had a very smooth swing and Toby Green, then the longest hitter in the Club. I recall Toby driving the 10th green, an unheard of feat at the time. George Harrison and Dave Cambie used to have chipping competitions down at the end of Grace Road where they lived. They would chip across the road, round and even over the houses, and out onto the harbour. George was a keen fisherman and he would go around to the newly reclaimed swamp that is now Memorial Park in order to practise his casting. Once George gave us some nylon line, the first we had ever seen. Jack Lloyd, dapper, swashbuckling and cigar smoking was a confident and able 6/7 handicapper who competed keenly with Dad before deciding to play his golf at

The Mount. Jack probably set a record for continuous appearances in the Labour Weekend tournament – he competed over forty times I believe. In a world where only a favoured few had a post-war car Harry Smith stood out. He was the proud owner of a Ford "Fortyniner", one of only two in the town. Harry's business partner Tui Harvey was a prodigious, if erratic, hitter. One day someone bet Tui he could not drive a ball from the 13th tee into the newly installed bunker between the 13th and 17th fairways. At the time I had not seen it done, nor heard of anyone having achieved the feat but Tui lined the ball up and proceeded to carry it into that bunker on the fly.

Ten years later I returned to the area and joined the Mount Maunganui Golf Club. It gave me great pleasure to meet again with George Harrison, Jack Lloyd, and others from those earlier days, and to play with them regularly. Later Paul O'Brien shifted across to play at the Mount and he and I still form part of a regular Tuesday four.

Bert Hart was the greenkeeper and another friend. One weekday afternoon, while Dad and I were playing a few holes, Bert drove up on the old Massey Ferguson tractor and stopped for a word with Dad. Apparently there had been a complaint made that I was putting with a five iron. I am sure I never as much as scratched the surface of a green while putting with my old jigger but Dad suggested I had better use a putter from then on so a hickory shafted putter was added to double my club numbers. When I was about 14 I was allowed to use my mother's clubs that had lain idle for a decade or more. These included a spoon, a three iron and a mashie with very thin blades. There was also a Man's eight iron with about as much bounce and loft as a modern sand wedge. There was even an ancient leather carry bag. I was in golfing heaven and my scores began to improve. At age 12 in what proved to be my last round at Tauranga during that period I went around the course in 81 strokes with the help of just those six clubs.

During my years at Tauranga I was largely unaware of there being any other junior players. I was the only son regularly caddying and there was no organised programme for juniors. When I got to college I found there were a few boys who played regularly, notably Michael Cambie, Robert Mowat, and Dick Wilson. These boys were a year or two ahead of me at school so our paths did not really cross. It was a few years later that I began to meet them at tournaments where they showed they had developed into fine golfers.

In the early Fifties the Club instituted an open Professional and Amateur 72 hole Stroke Play Tournament. This was an innovative move as prior to that the only tournaments available to amateurs were three-day events featuring two qualifying rounds on a Saturday followed by four rounds of Match play. The Professionals had even fewer opportunities to compete against their peers. The tournament was held in autumn and every effort was made to attract a quality field, with leading players from Auckland and the Waikato being regular participants. I was about ten when these began and Dad allowed me to make my caddying services available to these golfers. This was great as far as I was concerned for they paid me 2/6 a round as opposed to my father's occasional bottle of lemonade at the end of the day. I caddied for G. L. Taylor from Hamilton, and then W. W. Smith from Auckland for a couple of years. The tournaments were very successful and attracted considerable interest in the town. It was regrettable

that they lapsed some years later.

Opening and Closing days were important as few people played over summer and there were no competitions over those months. I recall one closing day when a variety of competitions were held after the day's play. There was a long driving contest where participants teed off from the top of the bank behind the 18th green. Dad was most surprised to be given a ball for being the only participant to land both his drives in the targeted area between the 11th and 18th fairways. There followed a short iron contest from somewhere near the ladies' 7th tee to the 6th green. All those who made a two played again and I recall Dr. Mark winning with his second two. He was a long handicapper and was absolutely delighted to have out-gunned all those lower handicapped players who had fancied their chances. Everyone then repaired to the clubhouse to enjoy High Tea followed by speeches and the presentation of the year's major trophies.

For the Labour Weekend Tournament of 1953 I was allowed to earn myself some cash by caddying for someone other than my father so I was not privileged to witness the deed that highlighted my father's golfing career. The details though are forever imprinted upon my mind. On the 6th, a par five of 507 yards, my father made an albatross two. The stand of Californian Redwoods on the hill between the 6th and 7th were then represented by a couple of newly planted saplings so, when Dad drove rather too much to the right past the large gum tree that once dominated the area, he found himself on a clear lie on a little flat terrace. His way forward was blocked by the stand of pines beside the Ladies' 7th tee but he had in his bag a four wood that he could rely on to produce a hook even when it was not desired. On this occasion he played up the 7th fairway and the club behaved as he wished it to, the ball drawing nicely around the trees and heading in the general direction of the green. The four did the usual searching and muttering until someone in desperation looked in the hole and there the ball nestled. Dad was not considered a long hitter and never before or since did he make the 6th green in two strokes. To celebrate this previously unheard of feat the Club presented Dad with a pewter tankard that I have to this day.

In those earlier days Information about the wider world of golf was very sparse. The NZ Herald certainly covered New Zealand golf and British events such as the Open Championship but the United States PGA Tour was unknown to me. We had seen the film "Follow the Sun" starring Glen Ford as Ben Hogan and later I recall reading a detailed account of Hogan's win in the Open at Carnoustie in 1953, the only time Hogan played in the Open Championship. He had been told he would not be considered one of the greats unless, or until, he added that title to his list of successes. Consequently Fred Ward's reference to "The Masters" that day at the Gully had no meaning to me at the time. Even golf played elsewhere in the Bay of Plenty was somewhat remote. I think the only local golfer to make the Bay teams at that time was Harry Dale from the Mount Club though Fred Ward and Jack Bateman had been members of Bay teams earlier. Ivan Deadman was one regular Bay representative who often played in tournaments at Tauranga. I also remember a young Don Boone playing in a four with Dad during a Labour Weekend tournament. That was at the beginning of Don's long and illustrious career in Bay golf. I will never forget an incident I witnessed in Don's first round match that year. On the 7th hole Don's opponent hooked his tee shot into the gorse to the left while Don was long down the middle. When we could not find

the ball Don played a good second just short and to the right of the green. As we moved on the other fellow shouted that he had found the ball. He took a bit of time and a couple of shots to get it back to the fairway, then another couple to get within range of the green where we were waiting. What was perhaps his sixth shot sailed to the right where it struck Don's bag as he waited to play his third. Under the rules of the game at that time Don had to concede that he had lost the hole. My father, as usual, let the incident be a lesson to me as he lectured me on the importance of keeping my gear and myself well out of the way of an opponent's wayward stroke. I did this religiously for some time though I still got caught out a couple of years later at Middlemore when an opponent shanked a short chip through a bunker onto my cart that was parked safely, I thought, beside the next tee.

The Club did not at first have a resident professional. Bronco Branch gave occasional lessons but was committed to his business in the town. Later Jim Paterson was appointed resident professional. I remember the first time Dad played in a four with Jim he was disappointed that Jim showed no apparent interest in anyone else's golf. I don't quite know what Dad expected. I know it must have been very hard going for Jim as paying for golf lessons would have seemed unimaginable extravagance to most members.

Jimmy Mowat had been the Professional before the Second World War and had regained his amateur status after it. He was a Scotsman of the old school who was strict on the rules of the game as well as those of the Club. Late in 1954 my father went on a teaching exchange to the USA, leaving his family home for the year. Before going he said he would pay my subscription for the year, six pounds, if I should make golf my chosen sport. As it was I was eager to get to College and play cricket and hockey so the subscription was not paid. Early the following year I had a round with a friend and his father, shooting that 81 referred to earlier. That evening my mother got a ring from Jimmy to say that if I was not playing with my father I was not eligible to play on the course so that was the end of my golf for the year. Rules are rules I guess and the rule was that sons of members could play with their fathers, not with other members, but perhaps a bit of flexibility would have done no harm in the circumstances. Towards the end of the year Dad returned from America and soon after was appointed Headmaster at Clevedon School near Papakura so our time at the Tauranga Golf Club came to an end though I have enjoyed playing the course in tournaments and pennant competition on many a subsequent occasion.

COURSE RECORDS

One afternoon in May 2002 Club member Eddie Burgess, a New Zealand representative at both Junior and Senior level, joined the Thursday afternoon 'Ball in the Bucket' brigade. Club auditor Neville Grey must have been pleased to become Eddie's partner by dint of the ball toss but little did he know what was in store. Opening with a birdie at the first Eddie followed with further birdies at the third, fourth, sixth, seventh, and ninth to be out in 29. He then birdied ten, eleven, fifteen, sixteen, and seventeen to be home in 31, so bettering the 61s of Kel Nagle, David Good, Bill Brask, and Michael Nicholson. Michael's 61 was scored on Waitangi Day 1991, his final six holes reading 4, 2, 3, 4, 3, 3. This would surely be the best ever played over those demanding holes. Later Kevin Smith equalled Eddie's score of 60.

While it may be true that the course was not set up for Tournament play when Eddie, Kevin, and Michael played their rounds we can be confident that it represented a true challenge. The month of May is not the middle of winter nor does it offer the long fairway roll of summer when the four 61s were recorded. It is impossible to compare the conditions under which these rounds were played. Regardless of the conditions Eddie's and Kevin's stood as the best rounds ever recorded on the course at that time and deserved recognition as course records.

The 59 posted by Richard Lee during the 2010 Carrus Open relegated these earlier records to history though Eddie and Kevin could still lay claim to the record score accredited to an amateur or to a Club member.

CHAPTER NINETEEN

THE WARD DYNASTY

Few families, if any, have had such a long and fruitful association with the Tauranga Golf club as has the Ward family. It began in 1947 when F W (Fred) Ward was appointed manager of the Tauranga Branch of Mackenzie's and he and his wife, Olwyn, moved to the Town. At that time Mackenzie's and Woolworth's were intense chain store rivals located in just about every New Zealand town of any size. They sold general merchandise at reasonable prices and perhaps were equivalent to the "Five and Ten Cent" stores of the USA. Woolworth's was an American company while Mackenzie's was an all New Zealand enterprise established by Mr R A McKenzie.
Fred began caddying at the Hokowhitu course of the Manawatu Golf Club at the tender age of seven. Fortunately bags were not the heavier bags of today as trundlers had not then been introduced. Fred must have been well regarded by his employers as he rose rapidly through the caddy ranks to earn the badge awarded to the number one caddy, a badge he was very proud to have been presented with. Like a lot of top professional and amateur players of those earlier times Fred learnt the skills and etiquette of the game by observing the actions of the best players he caddied for. Throughout his long career Fred never had a lesson, his smooth, rhythmical swing being developed as the result of emulating the best of what he observed. That remains a great way to develop a sound swing and young players should take every opportunity to watch the best players, amateur or professional, male or female, whenever they get the chance.

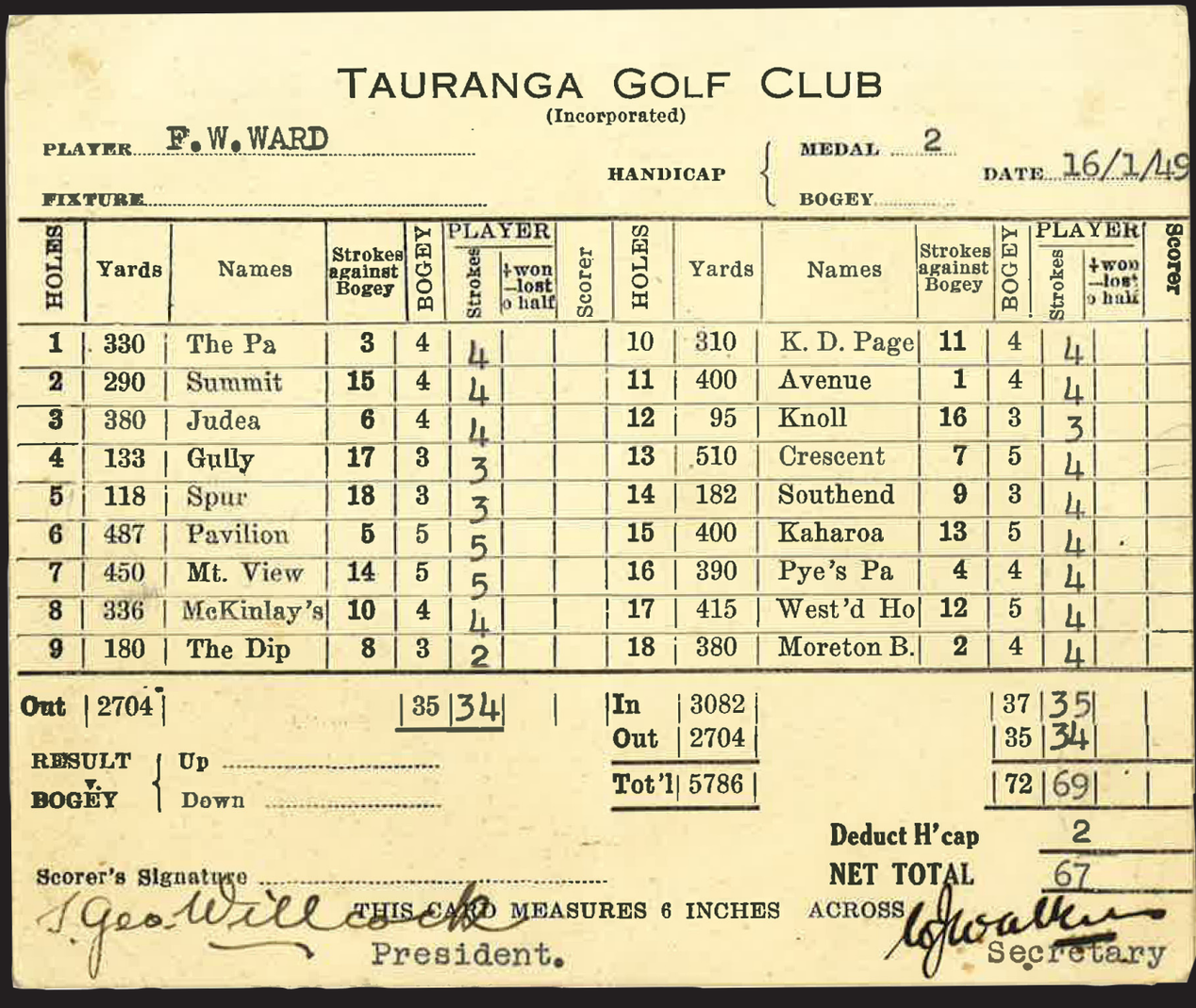
Fred was successful in winning the Senior Championship at Hokowhitu before moving to Tauranga where he immediately demonstrated his class by winning the Senior Championship in that first year of 1947. He was to win it on another six occasions between 1950 and 1956, his seven victories being second only to those of Michael Nicholson who won the Championship twelve times between 1970 and 1991. In addition to his Club Championship successes Fred won the Tauranga Open Championship four years in a row from 1947, and again in 1953 and 1958. These six victories place him ahead of D K (Don) Boone, of Springfield, who won the title on five occasions between 1956 and 1963. The Tauranga Open Championship was the premier event at the annual Labour Weekend Tournament that was first played in 1934. Apart from the War years of 1941 to 1945 when no tournament was held this extremely popular event attracted top players from Auckland, the Waikato, together with those from the Bay of Plenty and further afield. Sadly it fell victim to a new era where players are reluctant to travel away from their home clubs for tournaments such as this and it was discontinued following the 1999 event. At its peak the tournament attracted full fields of 112 divided into seven groups of sixteen for match play.

At Inter-Provincial level Fred represented the Bay of Plenty with distinction in four Freyberg Rose Bowl Tournaments. This tournament has gone by a number of names since, depending on the company sponsoring it. The Freyberg Rose Bowl has now taken a new role as the trophy attached to the "Masters" Inter-Provincial Tournament for the stars of an earlier age. Fred's lowest handicap was +1, though he did feel the handicapper was a bit harsh in making him give the course that one stroke.

In 1949 Fred encouraged Olwyn to join the Club and they were active and popular members until 1962 when Fred was promoted to Hastings where he joined the Hastings Golf Club at Bridge Pa. This was the home of Stuart Jones who left no room for any pretender to his throne thus ending Fred's championship winning run.

Fred's knowledge of the game and his organisational skills were recognised very soon after he joined Tauranga and he was prevailed upon to serve as Club Captain from 1948 to 1951, and again in 1953/54. Olwyn also took a full role in Club affairs, serving on the Ladies' committee for four years and reaching a handicap of 12. Their son Mark was a junior member from 1958 until 1962.

Playing in the annual Schoolboy Tournament of 1978 Kevin Ward, then a 17 year-old playing off a 24 handicap, aced the Knoll on the Wednesday using an eight Iron. Upon seeing Kevin on the course the following day Club member Peter Pollett congratulated Kevin and then asked in jocular fashion if he had scored any more aces that day. The nonchalant reply was: "Well yes, I got one on the fifth". And so indeed he had, using a 4 Iron this time. Kevin is a younger brother of John and Errol, members of this family that has been so much a part of the Tauranga Golf Club for more than sixty years.



TAURANGA GOLF CLUB
(Incorporated)

PLAYER F. W. WARD
FIXTURE
HANDICAP { MEDAL 2 / BOGEY
DATE 16/1/49

HOLES	Yards	Names	Strokes against Bogey	BOGEY	PLAYER Strokes	PLAYER +won −lost ○ half	Scorer	HOLES	Yards	Names	Strokes against Bogey	BOGEY	PLAYER Strokes	PLAYER +won −lost ○ half	Scorer
1	330	The Pa	3	4	4			10	310	K. D. Page	11	4	4		
2	290	Summit	15	4	4			11	400	Avenue	1	4	4		
3	380	Judea	6	4	4			12	95	Knoll	16	3	3		
4	133	Gully	17	3	3			13	510	Crescent	7	5	4		
5	118	Spur	18	3	3			14	182	Southend	9	3	4		
6	487	Pavilion	5	5	5			15	400	Kaharoa	13	5	4		
7	450	Mt. View	14	5	5			16	390	Pye's Pa	4	4	4		
8	336	McKinlay's	10	4	4			17	415	West'd Ho	12	5	4		
9	180	The Dip	8	3	2			18	380	Moreton B.	2	4	4		
Out	2704			35	34			In	3082			37	35		
								Out	2704			35	34		
								Tot'l	5786			72	69		

RESULT / BOGEY { Up / Down

Deduct H'cap 2
NET TOTAL 67

Scorer's Signature J. Geo. Willcocks

THIS CARD MEASURES 6 INCHES ACROSS

President. Secretary

Probably the first sub 70 round at Gate Pa

Left: Fred Ward demonstrates his strong address position

Below: Fred Ward and Andy Fletcher (Te Aroha) had a number of stirring matches in the annual Labour Weekend tournament.

Fred's departure very nearly coincided with the arrival in Tauranga of his brothers, Allen and Claude who were quick to join the Club. The latter would be much more readily recognised by the name of Buster. Like Fred they learned their golf in the Manawatu and each showed much of the family golfing ability. Allen made his mark early by winning the Palmerston North Club Championship in 1938 at the precocious age of 16. He played to a low of 3, while Buster did even better to reach as low as 1. Allen joined in 1961 and remained active until his premature death in 1979. He became a committee member in 1971 and proved to be an extremely influential and wise chairman of the Greens Committee, a position he held at the time of his death. Allen also found time to manage the Bay of Plenty Junior team, a reflection of his interest in the progress in the game of his sons and their peers.

Buster joined in 1962 and remained a member until his death in 2005. He was active almost to the end, being widely recognised as the Patriarch of the Ward Clan who made such an impact with the size of their group at Friday Night Twilight Tournaments throughout many a summer.

J W (John) Ward joined as a junior member in 1967. At Intermediate school he and his friend Noel Johnson had been encouraged to get seriously involved in the game through the influence of Una Wickham who taught at the school. Both eventually went on to represent the Bay of Plenty at Freyberg Rose Bowl level. John represented the Bay from 1972 until 1982 including appearances in the Freyberg team in 1975, 76, 77, and again in 1982.

John won the Tauranga Club Senior Stroke play Championship in 1980, 83, and 86, and the Labour weekend Open Championship in 1978. His lowest round at Tauranga was a 66, one better than Uncle Fred's best. At his peak John reached a handicap of 1.

Errol Ward, John's older brother, first joined in 1976, remaining a member for three years. When he returned to the game in 1993 he became more involved, so much so that he was elected to the committee in 1998 before serving as Club captain in 1999 and 2000. Errol has successfully tendered for a number of renovation building projects at the Club.

Younger brother Kevin was a member for just two years but made a lasting name for himself by scoring holes in one on successive days on 17/18 May 1978 when just 17 years old. These were at the 12th and 5th holes respectively.

Vivienne Phelps, sister to Errol, John, and Kevin, has been a member since 1997 while her husband, Owen, has been a member since 1990.

Later recruits to the Club include Annette Bainbridge and her husband Dennis, and Owen Teague. Annette and Owen are the children of Dorothy who was a sister to Fred, Allen, and Buster. The dynasty continues.

Many of the above, plus other family and friends, made up the "Ward Mafia", a group of up to 25 who patronised the Friday Twilight tournaments in the Eighties and Nineties when they were in full swing. Their ages ranged from that of Buster in his eighties to third generation juniors in their teens.

CHAPTER TWENTY

THE PROFESSIONALS COME TO PLAY

The committee of 1952/53 sought ways to promote the club to the rest of the country in order to attract green fee visitors and to encourage membership applications from residents and newcomers alike. The age of closed membership had not yet arrived and increased membership together with greater returns from green fee paying visitors were seen as the path to prosperity at club level. The committee reasoned that a prestigious tournament featuring leading professional and amateur players from throughout New Zealand would have a good chance of achieving these aims. They were also cognisant of the fact that professionals in particular lacked opportunities to showcase their skills to the public and it would be beneficial to all parties if the professional game were to be encouraged. Consequently the committee contacted the NZPGA and, with their full support, settled on a 54 hole Stroke Play Tournament to be staged on a weekend in June 1953.

That first tournament was judged to be a great success and the club has since continued to promote itself and the game on a wider stage by involving itself in the hosting of professional tournaments whenever the opportunity has arisen. In that first Invitation Tournament a field of 18 professionals competed for prize money of £200 while 42 invited amateurs made up a quality field. F X (Frank) Buckler, then of Auckland, averaged one over par through the three rounds to comfortably lead the professional field on 216, four strokes clear of Alex Murray, also of Auckland and no stranger to the course as he acted as adviser to the club on course design and development. J A (James) Paterson, then of Wanganui but soon to fill the vacant professional position at Tauranga, finished third. Scoring by the first few professionals was steady if unspectacular, the best rounds being par 71s by the two leaders.

New Zealand Maori champion T P (Tori) Jones of Taumarunui matched these par rounds in his final round to head off tournament favourite A J (Andy) Fletcher by a single stroke. Amateurs P G F (Pax) Smith and W W Smith, each of Titirangi, returned the only sub par rounds, each one under the card.

President Syd Randell in his comments at the prize ceremony admitted the promotion had been an ambitious one for the club but the support of the players and spectators had made the effort well worthwhile. “We are proud of our course and this tournament will have done much to popularise it and make it known in other parts of the North Island and New Zealand generally”. Mr Randell went on to say that the tournament had been staged with the dual objectives of showing players what a good course Tauranga was and to provide young players with the opportunity to see the best New Zealand golfers in action. Both objectives had been achieved.

On the Tuesday following the tournament the BOP Times published a number of comments by participants. These included:
Frank Buckler: “A beautiful course in excellent order. The only fault that could be found is that it might be short. Otherwise it is up to New Zealand championship standard. Compared to Auckland courses at this time of the year the condition of fairways and greens is simply amazing. The hazards are good and well laid out”.

Alex Murray: “The course was 100% in all respects. The fact that not one golfer in the field broke 70 showed the course is neither too short nor too easy. Conditions were ideal, no wind nor rain, yet the best 54 hole total was three over par. The green keepers are to be congratulated on excellent presentation and I believe the course would be ideal for a National championship”.

Bob Jackson: “The best conditioned course I have ever played on. The bunkers too are the best conditioned I have seen in New Zealand. Their condition does not put a player in a hopeless position yet they do test his skill”.

Editor’s note: At the time of the 1953 tournament the sand in the bunkers was pumice sand that was dug from a pit on what is now the back of the fourth tee. When dry and stirred up to a fluffy state this material provided an excellent medium from which to play the old-fashioned explosion shot favoured by players of the time. After rain however it became hard packed and difficult from which to gain much control over recovery shots even for talented players. It was not until 1963 that Papamoa sand was tried on the course and today players are fortunate to have bunkers filled with quality river sand. While players now may complain of bad lies and insufficient sand in bunkers I doubt they would appreciate a return to the pumice sand of those years. The heavier sand does require a different technique and the modern club player might be better rewarded by learning to use the correct approach rather than complaining about the state of the bunkers. All in all though it is worth remembering that bunkers are supposed to be hazards irrespective of what we see on our television screens.

TS Galloway (President NZPGA): “I saw the course first in 1924 and again in 1939. It has improved out of all sight. It is in my opinion one of the best country courses I have seen. The short fourth is a gem and the fifteenth one of the best par fours I have experienced”.

Basil Smith Jnr: “I have not seen a course more perfectly grassed. I have not heard one adverse comment regarding the course nor any part of the tournament. The Club is to be congratulated not only on the fine course, which is well up to National Championship standard, but also on a very fine tournament”.

TP Jones: “It is a grand course in every respect and, having won, I think it is just perfect. It is my first visit but I will be back”.

From the above comments it is clear that the staff and administrators of the time were getting many things right and the professionals appreciated the effort made to offer them an opportunity to play for a prize purse and for the opportunity to meet with their colleagues in convivial surroundings.

ALEX SHATTERS THE COURSE RECORD

The 1954 staging of the Invitation Tournament was notable for a brilliant round of 64, or seven under par, played by Alex Murray on the opening day of the tournament. The previous record stood at 68, a record shared by perennial club champion F W (Fred) Ward and the great Australian P W (Peter)

Thomson. Murray scored birdies at the 1st, 2nd, 5th, 7th, 10th, 12th, and 14th holes with not a single blemish on the card. One who witnessed the round remarked that Murray had seldom been on his own fairway but the quality of his iron play was such that he almost always reached the green in regulation. At the time the trees were 50 years younger and did not present quite the difficulties experienced today but, given the equipment of the time, this round compares very favourably with any that have followed since. Alex Murray, born in Scotland, was the son of a professional golfer and, so steeped in golf was the family, that no fewer than eleven uncles were also professionals. Murray showed his quality in winning three New Zealand Opens and would have won another but for his famous error in idly tapping his ball with his putter while waiting to putt during the final round at St. Andrews in Hamilton in 1937.

Despite shooting 69s in the first and final rounds Ernie Southerden of Napier finished two strokes behind Murray while Jim Paterson, now of Tauranga, repeated his third placing of the year before. Further down the field could be seen the name A E (Alf) Guy, a player renowned for his long hitting though his best days were now behind him. The BOP Times recorded that Alf thrilled the gallery by almost driving the 299 yard second hole. As Alf Guy was still one of the longest drivers in the game this gives some indication of the advancement made in ball and club technology as such drives as he achieved are now well within the range of a good number of club players

BUCKLER PREVAILS AGAIN IN 1955

Playing the most consistent golf seen to this time at Tauranga Frank Buckler left a quality field far in his wake following rounds of 72, 67, and 67. While not faultless his play was such as to leave the large gallery greatly impressed with the accuracy of his iron play and the quality of his putting.
Regular place getters Ernie Southerden and Jim Paterson followed Buckler thanks to each scoring a 69 in one of their three rounds. The Akarana amateur Neville Dowden also scored a 69 in annexing the amateur section.

1956 THE EMPEROR PAYS A VISIT

In 1956 the reigning amateur champion of New Zealand, S G (Stuart) Jones of Hastings, was attracted to the tournament and he did not let the gallery or his reputation down. With rounds of 70, 73, and a superb final round of 66 “The Emperor”, as he became widely known during his long and illustrious career, outplayed the professional and amateur fields alike by many strokes. This was not to be the last time that Jones demonstrated to the professionals that it was perhaps fortuitous for them that he preferred to remain within the amateur ranks.

Popular winner amongst the professional division was local man J A (Jimmy) Paterson. A true gentleman of the links Jim learnt his trade in England and was one of the finest iron players one could hope to emulate. His well-struck iron shots seemed to fly quite low off the club then, as they slowed, they would rise so as to drop gently onto the green. It was a great pity that Jimmy’s nervous system did not allow him to consistently play the brand of golf of which he was so obviously capable. On this occasion he held his nerve well enough to finish on 217, four over par and two clear of Jack Kelly of Auckland.

Bob Jackson, on this occasion, thanked the club on behalf of the professionals. He commented there

was a special atmosphere in particular clubs and that at Tauranga was one of being “at home”. The Professionals looked forward to coming to the club and to the town each year as a result of this special feeling.

1957 - BIG TED ENTERS THE SCENE

E J (Ted) McDougall, then of Pukekohe, was to become a regular visitor to Tauranga over many years, both as an amateur and as a professional. He was just 19 when he won the Lionel Smith Rose Bowl as leading amateur in the 1957 tournament. Born in Scotland Ted was to become an outstanding competitor at every level of New Zealand golf. Following his Tauranga victory he went on to win the National amateur championship later in the season. As Jones had done the previous Invitation Tournament McDougall put the professionals in the shade as he improved on each of his rounds carding 73, 71, and a final 67 to lead Ross Newdick, later to win a PGA title at Mt Maunganui, by five strokes. Ernie Southerden headed the Professional field one stroke behind Newdick with Buckler another stroke adrift. Stuart Jones honoured his pledge of the year before to return to Tauranga but an uncharacteristic 81 in his opening round put paid to any chance of him successfully defending his title. In accepting his prize from club president Warwick Nicoll Mr McDougall congratulated the committee on the course. The greens, he said, were much superior to any in Auckland.

BUCKLER AGAIN IN 1958

The 1958 tournament was notable for Frank Buckler’s third win in the six tournaments staged to that date and for the victory of W W Smith in the amateur section. WW had played in each tournament since inception without winning the Lionel Smith Rose Bowl, the major trophy for amateurs. Scoring was not up to the standard set in earlier years with Smith averaging 72s and Buckler one stroke worse on 217.

The 16 year-old Aucklander W J (Walter) Godfrey impressed many in the gallery. The BOP Times sports reporter of the day wrote in his tournament coverage that Godfrey’s easy swing indicated he would produce fine golf as he developed physically. How right his prophecy proved to be.

McDOUGALL REPEATS IN 1959

Now a member of the professional ranks Ted McDougall thrilled a large gallery in his first round by scoring a 67 after which he was never threatened, finishing nine strokes clear of veteran Alf Guy with a further stroke back to Frank Buckler in third position. In spite of this success so early in his professional life McDougall rejoined the amateur ranks less than two years later and went on to have a distinguished career there, a second victory in the New Zealand amateur championship coming in 1970.

A C (Alf) Relph of Rotorua was a very popular winner of the Lionel Smith Rose Bowl finishing seven strokes clear of R A Court of New Plymouth. Alf Relph was a wonderful servant of Rotorua and Bay of Plenty Golf for many years representing each as a player and as an administrator. He is one of only four men to be honoured with Life Membership of the Bay of Plenty District Golf Association. Our own Jim Reid, who served as Captain and later President of our Club in the sixties, was one of the other three. Following the amalgamation of the administration of men’s golf with that of women the BOPDGA has now been re-incorporated as GolfBOP. In 2009 Dan Dougherty, President of our Club from 1991 to

1993, was honoured with Life Membership of the new organisation.

AMATEURS SHOW THE WAY IN 1960

Alf Relph was again successful in the tournament of 1960. This event began in atrocious conditions under which most courses would have been virtually unplayable. Despite persistent heavy rain and gusty northerly winds Relph returned a remarkable score of just one over par. Bay of Plenty team mate D K (Don) Boone of Springfield was only one stroke behind. Sunday brought much more favourable conditions and a good sized gallery saw Relph drop only one further stroke over the two rounds to finish on 215. Boone also maintained form to finish a clear second on 218. Professional winner John Kelly of Auckland finished some distance behind these two but he did improve markedly on the 77 returned under the trying conditions of the previous day.

PROFESSIONAL PRIDE RESTORED IN 1961

Auckland professional, and regular participant, Bob Jackson led a quartet of professionals who relegated the amateurs to the lower spots on the Leader Board in the 1961 renewal of the event. The tournament attracted a strong field of 16 professionals and 56 amateurs. Jackson highlighted the weekend with a hole in one at the fourth hole, “The Gully”, on the Sunday afternoon. It has long been said that if you play the par threes well at Tauranga you will have a good round. This may be self-evident from the very fact that there are five of them here while most courses have only the standard four. The adage was surely true of Jackson on that afternoon for his aggregate of 12, or three under par, on the par threes led to a three under round of 68. With earlier rounds of 72 and 73 Bob won by four strokes from Noel Hayden, a good friend of Tauranga golf and a man who did a great deal for Junior Golf, first from his base in Rotorua and later in Auckland. It was good to see Bob Jackson succeeding as he had been a strong supporter of the tournament from the first staging.

Eldon Carswell of Rotorua who had almost certainly been one to benefit from Noel Hayden’s interest in juniors, led the amateurs with a rather uninspired total of 13 over par for the 54 holes. Carswell himself was heard to say he would have been much happier had he shot three seventies and finished second. Another prominent BOP representative in Ivan Deadman of Rotorua finished one stroke behind Carswell with Don Boone making it a Rotorua trifecta a further stroke back.

1962 - THE WOMEN ARE INVITED

Always willing to be innovative the organising committee decided to invite women (though they were still called lady golfers at the time) to the tournament. This was believed to be the first time women had been invited to participate in an open tournament of this nature in New Zealand. The initiative was very warmly received by the low handicap women invited. In the event itself local champion Miss Una Wickham had to bow to Mrs Jean Mangan of Palmerston North. The two were separated by a single stroke, Miss Wickham uncharacteristically missing a short putt at the last hole that would have tied the pair. Both women were New Zealand representatives so the aim of the promoters to provide competition for these women prior to the Tasman Cup series proved to be successful.

Meanwhile New Zealand Men’s Representative Walter Godfrey burnt off a strong amateur field with an

excellent closing round of 67. Apart from a sponsored tournament held earlier in the season at Akarana the amateur field assembled at Tauranga was said to be the best assembled in New Zealand that year. Appearing on the leader board were regular supporters of Tauranga tournaments including Peter Maude (Otorohanga), Terry Leech (Taupo), Ross Newdick (Auckland), Trevor Ormsby (Otorohanga), and Frank Cullen (Matamata).

In the professional division the two regular placegetters, Ernie Southerden and Jim Paterson, along with Irishman Eddie Fennell of Gisborne, fought out a close contest with Southerden edging home by a stroke from the other two. Paterson should have won in a canter but for an uncharacteristic 82 in the middle round. No player, amateur or professional, came close to emulating Godfrey's tournament total or his best round of 67.

In an unusual and much appreciated gesture Frank Buckler, now president of the NZPGA, presented trophies on behalf of the PGA to the Men's and Women's club captains of the Tauranga Golf Club "in appreciation of what the Club is doing, and trying to do, for golf in New Zealand".

BUCKLER WINS AGAIN IN 1963

Frank Buckler crossed the Kaimai ranges once again to annexe his fourth Tauranga Invitational on what must surely be his favourite course. The Canada Cup representative finished four under the card this time playing consistently good rounds of 69, 72, and 68. On this occasion no one amongst Buckler's professional colleagues could mount a serious challenge with only the long hitting amateur Peter Maude lying close after the first round. Maude held on to win the amateur title in spite of relatively poor rounds of 75 and 73 on the Sunday. Ross Newdick finished two strokes behind Maude.

The gap between Tauranga's best and those from elsewhere in New Zealand was demonstrated when Tauranga's leading competitor, D K (Doug) Furrie, finished eleven strokes shy of Peter Maude's total while another four local players were much further adrift. It was to be many years before Tauranga men began to make their mark at National level. In the case of the women however the club had seen much stronger representation and local star Una Wickham was a popular winner of the Women's division despite scoring rather more poorly than was her norm. Six strokes behind Una Sally Turvey, the 16 year old from Rotorua, threw out an indication of the future of the game as young players gradually came to the fore. Another youngster from Rotorua, Jane Butler, also gave an indication of her potential, only a poor middle round preventing her from challenging for the lead. Jane went on to a very successful career in golf and is now better known as Jane Little. In common with many quality players Jane's father was a Green Keeper so she was in touch with the game from a very early age.

RECORDS APLENTY IN 1964

As the result of some changes to the course that really had little impact on its playing difficulty the course record of 64 set by Alex Murray ten years earlier was no longer recognised as applying to "the new course". Consequently new records in both the Amateur and the Professional sections were recognised as the result of scores posted in the 1964 tournament. Walter Godfrey, now a professional, set the pace all the way with rounds of 69, 67 (recognised as the new record), and 72. Godfrey dropped

only one stroke during his record round, that being at the relatively easy tenth thus illustrating there are no easy holes in golf. Good as it was Godfrey's record was to last only as long as it took Terry Leech of Taupo to complete his afternoon round. Leech (son of legendary Taupo Green Keeper Charley Leech) had played the first two rounds very well in 70 and 72 to trail Ted McDougall by four strokes in the Amateur section of the tournament. Heavy overnight rain resulted in the greens playing slow and the fairways long on the Sunday. To add to these conditions drizzly rain fell throughout the afternoon. In spite of this Terry Leech played some of the greatest golf ever seen on the course during his round of 65. His outward nine of 34, thanks to a birdie at the long seventh, did not suggest what was to follow on the final, more difficult, second nine. Birdies at the 10th, 11th, 13th, and 15th, together with an eagle three on the short par five 17th were offset by a shot dropped at the par three 14th. To annex the Amateur prize Leech needed this score or better as McDougall continued his good form with a one-under-par round of 70 to finish just one stroke back.

Jane Butler, now representing the North Shore Club, won the Women's section on count back from Miss P Harrison on the strength of a final round of 77, three better than her rival. Incidentally this result would have been reversed had the committee adopted an alternative count back method that gives priority to the lowest round of the tournament. It is obviously important to have all tournament conditions published before the event. An indication of the strength of women's golf at our own Club was given by the placing of both Olga Johnson and Pat Kidd in the top ten, while Una Wickham was not a competitor that year.

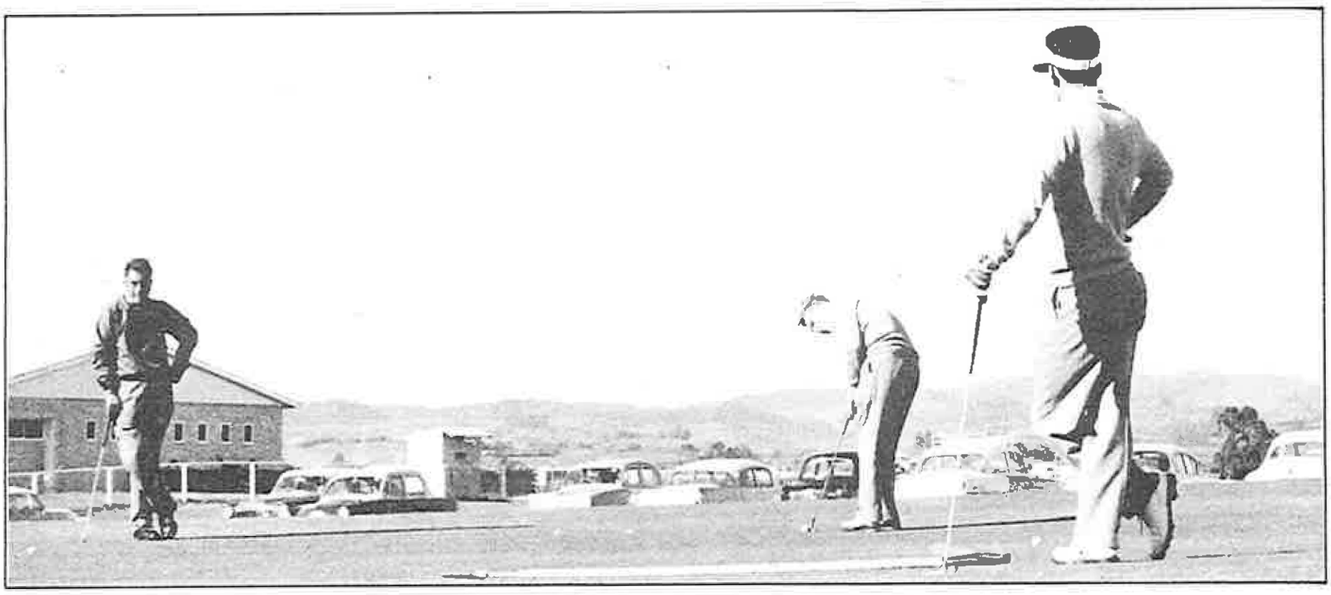
WALTER WINS AGAIN IN 1965

Although he was not able to reproduce the brilliance of the previous year Walter Godfrey again won the Professional section. Commencing with a 72 he improved a stroke in each round to defeat evergreen Ernie Southerden by three strokes. Interestingly the pair showed the same scoring pattern with Ernie starting one stroke higher on 73. In similar vein Terry Leech played steadily without the extra inspiration of the previous year and his four-over-par total of 217 was not good enough to hold out rising star Brian Boys of Hamilton who sandwiched a 75 between two 69s. Tauranga's Keith Dawkins claimed fourth place, the best performance by a local man in the history of the event, still nine strokes off the pace.

Thanks to an opening round of 71 Miss Natalie White of Auckland, a New Zealand representative, headed Miss Wickham by 10 strokes after the first 18 holes. Using all her experience and wealth of local knowledge to close the gap Una failed to do so by three strokes. Mrs Olga Johnson, another local, was two strokes back in third place.

Don Stevenson one morning bought a new ball at the Pro Shop when Jim Paterson was the incumbent. Don teed up and promptly toed his new ball back into the shop, breaking a large window on the way. Many will remember Don's wife Sylvie who was an active and very popular member over at least forty years commencing in the early sixties.

Action on the sixth green during the 1962 Invitation Tournament.
Ted MacDougall (back to camera) shows why he was known as "Big Ted".



Golf at Gate Pa

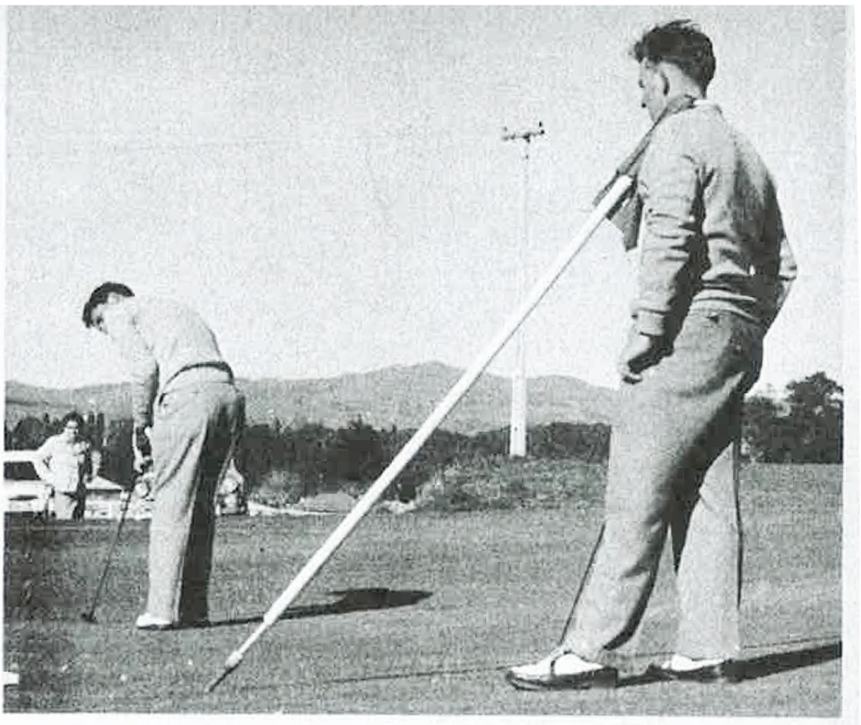
At the beginning of the month the Annual Amateur Invitation and £200 Professional Tournament was held on Tauranga's Gate Pa course.

Above: John Means lines up for a putt watched by Ernie Sutherland (left), and Walter Godfrey, while (below), the trio check their scorecards.

Left: Una Wickham in action.

Bottom left: Miss N.White of Auckland lines up a drive.

Scenes from the 1962 Invitation Tournament courtesy Photo News.
Corrections: Ernie Southerden is called Sutherland in first photo caption. It is Terry Leech not Tony.
Roy Bathgate - Club Captain - checks a competitor's card.



The young Auckland golfer and New Zealand representative Walter Godfrey was the star of the tournament and excitement was rife among the 500 spectators who followed his final round when, at the 18th, he needed to sink a six-foot putt to break the course record.

But the honour eluded Godfrey and he had to be content with the amateur tournament title--and the honour of sharing the course record.

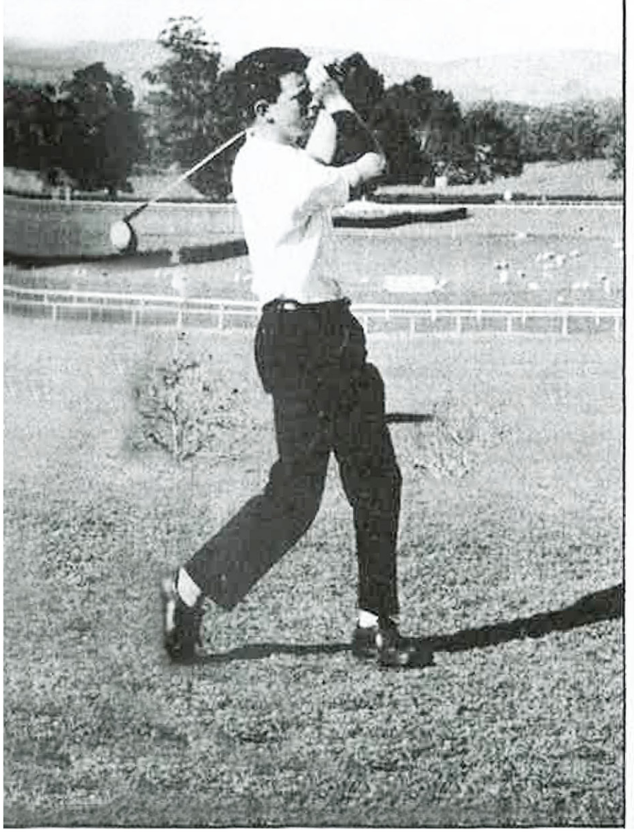
Above: Godfrey lining up a putt on the 10th.

Right: Watched by John Means, he sinks a short one.

Below, left (opposite page): John Means, Walter Godfrey, and Ernie Southerden (Napier professional who won the "pro" contest) check score cards.

Bottom left: Tony Leech of Taupo drives off.

Below: Roy Bathgate checks his scorecard.



CHAPTER TWENTYONE

THE SPALDING MASTERS AND THE NZPGA CHAMPIONSHIP

The 1965 Tournament proved to be the last of the Invitation Tournaments to be held at Tauranga but by no means did it herald the end of quality Professional and Amateur tournaments at the club. We were soon to see even bigger and brighter stars on show thanks to the initiative of local businessman R A (Bob) Owens; later Sir Bob. In 1965 Mr Owens had been instrumental in establishing the NZPGA Championship at Mount Maunganui. Prior to that time the Professional Championship of New Zealand was run by the New Zealand Golf Association in conjunction with their Open Championship and, like the Amateur Championship, it was a match play event following the Open. The Professional Championship was not played in 1964 and Mr Owens saw the opportunity to promote the Tauranga area, his company, and the game of golf. Once he settled upon a course of action Mr Owens was the type of man who made certain that a positive outcome ensued and the first STARS Travel (Stevedores Travel and Reservation Service) NZPGA Championship was held before enthusiastic, beach dressed, galleries at the height of summer in January 1965.

During these years a fledgling New Zealand Golf Circuit had developed with sponsored events being played at courses throughout the country. The committee at Tauranga felt it would be wise to drop the June/July Invitation Tournament and concentrate their efforts on becoming part of that circuit by promoting an event in January while visiting Professionals from New Zealand and Overseas were in the district. It was therefore fortuitous that in April 1967 the Spalding Company, then possibly the most important sporting goods company serving New Zealand, approached Tauranga with a view to staging the Spalding Masters as a pre-curser to the NZPGA at the Mount. The initiative Tauranga had shown in offering competition and prize money for the Professionals in earlier years when very little was provided for them undoubtedly had much to do with the approach now being made. As was to be expected Tauranga enthusiastically accepted the Spalding offer and the Tournament was scheduled for the 8th/9th of January 1968 over 54 holes for prize money of £1000. The Spalding Company put up £750 while the club decided to put in a further £250 so as to make the purse appear so much more attractive. This was considered an excellent purse at the time especially as the Professional purse for the Invitation Tournament had been only £200. Prior to the tournament New Zealand adopted decimal currency so the field ultimately played for total prize money of $2000. This was sufficient to attract a quality field headed by reigning PGA champion of Australia E W (Billy) Dunk.

The first day of the tournament saw a spate of sub par scoring which resulted in the accepted course record of 67 set by Walter Godfrey in 1964 being bettered no less than five times during the day before the 20 year old John Lister of Timaru settled the issue with a 64 towards the end of the day. There will always be debate about what constitutes a course record and many will feel as I do that this 64 only equalled the 64 scored by Alex Murray fourteen years previously. In the intervening period the course had been altered by siting the tee at the par three fifth to the South so the hole paralleled the seventh fairway and was some 30 metres longer. How much more difficult this made the course is impossible to measure, but since 64 was to be bettered within twelve months the question did not remain relevant for very long. On the more general question of course records it could be argued that they belong in the same genera as the fastest times in Marathons. There is no record for a Marathon as courses differ so much from one to another. In the same way Golf Courses do not offer the same conditions from one day to the next. Pin positions, tee positions, weather conditions, and condition of greens, fairways and

rough all change on a daily basis. Provided a round is played in accordance with the Rules of Golf and the course is set up from the normal teeing grounds then the lowest score ever recorded gets my vote as the 'course record'.

On that first day in 1968 six under par rounds of 65 were scored by Billy Dunk and Denis Sullivan (North Shore), 66s from Bob Stanton (NSW), Walter Godfrey (Auckland) and John Croskery (Remuera), and 67s from Len Thomas (Western Australia) and Terry Kendall (Manor Park). Sullivan's round included an Out of Bounds penalty at the thirteenth so a 63 had certainly been a possibility. The long hitting Dutchman, Martin Roesink, who had attracted very large galleries during the first two rounds was well down the field with rounds of 72 and 71. As a result the fans had deserted him when he embarked on his third and final round. That was unfortunate as they would have been treated to some wonderful entertainment. Roesink showed his true ability with a faultless 63, four under on each nine, to wrest the record from John Lister. It was claimed that Roesink drove the third green during this round but only his playing companions and their caddies were witness to the feat. Driving the third green was unheard of at that time yet today a number of club players drive across the trees in the direction of the green and occasionally one will reach it. Martin Roesink was later to try his luck in the United States where at least one Golf magazine claimed he was the longest hitter on the circuit. Unfortunately the rest of his game seldom reached the standard of his driving, perhaps because in his own words he "kept looking around to see who was on the course". The handsome Dutchman was certainly popular with female spectators and it may be understandable that his concentration was sometimes less than 100% on his game. A further example of his hitting ability was in evidence one day when he drove into the seventh fairway when playing the sixth. From there he lofted a nine iron over the pines and into the heart of the green. This was before the advent of the one-piece ball and metal drivers and, no, the pines were no less lofty than they are today.

In spite of missing a 'tiddler' on the 54th and final green Billy Dunk, a man renowned for setting course records in Australia, completed immaculate rounds of 65, 66, and 67 to defeat Tasmanian Bob Shaw whose closing 64 left him two strokes in arrears. Ted McDougall was an impressive winner of the Amateur division with rounds of 69, 66, and 66. In all 24 competitors aggregated par or better through the 54 holes.

MORE FIRSTS IN THE 1969 SPALDING MASTERS

The organising committee were delighted to accept the offer of the Spalding Company to have the great American Professional Miss Marilynn Smith play in the 1969 tournament scheduled to be played over 72 holes for the first time. It was no accident that Miss Smith was drawn to play in a dream grouping with New Zealand's best Amateur and Professional, Stuart Jones and Bob Charles respectively. This was the first occasion that a woman had played in men's company in any Open Tournament in New Zealand and proved extremely popular with the crowds that thronged the course. Playing before a gallery estimated at 600 these three all played excellent golf. Charles showed his class with a 66, Jones shot a 69, and Marilynn Smith a 74. Miss Smith expressed the opinion that New Zealand women's

golf would be greatly stimulated if New Zealand women were to join the USA Professional Tour. She believed that Tauranga's Una Wickham and Natalie White of Auckland "could fare well on the circuit though would have to be helped initially through considerable financial backing". Twentyfour players bettered par while 19-year old Jim Lancaster of the host club returned an excellent 70 in his first tournament at this level.

Teeing off in the second round Charles led by just one stroke from Guy Wolstenholme of England and Ted Ball of NSW. He soon showed he meant business with a superb round of 62 featuring eight birdies and no dropped shots, par having been dropped to 70 with the 17th hole now correctly identified as a par four. Charles commented after the round that he "holed every putt within ten feet except one on the 14th, but my only really good birdie putt was on the seventh". Ted Ball, of the lightning fast swing trailed by seven strokes and was heard to comment: "There is only one man who can stop Charles on this course. That's Kel Nagle and he's in Australia". How prophetic those words were to prove as Charles compiled rounds of 69 and 63 in the final rounds to finish on 260, twenty under par and ten strokes clear of John Lister in second place.

Meanwhile Marilynn Smith demonstrated that women playing off the back tees on a course set to test the best men would always have difficulty competing against them. Never the less the quality of her ball striking and general play impressed the spectators, both male and female, who were privileged to see her in action. Her best round was a 73.

Paul Hart, an unheralded NSW professional, matched Charles' record 62 during his third round, a feat witnessed by a mere handful of spectators until word of his deeds spread late in the day. With his other three rounds including a pair of 69s and a 71 Hart tied for third with Bob Shaw and Brian Boys. Stuart Jones made no contest of the Amateur division with a seven under aggregate including a fine 65 in the second round.

When asked by the BOP Times reporter for comment following the tournament the following were representative of the replies received:
Bob Charles: "The finest greens in New Zealand".
Dennis Sullivan: "That seventeenth green would grace any course in the World".
Guy Wolstenholme: "They have really worked hard on the course and the greens have been prepared by someone knowledgeable and are as good as anything in New Zealand".
Bob Shaw - recently returned from playing in Europe and the USA. "The only bad green is the 15th. The rest would compare favourably with anything I have played on".
Jess Vaughn (USA): "The course is as good as any I played on in England, the United States, or Australia, and would be on a par with many competition courses in the United States".
Marilynn Smith: "I found the course very much the same as Overseas, the greens being very true with no hidden tricks".

Editor's note: With respect to the comments above it should be noted that, at the time of this tournament, the 15th green had been struck by an as then unrecognised fungal infection while the 17th had not yet

been relocated to its present position.)

1970 - THE EMPEROR RULES

Otago Professional Alistair Palmer led with a 65 on the first day but a crowd of Australians, led by then five times British Open Champion Peter Thomson, loomed in his wake. This threat soon became reality as Thomson added a 66 to his opening 68. Another seven Australians were within two strokes of his lead. Three strokes further back Stuart Jones and Aucklander Bob Gillespie, who had aced the gully during his opening round, headed the Amateurs. During his round American Jesse Vaughn scored what must rank as one of the more spectacular eagles to have been recorded on the course. Playing the sixth hole Vaughn's tee shot found the fairway bunker that used to feature some twenty metres short of the tenth green. From there a magnificent stroke sent the ball to the heart of the sixth green where a five-metre putt completed an unlikely eagle. Many years later local man Josh Geary, runner up to Gavin Smillie in our Senior Championship final when just a schoolboy, went one better by holing out with a three iron from another now defunct fairway bunker for an albatross two on our 13th hole during the annual under-23 age group tournament held on the course.

Surprisingly Peter Thomson, after his strong start, dropped away in the third round leaving three other Australians, Vic Bennets, Paul Morgan, and Barry Coxon, as the main contenders moving into the afternoon's final round. No one was picking Stuart Jones to pose a threat to the leaders despite his steady rounds of 68, 71 and 70. While it is now unheard of for Professionals to be required to play two rounds on the final day of a tournament it was common practice in earlier years and the fourth round would fully test the mental and physical resources of all the contestants during a hot Tauranga day in January.

Jones, playing in a threesome with Coxon and Wolstenholme, birdied the two long holes on the front nine to be out in 33 making up just one of the three strokes by which he trailed Coxon. Meanwhile Wolstenholme overtook them both only to fall away on the more difficult second nine holes as many another has done before and since. It was not to be until the 16th that Jones was able to draw level with Coxon and, with Bennets also fading over the closing holes, it was down to these two to fight out the finish. To the delight of the gallery it was the Amateur who prevailed, his closing 66 being too good for Coxon's even par 70.

By the end of this round some players were suffering quite markedly from heat exhaustion or possible sunstroke and it was considered unlikely that competitors would ever again be scheduled to play 36 holes in one day under these conditions. The difficult conditions seemingly did not adversely trouble Australian David Graham who climbed many places up the leader board with a closing 64. Graham went on to join the PGA Tour in the USA where he won the USPGA Championship in 1979 and their Open Championship two years later. He later became known as "the club maker to the pros" designing and fitting clubs to suit each individual.

SNAPE SETS THE PACE IN 1971

Transplanted Australian Alan Snape, who had recently qualified as a member of the NZPGA and was later to become resident Professional at the Tauranga Club, led a quality field through the first two

rounds at eight under par. Unfortunately Alan was destined to strike disaster in the third round and thus drop from contention as more favoured contenders such as Charles, Marsh, Wolstenholme and Lister made their way up the leader board. This year the tournament had drawn the usual contingent of Australian and New Zealand Professionals but was made more International by the presence of a strong group of Americans headed by PGA Tour winner Larry Ziegler who was at that time 37th on their money list. Included in the American contingent were three young men who arrived in the belief that they were entered in this tournament and in the PGA Championship at the Mount. It transpired they had been let down by their New Zealand contact and organisers here had not heard of them. Fortunately the NZPGA and local organisers were flexible enough to allow their late entries and they were included in both fields. One member of this group, Jim Albus, responded by heading the first day leader board with a grand 64, six under par, a score he maintained to the end of the tournament to finish in eighth place. Years later Albus was to feature prominently on the Seniors Tour in America over a number of seasons. Fellow American Ziegler may well have won the tournament but for a poor round of 74 sandwiched between a 67 and a final pair of 65s.

Bob Charles and Graham Marsh, brother of Australian wicket keeper Rodney, were paired in a Trans Tasman battle that enthralled the large gallery that accompanied them throughout the afternoon in spite of rain that fell midway through the round. The contest became a virtual singles match between the pair until Wolstenholme, playing three holes ahead, looked likely to upset that scenario as he rose to the top of the leader board with just five holes to play. His bad hole came at the par three 14th but he held his game together over the closing holes to post a twelve under par total of 268. At that stage Charles and Marsh were also twelve under and playing the 16th. Marsh birdied that hole to move into the lead. Uncharacteristically Charles missed a putt of little more than a metre on the 17th to yield second place to Wolstenholme while Marsh gave the gallery a final thrill by playing a great iron shot to the 18th green. He made no mistake with the resultant two metre putt to round out a convincing victory. His total of 266 was made up of two 67s followed by two 66s, consistent excellence by a grand sportsman.

While the long 13th hole, “The Crescent”, proves the undoing of many a player Graham Marsh rated it his favourite hole. He commented: “I had two eagles, a birdie and a par there. It seems a simple hole but it does not allow you to get away with much”. Most club players would agree with him, at least in regard to the second sentiment.

An interesting incident occurred on the fourth hole during this round when Marsh’s tee shot struck the lip of the front bunker and fell back in. On reaching the green Marsh walked along the green above the bunker and pointed his club at the spot where the ball had struck. In doing so he disturbed a grain or two of sand. On reporting this to Charles the pair became concerned that a rule may have been infringed so the Rules Committee were called upon. After consulting with eye witnesses the committee ruled no advantage had been gained by the inadvertent disturbance of a few grains of sand and no testing of the condition of the hazard had resulted so no penalty would be imposed. Both Charles, and obviously Marsh, were happy with this decision. Later Larry Ziegler, on hearing of the incident commented: “The committee made the sensible and wise decision. However had it happened on the PGA Tour at home a penalty would have been imposed”.

Scoring in the 1971 event was remarkably good throughout the field with 64 rounds under the par of 70 being recorded while five players were under par in every round. Fifteen players bettered the 72-hole par of 280 including Amateur winner Ted McDougall.

1972 - TO CHARLES THE GLORY, TO MACKLIN THE SPOILS

The 1972 staging of the Spalding Masters, which also proved to be the last, featured a $3000 prize for a hole in one on the fourteenth hole. Murray Macklin, born in Tauranga but resident of Masterton, took the prize with a four iron shot during his second round. Under PGA rules Macklin, as a Probationary Professional, was unable to receive prize money from the tournament but special prizes such as those for holes in one were exempt from this policy so he was free to take the $3000. Later Bob Charles commented tongue in cheek: “I get only $1000 for playing 54 holes. Murray plays one shot and pockets $3000. Is that fair”? In reality of course Bob was only too happy for Murray, especially as he came from Bob’s hometown of Masterton.

While the field included some interesting newcomers, plus the usual representation from New Zealand and Australia, the leader board featured old rivals Bob Charles and Guy Wolstenholme from the first day. These two matched one another stroke for stroke with identical totals of 67 and 68 before Charles pulled clear with 65 against Wolstenholme’s 67 in the final round. Terry Kendall was a further four strokes back in third place while locals were delighted with the performance of their star junior, 18 year old Michael Nicholson, who annexed Amateur honours with grand rounds of 72, 69, and 69. An excellent photographic study of the two winners can be seen hanging in the clubhouse. Top honours to Michael in this tournament contributed to a great month for him which included a tie for leading Amateur in the City of Auckland Open at the Grange and a win in the New Zealand under 23 Championship played at Bridge Pa, Hastings. A closing 66 in that event emphasised the quality of Michael’s play.

A deluge during play of the third round of the 1972 Spalding which flooded many of the greens eventually forced the organisers to abandon that round and reduce the tournament to 54 holes. Though some players who were in the last stages of their rounds, including one who was reputedly seven under after the 14th, were very upset at the decision the committee had no choice. While greens on the final few holes were playable and the complaining players could have comfortably completed their rounds those on the front of the course had no chance of doing so. With the NZPGA Tournament scheduled to commence at The Mount there were no spare days available to complete a fourth round.

Following his victory at Tauranga Bob Charles was poised to become the first player to win $10 000 in a New Zealand season. Finishing in the top four places at Mount Maunganui would achieve that milestone.

TAURANGA STAGES 1974 NZPGA CHAMPIONSHIP

Sadly the 1972 staging brought down the curtain on the five year show that had seen the Spalding Masters attract quality golfers to Tauranga from many parts of the world. Those players had provided appreciative galleries with competitive, exciting golf. Fortunately the fans would not have to wait long for

the show to return to Gate Pa but the Spalding Masters itself was now confined to history. Tauranga's next opportunity to stage a major tournament came through the misfortunes of the Mount Maunganui club. Subsequent to the staging of the 1973 NZPGA Championship on the course the greens there were struck by disease to such an extent that they had to be completely worked up and resown. As a result Tauranga was asked to stand by in case the Mount was not ready in time for the 1974 tournament. This proved to be the case and Tauranga staged its first NZPGA tournament in January 1974. The loss of their greens proved to be a blessing in disguise for the Mount Club as the new Pencross greens proved to be a great success earning high praise when the Club later hosted a number of prestigious tournaments including two Men's Inter Provincial Teams events, the most recent in 2008 being won by the Bay of Plenty.

The 1974 PGA Championship brought Ted Ball's comments of 1969 into sharp relief. That great gentleman of Australian golf, Kel Nagle, came to Tauranga and quickly demonstrated his talents. He showed he meant business even in the more relaxed atmosphere of the Pro/Am traditionally played the day before the tournament proper. On that day the American, Jerry Breaux, matched the score of 62 set by Charles and Hart in 1969 only to see Nagle better this by a stroke within the hour. Nagle's 61 was free of blemish and contained seven birdies and an eagle three at the seventh. The latter helped him to a 29 outward nine. Breaux' round was even more spectacular with eagles at the sixth, seventh and tenth holes to go with five birdies. Dropped shots at the second, fifth, and seventeenth holes negated these to deny the American the chance to break 60. Perhaps to show that the Gate Pa course is not as benign as some are tempted to believe Breaux shot a 75 in the opening round of the tournament proper. Many a club golfer could empathise with this 13-stroke disparity between one round and the next. Breaux demonstrated his professionalism by shooting 7 under over the remaining three rounds to finish in a tie for fifteenth, a placing shared with Michael Nicholson, the leading Amateur. Michael's final three rounds were all sub par following an opening 73, another meritorious tournament for the young star.

New Zealand World Cup representative Dennis Clark of Palmerston North led the field with a 64 in the first round while players of the calibre of Lindsay Sharp, Kel Nagle and John Lister lay within three strokes of him. Nagle indicated his desire to win his sixth NZPGA title with a second round 64, three under on each nine, while Sharp kept in touch with a 66. Stewart Ginn, the popular and very fashionable Australian, was the prime mover with a 64 to add to his opening 69. Sharp would have been confident of closing the gap to Nagle following his third round 64 but it was not to be with Nagle also home in 64. The New Zealand Professional Walter Godfrey, a young man of enormous potential, made the strongest move, his 63 taking him to 13 under and just two strokes down on Nagle. In the final round it was Godfrey, playing with Nagle, who kept the pressure on the leader as others fell away. None the less the gap had increased to four by the time they teed up at the long 13th. Here Godfrey was long and straight while Nagle pushed his drive to the right. An attempt to cut a five iron around the big pine that once stood on that corner instead produced a draw and a visit to the racecourse. Even the greats get it wrong sometimes. Godfrey's two-putt birdie reduced the deficit to one and a real contest was on for the run home. The next three holes were halved in pars but Nagle bunkered at the 17th, came out too strongly, and they were square playing the 18th hole. This Nagle played to perfection. A long straight

drive presaged an immaculate iron to within 3 metres of the hole. A confident putt found the centre of the hole to ensure there was to be no further entertainment for the large gallery that day.

In an aside to the day's play Terry Kendall, having just made the cut for the final round, was drawn to play in a twosome at the head of the field. He and his fellow competitor completed their 18 holes in 2 hours 15 minutes with Terry shooting 67 to show it is possible to play quickly and still score well. It must be said neither player was too concerned about their position in the tournament so it was a very relaxed round. On the same subject long serving Greens Superintendent Grant Silvester was interviewed at this tournament on a number of aspects of play and he did comment that he had noticed a significant increase in the time taken to play a round of golf. "Five years ago a four could get around in little more than three hours and 3 1/2 hours was considered slow". Grant's view had some veracity as he was in a position to observe more rounds than practically anyone else over many years. Courses are more crowded these days so it is not realistic to expect to match the times of another age yet it does appear that there is a lot of room for improvement in the way modern club players manage their way around the course. Leaving your clubs in the right place, being ready to play when it is your turn, filling in the card while others are teeing off, saving social gossip for the clubhouse. These are all ways to save time and thus add to the enjoyment of everyone. Simple course management is perhaps something of a lost art. Four-hour rounds are now perhaps realistic and acceptable, much longer and they cause unnecessary frustration to the majority of the field. It is also apparent that there is now an unwritten law, at least on our course that: "Thou shalt let no other group play through even if you have lost two fairways and are searching for a ball". This is all really a little sad.

THE JUBILEE NZPGA CHAMPIONSHIP OF 1976

The legendary A J Shaw was a special guest at the 50th Jubilee Tournament staged at Tauranga in January 1976. Andy Shaw won seven New Zealand Open Championships between 1926 and 1936 together with seven Professional titles, the last of these in 1946. Born in Scotland he was a superb striker of the ball and, given the financial opportunity, was considered to have had the game to succeed on the American Tour. In exhibition matches in New Zealand he defeated both Gene Sarazen and Walter Hagen.

Californian visitor Bill Brask enlivened an unusually rainy January day when he equalled Kel Nagle's record 61 in the opening round. Eagles at 6 and 7 followed by birdies at each of the next three holes took Brask to nine under and the record looked there for the taking with eight holes left to play. Unfortunately fate, in the form of the weather, played a hand, the round being suspended for an hour as some greens became flooded. When play resumed Brask drove under the Lawsoniana to the right of the eleventh fairway to drop his first stroke. Birdies at 13 and 15 made it ten under but he was only able to score a five on the par 4 seventeenth as the rain poured down and when a birdie putt slipped by on 18 the record was equalled, not broken.

In spite of the conditions sixteen players beat the par of 70 with John Lister, Bob Charles, and Simon Owen all close enough to catch Brask should he falter. The second round will be remembered as the day Kel Nagle took seven strokes to complete "The Knoll", the infamous, seemingly innocuous, par-

three 12th hole that has ruined many a lesser player's day. While Nagle was effectively eliminating himself from contention fellow Australian David Good scored 61 to match the record held by Nagle and Brask. Good's ten birdies included twos at four of the five par threes, his one dropped shot coming from a five at the seventeenth. The course at the time these 61s were recorded measured 5602m, only 15m short of the course as measured from the blue tees today.

Good led Brask by a stroke with another two strokes back to Lister commencing the third round and the three put even more distance on the rest of the field with the first pair scoring 65s and Lister a 67. Good was the first to fade in the final round, his four bogeys in the middle of the round leading to a 72 and a third place finish earning him $1800 from the $20 000 prize pool, a very large purse at the time. Brask made the early move with a birdie at the second followed by an eagle and two more birdies in the next five holes. He looked all over the winner even when Lister started his own birdie barrage with four in succession starting with a two at the fifth. Following a spectacular shot from the now defunct fairway bunker to the heart of the 13th green Lister's eagle putt lipped out, the birdie leaving him still three behind with only five to play. To the disbelief of the gallery, and no doubt to his own, Brask bogeyed each of the final three holes to allow Lister to draw level at 17 under par. The stage was set for a dramatic play off made more pressured by the need for Brask to catch a plane for home. The playoff started at the 16th hole as only the latter part of the course was set up for TV coverage. The crowd that flocked there to follow the outcome was such that it enclosed the par four hole from tee to green two and three deep in places. The sight from the tee was impressive. The 16th was halved in pars before the pair moved on to the 17th where Lister launched an 8 iron from the centre of the fairway to within a metre of the pin to ensure the championship was his. A memorable occasion in the history of competitive golf in Tauranga, both for the pleasure derived from a New Zealand victory, and for the play and deportment of the man who had set the standard from the first moments of the tournament, Bill Brask.

A number of Professionals from New Zealand and Australia were sponsored by Air New Zealand at that time to act as ambassadors to the company. As part of the deal they were required to assist in putting on clinics for interested juniors at tournaments such as this. John Lister was one such and his input to the clinic held in Tauranga was outstanding. His clear demonstrations and explanations were of exceptional value to those attending and anyone fortunate to be present during his explanation of the correct way to handle bunker shots would be unlikely to have had much problem with those since.

THE NZPGA CHAMPIONSHIP OF 1978

Scoring during the opening day that year was surely the poorest for any major tournament held on the course. Among the few to break par was the popular Anglo Australian Guy Wolstenholme, a great supporter of New Zealand tournaments over those years. Scores improved on the second day with Wolstenholme heading New Zealand amateur representative Geoff Clarke of St. Clair by a stroke with Bob Charles best of the rest on even par. In spite of tournament best cards of 64 from Simon Owen and Stuart Reese in the third round the tournament looked to be Wolstenholme's for the taking following his second successive 67. This gave him a four-stroke lead at 7 under starting the final day.

Wolstenholme may have had a portent of things to come when he commented: "I'm in good shape for

tomorrow as long as the trees don't get in the way. The trees can make this course a bit tricky. You can be lucky or stone dead". This was prior to the "skirts" of the trees being raised off the ground as they now are and indeed one could be stone dead under many of them. The final day developed into a contest between Wolstenholme and Owen, though not head to head as Owen was two or three holes ahead in the field. Owen made some ground over the early holes before Wolstenholme regained his four-stroke lead with an eagle on the 7th. When Owen hit out of bounds at the 10th and then compounded the error by three putting the green his challenge was seemingly over. To his credit he did not allow the mistake to ruin his round, scoring three birdies in the final eight holes to post a 67. As Owen walked the 18th fairway he was still four behind Wolstenholme who was then playing the 16th. When they completed those holes the margin was down to a single stroke, Owen holing a four metre birdie putt while his rival struck tree trouble, then three putted for a double bogey six. Incredibly another double bogey followed at the 17th for the man who had made virtually no error in sixty nine previous holes. Thus Simon Owen, the man who was later to battle the great Jack Nicklaus right to the final hole of the British Open, found himself a surprise winner of the 1978 NZPGA Championship of New Zealand.

CHARLES' PUTTER FAILS TO DELIVER IN 1980

An air shot on the 15th hole when his swing encountered a small branch on his downswing cost Roger Davis, the man with his name on his socks, sole custody of the lead after round one of the 1980 NZPGA Championship. His 66 matched that of Kim Southerden, son of Ernie who was a three-time winner of the New Zealand Professional Championship during its earlier match play era. Ominously poised behind the leaders were Simon Owen and Bob Charles on 67 along with Rick Barker, later to become resident professional at Tauranga. American Mike Krantz and Billy Dunk scored 68s.

Charles put a break on the field with a second round 63 that featured eight birdies. Owen and Southerden held on three strokes back while Davis, Krantz, and Barker were still well in contention. Charles increased the lead with a third round 64 that might well have been even better. Playing partner Mike Krantz was quoted as saying: "I think Charles could beat the world on this course". Record books were being consulted to see if anyone had bettered 16 under par after three rounds and to see what Charles might need to do in the final round to better existing 72 hole records. Charles' putting, for which he was renowned throughout the golfing world, was on target during these three rounds and he needed just one further birdie in the final two holes of that third round to join Brask, Nagle, and Good as record holders on 61. To the disappointment of the large gallery, and probably his own, though he showed no outward sign of that, Charles failed to find the green at either hole to drop strokes at each. His 64 still left him five strokes clear of Davis (65) and seven clear of Krantz (66) and Owen (68). Barker continued his strong run with a third sub-par round taking him to seven under with a round to go.

Starting the final round Charles had two goals: To break Mike Souchak's best ever 72 hole total of 257, and to win a tournament in the fourth decade in which he had played Championship golf, his first success having come in the 1954 New Zealand Open at Heretaunga. Birdies at the two opening holes suggested both goals could well be achieved but it was not to be. Another two birdies and a single dropped shot made up a 67, a good closing round in most circumstances but disappointing on this particular day. Somehow the putts, that had seemed mystically drawn to the centre of the cup from all

distances on previous days, now slid past the edges. Charles' final 19 under par total of 261 comprised 21 birdies, a single eagle, and a meagre four bogeys, ensuring that the second goal was never in doubt.

An intriguing battle developed for second place worth a healthy $3560. Roger Davis prevailed, his 68 giving him a total of 267 that would have been good enough to win many a tournament. A pair of 65s in the final rounds catapulted Billy Dunk up the leader board for a share of third place with Simon Owen. John Lister went one better over those final rounds with a 65 and a 64. Rick Barker dropped a couple of strokes but still completed a very strong tournament at five under.

Gillian Bannan, now a full member of the NZPGA, achieved a notable first by completing four rounds playing off the same tees as the men. Her total of 34 over par reflected the difficulty women would always face in competing against men on equal terms.

THE 1981 NZPGA CHAMPIONSHIP

That year the Tournament attracted a field of 144 drawn from Australia (47), The United States (22), The United Kingdom (5), Japan (3), Canada (2), and New Zealand. Prize Money had now increased to $50 000 with a top prize of $9000. Though one $5000 sponsor failed to "hole out" the prizemoney and the total entry both represented records for a PGA Tournament in New Zealand. The change from the traditional New Year dates to late November to tie in with the NZ Open at Titirangi would have had much to do with the superb field attracted to the tournament.

The Pro/Am on the Wednesday gave a good indication of the sort of scoring that was to follow. Terry Gale of Australia led with a 63, three others shot 64, and four made 65s. As an indication of the quality of the field 25 players were on 68 or better.

While Terry Hulls, a 23 year old from Australia, replicated his Countryman's 63 of the previous day, the first round highlight was credited to a young New Zealand professional from North Shore, John Reid. Reid ended the day on what would prove to be a very ordinary score of 70, but he came away the proud owner of a sparkling new Honda Civic valued at $13 200, compliments of his hole in one at the 14th hole. John used a nine iron for this perfect stroke. Such a club choice would be more in keeping with the modern game as now seen on the USPGA Tour rather than that of 1981. This was but one of an unprecedented string of aces scored during the week. Barry Vivian set the trend during the Pro/Am by acing the Knoll, while on Saturday Bob Charles went into the lead when acing the fifth. Moments later Terry Gale completed the quartet when his tee shot found the cup at the ninth hole.

Terry Hull's 63 included an eagle and seven birdies while New Zealand hopes, Bob Charles and John Lister, were well placed on 65. The hot scoring continued on the Friday with the cut being made at one over par 141. Notable players to miss the cut included Simon Owen, Jack Newton and Wayne Grady, a further indication of the quality of the field. John Lister scored successive 65s yet complained of a bad break at the Knoll (who hasn't on occasion?). His nine iron landed well up on the green, or so he claimed, before "sinking back" into the bunker. Ted Ball, the Australian credited with the fastest swing in golf, matched Lister's paired 65s, while Charles was just one stroke off the pace. Roger Davis (66, 66),

Eamon Darcy (68, 64), Terry Gale (66, 67), Peter Croker (65, 68) and Ian Stanley (65, 68) were in close attendance. New Zealand's Bob Charles looked to have his fourth NZPGA Championship safely under control when he scored another 65 on the third day. This left him a comfortable three strokes clear of Ted Ball and Roger Davis, and five clear of Terry Gale and Kel Nagle. Canadian Jerry Anderson was one stroke ahead of the latter two and thus four behind the leader. The only question in the mind of most spectators seemed to be by how many strokes would Charles win. Alas the putter that had served Charles so well throughout his career decided to go cold that day. Three putts were required at the fifth, a hole that had yielded an ace the day before. Another three-putt followed at the ninth. In spite of these blemishes Charles teed off on the penultimate hole with a lead of two strokes over Gale who was then in the clubhouse and resigned to finishing a stroke or two short of the win. Surprisingly Charles missed from less than two metres at the seventeenth for his third three-putt, and third bogey, of the day leaving him just one stroke clear playing the final hole. There his tee shot was hooked to finish just short of a tree on the right of the fairway. A good recovery was drawn around the tree to finish in the mouth of the green from where he failed to get down with a chip and putt so a play off was required.

The sudden death play off commenced at the sixteenth where both drives were well placed in the fairway. Charles made the green with his second but was at least 15 metres away while Gale failed to make the green at all. His chip was weak finishing three metres short. Uncharacteristically Charles putted some 1.5 metres beyond the hole only to see Gale roll his longish putt home. The crowd who had braved miserable weather featuring rain and a blustery wind throughout the day were stunned to see Charles pressure putt slide well wide of the hole for his third successive bogey. Gentleman and sportsman as always Charles was quick to congratulate Gale, his sincerity obvious to all in spite of the disappointment he must have felt.

At the start of the day many players had an opportunity to challenge for the title but all, other than the ultimate champion, fell away. Perhaps the weather conditions, so much in contrast to those earlier in the week, may have accounted for the fact that only seven players bettered par. Round of the day went to Peter Crocker whose 66 included four birdies and an eagle. No one else managed an eagle on the day. Amongst those expected to challenge for the title Ball blew his chance by taking three to find the green at the knoll, Davis lost interest rather early dropping shots at the second, fourth and fifth, while Lister, like Davis, shot 69. Nagle played well enough to be a serious threat but for once the Tauranga course failed to yield much in the way of birdies to the popular Australian. The Canadian Anderson launched the most threatening challenge to Charles and Gale when he birdied the ninth and tenth but bogeys at the 16th and 17th ended his run.

Tauranga Club professional Rick Barker performed well in the Tournament making the cut comfortably with rounds of 68 and 70. Rick finished mid field with a three over par total of 283.

Sadly this 1981 staging of the NZPGA Championship was to prove to be the last held at the Tauranga course. The Championship went into recess for a lengthy period before being resurrected at the Clearwater course in Canterbury in the new Century. It was to be another 25 years before Tauranga again saw a quality field of Amateurs and Professionals contest an Open Championship.

Bob Charles (now Sir Bob) and Michael Nicholson. Proud recipients of the Spalding Masters Trophy and Lionel Smith Rosebowl as professional and amateur champions in the 1972 tournament.

CHAPTER TWENTYTWO

EXHIBITION MATCHES

Tauranga has long sort ways to bring top golf to the district and though the likes of Gene Sarazen and Bobby Locke, who each toured the country in their prime, could not be attracted to the club other options were pursued. In 1960 Kel Nagle played Jim Paterson, the match finishing all square with Nagle scoring 68, Paterson 69. For their pains Nagle was paid £75, Paterson £25, while the club lost £25 on the day and felt it was money well spent.

Another popular Australian, Peter Thomson, participated in an exhibition match with Fred Ward when that fine player was at the peak of form. Some who were present recall Thomson hooking his drive under the hedge that ran the entire length of the boundary to the left of the fifteenth fairway. This Lawsoniana hedge was wide and the branches reached the ground. Anyone who attempted to play from inside the hedge, as Thomson did, was virtually invisible. The ball emerged followed by the player who quickly advised his opponent and the gallery that he had played an “air shot” when his club struck branches on his downswing. That would have been a rare event in the life of one of the greatest of British Open Champions.

In the year following the Nagle exhibition Bob Charles played a match against Jimmy Paterson. Once again the local Professional gave a good account of himself against outstanding opposition. On this occasion Charles was the winner by two and one following an excellent display by both men before a large and appreciative gallery.

The fifteenth hole has been the subject of some interesting observations. Though little longer than the sixteenth it always seems to play much longer. It is well within the recognised length for a par four for men and just above the upper limit for women. It is rated par five on the women’s card. The competitors in the top 16 in the Una Wickham Memorial Tournament played off the blue tees while the remainder played off the yellow. For many years during that tournament the yellow tees were placed on the back of the fifteenth tee, the blues on the front. This happened on no other tee. When asked why this was done the official response was that the hole was played as a par four for the top group, a par five for the rest. When asked what importance this had in a tournament that was entirely Match Play the enquirer met only with a perplexed look. It was many years before it was realised that the top players should be offered the greatest challenge at every hole.

It was even more perplexing to see the reigning New Zealand Women’s Stroke Play Champion arrive at the fifteenth tee to find no yellow blocks. This was during the Carrus Tournament when the women were playing from yellow, the men from blue tees. It soon transpired that the blocks were about fifty metres ahead in the fairway where they had been placed by the Tournament Director who was an outside ‘expert’ supposedly well steeped in golfing lore though perhaps not in common sense! We can only presume the young star needed the head start in order to have a chance to play the hole in four strokes to match the men she was no longer competing against. To add to the quandary this young lady was the only woman to survive the 36-hole cut thus displacing a male player who had played off quite different tees.

In 1967 Tauranga staged a match between four of the International Professionals competing in the PGA at Mount Maunganui. A large gallery saw Martin Roesink (Holland) and Tony Jacklin (England) defeat Billy Dunk (Australia) and Resident Professional Jim Paterson two up. The three overseas stars all scored 66s while Paterson was also under par. While Roesink thrilled the crowd with the power of his driving it was Jacklin who particularly impressed for the all round quality of his game. His pure swing and clean struck iron shots had many an astute judge claiming we would hear much more of him in the future. This proved to be accurate as Jacklin went on to win the NZPGA at Mt. Maunganui that week in an 18-hole play off with Roesink. Far more importantly Tony Jacklin was to restore British golfing pride with victories in both the British and US Opens the following year. He then went on to enjoy a successful career that culminated in appointment to Captaincy of the European Ryder Cup Team.

The exhibition that afternoon began with a clinic on the first tee. Bob MacDonald, a popular Professional from Wellington acted as Master of Ceremonies in between amusing the large audience with his comic imitations of well known golfing identities. His show, in itself, would have made the afternoon worthwhile.

Martin Roesink demonstrated his driving ability by playing a number of drives. His first two were slightly faded and finished at the base of the second tee. The next was pin high to the left of the first green, the last three were all through the back of the green. It was a spectacular demonstration of power hitting. This was with a wooden headed, steel shafted driver, and using the rubber-wound ball. It is difficult to imagine where these drives would have reached had he been using equipment equivalent to that available today.

THE BILLY CASPER SHOW

When Billy Casper visited New Zealand in 1969 Tauranga had the opportunity to invite one of the World's very best players to demonstrate his talents to our members and to interested members of the public. Casper, along with Bob Charles, was recognised as one of the great putters of all time, yet he was very much more than that. During his career he registered 51 Professional victories including three majors, the 1970 Masters at Augusta complementing his two United States Opens. He appeared in eight Ryder Cup teams registering more points than any other player and was described by Johnny Miller as being the "most underrated golfer of all time, hands down". It is difficult to see why he was so underrated as he competed extremely successfully in an era during which Ben Hogan was still active while stars such as Arnold Palmer and Gary Player were enjoying their best years.

For his visit to Tauranga Casper was scheduled to put on an exhibition clinic before Lunch then play an 18-hole match partnering the newly crowned Club Champion Jim Lancaster against Club professional Jim Paterson and Noel Hayden of Rotorua. Lancaster, at that stage the youngest winner of our championship aged 19, was given the honour of partnering Casper against the two club Professionals. Defeated championship finalist John McLeod was invited to caddy for the American and advise him on features of the golf course, as Casper had no prior knowledge of any of the holes.

No one who was privileged to be present at the exhibition will forget the occasion. Billy Casper was a

little taken aback when invited to play his demonstration shots from the upper level of the putting green but, on being reassured by Greens Superintendent Grant Silvester that he would be only too happy to repair all the damage later, Casper held nothing back as he played a great variety of strokes including many that took considerable divots. The choice of the putting green as a stage for the show was perfect in allowing the big crowd to get an excellent view of the action. While Casper was not known as an especially long hitter his driving down the seventh fairway certainly impressed those present with both its length and its accuracy. He had a caddie stand at the top of the hill while he drove balls almost to his feet. He would then wave the caddie back twenty yards or so and repeat the process. This he did once or twice more with the caddie barely moving to retrieve the balls. To have such control over the longest club in the bag was remarkable and his control of the iron clubs was equally impressive. A truly wonderful clinic staged by a great personality.
For a description of the exhibition match that followed we are indebted to a first hand account from the man closest to the action, Jim Lancaster.

THE DAY I PARTNERED BILLY CASPER

I had only been playing golf for four years at the time when I was fortunate to win the Club Championship and thus gain the right to partner Billy Casper in the exhibition match. To be honest I had not read a lot about the top Professional players so was not as over-awed at the prospect of partnering a player of such fame as I may otherwise have been. I have since learned that Billy was the leading money winner on the PGA Tour in two of the previous three years, a five-times winner of the Vardon Trophy for the lowest scoring average on Tour, and winner of 68 Professional Tournaments, including 51 PGA Titles. This places him at 7th on the all-time list of tour winners. He also won three majors.

At the time of the exhibition Billy was staying on a sheep station at Taupo during a holiday in New Zealand and consequently was very relaxed. Perhaps that was his nature anyway. I recall the exhibition clearly. The shots he demonstrated were amazing to me and I would think to all those present. Prior to hitting each shot Billy would explain what he intended to do. The caddie hardly moved as sliced shots, drawn shots, and even straight ones, landed at his feet even when he was up to 280 yards away. This was achieved using clubs with steel shafts and wooden heads. Also the old wound ball then in use flew considerably less in distance than does the modern one-piece ball. Throughout the exhibition, and during the subsequent round, Billy was friendly, jovial, and talkative. I was surprised that he invited members of the gallery to take photographs and ask questions about any aspect of the game they wished.

I had not considered myself to be a nervous player but since I started bogey, triple bogey, double bogey, I must have been nervous without being fully aware of it. Poor Billy must have wondered what he had done to deserve such a partner. With his encouragement I settled down and played three under over the remaining holes to complete a respectable 74. It was a giant relief to redeem myself in the eyes of my partner and those of the large gallery that accompanied us throughout the day. We were matched against local Professional Jim Paterson and his colleague Noel Hayden. With Billy breezing around the course in a bogey-free 67, we won comfortably. Billy had never seen the course before the round

so his score was especially commendable. He talked all the way round, commented on shots played by myself and the other two, and freely answered questions from members of the 1000 strong gallery. I got the impression he knew just where each of his shots would land and how far it would run. With the small heads typical of woods of that time he was able to work the ball in any desired direction. He never looked in serious danger of dropping a shot and on the only couple of times I recall his missing a fairway he was able to play a great recovery shot.

I recall him enquiring where the third green was and, after receiving conflicting advice on his best approach to the hole he decided to take the trees on. His tee shot finished just 40 yards short of the front of the green. On the 7th he played a seven iron for his second contrary to the advice of his caddie who wanted him to take more club. As a consequence he finished short and failed to gain the birdie his drive deserved. He did birdie the 9th, his five-iron finishing about 10 ft. from the hole. Another birdie followed at the 10th to reward a drive of some 280 yards.
At the time I had the confidence of youth on the putting green and had the habit of walking forward ready to retrieve my ball from the hole following putts of ten feet or so. I did this again at the 11th only to have Billy tell me to “Let the ball get to the hole before you pick it up”. It was holed on this occasion or I would have looked a little silly.

Billy had a good sense of humour. I had a set of Kangaroo head covers and dropped the one from my driver beside the 17th tee. Billy immediately gave it a thump with his driver as he said, “what’s that critter. Quick, get it”.

Over the years I have been privileged to play in Tournaments such as the Spalding Masters and the PGA Championship where I have been paired with some outstanding Professionals from New Zealand and Overseas. None of these were of the calibre of Billy Casper who played with, and defeated, many greats of the game including Ben Hogan, Arnold Palmer, and Byron Nelson. In 2000 the United States Golf Digest ranked Billy as the 15th greatest golfer of all time. While, at the time of the exhibition, I was unaware of Billy’s true standing in the history of the game I have since come to realise how fortunate I was to have been one of a very few New Zealanders to have played with Billy Casper, a great golfer, a true gentleman, and a man who was patient enough to put a novice like myself at ease throughout the day.

At the end of the round the Club presented Billy with a book featuring the scenery of New Zealand. I received an inlaid wooden box suitably engraved as a memento of my experience. I treasured that box for 37 years until, sadly, it was stolen from my home in 2007.

CHAPTER TWENTYTHREE

PROFESSIONAL GOLF RETURNS TO TAURANGA

When well performed New Zealand Professional Greg Turner promoted a series of tournaments to provide opportunities for budding young players in New Zealand the Tauranga Club was quick to volunteer to be one of the host clubs. Paul and Sheryl Adams of Carrus Corporation, a local company involved in sub-division developments, became the name sponsor. Many other local companies became involved to ensure that the first tournament was able to attract a quality field including leading Amateurs together with the best of the Country's Professionals.

THE 2006 CARRUS TAURANGA OPEN CHAMPIONSHIP

The tournament proved to be an outstanding success, not least because of the runaway success of local Amateur Josh Geary. While Josh was best known as a member of the Mt. Maunganui Golf Club as a boy he was also a member both of Otumoetai and of Tauranga. In 2001, still a schoolboy, he featured in the final of our senior championship where he went down narrowly to the experienced Gavin Smillie. Geary played superlative golf throughout the Carrus Open apart from one hole during the third round when he struck all sorts of trouble on the long 7th hole to record a ten, his first double figure score since his first tournament start as an eleven year old. Cruising well clear of Tauranga's Kevin Smith prior to this Geary yielded no less than seven strokes of his lead as Smith eagled the same hole. It was a mark of Geary's temperament and the quality of his game that he was still able to complete the round in 70. With par surprisingly retained at 71 for the event Geary completed the tournament a nominal 22 shots under par. (Traditionally the 17th hole, never a genuine par 5, is reclassified as a par 4 during Professional events). None-the-less rounds of 63, 63, 70, and 66 represented golf of the highest quality.

After nine holes of the final round Smith and Geary were locked together at 16 under, well clear of the Professionals headed by Grant Moorhead, Doug Holloway and Tony Christie. While the others went

BIRDS

One evening I was walking home in the gathering darkness when I saw what appeared to be one of those long-necked driver covers lying on the fifteenth fairway. As I bent to pick it up it moved away. It was the Golden Amhurst pheasant that lived on the course for a number of years, a very beautiful bird and a pleasure to see.

The unusual blackbirds with white markings that are seen near the clubhouse have been with us for many 'bird generations'. The rare genetic sport causing this has not been in evidence elsewhere to my knowledge.

Another bird that attracted attention briefly was 'Morrie Minor', a very friendly mynah bird that was soon captured and sent off to an aviary somewhere. This was rather sad as he was becoming quite a character on the course.

Members welcome the annual visit by many Tuis that enjoy the nectar from Japanese flowering cherries. Unfortunately those same trees are becoming a serious weed in the countryside as the tuis spread the seed far from the original trees..

backwards Geary picked up another six shots to finish seven clear of Smith with the leading pair of Professionals, Moorhead and Holloway, a further six strokes away. Geary made the decisive move by holing out from the greenside bunker at the tenth for an eagle two. Birdies followed at the 9th, 12th, 13th, 14th, and 17th.
Moorhead, a member of New Zealand's only successful Eisenhower Trophy winning team, fired a grand 64 to catch Holloway who scored a 66, the pair each taking away a very welcome $6400. Moorhead birdied the last four holes to bypass a number of his fellow Professionals.

THE 2007 CARRUS TAURANGA OPEN CHAMPIONSHIP

With Josh Geary not able to return to Tauranga to defend his title it was left to Auckland Amateur Leighton James and Taihape Professional Hamish Robertson to emulate his opening round 63 of the previous year. Amateurs Josh Munn (a 16 yr old from the Manawatu), Sean Roach (Arrowtown), and Mike Wilson (ex BOP team member) all shot 65s, a total matched by Professional Brad Shilton.

James and Robertson continued to set the pace when each shot 67 in the second round while Mark Purser, a Waikato Professional, came into contention with a magnificent 61. This included two eagles, six birdies, and a single bogey. This year the 17th was correctly rated as a par four so par was set at a more realistic 70. This round elevated Purser to equal third with local man Jared Pender, later to be selected to represent New Zealand at the Eisenhower Tournament. Jared's scores of 67 and 65 represented his best form at this level.

A second 63 from Leighton James appeared to have put the Championship out of reach of the others with the final round to come. While a pair of Amateurs again led the field the question of who would take the money was yet to be decided. Purser was not prepared to allow James the title without a fight and, in a dogged pursuit he finally got his nose in front to win by a single stroke. To achieve this he had to shoot a seven under par 63 while James slipped to a one over 71. Kevin Smith, such a prominent contender the year before, headed all but one of the Professionals to finish third. An inexplicable four-putt at the 15th ended his challenge though his third round 61 ranked with Purser's earlier 61 as the rounds of the tournament. Robertson was 12 strokes worse than that in his third round to lose any chance he had of heading the field.
Purser and James were level with two holes to play but Purser stole the initiative at the 17th when he hit a wedge from 128m and canned the resultant 3m putt. James could only par the final two holes to finish a valiant second.

THE 2008 CARRUS TAURANGA OPEN CHAMPIONSHIP

Sublime conditions, immaculate fairways, and fast greens presented a quality field with a matchless opportunity to create records on the opening day of the championship. While many threatened to do so none succeeded. Kevin Chun, seven under with four to play, Michael Hendry, his score spoilt by one double bogey, and Amateur Scott Johnson all shot 65s to set the pace. A trio of Amateurs including 2007 runner-up Leighton James came in at five under.
13-year-old Cecilia Cho led the women on even par 71.
Hendry held his form through the second round to establish a three-stroke advantage over the field.

Grant Moorhead of Eisenhower Trophy fame moved into second place with an excellent 66. Josh Geary, not especially comfortable with his game, still managed to shoot 68-67 to share fourth place. Local New Zealand representative Jared Pender improved five strokes on his opening round of 71 to make the top ten.
After three rounds Hendry, Moorhead, and Brad Shilton led by one stroke from Geary with many others poised to make a serious challenge for the title. A brilliant final round 64 looked to have ensured Geary of his first victory as a Professional as others fell by the wayside. Eventually only Moorhead looked to have a chance to match Geary's 14 under total. This possibility increased dramatically when he holed a 5m putt on the tough par four 17th, a hole where Geary earlier had dropped his only stroke of the round after his second had ended with the ball wrapped in a fallen branch to the left of the green. Courageously Josh had elected to play the ball as it lay rather than pay the penalty for deeming it unplayable. The two-stroke swing on this penultimate hole sent the pair into a play-off when Grant failed to birdie the final hole.
In deference to the large crowd estimated at fifteen hundred that clustered about the 18th green the players returned to that tee to settle the issue. Both missed birdie opportunities as had been the case when playing the hole as the 72nd so back to the tee they went. This time Geary thrilled the crowd by firing his wedge second to within 30cms of the hole to ensure victory.

Fellow local Jared Pender shot the low round of the tournament, a brilliant 63, to elevate himself to fourth place overall and leading Amateur one stroke clear of Gary John Hill. This showing may well have cemented Jared's claim to a spot on the Eisenhower team.

THE 2009 CARRUS TAURANGA OPEN CHAMPIONSHIP
Peter Fowler, the Auckland based Australian Professional, may well have been the favourite to win the 2009 Carrus Tauranga Open and his opening 65 did nothing to dent public confidence. Blair Shaw, of Hastings, matched Fowler's score while another eight players lay within two strokes of the lead. These included local Amateur Brad Kendall of Mt Maunganui and Jared Pender, now a member of the Professional ranks. Shaw's round featured an ace on the difficult par three fifth hole, the ball pitching just 15cms from the cup before finding the bottom of the hole.

Fowler scored a second 65 to open up a three-stroke lead over Pender whose 66 left him one stroke clear of three other rookie Professionals in Troy Ropiha, Blair Shaw, and Hamish Robertson. Cecilia Cho followed her opening 72 with a brilliant round of 67 to take a decisive lead into the final round of the Women's section.

Peter Fowler carried his wonderful form into the third with an excellent 66 to leave him in a seemingly impregnable position three strokes clear of his nearest pursuer. Michael Hendry and Hamish Robertson shot 65s to inch closer to that lead, while Pender's nine under total suggested a high finish was well within his grasp on his home course.

Fowler lowered his guard early on the final day, dropping two strokes in the first eight holes after dropping only one over the preceding 54 holes. The putts that previously found their way unerringly

into the cup now slid frustratingly by to allow the chasing pack to get within range. With just four holes to play any one of six front-runners looked capable of taking the title. It was Michael Hendry who best held his nerve to draw level with Fowler at 12 under and so force a play-off for the second successive year. This time only one traverse of the 18th was required to settle the tie before Hendry holed a pressure-filled three metre putt to nullify the many disappointments he had suffered through a run of close finishes in previous tournaments.

Hamish Robertson and Richard Lee failed by just one stroke to join the play-off while Pender disappointed his local fans by shooting a closing 73 to fall back into 11th place. Omokoroa teenager Andrew Stewart shot the round of the day, a 66, to annex the Amateur title while Cecilia Cho had made no race of the Women's contest that concluded the previous day.

THE 2010 CARRUS TAURANGA OPEN CHAMPIONSHIP

Wellington Professional Andrew Green set the 2010 renewal of the Carrus alight with a sizzling 62 in glorious conditions on the opening day. Andrew may well have believed this would give him a substantial lead going into the second round but that was not to be. Southland Amateur Cody Harper (63), and Wellington Professional Brenden Stuart (64) had other ideas.

The Women's field featured World long-drive champion Phillis Meti who thrilled the gallery with some prodigious driving. Sadly her short game was not of the standard to allow her to take advantage of the opportunities these drives provided.

Andrew Green followed his 62 with a superb 63 and yet this wonderful start was over-shadowed by Japanese based professional Richard Lee who established a new course record with a spectacular 59, the first time a sub-sixty total had been recorded in a New Zealand tournament. As word of this

There are many stories of the par threes at Tauranga. It is notable that David Good, during his record round of 61 in 1976, scored four twos and one three. Club member Eddie Schwartfeger bettered this total of 11 for the par threes in rather dramatic fashion. Playing a Club competition round in June 1982 Eddie scored two pars, a birdie two, and an ace at each of the 9th and 14th holes. Some felt the feat of two aces in the one round may have been a first, and perhaps it was for New Zealand, but a little research discovered that the feat had been achieved over 300 times in America (where else?) the previous year alone.

While no written record has been discovered old time members claim that Jack Bateman, four times Senior Champion and our first BOP Champion of Champions, also bettered David Good by scoring all five par threes in two during a handicap singles match in the early fifties. Jack's opponent that day would have felt a little shell-shocked.

possibility spread about the course a large crowd was drawn to the tenth green in the hope of seeing history made. They were not disappointed as Richard took up the challenge of attempting to drive this short par four only to see the ball roll into the bunker alongside the green. A solid bunker shot left the ball within two metres of the hole from where Richard appeared to hole it calmly enough though he later confessed his hands were not as steady as may have appeared. In spite of this remarkable round Richard still trailed the leader by three strokes. Wellington Amateur Nick Gillespie matched Green's 63 to lie level with Lee at 12 under. Unnoticed in all the excitement Masterton Amateur Ben Campbell quietly went about his business to compile rounds of 66 and 65 to trail by six strokes together with Cody Harper.

The third day was something of a comedy of errors, the leaders appearing to vie with one another to see who would self-destruct next. First Nick Gillespie (65, 63) appeared to destroy his round by firing three balls into the orchard beyond the Norris residence to the left of the eighth fairway. Playing partner Andrew Green followed by recording a 9 at the par three ninth. He followed an out of bounds tee shot by firing his second tee shot into the bunker alongside the green. Andrew then incurred a two-stroke penalty when his caddie (his father) raked the bunker while Andrew's ball lay within it.

Meanwhile Campbell took advantage of the situation as he added a 64 to establish a three-stroke lead over Green (73), with a further two strokes back to Hendry (66) and Lee (72). Ryan Fox, son of legendary All Black Grant, produced his best Tauranga performance to date, three successive 67s leaving him a further stroke back.

Ben Campbell gave no one else a chance on the final day, shooting a 66 to win by four from Hendry who shot 65. Fox improved on his 67s with a 66 to edge Jared Pender, who closed with a 64 to add to his third round 63. This enabled Jared to collect his best cheque as a Professional with his second placing behind Hendry. Richard Lee, perhaps still somewhat shell-shocked from his 59, self-destructed at the 13th by firing a succession of drives into the racecourse to record a double-digit hole score and a final round 77. It may be hard to believe that a Professional could show a spread of 18 strokes between any two rounds of a tournament but it did happen.

PAST CHAMPIONS

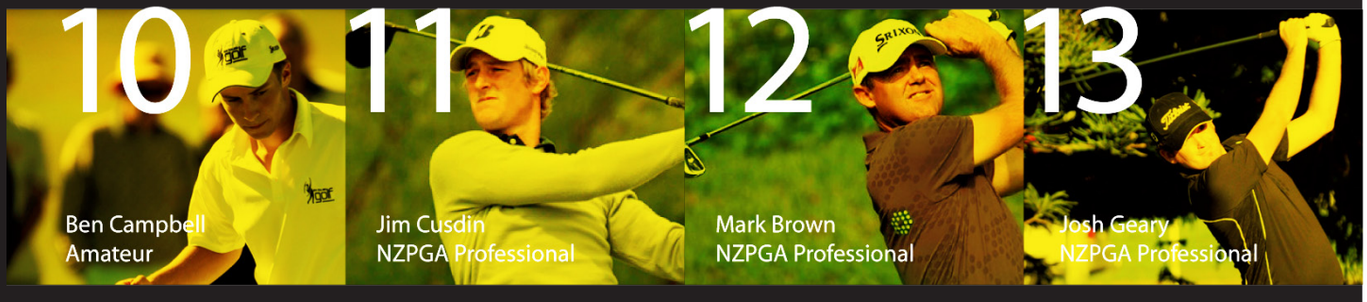
Caroline Bon of Northland made no race of the Women's section, firing three sub-par rounds to finish 15 strokes clear of what has to be said was a rather mediocre field. This in no way detracted from the merit of Caroline's performance, sub-par rounds being hardly commonplace in New Zealand Women's Golf.

THE 2011 CARRUS TAURANGA OPEN CHAMPIONSHIP

Unheralded Waikato Professional Jim Cusdin won the 2011 Carrus Open in fine style in spite of his claim at the final day presentation that he had not been confident at the start as he had not played the course well on previous visits. Tournament favourite and clear first day leader Michael Hendry expressed very different sentiments in relation to the course. Said Hendry: "I love this course. It really suits my game. It is a course where you feel you can attack every hole but the key is not to push too hard. I did that on the 8th hole on day one and paid the price. The key is patience."
Hendry set the pace in round one, posting a five under par 65 in very windy conditions, one stroke ahead of local star Jared Pender and Te Anau Professional David Klein. Co-favourite Gareth Paddison followed on 67. Hendry's round included six birdies and a sole bogey on that 8th hole.

Gareth Paddison, showing the value of the experience he has gained from appearances on the PGA Tours of both the USA and of Europe over the previous season or two, scored an impressive 64 in favourable conditions to lead by three strokes over Dominic Barson (also 64) and Pieter Zwart after the second round. Michael Hendry dropped back with an even par 70, while Pender (67), and amateur Ryan Fox (67) remained well in contention. Starting at the 11th Fox four putted the Knoll, an experience not unknown to local members though they seldom play the green when it is running as fast as it was that day. Despite that set back Fox later birdied each hole from the second to the eighth with the exception of the par three Fifth. Six birdies in seven holes demonstrated the true quality of golf of which this talented New Zealand representative is capable.

The women competed over 54 holes so their competition finished on the Saturday afternoon with NZ representative Emily Perry of Waikato firing a final round of 72 to finish five under par and four strokes clear of Charlotte Thomas.



Cusdin and Fox staged an epic battle over the final round on an uncharacteristically wet Tauranga Sunday afternoon. The day was so wet that play had to be suspended for two hours in mid afternoon as the greens became unplayable. This was in spite of the dedicated efforts of a large number of officials and volunteers who worked the squeegees vigorously in an attempt to keep the play flowing. In spite of the conditions and the frustration of suspended play this pair played impressive golf over that final round. Cusdin appeared to have set up a winning lead when he birdied the 14th and 16th only to see it reduced to a single stroke as they teed off the 18th. Jim Cusdin confessed to feeling very nervous as he had never succeeded in winning over 72 holes on any previous occasion. Ryan Fox reduced the pressure when driving to the right into the area by the advertising signs. When correctly denied free relief from that situation he was forced to chip into the open before firing his third shot to the green. Meanwhile Cusdin played safely to the green to set up a 6m putt that he was greatly relieved to see fall into the hole for a birdie and an excellent winning total of 15 under par. Michael Hendry closed with a 64 but his earlier 70 in round two had effectively left him too far adrift though he continued his run of "Podium finishes" at the Carrus with third placing on 12 under. Paddison followed on 10 under.

CHAPTER TWENTYFOUR

THE UNA WICKHAM MEMORIAL TOURNAMENT

The Club lost its greatest woman player with the untimely death of Una Wickham in 1983. The Women's Committee decided to institute a tournament in her honour and endeavour to develop it into a truly prestigious event on the Northern Golfing Calendar. This became a reality with the tournament soon attracting the best players from Whangarei to Taupo and sometimes beyond. For some years it served as a trial for the Northern Inter Provincial teams but sadly lost support as other priorities commanded the attention of the top players. It is unfortunate that we no longer have the opportunity to see outstanding women players of the quality of Brenda Ormsby, Jan Arnold, Tina Howard, Gina Scott, our own Joanne Brooks, and many others. These women inspired local players, both men and women, to endeavour to raise their own standards. It is to be hoped that one day the top women players from around the country will again grace our links in honour of our greatest woman player. A year by year history of the tournament, and its predecessor the Tauranga Women's Open Match Play Tournament follows.

1976 Shirley Johnson of Rotorua won the final of this, the inaugural staging of the tournament, defeating Una Wickham 6/4 in a surprisingly one-sided final. Earlier Shirley had defeated a youthful Brenda Ormsby of Te Puke in another easy victory. Shirley was then playing number one in the Bay of Plenty representative team, a position she clearly warranted on these performances.

1977 Shirley Johnson successfully defended the title she had won the previous year, easily holding out the challenge of Penny MacDougall in the final. Earlier in the tournament Tauranga's Mary Parkinson had provided Shirley with much stronger opposition before losing one down.

1978 Alison Eather of Auckland won the Championship after a series of tight matches. She was three down with five to play versus Tauranga's Peg Copestake yet got home at the 20th. 1977 finalist Penny MacDougall was five up at one stage yet lost to Alison at the 18th. Playing Avis Osborne (Mt Maunganui) in the final Eather was two down with two to play yet again won on the 20th. Such a series of fighting come backs must seldom have been matched in this or any tournament. The semi-final against Cushla Hickey of Opotiki was the antithesis of the other three matches, Miss Hickey being five down after twelve holes only to come back strongly before losing by just one hole.

1979 Jocelyn Glanfield (North Shore) became the new champion, defeating Sue Bunt (Titirangi) one up in the final after accounting for the defending champion Alison Hasey (Nee Eather) two up in the semi-final. Sue Bunt went on to a distinguished career in Golf Administration where her work over a number of years did much to further Golf in Auckland and in New Zealand.

1980 The tournament continued to be seen as a trial for the Bay of Plenty Russell Grace team while the Auckland and Waikato selectors were also very interested in the form displayed by potential team members. As a result the tournament attracted strong entries from these regions. New Zealand representatives Cherry Kingham (Grange), Jan Arnold (Morrinsville), and Brenda Rhodes (Nee Ormsby) highlighted another strong field in 1980. In the final it was Jan Arnold who prevailed 4/3 over Kingham who never recovered from Arnold's sizzling outward 32. Earlier Kingham had scored a surprisingly easy victory over Rhodes.

1981 In spite of two New Zealand representatives being involved the final was a disappointing match. Neither Kingham nor Rhodes was able to show the form expected of them. It could be said, probably unkindly, that Kingham made fewer mistakes to prevail 2/1.

1982 The final featured the finalists from the previous year in Cherry Kingham and Brenda Rhodes. These two could now lay claim to being the best two women golfers in the country. Rhodes, who had held the National Championship for the previous two years, was again frustrated in her ambition to win this tournament. The match featured superb tee to green play by Rhodes in particular but some tentative putting by her allowed Kingham to stay in touch before finally taking control to win 2/1. Despite the excellence of much of the iron play only one birdie was scored in the entire match.

1983 Ruth Middleton (Matamata), now in the veteran class, was able to show the youngsters she still had plenty of quality to her game and probably caused provincial selectors some perturbation as she defeated three potential Bay of Plenty representatives on her way to the final against Jocelyn Queenan (Nee Glanfield). Ruth, a long time supporter of Tauranga tournaments, was a very popular winner of the final.

1984 This was the year that the tournament was first played under the title of The Una Wickham Open Match Play Tournament in memory of the Club's greatest woman player. Former New Zealand Champion, Jan Arnold, won the tournament. defeating eighteen-year old Jan Cooke of Western Bay, now Omokoroa Golf Club, who played very well to be beaten just two down. Jan Cooke might well have been considered a prodigy of Miss Wickham as she had been pulled from relative obscurity by Una to fill the number five spot in the winning BOP Russell Grace team of 1983. A win by either finalist would have seemed a fitting tribute to the late Miss Wickham. On the way to the final Miss Cooke had defeated two previous winners in Jocelyn Queenan and Alison Hasey to demonstrate her form and her potential.

1985 The tournament this year again featured Jan Arnold and Brenda Ormsby, the latter having reverted to her maiden name. This time the two came fresh from finishing second to the USA in the World Team Championship. Mary Laugerson (ex Wanganui) who was widely recognised as one of New Zealand's most knowledgeable golf authorities claimed the two finalists to be the best New Zealand had ever produced. While other candidates for such an honour will spring to many a mind it has to be true that these two names would rank very highly in a New Zealand Golfing Hall of fame.

The dominance these two held over a quality field was amply demonstrated in the semi- finals where Arnold beat the Auckland number one, Karrin Duckworth 7/6, while Ormsby beat Bay of Plenty number one, Jane Little, 6/5.

The final featured quality golf with many birdie opportunities, a pleasing number of which were converted. Successive birdies at the fifth and sixth edged Arnold ahead and, although Ormsby squared the match a number of times, Arnold was never behind before winning just one up after Ormsby missed the final green with her approach. The winner was an approximate two under par at the close.

Once again Brenda had fallen just short in her desire to win this tournament, a desire even stronger now that the tournament had been dedicated to the memory of a woman whose golf had been an inspiration to her.

A highlight of the tournament from a local aspect was the hole in one scored by Noeline Grant at the fifth hole during Sunday play.

1986 The quality that has for so long been displayed in this tournament was emphasised this year when the semi-finals featured four of the very best players in the country. The Auckland pair of Karrin Duckworth and Marnie Maguire were shortly off to Asia to represent New Zealand in the Queen Sirikit Tournament, while Bay of Plenty's Jan Cooke was named non-travelling reserve for that team. Brenda Ormsby, now back in the Bay and based at Springfield, made up the semi-final group. Jan Cooke looked all over the winner against Duckworth only to lose the lead late in the day to go down at the 19th. Meanwhile Brenda Ormsby took an early 3 up lead against 16-year old Maguire and, though Maguire was able to square the match immediately after the turn, Ormsby pulled ahead again for a comfortable 2/1 victory to leave her poised to win her first Tauranga Una Wickham Open Championship. Alas for Ormsby it was to be another defeat in her fourth final. It was Duckworth's exceptional play on, and around, the greens that made the difference in the final. Four down at the turn it looked all over for Ormsby but she came back strongly to square the match with three holes to play only to see her opponent win two of those final three holes for an entertaining two up victory.

1987 There was a new look to the field this year with many of the name players of previous tournaments missing for one reason or another. The final had a real Hawkes Bay flavour to it with Karen de Lautour (ex H Bay, now Remuera) defeating Ingrid van Steenbergen (ex Tauranga, now Hawkes Bay) 3/2 after van Steenbergen had set the early pace. Prior to this tournament van Steenbergen, previously apprenticed to the Greens Staff at Tauranga, had been appointed Head Green Keeper at the Flaxmere course in Hawkes Bay. She was probably the first woman to be appointed to such a position in New Zealand.

1988 Ingrid van Steenbergen returned to have another attempt at the title that had eluded her the previous year. Her quest was successful when, in a close fought final, she defeated former National trialist Jan Malcolm (Lochiel) at the 19th. Local teenager Catherine Rodgers proved something of a giant killer as she eliminated Gay McMillan (Paeroa) and Jan Cooke (now Tauranga) on the way to a semi-final loss to Jan Malcolm.

1989 Jan Higgens (nee Cooke), now of Manakau, defeated defending champion Ingrid van Steenbergen at the 19th, the same hole where van Steenbergen had won her title one year before. Both finalists had previously been members at Tauranga and both had represented New Zealand at Overseas tournaments in 1988 so there was a lot of local interest in the final. The crowd were not disappointed as the pair fought out a close match where not more than one hole separated them as they each played the course in not more than one over par, this from the blue tees as was always the case for the Championship group. The power these women bring to their game was exemplified by Higgen's play of

the 13th hole where her second shot finished pin high and just to the right of the green.

1990 One can imagine the delight experienced by Brenda Ormsby when her long quest for success in this tournament was rewarded with a 3/2 win over Otago's Jan Scandrett in the final. Brenda played in the first Tauranga Match Play Open in 1976 and in most of those held since. Runner up on four occasions Brenda had missed the previous two tournaments. This year she may have been in more relaxed mood as she defeated Gina Scott, Sheree Higgens (now married to successful New Zealand professional David Smail), and Ingrid van Steenbergen on her way to the final.

The promising young Tauranga player Anne Rodgers, sister to Catherine, did very well to defeat three very well performed players, including Lynnette Brooky (Grange), in winning the Championship Plate after bowing to van Steenbergen in the first round. Earlier in the tournament Brooky had aced the fifth hole and almost repeated the feat at the fourth in her match with Rodgers, the ball finishing just centimetres from the hole after almost completing a 'slam dunk'.

1991 The tournament this year was recognised as an official New Zealand trial. This guaranteed an exceptional field including the entire National squad of nine players. Ultimately the two top ranked entrants met in the final after relatively straight forward wins in the preliminary matches. Left hander Lisa Aldridge (Paraparaumu), playing in her first Una Wickham Tournament defeated four time finalist and previous winner Ingrid van Steenbergen at the 19th hole by sinking a 2m. birdie putt. Ironically this putt was almost identical to the putt holed by van Steenbergen at the first hole of the match for birdie. It was Ingrid's third visit to the 19th hole in her four finals. Of these she had won just that once in 1988.

1992 Brenda Ormsby had a lot less work to do in winning her second Una Wickham Match Play Title than had been the case when winning her first two years previously. In grand form throughout the tournament Brenda needed only 57 holes to dispose of her four opponents, only Sandra Carey of Putaruru getting close when going down 2/1. Anne Familton (Grange) went down 5/3 in a final where Brenda's consistency left few opportunities for her opponent to win a hole.

1993 Two of New Zealand's most talented young players, Gina Scott (Kawhia) and Shelley Duncan (Otago) reached the final following preliminary play that featured many close contests. These two were the only New Zealand squad members competing this year and fittingly came through to meet in the final where Scott prevailed two up in a very entertaining final. Gina Scott in particular thrilled the gallery with the length of her drives. These were consistently around the 230 - 240m mark. As an example of her power she was able to reach the 17th green with a seven iron second following her drive from the blue tees. When just 20 years old Scott had won the Waikato Champion of Champions title in 1991. Later she was to play in the Professional ranks in Europe.

This 1993 Una Wickham Tournament introduced an eleven year old from Whitianga to the Tauranga public. Julia Kraschinski started golf as a nine year old and qualified for this tournament when she reduced to a twelve handicap. Playing in the fourth sixteen she defeated four much older players in winning the group. It must have been quite unnerving to be outplayed by one so small and so young.

Julia came to be much admired as she returned to the tournament over the following years. Julia and her sister Miriam, who contested the tournament a little later, were born in Germany before the family moved to New Zealand.

1994 This year the tournament was designated as an official trial for both the Bay of Plenty/Thames Valley and Waikato/King Country teams thus ensuring all prospective team members in those regions were entered. Top seed and recently crowned World Left Handed Champion Lisa Aldridge staved off the challenge of the Northern stars, defeating Brenda Ormsby in the final.

1995 This year saw the emergence of Tina Howard of Taupo who was to have a significant presence in the Una Wickham Championship over the following years. Barely qualifying for the Championship flight in 14th spot the teenager defeated Ingrid van Steenbergen, Sandra Carey, and Robyn Pellow (Ngaruawahia) on her way to meeting the 1992 champion Gina Scott in the final. In that match Howard surged to a five-hole lead after seven holes and looked certain to bring off a huge upset when still four up with just five to play. It has long been claimed that whoever wins the 14th at Tauranga wins the match and Scott must have been aware of this as she birdied the par three to start her come-back. Pars over the testing 15th, 16th, and 17th holes and a birdie three at the 18th brought Scott level before she won the title with a further birdie at the first extra hole. After dropping seven strokes over the first six holes Scott was level with par over the final twelve.

Thirteen year old Julia Kranschinski distinguished herself by reaching the semi-finals where she bowed to the ultimate champion by 3/ 2.

1996 The Auckland, Waikato, and Bay of Plenty selectors all designated the tournament this year as an official trial again ensuring a quality field faced the starter. Tina Howard defeated Joanne Croskery, Catherine Knight, and Annette Stott on the way to another showdown against Gina Scott in the final. Gina had made it to the final by defeating three members of the BOP/TV representative team in Joanne Henderson, Julia Kraschinski, and Brenda Ormsby. As in the 1995 final between these two Tina began with a rush to be five up after just eight holes and though she three putted the ninth she still made the turn one under the card and four up. Unlike in the previous year she did not allow Gina back into the match and won comfortably.

1997 Kaye Carroll returned to the tournament after an absence of twelve years during which she produced a family of four children. Kaye (nee Johnson) had been an unknown teenage golfer from Opotiki when Una Wickham, realising the potential of the youngster, plucked her from comparative obscurity to join her in the Bay of Plenty team. Together they enjoyed a number of Russell Grace successes. Thus it was not difficult to see why Kaye had long harboured an ambition to win the Una Wickham Memorial since her first appearance in the event.
In the final Kaye Carroll defeated Wendy Hawkes one up after an exciting match. On the way Carroll had defeated ex Tauranga player Joanne Brooks (Grange) in round one and Eleanor Hodgson (New Plymouth) in the Semi-final. Eleanor had caused a big surprise in defeating top seeded Julia Kraschinski at the 19th in the second round while Wendy, besides beating her twin sister Angela in round two, had

caused perhaps an even bigger upset by ousting tournament favourite Tina Howard in their semi-final.

1998 Twin sisters Angela and Wendy Hawkes of Titirangi met in the second round, one of many times these two were to meet in important tournaments. An excellent match went to the 20th before Angela prevailed. Angela then defeated International René Fowler 3/2 in the semi-final and defending champion Tina Howard 2/1 in the final. Angela's victory was well received by the gallery as Wendy and Angela had been loyal and popular supporters of the tournament

1999 Responding to changes in the National Diary of Events the organising committee opted for a change from the traditional February dates to a weekend in August. Whether or not this was a wise decision is open to debate but it does appear to have heralded a decline in the quality of the field and the prestige of the tournament. While this year the tournament attracted most members of the Bay of Plenty team selected for the Inter Provincial Championships there were few quality players from elsewhere. In a rather ordinary final, which perhaps was indicative of the quality of the field, Sandra Baxendine (Matamata) defeated Sue Bassett (Te Puke) one up. Local interest centred on the performance of Chelsea Cox, daughter of Vanessa Barker, wife of Club Professional Rick Barker. Chelsea must have caused some concern to the Bay selectors as she defeated two of their team before losing a close semi-final match with Baxendine one down.

2000 The tournament date was changed to June. That suited Tina Howard, now a member of the New Zealand National Team and on a Golf Scholarship to the Louisiana State University. Home for a break Tina won her second Una Wickham title by defeating Robyn Pellow (Ngaruawahia) 2/1 in the final. This meant Tina had made the final in all four of her appearances in the tournament, winning two of those.

2001 That year the tournament regained status as an official trial for the Waikato and Bay of Plenty teams. Brenda Ormsby on plus 3 and Tina Howard on plus 1 were the highest ranked players while thirteen of the Championship flight contenders were on handicaps of 3 or better. Jan Storey of Waiterimu was in giant killing form, disposing of Penny Newbrook (Springfield), Wendy Hawkes (Arrowtown) at the 21st, and Brenda Ormsby (Te Puke) at the 19th. Tina Howard had a much easier passage to the final winning her matches comfortably. Storey continued her form into the final to reach the end of the regulation 18 holes all-square. Down the 19th in gathering gloom went the pair only to halve that hole. Recognising that the gloom would make the 2nd hole virtually unplayable the referee obtained the consent of the committee to play the 18th as the 20th hole. Though Tina raised an objection play resumed on the 18th where enterprising Club members lined up their cars to cast some light on the green and approaches. Again the hole was halved and the players, now facing almost total darkness agreed to share the title - a bizarre ending to an entertaining final.

2002 Wendy and Angela Hawkes were probably the best performed women in the field and they met in the semi-final where Wendy prevailed 3/2. It was unfortunate that these two seemed destined to meet before the final in so many tournaments. It would have been interesting to see them meet in a final. Wendy continued on her winning way to score a 2/1 victory over Akane Iijima of Pakuranga in a final that was closely contested throughout.

2003 While the 2002 final featured a player of Asian descent the 2003 tournament could be considered the real beginning of the trend that saw Asian women rising to the top of women's golf in New Zealand. Five of the Championship flight were this year of Asian descent. The failure of one of these to arrive from Auckland infuriated Tournament organisers especially as they were not advised of the non-appearance until 15 minutes before tee off. Worse, the player was seeded number one for the tournament. Tournament officials were equally upset upon learning that a National training camp had been scheduled in Wellington for the same dates. Remarkably Women's Golf NZ claimed to be "unaware of the status of the Una Wickham event". Sixteen top players were in Wellington for the camp. Women's Golf NZ did adjust their calendar to avoid a clash in the future.

The final featured two young Asian women with 16 yr. old Bo Bae Kim defeating 12 yr. old Sharon Ahn one up. The power generated by these young players was evidenced on many occasions with drives of 250m and more being a regular feature of their play. The 15th hole that is normally played as a par five by women club players was reached by Ahn with a drive and five iron. Many a man could watch these young women and learn that hitting it long does not necessarily require brute strength. The feature that stands out is the co-ordinated rotation of the upper body with little apparent movement of the legs and knees.

2004 Stacey Tate (Huapai), a young player of genuine potential, defeated Mi Kyung Kim (Pupuke) 3/1 in the final after defeating the top seed, Tina Howard, in the semi-final. The final was notable for the over enthusiastic behaviour of Kim's father who caddied for his daughter. At the sixth hole the referee ruled that Kim had conceded Tate a short putt for a half based on something she had said that caused Tate to pick up her ball. While Kim made no protest her father began to rage at the referee for "not being fair to his daughter" though it was difficult to understand what he was concerned about. When he started to protest again at the eighth tee the referee suggested it might be better if he ceased caddying and left his daughter to get on with the game. He then handed the bag to another family member and the match continued in a better atmosphere. It sometimes seems that young players, especially those of Asian descent, would do better if their parents left them to find their own way in the game.

2005 Perhaps the most interesting match of this tournament took place during the second round on the Saturday afternoon. 13 yr. old Zoe Beth Brake (Kawerau) and Penny Newbrook, a former New Zealand number one, finished all square at the end of regulation play. At that stage darkness had set in so the pair set out virtually at dawn the following morning with Brake securing the win at the first extra hole. Brake later claimed that she had looked up to Penny as her idol from the time she, Brake, had begun to play as a six yr. old so she had mixed feelings following her win.

The final featured two Asian women with Jackie Shin defeating last year's runner up Mi Kyung Kim one up. Shin played the first nine in two under par to turn four up before her short game began to falter. Just one up with three to play a win at the sixteenth gave Shin just enough breathing space to hold out her rival.

2006

Preparations were made for the tournament in the usual manner that year but, sadly, the entries were not sufficient to make it viable to continue. The tournament appears to have been a victim of the times. More women were now committed to full-time work, the appeal of tournaments away from home was on the wane, and economic conditions seemed to have become more difficult for many potential participants. The women were not alone in these problems. The long established and previously highly popular Labour Weekend Tournament for men, featuring the Tauranga Open Title, had struggled to survive in the same era before finally fading into history. The sad realities of a more pressured world were exerting their influence over a multitude of activities. Golf, including the social aspects of our game, was to be no exception to the trend. The demise of these tournaments could in no way be attributed to those charged with their organisation. Everything that could reasonably have been done to ensure their popularity and consequent continuation was done. The world had simply moved on.

THE RUSSELL GRACE TOURNAMENT

The most important Women's tournament ever staged at Tauranga has been the 1973 Inter-Provincial Championship then known as the Russell Grace Inter-Provincials just as the equivalent Men's tournament was known as the Freyberg. These tournaments actually involve competition between teams representing the District Golf Associations rather than Provinces but what's in a name? While sponsorship has led to the demise of these old respected names this has been a small price to pay for the very welcome benefits that sponsors have brought to the Championships.

Anna Brabyn has given us information relating to the history of the tournament and the Russell Grace Cup. Mrs Nancy Young donated the cup to the NZLGU in memory of her mother, Mrs Russell Grace, who was a talented Wanganui representative golfer and long time member of the LGU. It had been Wanganui that first suggested that a National Inter-Provincial Championship be held. Originally the teams competed on a Regional basis, the first final being held at Invercargill in 1949 when Auckland became the first name engraved on the cup. All Districts competed at the one venue for the first time at the Ngamotu course in New Plymouth in 1963. Auckland was again successful though they had not dominated in the intervening years, this being their third victory. Bay of Plenty and Canterbury had been equally successful. Bay of Plenty/Thames Valley were again successful in 1983 at Heretaunga when the cup was awarded for the last time prior to the Tournament becoming known as the Stylemaster Inter-Provincial Championship. The Russell Grace Cup that somewhat incongruously had started life as a trophy awarded to the winner of a prestigious race at the Wanganui Racing Club was finally retired to a supposedly permanent home at the Wanganui Golf Club. The name and the cup were however resurrected to serve the New Zealand Masters Inter-Provincial Tournament first held at Methven in 1992. Many competitors in that first tournament would have been well aware of the proud history of the trophy.

The 1973 Russell Grace Tournament was held in perfect autumn weather at our Gate Pa course. It has often been said that our course is at its best in the Autumn months and, with the extra work put into course preparation for the tournament, this certainly proved to be the case.

Una Wickham, so often a major contributor to Bay of Plenty successes turned her talents to a spot of soothsaying prior to the start of tournament play. She predicted that the Waikato/King Country combination could well prove to be the dark horse of the tournament. Waikato number one Ruth Middleton indicated her intention to prove this prediction to be justified when she recorded six birdies in leading her team to a shock opening round victory over defending champions Auckland. This was Miss Middleton's seventeenth Russell Grace and seldom had she played better golf. Four birdies in the first nine holes had the talented Gillian Bannan tottering yet Ruth had to birdie the 15th and 16th in order to prevail 3 and 2. This match set the standard for much high quality play leading to many a hard fought match throughout the tournament.

Two Tauranga players, Miss Wickham and Mrs Kath Johnston were included in the BOP/TV team. The formidable Wellingtonians were despatched that first morning but the highly favoured Manawatu/ Wanganui team proved too strong in the afternoon thus diminishing hopes of a local victory. The BOP/ TV team finally finished a very credible fifth.

Miss Middleton led from the front in becoming the only number one to remain unbeaten throughout the tournament as her team continued on its winning way. On the final day Canterbury, the most likely team to deny Waikato/King Country victory, was locked in an exciting battle with BOP/TV. Una Wickham, playing her best golf of the tournament, defeated Canterbury number one Sue Boag but it was not enough as Canterbury scraped home by three matches to two. Canterbury could then only sit back and hope that their neighbours, South Canterbury, could topple Waikato/King Country. That was not to be and Waikato/ King Country had their name on the cup for the first time in their history. They thoroughly deserved what was very much a team success. Each individual member had wins when they were needed and though Canterbury scored more individual wins by a margin of four Waikato took the title by eleven team points to ten.

The organization of the tournament had been excellent, the fine weather played its part, the course was in as good a condition as any player could wish, and much of the golf had been of a standard to entertain the most discerning of spectators. The only occurrence to cast a gloom over the tournament came at the end of the final day. An excellent gallery had followed the last few holes as the tension mounted to see which of the two leading teams would prevail. As a result a large gallery was assembled around the 18th green in the gathering gloom and there they remained in the expectation that the ceremonial presentation of the cup would follow very soon after the final putt was holed. Alas it was not to be. The organisers representing the Club were ready, the Press was waiting, the spectators were expectant. Where were the LGU representatives? Finally someone tracked them down. For some reason known only to themselves they had found that particular time to be the most appropriate hour to cloister themselves in the privacy of the Ladies' locker room to deliberate on the selection of teams for something known as the 'Home Internationals'! By the time they emerged the crowd had departed for warmer destinations.

CHAPTER TWENTYFIVE

THE SECOND ONE HUNDRED YEARS 2014 - 2114

In this chapter I will attempt to look into the future to see how the Club and Course will develop during the next 100 years. The chapter will read as though written by someone looking back over the second century of Golf at Gate Pa. Sadly I will not know how perceptive these predictions prove to be.

THE SHORTCOURSE FACILITY

The second 100 years of our Club really started with the establishment of the new short course facility to the left of the second fairway. Suitable practice facilities, or the lack thereof, had long been a problem for the Club, restricted as it had been from the beginning by the lack of space upon which to expand. The available acreage was barely adequate to establish 18 holes of sufficient length to provide a realistic challenge, let alone allow for practice facilities. The problem became even more evident as advances in technology, particularly in ball technology, reached a peak in the early years of the new Century.

The land the new facility occupies was part of a block purchased by Jack Grant's Grandfather over 100 years ago. Jack and his wife, well known, long standing, Club member Sybil Grant, farmed the land for many years. Older members will recall Jack and Sybil making hay on the area then transporting it across the second fairway to link with the driveway to Cameron Road.

The Tauranga City Council recently purchased the land, and some perceptive members of our Club saw the potential offered by the relatively flat area adjoining the second fairway. The legal expertise of Board member Michael J Smith overcame any possible obstacles and satisfactory lease terms were negotiated with the Council. The Short Course team then investigated the available products and made the decision to use synthetic materials to establish permanent, low maintenance, tees and greens. Field Turf NZ were the preferred product supplier and they were contracted to supply and install three greens together with the associated tees, a large practice mat, and an additional large green to be known as the High Performace area. Our own staff established Windsor Green fairways using material harvested from our established fairways.

2013 Club Champion Dave Cooke, in tandem with Club Professional Jay Carter, designed the course to serve a wide variety of purposes for a wide variety of people. The course can be used as a short six-hole Pitch and Putt course, a practice area for anything from chipping to medium iron play, or as a versatile teaching facility where individuals or large groups might be accommodated. There is even a bunker where members can develop those skills so frequently required during most rounds. This particular feature, as with others, is the first of its kind in New Zealand. A product named Bunker Matrix was laid in the base of the bunker, this asphalt derived product encapsulates the clay base so as to keep contamination of the sand to a minimum. The porous nature of the matrix allows water to flow through the sand and out through aggregate material and strategically placed pipes. All this ensures

the sand remains in good condition and very little maintenance is required.
None of this development would have been possible had it not been for a grant from the Lion Foundation arranged by Club Manager Michelle Towersey and BOP Golf Chief Executive Chris McAlpine. This grant covered all direct costs so the only cost to our Club was through the use of our staff to establish Windsor Green turf throughout the area.

The promoters of the Short Course Facility envisage a wide variety of activities taking place on the area over the coming years. Time will tell how much of this comes to pass. Whatever the final usage the facility should prove a valuable adjunct to the main course limited only by the imagination of those who use it and promote it.

The most important debate of the first two decades of the 21st century was related to Global warming. The question was not as to whether it was a reality, but whether it was caused by the activities of humans or was a purely natural phenomenon that had been recurrent throughout the history of the planet. By the year 2020 the vast majority of people had come to accept that anthropogenic activity was clearly the major cause. In light of all the evidence presented to the public and to politicians by scientists it became increasingly difficult to argue that a century and more of intensive livestock farming, forest clearance, fossil fuel use in transport, energy production, and other applications, together with the associated generation of waste products had had little, if any, influence on the state of the atmosphere and the consequent health of the Planet. The academic debate receded into history as people everywhere realised that fighting the problem, not debating the cause, was essential if a path to a sustainable future was to be found. The dangerous upward trend in Global temperature was finally stopped in the decade of the Forties, but not reversed until much later in the Century.

The Bay of Plenty had been blessed with a climate that was the envy of those in other parts of the Country, and indeed in much of the World. While summer droughts had been an occasional problem in the region they became much more frequent and more intense as the Century progressed. Consequently the decision of the Board back in the Nineties to establish Windsor Green fairways throughout the course proved to be a great investment for the future. These Cynodon fairways continued to thrive and provide a good playing surface in both summer and winter without the need to install fairway watering. Extensive irrigation would not have proved a viable option in any event as legislators were forced to severely restrict water usage as water became an increasingly scarce resource.

By 2020 the Board had reacted to the restrictions on the use of irrigation water by converting all the tees and fairways to Windsor Green and to investigating the availability of a suitable strain of Cynodon for use on the greens should the need to convert them arise. In 2030 the decision was made to go ahead with converting the existing predominately Brown top greens to a very fine leaved Cynodon developed by the New Zealand Institute of Turf Management. While these measures added to the requirement for a greater level of mechanical treatment to greens, fairways, and tees, they allowed members to enjoy a high standard of course presentation even in the driest years.

Throughout its early years the Tauranga course had been considered short by National or International standards. There was little that could be done to change that though the reduced run on the Cynodon fairways certainly increased the effective playing length by a significant margin. The possibility of developing some additional holes in the Kopurererua Valley had been in mind since late in the 20th Century but the cost and other problems associated with this meant no decision to go ahead had been made by 2020. At that time modern equipment, especially advances in ball technology, had contributed to the relative shortening of all golf courses. Many quite ordinary club golfers were driving the ball far in excess of the distances reached by top professionals in the years when the PGA Championship was held on the Tauranga course some fifty years previously. Fortunately the International administrators of Golf, the Royal and Ancient Golf Club of St Andrews (R and A) and the USGA, finally recognised that technological developments were simply making the game more and more expensive as existing courses proved too short for even the average player. The solution they settled upon was to restrict the

distance the ball would travel when driven by “Iron Byron” the mechanical driving machine owned by the USGA. This was achieved by softening the ball so that drives in excess of 250m by professionals and top amateurs became the exception rather than the rule. Few players could reach a hole of 450m or more in two strokes. This regulation was introduced in 2020 though the manufacturers challenged it all the way through the courts, ultimately without success. Golf ball manufacturers were understandably reluctant to see any restriction on ball design as they had so much invested in research and development. The Callaway Company alone spent 170 million $US in developing their first ball termed the Rule 35 ball. To compete with one another to produce a ball that is fast and low spinning off the drive, yet has a high spin rate when struck with a short iron, the competing companies employed people who previously worked as aerospace engineers or polymer and rubber chemists. Many employees held PhDs in these areas or in physics or applied mathematics. The humble golf ball had become a product of Space Age

Continuing the story of early tribulations suffered by Junior Boys we recall an incident from the Sixties. Two juniors, Wayne Holden and Brent Sutherland, both still at College, were playing the quarter final of the Club Senior Championship. All square after 18 holes they set off to the 19th tee. When the Captain informed the men waiting to tee off at the first hole for their afternoon round that the boys would need to play through the comments of some of those men waiting to tee off were to the effect that “we are not standing aside for a couple of juniors”. The Captain made it very clear that that was exactly what they were required to do. After this distressing confrontation, the boys were clearly uncomfortable playing the hole, and from memory, scored a five and six to complete the match.

In Michael Nicholson’s junior days the Clubhouse was divided into two distinct areas, the linoleum covered dining area and the carpeted lounge. The rule was that juniors were not permitted on the carpeted area. This was presumably to protect them from the evils of the Bar or perhaps the risqué stories and language of the senior members. By dint of his ability and behaviour Michael had been invited to join the playing category termed Boys’ A, thus enabling him to play on Saturday afternoon with the men. As Michael was still not permitted on the carpeted area the three men playing with him each week would position a table such that they could sit on the carpeted area while Michael’s chair sat on the linoleum. Thus the rule was complied with.

How times have changed. Juniors today are given every encouragement to develop their game and to participate fully in Club activities. They qualify for our representative Pennant teams, including at senior level where they often excel. It is to be hoped they will appreciate that the privileges they now enjoy were hard earned by their predecessors and by those adult members who recognised the need to change the culture that had long treated junior members as deserving of little in the way of encouragement

technology. The golf ball market is highly lucrative and long dominated by Acushnet, manufacturer of Titleist, Pinnacle, and Cobra brands. Other companies had been determined to challenge Acushnet's dominance and research funding seemed to be no problem. Even following the Court decision in favour of Golf Administration the research continued as companies vied to produce "the better ball" within the new regulations. Spin rates, dimple pattern, and cover properties were all fertile areas for further experimentation. Never the less an effective cap had been placed on distance, and club administrators could confidently expect that future course policy would not need to plan for ever increasing driving distances.

For the Tauranga Golf Club, and for Clubs World-wide, the successful introduction of the softer ball had far reaching consequences. The need to lengthen courses was no longer apparent while new courses could be developed on relatively small areas. This was important in an age when suitable available land had become increasingly scarce and expensive. The Tauranga course once again became sufficiently challenging to test the best players, both men and women, while offering fair competition to Club members at all levels of ability.

Though legislation to restrict the flight of the golf ball achieved the desired result Club officials were still interested in making changes, both major and minor, to course design. Three major weaknesses that had long been identified were successive par threes at the fourth and fifth holes, the fact that there were five par threes in all, and the lack of practice facilities. During the decade of the 2030s funds were found to develop two holes in Kopurererua Valley. The third hole was now played as a dog leg to the left, the drive being essentially the same as previously, the hole then turning in a south-westerly direction to a green requiring a mid to long iron second stroke from a drive of average length. A new par four fourth hole was developed requiring a drive and a short iron to a green to the left of, and slightly beyond the present third green. This green was well bunkered to penalise a wayward short iron. These two holes were developed without any inconvenience to play as the existing third and fourth holes remained in play until the third was no longer required. The existing fourth, an excellent par three, became the fifth hole while the existing fifth was incorporated into extended practice facilities linked to the driving range. The abandonment of the existing fifth also enabled extensive contouring of the seventh fairway to provide a better landing area for the second stroke, a long sought improvement to that hole.

A number of other changes were made in the first half of the 21st Century. These included:

Hole 1
The green was moved back and tucked slightly to the right so that the tee shot needed to be played towards the left side of the fairway in order to gain the best approach to the pin.
Hole 2
The Casuarinas to the right were removed and replaced by a cluster of fairway bunkers.
Hole 6
A new bunker was installed to guard the left front of the green.
Hole 7
A new green was developed to the right of the existing green to provide a more accessible target for

the third stroke. When allied with the newly contoured landing area for the second stroke the new hole provided a fairer yet adequate challenge to all players. Few lamented the demise of the green that had been developed in the early years of the new millennium.

Hole 8

The fairway bunker on the right was eliminated and replaced 30m forward of the original position. Its partner on the left was enlarged by extending it towards the green. These bunkers now tended to penalise the better player's poorer stroke rather than the average player's best effort, a much more desirable aim on a club course.

Hole 11

The bunker to the right and short of the green was reinstated but reconstructed so as to allow for easier maintenance. It had long been felt the hole had lost much of its character when removal of the original bunker had opened up the right hand side of the green.

Hole 14

The shrubbery in the Southeast corner was brought back into bounds.

Hole 15

The Casuarina hedge along the first half of the fairway was removed after replacement groves of trees had been grown behind them. Fairway bunkers supported these groves in order to encourage play away from the left side of the fairway. The Out of Bounds line reverted to the boundary fence. Greenside bunkers were installed to the front left of the green to further encourage play away from the left side.

Hole 17

One of the bunkers in front of the green was eliminated in order to provide an opening to the green. It was considered unfair to expect an average to poorer player to be capable of playing a shot from one bunker across another to reach the pin. For men the hole was re-rated to play as a par four, its length being well within the recommended range, even now that driving distances had been constrained.

As a corollary to these course changes the men's committee had another look at stroke allocation and analysed stroke play cards returned by their own members over a three-month period including the 72 Hole Stroke Play Championships. As a result of this analysis serious anomalies that had arisen earlier in the millennium were rectified. The review included the re-rating of holes two and twelve in particular. Now no par three hole rated ahead of any par four or five hole. The revised allocation closely resembled that which had existed throughout most of the previous sixty years. While the analysis showed the 17th hole deserved to be the third stroke hole this was considered to be too late in the round for that allocation as match players might very well lose their match before being able to exercise their right to use the stroke. In all respects the new allocation exactly followed the recommendations contained in both the USGA and the NZGolf handbooks. The long-standing controversy associated with this topic was finally put to rest to the satisfaction of the majority of players following an awareness campaign to familiarise those interested in the aforementioned recommendations. As a result of the information made available the women's committee came to realise that the par of a hole has no bearing on fair allocation of strokes for match play and their fifteenth hole was re-rated as the 5th stroke hole.

The New Zealand economy enjoyed a protracted period of growth beginning in the late 2020s leading to a significant rise in the living standards of the majority of the population. This growth was based upon the forward thinking of the Government, or in spite of their actions, depending upon your political

persuasion. In truth the stimulus arose in the desire of young, educated New Zealanders to make the best future for themselves and for their country. Many of these young people were those returning from Overseas in search of a more relaxed life style while highly qualified immigrants from a wide variety of countries added significantly to the pool of talent. The aspirations of these people led the country away from its traditional dependence on the production of meat, milk, wool, wine, wood and fruit. This eventually led to New Zealand becoming a World leader in Biotechnology. This was especially true of applications in genetic engineering related to the Agricultural, Horticultural, and Medical Sciences. Developments in healthcare, environmentally friendly energy production, and other innovations in science and engineering contributed to significant advances in the wealth and living standards of the population.

With improved economic conditions golf enjoyed an upsurge of interest and the Tauranga Club was again forced to operate a waiting list. The four-day working week had become a reality for many people even though it was not made a constitutional requirement. This put further pressure upon courses as players made greater use of the facilities seven days a week. The population of Tauranga and the Western Bay of Plenty continued to grow and new courses were developed at Papamoa (opened 2026), and at Tauriko (opened 2035).

With more people enjoying a high standard of living and greater leisure time open Match Play tournaments of various formats began to be promoted by Clubs across the Country. The reinstatement of the once popular Five Day Veteran Golfers' Match Play tournaments across the Country was in the forefront of this trend. In 2030 Tauranga became one of the first clubs to restage such an event. A year later the Club reinstated the Annual Labour Weekend Tournament in the original format that incorporated the Tauranga Open Championship last held in 1999. Full fields were attracted to both events with many participants coming from outside Clubs.

For much of its history the Tauranga Golf Club had struggled to maintain subscriptions at sufficiently high levels to ensure they covered annual running costs while allowing reserves to be put aside for future capital needs. For too long the Club had relied on sponsorship from City Businesses and on grants from those who controlled the distribution of profits from Poker machines. Sponsorships had always proved difficult to obtain while grants from Gaming Machines now tended to be channelled towards genuine charities rather than to Sporting Clubs. The growth of the city population, allied to higher living standards, meant that members were better able to meet the true costs of their sport. In addition the advantageous siting of the course well within City boundaries meant there was never a shortage of people keen to join a Club that offered excellent playing conditions all year round together with Clubhouse facilities of a very high standard. The future promised to be at least as rewarding as had been the past.

APPENDICES

APPENDICES

SENIOR CHAMPIONSHIP – MEN

1911 A Matheson
1912 A Matheson
1913 H Phillips
1914 Not Played
1915 J Fowles
1916 J Fowles
1917 R Renshaw
1918 H J Rowe
1919 R H Roache
1920 R Renshaw
1921 A Matheson
1922 R Renshaw
1923 R Renshaw
1924 G Pott
1925 R P Baigent
1926 G Pott
1927 A Matheson
1928 E Hetherington
1929 A C Anderson
1930 R J Phelan
1931 C C T Davis
1932 W Hamilton
1933 R T Goulding
1934 H J Bateman
1935 J K Lusk
1936 R D Johnston
1937 R M Fell
1938 R D Johnston
1939 A Roache
1940 W Renshaw
1941-45 Not Played
1946 H J Bateman
1947 F W Ward
1948 H J Bateman
1949 H J Bateman
1950 F W Ward
1951 F W Ward
1952 K Ramsden
1953 F W Ward
1954 F W Ward
1955 F W Ward
1956 F W Ward
1957 D K Furrie
1958 D K Furrie
1959 R S Mowat
1960 D K Furrie
1961 R S Mowat
1962 D K Furrie
1963 K D Dawkins
1964 K D Dawkins
1965 D K Furrie
1966 K D Dawkins
1967 K D Dawkins
1968 K E Carter
1969 J Lancaster
1970 M N Nicholson
1971 W McF Graham
1972 M N Nicholson
1973 M N Nicholson
1974 M N Nicholson
1975 M N Nicholson
1976 M N Nicholson
1977 W B Bellingham
1978 J Lancaster
1979 I M Dale
1980 I M Dale
1981 M N Nicholson
1982 M N Nicholson
1983 B Roderick
1984 P Creighton
1985 M N Nicholson
1986 M N Nicholson
1987 M N Nicholson
1988 J Lancaster
1989 I M Dale
1990 I M Dale
1991 M N Nicholson
1992 G McFarlane
1993 T B Murdock
1994 G McFarlane
1995 G McFarlane
1996 E A Burgess
1997 G Kinghorn
1998 T B Murdock
1999 M Cannell
2000 B Burbery
2001 G J F Smillie
2002 T B Murdock
2003 R Craven
2004 T B Murdock
2005 A Arthur
2006 K Smith
2007 G Kinghorn
2008 G Kinghorn
2009 T B Murdock
2010 B Burbery
2011 T B Murdock
2012 H O'Donnell
2013 D Cooke

INTERMEDIATE CHAMPIONSHIP – MEN

1946 H Smith
1947 L E Gamman
1948 K Ramsden
1949 C C Parkes
1950 K G Salmond
1969 W Borell
1970 I H Johnson
1971 H A Iles
1972 P T Rice
1973 C H Riley
1992 V Holst
1993 T O'Connor
1994 R Knowles
1995 G Harper
1996 R Knowles

1951 J A J Hart
1952 J E Lloyd
1953 P R Person
1954 J H Neville
1955 E J Scotland
1956 D Gill
1957 W J Urwin
1958 H Jones
1959 A D Elliot
1960 M V Sandlant
1961 J L Tennent
1962 W D Reid
1963 C M Glen
1964 H Dare
1965 C W Castell
1966 C N Ogg
1967 C M Glen
1968 W Holden
1974 T L Forrester
1975 T L Forrester
1976 C H Riley
1977 C H Riley
1978 V J Petrie
1979 R Wagstaff
1980 J Groot
1981 G J Hooper
1982 N J Robson
1983 R Knowles
1984 K Bates
1985 J Groot
1986 S Astill
1987 B Calderwood
1988 W McF Graham
1989 J Grant
1990 C H Riley
1991 B McKegg
1997 B Giles
1998 C Wilson
1999 J Grant
2000 I Thomas
2001 M Mangos
2002 W Groves
2003 P Smith
2004 W Groves
2005 B Hickisey
2006 D Rush
2007 D O'Brien
2008 C Gray
2009 M Warner
2010 B Benjamin
2011 J Tisch
2012 R Pittams
2013 J Carter

JUNIOR CHAMPIONSHIP - MEN

1932 R M Fell
1933 I Bartlett
1934 D V Hanna
1935 D Simmons
1936 E W Woods
1937 W Reid
1938 C W Johnstone
1939 H P Butts
1940 T D Harvey
1941 -45 Not played
1946 A L Davidson
1947 P S Packman
1948 C W Johnstone
1949 D S McShane
1950 I Grant
1951 C E Washer
1952 P R Person
1953 J H Neville
1954 D S McShane
1955 E C Babington
1962 J M Church
1963 A S Bluett
1964 D Hitchcock
1965 D S Cooney
1966 E R Ferguson
1967 W Holden
1968 T L Forrester
1969 C H Doughty
1970 J C Robinson
1971 J M Ollivier
1972 H Cox
1973 B M Owen
1974 E J Kerrigan
1975 A G Singh
1976 R A Mayer
1977 D W McCullough
1978 P Kearney
1979 K Frith
1980 G Goudie
1981 A Dale
1988 M Mangos
1989 A Gallagher
1990 R Granger
1991 G Seigel
1992 G Seigel
1993 T Forward
1994 J Braid
1995 N Rose
1996 H Donald
1997 H Steer
1998 A G Brown
1999 J Loughlin
2000 R Craw
2001 D Hermitage
2002 J Robins
2003 M McKeown
2004 A Palmer
2005 A Palmer
2006 D Moscow
2007 D Stewart

1956 M D Bell
1957 R E Wilson
1958 J C Palmer
1959 B D Ray
1960 F A Shearman
1961 H I Kiddie
1982 G R McLean
1983 J C Robinson
1984 N Copestake
1985 B Krause
1986 L Holst
1987 F W James
2008 S McFadyen
2009 C Breeds
2010 C Breeds
2011 S McFadyen
2012 N Grey
2013 B Patterson

OPEN CHAMPIONSHIP - MEN

1934 H D Brinsden
1935 H D Brinsden
1936 H D Brinsden
1937 H D Brinsden
1938 N P Green
1939 N P Green
1940 N P Green
1946 H J Bateman
1947 F W Ward
1948 F W Ward
1949 F W Ward
1950 F W Ward
1951 H J Bateman
1952 A Fletcher
1953 F W Ward
1954 G L Taylor
1955 J C Belk
1956 D K Boone
1957 D K Boone
1958 F W Ward
1959 D K Boone
1960 N Payne
1961 D K Boone
1962 P D Rouse
1963 D K Boone
1964 T Ormsby
1965 J C Oliver
1966 J C Oliver
1967 T Ormsby
1968 K E Carter
1969 R E Wilson
1970 R J Silson
1971 K Sommerville
1972 M N Nicholson
1973 M J Tricker
1974 N H Johnson
1975 M Cordukes
1976 N H Johnson
1977 W H Hall
1978 J B Ward
1979 N H Johnson
1980 O J Kendall
1981 O J Kendall
1982 G Goldfinch
1983 O J Kendall
1984 D Talyancich
1985 M N Nicholson
1986 D Talyancich
1987 M N Nicholson
1988 M N Nicholson
1989 O J Kendall
1990 M Jenkins
1991 C M Holst
1992 E A Burgess
1993 S Niven
1994 A McNair
1995 M Melling
1996 M Hall
1997 E A Burgess
1998 Not Played
1999 N H Johnson
2000 Recessed

This championship, known as the Tauranga Open Championship, was the feature event in the annual Labour Weekend tournament and attracted quality players from a wide area. It was not played during the war years from 1941 through to 1945 and went into recess again following the 1999 staging.

SENIOR STROKE PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP - MEN

1980 J B Ward
1981 M N Nicholson
1982 M N Nicholson
1983 J B Ward
1984 M N Nicholson
1985 M N Nicholson
1992 I M Dale
1993 M N Nicholson
1994 B Burbery
1995 G McFarlane
1996 E A Burgess
1997 T B Murdock
2004 K J Smith
2005 T Pudney
2006 G Kinghorn
2007 T Pudney
2008 D Dale
2009 T B Murdock

1986 J B Ward
1987 M N Nicholson
1988 J Lancaster
1989 I M Dale
1990 P Gillett
1991 C M Holst
1998 G Kinghorn
1999 G Kinghorn
2000 E A Burgess
2001 E A Burgess
2002 G Kinghorn
2003 T B Murdock
2010 E A Burgess
2011 T B Murdock
2012 D Cooke
2013 T B Murdock
2014
2015

INTERMEDIATE STROKE PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP - MEN

1980 K M Giffney
1981 P Johnston
1982 B Simister
1983 N J Robson
1984 D Benefield
1985 N J Robson
1986 N J Robson
1987 W M Graham
1988 D Dougherty
1989 M Mangos
1990 G Goldsbury
1991 B Simister
1992 G Fairbairn
1993 R Giles
1994 P Mead
1995 B Partridge
1996 M Polley
1997 B Mckegg
1998 R Pittams
1999 D Kirkwood
2000 P Kendall
2001 S Baker
2002 G Harper
2003 R Aitken
2004 I McCallum
2005 A Mestrom
2006 R Bills
2007 T Preston
2008 D Cooper
2009 B Simister
2010 C Wilson
2011 B Benjamin
2012 P Smith
2013 D Stratton
2014
2015
2016
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023

JUNIOR STROKE PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP - MEN

1980 L A Gillon
1981 J C Robinson
1982 A Dale
1983 B Langton
1984 B Langton
1985 T Parkinson
1986 M McKeown
1987 C Mexted
1988 A Gallagher
1989 T Stevenson
1990 W Casey
1991 N Robinson
1992 B Langton
1993 M McKeown
1994 C Gray
1995 C Breeds
1996 B Bradley
1997 P Arneson
1998 R Black
1999 J Stevens
2000 H Steer
2001 G Siegel
2002 H Steer
2003 W A Walton
2004 H Steer
2005 A Palmer
2006 J Forrest
2007 D Stewart
2008 D Hermitage
2009 B Dixon
2010 R J Knowles
2011 S McFadyen
2012 S Davies
2013 M Ball
2014
2015

SPALDING MASTERS CHALLENGE BOWL

1967 W J Godfrey
1968 W Dunk
1969 R J Charles
1970 S G Jones
1971 G V Marsh
1972 R J Charles

The tournament was discontinued following the 1972 staging and, with the agreement of the Spalding Company, the trophy was reallocated to the Tauranga Under 23 Open Stroke Play Championship. As will be seen some exceptional young golfers have held the trophy aloft in emulation of the great

quintet above. The performance of our own Eddie Burgess to win as a teenager against older players in 1993 and again in 1996 and then to retain the title against all comers over the following three years is unlikely ever to be matched.

72 HOLE OPEN UNDER 23 CHAMPIONSHIP - MEN

1993 E A Burgess	2001 B Iles	2009 A Stewart
1994 N Davey	2002 M Jupp	2010 B Campbell
1995 Not Played	2003 M Purser	2011
1996 E A Burgess	2004 J Geary	2012
1997 E A Burgess	2005 R Wright	2013
1998 E A Burgess	2006 J Geary	2014
1999 E A Burgess	2007 L James	2015
2000 G Kinghorn	2008 G J Hill	2016

In conjunction with the Under Twenty Three Championship featured above the schoolboys in the field also compete for the A L Davidson Cup. This pre-dated the Under 23 Championship by some years.

OPEN SCHOOLBOY CHAMPIONSHIP – A L DAVIDSON CUP

1967 A D Chadwick	1984 J Malpas	1999 J MacIntosh
1968 P Harstone	1985 L Spence	2000 J Davis
1969/70 M N Nicholson	1986 J White	2001 B Iles
1971 N H Johnson	1987 S Scahill	2002 M Jupp
1972 S F Reece	1988/9 R Rainford	2003 A Arthur
1973/75 Not Played	1990 A Carter	2004 J Hamilton
1976 I Peters	1991/2 G McFarlane	2005/6 S Shin
1977/78 S Wiltshire	1993 E A Burgess	2007 D Lee
1979 N McNab	1994 N Davey	2008 I Edwards
1980 T Phillips	1995 Not Played	2009 S Brownlee
1981 P Mexted	1996 G Penrose	2010
1982 D O'Brien	1997 M Jupp	2011
1983 D Sipson	1998 C van der Nagel	2012

SCHOOLBOY CHAMPIONSHIP – THE FRASER CUP

1964 J H Jones	1979 S Wiltshier	1994 E A Burgess
1965 J H Jones	1980 N Macnab	1995-98 Not Played
1966 B Burbery	1981 R Parkinson	1999 S Trebilco
1967 J Lancaster	1982 C Dawkins	2000 C Keown
1968 J Lancaster	1983 R Craven	2001 A Arthur
1969 J Lancaster	1984 J Whiley	2002 K Baker
1970 M N Nicholson	1985 J White	2003 M Preston
1972 M N Nicholson	1986 B Drummond	2004-5 Not Played

1971 N H Johnson	1987 S Astill	2006 G Yeatman	2013 S Blomquist
1973 J B Ward	1988 S Astill	2007 T Pudney	2014
1974 N H Johnson	1989 D Schwartfeger	2008 O Coxhead	2015
1975 J Dudson	1990 G Sims	2009 B Shanly	2016
1976 K Wiltshier	1991 E A Burgess	2010 K Knedler	2017
1977 K Wiltshier	1992 E A Burgess	2011 J Cannon	2018
1978 S Wiltshier	1993 J D Carter	2012 S Blomquist	2019

While the A L Davidson Cup is open to schoolboys belonging to any club the Fraser Cup is open only to schoolboys belonging to the Tauranga Club. It does appear that through changes in administration the concept that only schoolboys are eligible for this competition has been overlooked. Consequently in some years it may have been played as a competition open to Junior Boy members rather than restricted to those still at school. In some years the competition was not held as the administrators were apparently not aware of the existence or purpose of the trophy. The donor of this Trophy, Mr Ken Fraser, was born in Scotland. On arrival in New Zealand he farmed at Mangaweka for some years before moving to Auckland where he established a successful business producing and distributing agricultural chemicals. Later he moved to Tauranga where he resided for many years. Ken took a keen interest in young people and donated the cup to encourage Junior Boys to work hard at the game. The success of many of those whose names feature above is testimony to that encouragement.

SENIOR CHAMPIONSHIP - WOMEN

1919 Mrs G Henderson	1951 Miss D Blundell	1983 Mrs A Osborne
1920 Miss R Daines	1952 Miss D Blundell	1984 Mrs P Copestake
1921 Miss R Daines	1953 Miss A Mark	1985 Miss J Brooks
1922 Miss R Daines	1954 Miss U Wickham	1986 Mrs G Snelling
1923 Miss N Wallis	1955 Miss U Wickham	1987 Mrs A Osborne
1924 Mrs D V Hanna	1956 Miss U Wickham	1988 Miss E Proctor
1925 Mrs R Burke	1957 Miss U Wickham	1989 Mrs A Osborne
1926 Mrs D V Hanna	1958 Miss U Wickham	1990 Mrs A Osborne
1927 Miss C Humphreys	1959 Miss U Wickham	1991 Mrs R Clark
1928 Miss E M Goodyear	1960 Miss U Wickham	1992 Mrs R Clark
1929 Miss M Sanders	1961 Mrs O Johnson	1993 Mrs J N Merrick
1930 Mrs E W Heald	1962 Mrs P Kidd	1994 Mrs R Clark
1931 Mrs E W Heald	1963 Mrs O Johnson	1995 Mrs R Clark
1932 Miss M Sanders	1964 Mrs O Johnson	1996 Mrs R Clark
1933 Mrs E W Heald	1965 Miss U Wickham	1997 Mrs R Clark
1934 Mrs E W Heald	1966 Miss U Wickham	1998 Mrs A Brabyn
1935 Mrs E W Heald	1967 Miss U Wickham	1999 Miss C Cox
1936 Miss P Hartley	1968 Mrs P Kidd	2000 Mrs JN Merrick
1937 Mrs A Ripley	1969 Mrs P Kidd	2001 Mrs R Clark
1938 Mrs E W Heald	1970 Mrs O Johnson	2002 Mrs R Clark

1939 Mrs V Maltby
1940 Miss A Mark
1941 Miss A Mark
1942 Not Played
1943 Not Played
1944 Miss A Mark
1945 Miss A Mark
1946 Mrs G M Maxwell
1947 Mrs V Maltby
1948 Mrs R L Bartlett
1949 Mrs C Green
1950 Miss A Mark
1971 Miss U Wickham
1972 Mrs K Johnstone
1973 Miss U Wickham
1974 Mrs P Copestake
1975 Miss U Wickham
1976 Mrs O Johnson
1977 Miss U Wickham
1978 Miss U Wickham
1979 Mrs P Copestake
1980 Miss U Wickham
1981 Mrs R Clark
1982 Mrs M Parkinson
2003 Mrs R Clark
2004 Mrs R Clark
2005 Mrs A Brabyn
2006 Miss W Hanna
2007 Mrs M McCool
2008 Mrs M McCool
2009 Miss R Downs
2010 Mrs A Brabyn
2011 Mrs A Brabyn
2012 Miss W Hanna
2013 Miss W Hanna
2014

INTERMEDIATE CHAMPIONSHIP - WOMEN

1954 Mrs F Davidson
1955 Mrs R Smith
1956 Mrs N Webster
1957 Mrs E Godfrey
1958 Mrs N Webster
1959 Mrs T D Johnson
1960 Miss C Moloney
1961 Mrs G Jackson
1962 Mrs T D Johnson
1963 Mrs R Boone
1964 Mrs W Crawford
1965 Mrs A Hawkins
1966 Mrs J Ladkin
1967 Mrs F Grayson
1968 Mrs S Beamsley
1969 Mrs M Iles
1970 Mrs A Goldthorpe
1971 Mrs N Faulds
1972 Mrs E Martin
1973 Mrs P Wagstaff
1974 Mrs P Wagstaff
1975 Mrs F Davidson
1976 Mrs N Burne
1977 Mrs S Beamsley
1978 Mrs V Hemingway
1979 Mrs P Singh
1980 Mrs N Grant
1981 Mrs J N Merrick
1982 Mrs N Ray
1983 Mrs G Gemming
1984 Mrs L Ladner
1985 Mrs M McFarlane
1986 Miss M Hammond
1987 Mrs S Cooke
1988 Mrs H Kennedy
1989 Mrs H Scott
1990 Mrs K Christie
1991 Mrs A Jury
1992 Mrs W Clarke
1993 Mrs M Hales
1994 Mrs A Rowe
1995 Ms B Glynn
1996 Miss C Cox
1997 Mrs M O'Hagan
1998 Mrs T M Ferguson
1999 Mrs A Stevens
2000 Mrs G McGibbon
2001 Mrs T M Ferguson
2002 Mrs P de Vere
2003 Mrs L Anderson
2004 Mrs L Hawksworth
2005 Mrs H Bourne
2006 Mrs L Hawksworth
2007 Mrs P Verran
2008 Mrs L Hawksworth
2009 Mrs L Taylor
2010 Mrs L Taylor
2011 Miss S Garden
2012 Ms M Duncan
2013 Mrs L Bryant

JUNIOR CHAMPIONSHIP - WOMEN

1933 Mrs C Waterson
1934 Mrs D Hartley
1935 Mrs C Wright
1936 Mrs H Turner
1960 Mrs B Henderson
1961 Mrs O Alsop
1962 Mrs R Marlow
1963 Mrs J Colebrook
1988 Mrs M Barrow
1989 Mrs J Hildyard
1990 Mrs J Hildyard
1991 Mrs M Mabey

1937 Mrs H Turner
1938 Mrs M Strange
1939 Mrs R Sherriff
1940 Mrs R Tollemache
1941 Mrs E Wallis
1942 Not Played
1943 Not Played
1944 Miss A Newsham
1945 Mrs C Stretton
1946 Mrs R Bartlett
1947 Mrs N Hare
1948 Mrs T D Johnson
1949 Mrs T D Johnson
1950 Mrs S R Ellis
1951 Mrs L Smith
1952 Mrs D Coutts
1953 Dr J Reading
1954 Mrs A Bailey
1955 Mrs L O'Connor
1956 Mrs O Alsop
1957 Miss M Shanks
1958 Not Played
1959 Miss C Moloney
1964 Mrs S McLean
1965 Mrs J Crossman
1966 Mrs E A Mitchell
1967 Mrs N Ray
1968 Mrs L Oliver
1969 Mrs D Horn
1970 Mrs P Tingey
1971 Mrs J Pollett
1972 Mrs P McEwan
1973 Mrs J Lever
1974 Mrs L Beattie
1975 Miss C M White
1976 Mrs R Clark
1977 Mrs L Holst
1978 Mrs M Ware
1979 Mrs D Moynahan
1980 Mrs M Robins
1981 Mrs L Smith
1982 Mrs S Moore
1983 Mrs M Ferrow
1984 Mrs S Iles
1985 Mrs M Robins
1986 Mrs D Warren
1987 Mrs M Jackson
1992 Mrs R Anderson
1993 Mrs M Bailey
1994 Mrs C Perry
1995 Mrs E Lockhead
1996 Mrs T D Ferguson
1997 Mrs M Azariah
1998 Mrs S Jordan
1999 Mrs C Elworthy
2000 Mrs P Goodhue
2001 Mrs D Palmer
2002 Mrs J Dawkins
2003 Mrs M Brown
2004 Mrs V Western
2005 Mrs V Baveystock
2006 Mrs S Crawford
2007 Mrs M Brown
2008 Mrs H Palmer
2009 Mrs V Western
2010 Mrs G Kim
2011 Mrs M O'Hagan
2012 Mrs G Kim
2013 Mrs P Verran
2014
2015

Until the Intermediate division was introduced in 1954 there were only two championship divisions for women. Consequently those winning the junior title prior to 1954 were competing in a different handicap division from that pertaining to the present day Junior Championship.

SENIOR STROKE PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP - WOMEN

1981 Mrs R Clark
1982 Miss E Proctor
1983 Miss E Proctor
1984 Miss E Proctor
1985 Mrs A Osborne
1986 Miss G Snelling
1987 Miss J Brooks
1988 Miss E Proctor
1989 Miss E Proctor
1990 Mrs E Proctor
1991 Mrs R Clark
1992 Mrs R Clark
1993 Mrs R Clark
1994 Mrs R Clark
1995 Mrs S Owen
1996 Mrs R Clark
1997 Mrs A Brabyn
1998 Mrs A Brabyn
1999 Mrs A Brabyn
2000 Mrs A Brabyn
2001 Mrs R Clark
2002 Mrs R Clark
2003 Mrs M McCool
2004 Mrs A Brabyn
2005 Mrs A Brabyn
2006 Mrs A Brabyn
2007 Mrs M McCool
2008 Mrs M McCool
2009 Miss R Downs
2010 Miss R Downs
2011 Mrs M McCool
2012 Miss W Hanna
2013 Miss W Hanna

INTERMEDIATE STROKE PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP - WOMEN

1981 Mrs S Beamsley	1992 Mrs A Rowe	2003 Mrs A Holdem
1982 Mrs G Gemming	1993 Mrs S Bills	2004 Mrs S Martin
1983 Mrs B Simmonds	1994 Mrs R Palmer-Forbes	2005 Mrs J Church
1984 Mrs D Swartfeger	1995 Mrs S Watson	2006 Mrs M Carver
1985 Mrs S Moore	1996 Mrs A Holdem	2007 Mrs A Fitches
1986 Mrs M Chadwick	1997 Miss K Copestake	2008 Mrs H Han
1987 Mrs P Sandlant	1998 Mrs D Hartley	2009 Mrs S Grant
1988 Mrs S Watson	1999 Mrs M Clews	2010 Mrs A Holdem
1989 Mrs J Paris	2000 Mrs V Hemingway	2011 Mrs L Bryant
1990 Mrs A Rowe	2001 Mrs P De Vere	2012 Mrs J Dawkins
1991 Mrs A Jury	2002 Mrs F Horan	2013 Mrs S Grant

JUNIOR STROKE PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP - WOMEN

1981 Mrs M Lilly	1992 Mrs P Mullins	2003 Mrs M J Mabey
1982 Mrs J Brandon	1993 Mrs J George	2004 Mrs B Hall
1983 Mrs M Goodjohn	1994 Mrs H Scott	2005 Mrs S Anderson
1984 Mrs S Watson	1995 Mrs C Perry	2006 Mrs S Anderson
1985 Mrs D Hartley	1996 Mrs A Smit	2007 Mrs M Brown
1986 Miss S Cooke	1997 Mrs C Jones	2008 Mrs H Palmer
1987 Miss L Perry	1998 Mrs G Lee	2009 Miss D Magee
1988 Mrs A Pope	1999 Mrs J Church	2010 Miss M Grant
1989 Mrs J Calderwood	2000 Mrs M Young	2011 Mrs M O'Hagan
1990 Mrs P Mullins	2001 Mrs D Palmer	2012 Mrs G Kim
1991 Mrs S Sproull	2002 Mrs S Crawford	2013 Mrs K Gregg

NINE HOLE STROKE PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP – SANDLANT TROPHY

2001-3 Mrs T Harmer
2004 Mrs M Guy / Mrs P Yates
2005-8 Mrs M Guy
2009 Mrs M Dormer
2010 Mrs M Guy
2011 Mrs M Guy
2012 Mrs M Guy
2013

NINE HOLE MATCH PLAY CHAMPIONSHIP – TROPHY

2001 Mrs A Harris
2002 Mrs T Harmer
2003 Mrs T Harmer
2004 Mrs M Guy
2005 Mrs T Harmer
2006 Mrs S Crawford
2007 Mrs M Guy
2008 Mrs H Dove
2009 Mrs J Thomas
2010 Mrs M Guy
2011 Mrs M Guy
2012 Mrs T Ferguson
2013 Mrs S Thorpe
2014

CLUB OFFICERS

BOARD CHAIRPERSON

1995/96 B Partridge
1997 Ms J Paris
2009/10 R Craven
1998/99 Ms B Glynn
2000/02 D G S Mowat
2011/ G Cathie
2003/07 R Cashmore
2008 M Goodhue

PRESIDENT

1936/39 D Ivory
1940/43 A J Mirrielees
1944/46 J Mackay
1947/49 J D Page
1950/52 S G Willcock
1953/54 S G Randall
1955/57 A L Davidson
1958/59 A W Nicoll
1960/61 K Nattrass
1962/63 C W Johnstone
1964/65 R G Bathgate
1966/68 A S Bluett
1969/70 J Reid
1971/72 D McF Wilson
1973/74 D G S Mowat
1975/77 A Gallagher
1978/79 M W White
1980/81 R F Kidd
1982 K Frith
1983/84 R B Eaton
1985/86 E Hutcheson
1987/88 P E Tierney
1989/90 R T Fleming
1991/93 D W Dougherty
1994/95 N Copestake
1996/97 P Munn
1998 M Sandlant
1999/00 J G Baker
2001/02 Mrs P Copestake
2003/04 D G S Mowat
2005/11 Mrs A Brabyn
2012/13 R Stanway

No record has been found of Presidents elected prior to 1936. Early records suggest the Club elected only a Captain and a Secretary/Treasurer in the early years.

CLUB CAPTAIN

1948/51 F W Ward
1952 K Ramsden
1953/54 F W Ward
1967 B J Henning
1968/69 S B Kanapu
1970 D McF Wilson
1988 G Goudie
1989/90 K Moynahan
1991/93 N Copestake

1955/56 D E Coutts
1957/58 C W Johnstone
1959/61 R G Bathgate
1962 R S Lucas
1963/64 D M Collins
1965/66 J Reid
1971/72 D G S Mowat
1973/79 K Frith
1980/81 R B Eaton
1982/83 I R W Allen
1984/85 K D Dawkins
1986/87 K Frith
1993/95 J G Baker
1996/02 No Position
2003/04 J G Baker
2005/08 K Steward
2009/13 M J Smith

In 1986 D Cotteral was elected to the position but failed to take up the office. Members were pleased to accept an offer from Keith Frith to fill the breach for a further term.

Up until 1996 the Captain, together with other executive members, had been elected by the full senior membership (men and women). This person was effectively the Men's Captain and his chief function was as Chairman of the Men's Match Committee that was known simply as the Match Committee. There was irony in the situation where the women members could, in theory, decide who should be in charge of men's competitive golf. In 1996 a new position of Club Captain was constituted distinct from that of Men's Captain. The new appointee was to be a member of the Board and would chair the Player's Committee that was introduced to oversee and coordinate all golf played on the course. As a corollary the men would now elect their own Captain and Match Committee just as the women had done since 1937.

MEN'S CAPTAIN - POST 1995

1996 D Allen
1997/98 D Hermitage
1999/00 E Ward
2001/03 K Steward
2004/05 R Fletcher
2006 K Wehipeihana
2007/08 M J Smith
2009/ 11 C McAlpine
2012 L Klee
2012/13 L Klee
2014 V Ashton

Prior to the end of the 1996 season Don Allen relinquished the position. Keith Dawkins volunteered to complete the term.

WOMEN'S PRESIDENT

1937/38 D Hanna
1939 C Auld
1940 R Poynter
1941 M Sanders
1942 E McKerrow
1943 A Newsham
1944 V Ronayne
1945 C Gilmore-Rogers
1946/49 T D Johnson
1950 P Bateman
1951 D Steedman
1954/57 R Gordon
1958/61 J Carnachan
1962/64 N Hare
1965/68 J Edwards
1969/70 J Cullen
1971/72 J Bongard
1973 E Godfrey
1974 N Burne
1975/76 J Crossman
1977/78 I Duckmanton
1979/80 S Eaton
1983/84 L Hutcheson
1985/86 P Cross
1987/88 V Hemingway
1989/90 A Rowe
1991/92 J Rice
1993/94 A Scoular
1995/96 P Sandlant
1997/98 D Hartley
1999 A Holdem
2000/01 L Goodhew
2002 R Anderson

1952/53 F Woollams
1981/82 D Garland
2003 Discontinued

WOMEN'S CAPTAIN

1937/38 V Maltby
1939 R Strang
1940 V Maltby
1941 C Page
1942 /43 A Mark
1944 E Thorpe
1945 T D Johnson
1946 R Daines
1947/48 R Gordon
1949/51 F Woollams
1952/54 A Mark
1955/56 J Carnachan
1957 M Neville
1958/59 N Burne
1960/61 N Hare
1962/64 J Edwards
1965/66 J Reid
1967/68 J Cullen
1969/70 J Bongard
1971/72 E Godfrey
1973/74 J Crossman
1975/76 I Duckmanton
1977/78 S Eaton
1979/80 D Garland
1981/82 L Hutcheson
1983/84 P Cross
1985/86 V Hemingway
1987/88 A Rowe
1989/90 J Rice
1991/92 A Scoular
1993/94 P Sandlant
1995 D Hartley
1996/97 A Holdem
1998/99 L Goodhew
2000/01 R Anderson
2002/03 P Verran
2004 S Grant
2005/06 P DeVere
2007/08 J Payne
2009/11 S Martin
2012/13 J McDonald

VETERAN MEN'S PRESIDENT

1952/56 J McKenzie
1957/58 G Wallace
1959 D C Collins
1960/61 J McKenzie
1962/66 J Mark
1967 J McKenzie
1968/69 E C Babington
1970 K McIntyre
1971 K Thomson
1972 E M Blomfield
1973 O H Simmonds
1974 C Colson
1975 L E Woods
1976 K G Golden
1977 G A Sanders
1978 P Layton
1979 V Armstrong
1980 G Thomson
1981 J Beamsley
1982 J Beamsley
1983 J Farmer
1984 S Carswell
1985 P Johnston
1986 W Calver
1987 E Otway
1988 B Krause
1989 G Mason
1990 W Vinnecombe
1991 M Kelly
1992 J Newman
1993 B Baker
1994 P Munn
1995 B Child
1996 R Holden
1997 E Otway
1998 M Sproule
1999 J Loughlin
2000 G Riley
2001 R Ellison
2002 P Walker
2003 J Turnbull
2004 M Sandlant
2005 I Anderson
2006 R Diprose
2007 H Boughtwood
2008 J Miller
2009 P Simpson
2010 R Fletcher
2011 D Schokking
2012 D Schokking
2013 D Smith
2014 W Abelskamp

VETERAN WOMEN'S PRESIDENT

1988/89 M Calver
1990/91 H Casey
1998/99 Fay Horan
2000/01 S Cross
2007/10 K Gregg
2011 C Hope

1992/93 S Crawford	2002/03 S Crawford	2012 C Hope
1994/95 K Christie	2004/05 J Paris	2013 A Coad
1996/97 T Congreve	2006 E Drummond	2014 A Coad

CLUB TROPHIES

A full photographic record of all trophies has been compiled and a copy kept in the Club office. Consequently a full list of them will not be provided here. There are some trophies that warrant an explanation of their origins and others where it is important to acknowledge those people who donated them. In many cases the trophy donors were responsible for establishing a competition where none existed prior to their initiative. In most instances the donors have been notable figures in our history and their contributions to the development of the Club have been recorded elsewhere in this publication. This is especially true of the trophies involved in Veteran's competitions, both Men and Women's.

MEN'S TROPHIES

One of the earliest trophies to be contested was the Cameron Cup. Senior players compete for this over 36 holes of Stroke Play. Surprisingly the Cameron name is not derived from our main thoroughfare or from one of the Cameron families of the district. Miss Mae Cameron of Auckland was a regular visitor to Tauranga and enjoyed her visits so much that in 1924 she decided to present this cup to the club as a mark of her appreciation. The first of the two rounds of this competition serves as the qualifying round for the Aquila Cup. This is a senior handicap Match Play event.

The origin of the Aquila Cup has been lost with the passage of time. There was a coastal steamer by that name that made regular trips between Auckland and Tauranga and it is likely that some of the men manning her enjoyed a game of golf when in port. Perhaps the Captain or some of the men decided to express their appreciation for hospitality extended to them. I would like to think that this was the case.

The Waitemata Cup contested by Intermediate members in parallel with the Cameron Cup for senior players is an example of trophies that were presented to the Club in appreciation of the support given by the Club to the suppliers of certain products. Waitemata was a brand of beer produced by Dominion Breweries and supplied to the Club through Guiness Brothers who ran their business from premises at the Northern end of The Strand. Brownie and Joyce Carnachan, Colin and Betty Johnstone, were prominent Club members associated with the business, Betty and Joyce each being members of the Guiness family.

Those Intermediates qualifying for Match Play as a result of their performance in round one of the Waitemata Cup went forward to contest the Geo Wilcock Junior Cup, more commonly known simply as the Wilcock Cup. Life Member and Past President George Wilcock presented this trophy in an era when only two competition grades were recognised, Senior and Junior. When the Intermediate grade was instituted in 1946 it was felt appropriate that the Wilcock Cup should be contested by players at that level rather than by players in the newly defined junior grade.

The committee provided the Junior Cup to be contested in parallel with the Cameron and Waitemata Cups while Norman Green presented the Green Cup that is now awarded to the winner of the junior

handicap Match Play event. This was originally awarded to the winner of the 'C Grade Championship' that was contested by longer handicap players prior to the introduction of the three grades we now recognise.

Match Play events have always been popular with Club players. The Occupational Four Ball was an early introduction to the programme and was open to all members, the only restriction as to who could team together being that implied by the title. This event drew very large fields often requiring elimination matches to be played in order to allow pairs to advance to the main draw of 64. Eventually the competition was discontinued and replaced by the Senior/Junior Four Ball and the associated trophy transferred to the new event.

The Winter Four Balls are contested in three grades. Norman Robson and Paul O'Brien, well-known Club members who ran Businesses on The Strand, presented the cups awarded to the senior winners. Bob Eaton and Keith Frith presented the cups contested by the Intermediate pairs while the committee provided those for the juniors.

The most important Match Play events are those for the Club Championships. Several of the trophies associated with these are of very long standing. Bill Darley who was Secretary to the Club when it first moved to the present course in 1914 presented the W M Darley Cup. It is awarded to the player recording the best gross score over the two qualifying rounds. The Passmore Trophy goes to the best nett qualifier. Like the Waitemata Cup this is a trophy presented to the Club by a grateful supplier. CS Passmore was a liquor wholesaler based in Auckland. In the first few years after this trophy was presented the winner also received two bottles of the best of the Passmore range. The first player to find this tradition had been discontinued was a very disappointed man.

Mr E T Baker, one of our earliest Life Members presented the Senior Championship Cup.

Stroke Play Championships were established in 1980. These were originally played over 72 holes as stand alone competitions not associated with the Match Play Championships. More recently they have been reduced to 54 holes and qualification for the Match Play Championships is based on rounds played in these competitions. Some consider that the staging of the two championships in tandem has reduced the importance of the Stroke Play Championship. The practise of allowing the best two of the three rounds to count for qualifying purposes also causes problems for purists and/or traditionalists. Whether these innovations continue into the future remains to be seen.

David N Coleman, a prominent Tauranga Share Broker, presented the cups awarded to both the Senior and the Intermediate Stroke Play Champions while the Juniors play for the ANZ Bank Cup. The Alan Ward Memorial Trophy is awarded to the player scoring the best Nett over the first two rounds of the Stroke Play Championships. Alan was a member of the Ward family featured in Chapter Nineteen. Details of Alan's service to the Club are given there.
The James Mowat Memorial Trophy has gone through a number of transformations. Jame's widow Margaret presented the trophy and, following the advice of the then Match Committee, it was originally

presented to the player recording the best aggregate gross score over any five rounds throughout the season. This proved difficult to administer in the pre-computer era and for some years it was contested as a Match Play event open to all members whatever their handicap. This led to some interesting singles matches involving senior players having to give a stroke a hole, and sometimes more. That is very difficult to do. The Mowat family provided vouchers that the recipients could use to subsidise purchases of their own choice. The sight of Reg Carter one year proudly donning a Club jacket that he had decided was the ideal prize to commemorate his win lives vividly in the memory. Following a period when it was awarded for the best aggregate nett score over the Stroke Play Championships the trophy reverted to its original role, computers having now made record keeping much simpler.

The Pinto Fruit Juice Company donated The Pinto Cup for Foursomes competition. Past president Dan Dougherty was manager of the company at a time when the company was a major supplier to the Club.

Other important trophies are the Alan Bradmore Memorial Cup and the Nicoll Cup. Harry Bradmore presented the former in memory of his son Alan who was killed in the Second World War. It is contested over two rounds of Stableford competition. Harry and his son Maurice have been acknowledged earlier in relation to their invaluable work in relation to the trees on the course. Life Member Warwick Nicoll presented the latter Cup and it is contested over two rounds of Par competition.

WOMEN'S TROPHIES

Many women and some men have donated trophies that are contested throughout the year by our women players. Although some of these trophies, such as those related to the Una Wickham Tournament, are no longer contested there remain a considerable number that are keenly contested each year.

Trophies associated with the Una Wickham Memorial Tournament include:

- The Una Wickham Memorial Salver presented to the Championship winner. This trophy was presented to the club by Una's brother Neville, his wife, and her aunt Mrs Rennie Wallace (Gordon).
- The KE Carter Motors Salver (Second 16). Ken Carter was an excellent player who represented Wellington prior to his move to Tauranga.

Trophies associated with the Open Tournament in May include:

- The Fairway Cup donated by Nancy Hare, a former Captain and President and awarded to the Tauranga player returning the best Gross score.
- The Nancy Burne Trophy donated by past Lady President Nancy and awarded to the Tauranga player returning the best Nett score.
- The Hazel Casey Salver awarded to the Tauranga player in the Bronze division returning the best Nett score.
- The Moana McAllister Salver awarded to the Tauranga player returning the best Stableford score. Moana was a member of the Waihi Club and a regular visitor to our tournaments.

Trophies associated with Match Play competition include:

- The Contenders Trophy donated by Anne Mark. Awarded to winner of Handicap Match Play for the top sixteen.
- The Contenders Plate, donated by Shirley Eaton, a past Captain and President.
- The Lillian Baker Cup, a handicap Match Play event for players aged sixty years or more. (Lillian, a Gate Pa identity was closely related to the writer Ngaio Marsh).
- The Elsie Hanna Cup for handicap Match Play.
- The Jean Cullen Consolation Cup contested by the second 32 following qualifying for the Elsie Hanna Cup. Jean was a former Ladies' President.
- The Coates Trophy for handicap Match Play. Donated by Jackie and David Coates.
- the Olga Johnson Trophy for Fourball Match Play – Senior division.
- the Massey Salver for Intermediate Fourball Match Play. Pat Massey was a former Club Secretary.
- the Eaton Trophy for Junior Fourball Match Play. Donated by Shirley Eaton, a past Ladies' President.

Trophies associated with the Match Play Championships include:

- The Sare Cup donated by Dawn Sare and awarded to the top qualifier in the Senior Championship. Dawn was Ladies Secretary at one time.
- The Bongard Trophy awarded to the top qualifier in the Intermediate Championship. Jean Bongard was a past Ladies' President.
- The Sim Trophy donated by Nen Sim and awarded to the top qualifier in the Junior Championship.
- The Anderson Rosebowl awarded to the best Nett qualifier in the Senior Championship. Robyn Anderson was a previous Ladies' President.
- The Audrey Payne Memorial Plate for the best nett qualifier in the Intermediate Championship. Donated by Noel Payne in memory of his wife.
- The Alison Holdem Salver awarded to the best nett qualifier in the Junior Championship. Alison served as Ladies' Captain and President.
- The Minie Jordan Salver awarded to the Senior Champion.
- The Intermediate Cup awarded to the Intermediate Champion.
- The Armstrong Cup awarded to the Junior Match Play Champion.
- The Hutcheson Trophy awarded to the Junior Girls' Champion. Donated by Loeta Hutcheson who served terms as Captain and President.
- The Ramsden Cup donated by Joan Ramsden for C Grade Handicap Match Play. Joan served a term as Ladies' Secretary.
- The Evans Plate donated by Elva Evans and awarded to the Senior Championship Runner Up.
- The Davidson Salver donated by Fay Davidson and awarded to the Intermediate Championship Runner Up.

• The Wagstaff Salver donated by Patsy Wagstaff and awarded to the Junior Championship Runner Up.
• The Committee Salver awarded to the Junior Girls' Championship Runner Up.
• The Una Wickham Plate donated by Miss Wickham and awarded to the winner of the Senior Championship Plate.
• The Betty Gordon Salver donated by Mrs Gordon and awarded to the Intermediate Championship Plate winner.
• The McEwan Trophy donated by Pam McEwan and awarded to the Junior Championship Plate winner
• The Margaret Mowat Trophy donated by Mrs Mowat for the second 16 in the Senior division.
• The Edwards Trophy donated by Joyce Edwards for the second 16 in the Intermediate division.
• Mrs Bradmores' Cup donated by Mrs Harry Bradmore for the second 16 in the Junior division. Mrs Bradmore was a generous donor to the Ladies' section of the Club.

Tropies associated with the Stroke Play Championships include:

• The Nelle Golden Plate awarded to the player scoring the best Nett in the first round. Ken Golden presented this trophy in memory of his wife.
• The Dorothy Garland Trophy is awarded to the player recording the best aggregate Nett score over the rounds of the Championship. Dorothy served as Captain in the late Seventies after she and Tom moved to Tauranga from Reporoa.
• The Loeta Hutcheson Trophy is awarded to the Senior Stroke Play Champion.
• The Cross Trophy is awarded to the winner of the Intermediate Stroke Play Championship. Peg Cross was another who served as Lady Captain and President.
• The Coates Trophy is awarded to the winner of the Junior Stroke Play Championship.
• The Robyn Cup is awarded to the winner of the C Grade Stroke Play Championship for those handicapped from 41 to 54. M C Marlow donated this cup.

Trophies associated with Saturday Women's play include:

• The Bluett Trophy donated by Betty Bluett for handicap Match play.
• The Goldfinch Plate donated by Mabeth Goldfinch and contested over two Medal rounds on Nett scores.
• The Sheila Morgan Sportswoman Trophy contested via Fourball Match Play.

Trophies associated with Nine Hole Women's Golf include:

• The Women's Golf Tauranga Cup presented by the Women's Committee and awarded to the Match Play Champion.
• The Sandlant Trophy donated by Phyll Sandlant and awarded to the Stroke Play Champion. Phyll could be regarded as the pioneer sponsor of Women's Nine Hole Golf.
• The Sandlant Dish awarded to the runner up in the Stroke Play.

• The Tauranga Stableford Trophy awarded to the player returning the best aggregate from three of four Stableford rounds.
• The Sandlant Candelabra awarded to the most improved player.
• The Hazel Casey Pitch 'N Putt Cup.
• The Alison Holdem Trophy awarded to the handicap Match Play winner.
• The MacMurdo Cup awarded to the winners of the Four Ball Match Play competition. A keen Nine Hole member, Suzanne MacMurdo, donated this.

Other trophies contested through the season include:

• The Crossman Trophy awarded to the player scoring the best aggregate over any six stableford rounds during the season. Donated by former committee member Jo Crossman.
• The Silson Trophy awarded to the top qualifier in the Elsie Hanna Cup. Nell Silson gave this silver jug to commemorate the staging of the Russell Grace Inter-Provincial Championship in Tauranga in 1973. Nell was a previous member of the Ladies'committee.
• The 'Score of the Year' Trophy awarded to the player returning the best 18 hole gross score over the season. This unique trophy features the medal awarded to Miss Una Wickham when representing New Zealand at the Commonwealth Tournament.
• The Tui Cup donated by Tui Harvey for Summer Handicap Match Play.
• The Marillier Trophy for the best aggregate over six Stableford rounds during the summer season. Donated by Lynn Goodhue (nee Marillier). Lynn served as both Captain and President of the Ladies Club.
• The Hazel Casey Trophy awarded to the winners of the Nancy McCormick Foursomes. The 36+ women pooled their resources to provide this trophy in appreciation of the support given to them by Life Member Hazel Casey.
Nancy McCormick of Auckland was appointed secretary to the LGU in 1930 and held that position until 1952. She was one of the most influential figures in the history of women's golf in New Zealand. The Foursomes competition that commemorates her name is contested throughout the country.
• The Jean Reid Trophy is awarded to the player adjudged to be the most improved over the season. Jean and her husband Jim were active and popular members over many years. Jean served on the Women's committee and as Women's Captain in the Sixties. She also filled the position of caterer for several years. Jean also presented the Tui Cup (not to be confused with the Tui Summer Cup).
The former is awarded to the Saturday Woman scoring the best aggregate over two rounds of Stableford competition.
• The Cronulla Cup is awarded to the player with the best Stableford score on Captain's Day. Members of the Cronulla Golf Club of Sydney, in appreciation of the hospitality shown by our Club when they visited, presented this trophy.
Cronulla was the Club where Greg Holst had been employed prior to his appointment to Tauranga.

• The Duckmanton GTC Trophy awarded to the player returning the best Stableford score on Past/Present Committee Day. Ivy Duckmanton was a former President and Captain of the Ladies Club.

• The Elva Godfrey Trophy awarded to the player returning the best Stableford score in the Christmas Hamper Tournament. Elva also served as Ladies' Captain and President.

• The Memory Vase awarded to the player aged 65 or over returning the best Medal round during the season. Jean White presented this trophy in memory of her mother Margaret Mowat.

LIFE MEMBERS

Mr E T Baker	Honoured prior to 1948
Mr R T Goulding	Honoured prior to 1948
Mr D A Ivory	Honoured prior to 1948
Mr A J Mirrielees	Honoured prior to 1948
Mr P H Roach	Honoured prior to 1948
Mr H B Lusk	1948 - 49
Mr C Steedman	1948 - 49
Mr J A Towsey	1948 - 49
Mr S G Wilcock	1948 - 49
Mr H J W Bradmore	1958
Mr A W Nicol	1958
Mr R J Phelan	1963
Mr A L Davidson	1964
Mr K Nattrass	1973
Mr J C Hare	1980
Mr K Frith	1985
Mr A Gallagher	1988
Mr M W White	1991
Mr N Copestake	1997
Mr B Child	1997
Mr K D Dawkins	2000
Mr D G S Mowat	2006
Mr E A Craig	2007
Mrs E Hanna	Honoured prior to 1948
Mrs S R Gordon	Honoured prior to 1948

Mrs A Mark	1963	Mrs J Carnachan	1972
Mrs J Edwards	1980	Mrs E (Nen) Sim	1985
Mrs E Galbally	1994	Mrs H Casey	2000
Mrs P Copestake	2005	Mrs P Sandlant	2006

Raceday late 70's early 80's.
Note lack of housing development in Pyes Pa.